

Manual for the Dyadic Parent-Child Interaction Coding System

Third Edition

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Feedback is invited on any aspect of this document

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Quick Reference Guide
Standard and Supplemental Categories of the DPICS

STANDARD CATEGORIES	
PARENT CATEGORIES	CHILD CATEGORIES
Coding guidelines begin on page 22	Coding guidelines begin on page 106
<i>Verbalization Categories</i>	
Negative Talk (NTA)	Negative Talk (NTA)
Direct Command (DC)	Command (CM)
Indirect Command (IC)	Question (QU)
Labeled Praise (LP)	Prosocial Talk (PRO)
Unlabeled Praise (UP)	
Information Question (IQ)	
Descriptive/Reflective Question (DQ)	
Reflective Statement (RF)	
Behavioral Description (BD)	
Neutral Talk (TA)	
<i>Vocalization Categories</i>	
None	Yell (YE)
	Whine (WH)
<i>Response Categories</i>	
None	Answer (AN)
	No Answer (NA)
	No Opportunity for Answer (NOA)
	Comply (CO)
	Noncomply (NC)
	No Opportunity for Compliance (NOC)
<i>Physical Categories</i>	
Negative Touch (NTO)	Negative Touch (NTO)
Positive Touch (PTO)	Positive Touch (PTO)

SUPPLEMENTAL CATEGORIES	
PARENT CATEGORIES	CHILD CATEGORIES
Coding guidelines begin on page 191 (Appendix B)	Coding guidelines begin on page 220 (Appendix B)
<i>Verbalizations</i>	
Play Talk (<i>PT</i>)	Play Talk (<i>PT</i>)
<i>Vocalizations</i>	
Yell (<i>YE</i>)	Laugh (<i>LA</i>)
Whine (<i>WH</i>)	
<i>Response Categories</i>	
Answer (<i>AN</i>)	None
No Answer (<i>NA</i>)	
No Opportunity for Answer (<i>NOA</i>)	
Compliance (<i>CO</i>)	
Noncompliance (<i>NC</i>)	
No Opportunity for Compliance (<i>NOC</i>)	

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INTRODUCTION

The Dyadic Parent-Child Interaction Coding System (DPICS) is a behavioral observation system designed to assess the quality of parent-child social interactions. We make a point of *not* referring to this third edition as

“DPICS-III,” to emphasize that the DPICS is a single, adaptable system for recording important parent and child behaviors that maintain particular parent-child interaction patterns associated with ineffective parenting styles and disruptive child behavior. It is not a fixed set of behavioral categories to be used inflexibly. The DPICS categories have undergone continuous refinement and psychometric study since the first published edition (Eyberg & Robinson, 1983; Robinson & Eyberg, 1981), and the system permits selection of categories that address the user’s specific purpose in observational recording. Investigators in our own laboratory and others have added promising new categories to the DPICS for study. Experimental categories that evidence psychometric strength and utility are retained and refined within the system. Psychometrically inadequate categories are deleted. This third edition replaces earlier editions. In this edition, we have moved promising categories still under study to the appendix, to underscore their distinction from the standard categories.

Since its original publication, clinicians and researchers have used this coding system to guide treatment and evaluate change in parent-child interaction therapy (PCIT) and other parent training interventions for young children with disruptive behavior. Forensic child psychologists and clinicians have used the DPICS to describe parenting abilities, parent-child attachment, and changes in parenting behaviors following interventions with abusive families. The DPICS has also been used to describe parent-child interactions of children with comorbid psychosocial and developmental disorders and to examine interactions between health-care providers and children during speech and physical therapies and educational tutoring. Researchers have adapted the DPICS to record adult-child interactions occurring in the home and classroom as well as clinic setting; to record parent-infant interactions; and to record interactions of parents with school-age children. Researchers continue to explore new situations and new categories of behavior as the DPICS develops.

The Format of this Manual

This manual contains three major sections. In the Introduction, we describe the development of the coding system, including the psychometric findings that guided category revision in this third edition, applications of the DPICS in the psychological literature, and general guidelines for coding parent-child interactions using the DPICS. In the main section of this manual we present the empirically established behavioral categories, with detailed coding guidelines for each category. In this second section, all parent codes are presented first, followed by child codes. The final section of this manual contains the appendices, which include supplemental parent and child categories, tables of standardization data for normative and clinical samples in the standard DPICS situations, and the data recording forms.

In the main section of this manual, each DPICS category is presented in a uniform format. First, the category is broadly defined with its essential elements. This definition is followed by a list of representative examples for quick reference. A list of decision rules is presented next for use when a coder is uncertain whether the category should be coded in a particular instance. Finally, the guidelines address specific characteristics of a behavior required to code it in the described category. Each guideline includes examples that illustrate the distinction being made.

To help locate categories quickly, several changes have been made to the manual. The *Quick Reference Guide*, at the front of this manual, lists all DPICS categories in the order they appear in this manual (that is, in priority rule order). In addition, the table of contents is formatted to demonstrate the organizational scheme. For electronic use of this manual, it is possible to go directly to the specific guidelines for a category by clicking on the category in the table of contents.

Overview of the DPICS

The DPICS categories serve as markers of parent-child relationship quality expressed through overt verbal and physical behaviors during social interactions that vary in the degree of control required by the parent. The child behaviors of interest in the DPICS are those that reflect social reciprocity and cooperation in dyadic interaction. The parent behaviors of interest are those that express reciprocity, nurturance, and parental control (antecedent and consequent behaviors that serve to increase or decrease child reciprocity and cooperative social behaviors). Thus, parent behaviors in the DPICS combine to represent parenting styles such as authoritative, authoritarian, and permissive styles as defined by Baumrind (Baumrind, 1967, 1991), and the child behaviors combine to represent degrees of optimal behavioral functioning in young children. Importantly, the DPICS is designed to capture children’s oppositional and defiant behaviors and the prosocial

behaviors incompatible with child disruptive behavior. It is not designed to assess child internalizing behaviors such as anxiety or depression.

The purposes of the DPICS are the same as described in earlier editions: (a) to provide an observational measure of parent and child behaviors during dyadic interactions as one component of the psychological evaluation of childhood disorders and/or parenting skills; (b) to measure baseline or pre-treatment behaviors occurring in dyadic family interactions; (c) to provide a measure of ongoing progress during therapy that focuses on changing general parent-child interaction patterns; and (d) to serve as a behavioral observation measure of treatment outcome.

The DPICS observations are conducted in three standard parent-child interaction situations (child-led play, parent-led play, clean-up), in which verbalization (e.g., *Labeled Praise*), vocalization (e.g., *Whine*), and physical behavior (e.g., *Positive Touch*) categories are coded for both child and parent. Although frequency is a key parameter for many of the individual behaviors coded in the DPICS, it is important to recognize that several of the behavior categories capture sequences of behavior. For example, the category *Reflection*, by definition, identifies a sequence of two similar verbalizations stated sequentially. Sequences are also identified by the *Response* categories, such as *Compliance* and *Answer*.

The DPICS categories presented in this manual have been standardized with children ages 3 through 6, and psychometric data from the major standardization studies are reported in this manual. The DPICS was originally designed for children ages 2 through 6, and children spanning this age range were included in the first standardization of the DPICS (Robinson & Eyberg, 1981). More recently, psychometric studies at Auburn University (Elizabeth Brestan, principal investigator) are examining the DPICS categories with older children (ages 7 to 12), and the final report is due shortly (Brestan, personal communication, October, 2004). Until those data are available, we encourage caution in interpreting data from parent-child dyads with older children. Further, the experimental categories introduced in the second edition of the DPICS have not been examined with 2-year-olds; for this age group in particular, the child verbalization categories should be piloted before use.

The normative data presented in this manual are limited to parent-child dyads with children in the 3- to 6-year-old age range. The clinic-referred children in the standardization studies presented in this manual met the following criteria: (a) diagnosis of Oppositional Defiant Disorder according to the DSM-IV; (b) standard score equivalent ≥ 70 on the Peabody Picture Vocabulary Test; (c) Standard score equivalent for parents ≥ 70 on the Wonderlic Personnel Test; (d) no history of severe physical impairment, such as inability to see, hear, or walk; and (e) no history of severe mental impairment, such as autism spectrum disorders or psychosis. Dyads were not excluded for the presence of secondary comorbid diagnoses such as attention deficit hyperactivity disorder (ADHD), conduct disorder, anxiety disorders, or learning disabilities, nor for parent personality or mental disorders. Non-referred, "normative" comparison children in the psychometric studies met similar criteria but were screened for the absence of a disruptive behavior disorder and ADHD.

Reliability of the DPICS Categories

Reliability of Live Coding

Coding from videotape is relatively recent. In the original DPICS standardization study (Robinson & Eyberg, 1981), all categories were coded live. During development of the DPICS-II, Bessmer and Eyberg (1993) examined the categories (excluding the experimental reflexive categories) with live coding. A community sample of 20 mother-child dyads was recruited and observed in the Child-Led Play (CLP) and Parent-Led Play (PLP) situations. From these observations, three types of inter-observer reliability were calculated: (a) Pearson product moment correlations; (b) Percent agreement; and (c) Cohen's kappa. These data, presented in Table 1 (Appendix C), show that the parent and child categories that occurred with sufficient frequency demonstrated adequate interrater reliability when coded live. The child categories Smart Talk, Yell, Whine, and Negative Touch did not occur with sufficient frequency to permit calculation of inter-observer reliability in this non-problem sample.

Reliability of Videotape Coding

Although videotaping interactions for later coding is time-consuming, it offers several advantages. The primary advantage is that a videotape may be paused and rewound to observe again a behavior that was

unclear initially. Videotaping interactions can also be advantageous when many behaviors have been selected for coding. It would be possible, for example, to code one set of behaviors (e.g., parent behaviors) during a first pass and then code remaining behaviors (e.g., child behaviors) during a second pass. Videotaped interactions are also more convenient for reliability checking, because the two observers do not need to watch the interaction at the same time. In addition, when using a computer coding program while viewing videotapes, codes may be entered with the time of occurrence, yielding more accurate records for subsequent sequential analysis of data.

Reliabilities for the third edition DPICS categories are drawn from the standardization studies conducted on all DPICS categories from the second edition. In the DPICS-II standardization study for mother-child dyads, Bessmer, Brestan, and Eyberg (2005) examined three types of inter-observer reliability (Pearson correlations, percent agreement, Cohen's kappa) of videotape coding with 30 non-referred mother-child dyads and 30 mother-child dyads referred for treatment of oppositional defiant disorder (ODD). Table 2 (in Appendix C) shows the reliabilities for each category across all 60 children. Two categories, child *Labeled Praise* and Parent *Yell*, did not occur in this sample of problem and non-problem dyads. Focusing just on kappa reliability, results indicated adequate to strong inter-observer reliabilities for all DPICS-II categories that occurred except child *Negative Touch* (Cohen's kappa < .40), which occurred infrequently.

Brestan, Foote, and Eyberg (2005) standardized the DPICS-II categories for father-child dyads using 60 new families of non-referred ($n = 30$) and referred children with ODD ($n = 30$). Intraclass correlations and kappa reliabilities established on 58% of the total sample are shown in Table 3 (Appendix C). Among the individual categories examined by Brestan et al. and included in this third revision of the DPICS, two parent categories (*Whine*, *Yell*) and one child category (*Labeled Praise*) had poor reliability (Cohen's kappa < .40). The low reliabilities in this sample again occurred for categories with low frequency of occurrence.

We cross-validated the kappa reliability of all the DPICS-II individual categories and selected composite categories in a pretreatment sample of 89 children diagnosed with ODD and their parents. The sample included 42 father-child dyads and 89 mother-child dyads. Reliability was checked for 33% of the observations from each family. Combining data across the three DPICS situations, the two days of observation, and both the father- and mother-child dyads, the kappa estimates for the parent categories ranged from .38 to 1.00 and for the child categories from .29 to .88. The reliability estimates for each category are shown in Table 4 (Appendix C).

In addition to inter-observer reliability, the DPICS categories have demonstrated test-retest reliability. In a study examining 79 clinic-referred mother-child dyads in the PLP and CU situations, Brinkmeyer (2005) examined one-week test-retest reliability of parent *Critical Statement*, parent *Praise*, and child *Negative Talk* (defined as *Smart Talk* plus *Critical Statements*). She found that all three categories showed significant moderate stability in both situations (see Table 5).

Validity of the DPICS

Several studies demonstrated the validity of the categories of the original DPICS, and most of these categories have been retained in the subsequent editions of the DPICS. In the first standardization of the DPICS (Robinson & Eyberg, 1981), the discriminative validity of several individual categories was established. Specifically, referred children showed more *Whines*, *Yells*, and *Noncompliance* than nonreferred children, and parents of referred children gave more *Critical Statements* and *Direct Commands* to their children and asked fewer *Descriptive Questions* than parents of non-referred children.

Early parent-child interaction therapy outcome studies also demonstrated the treatment sensitivity of the DPICS categories (Eyberg & Matarazzo, 1980; Eyberg & Robinson, 1982). Specifically, Eyberg and Matarazzo found significant decreases in mothers' *Direct Commands*, *Indirect Commands*, *Descriptive Questions*, and *Critical Statements*, and significant increases in *Descriptive Statements*, *Labeled Praise*, and *Total Praise* in CLP after treatment. In the PLP situation, they found significant decreases in mothers' *Indirect Commands* and *Descriptive Questions*, and significant increases in *Labeled Praise* and *Total Praise*. Eyberg and Robinson found similar changes with treatment, as well as significant decreases in child *Inappropriate Behavior* (defined in that study as *Whine*, *Cry*, *Negative Touch*, *Smart Talk*, *Yell*, and *Destructive*) and the *Noncompliance Ratio* (defined as the frequency of child *Noncompliance* divided by the frequency of commands that have opportunity for compliance (i.e., alpha commands). Since these early studies,

discriminative validity and treatment sensitivity of the DPICS categories have been demonstrated many times. In the next section, we review the evidence of validity from the more recent studies examining the categories from the DPICS II.

Discriminative Validity

Discriminative validity refers to the degree to which a category distinguishes between two or more groups known to differ on the construct assessed by the system, as determined by an independent criterion (Kelley, Reitman, & Noell, 2003). The discriminative validity of the DPICS has been documented in several studies demonstrating discrimination between non-referred families and families referred for treatment of children with disruptive behavior disorders.

In a recent DPICS standardization study with father-child dyads (Brestan, Foote, & Eyberg, 2005), clinic-referred and non-referred families showed significant differences on three of six composite categories examined, including child Compliance Ratio, father Inappropriate Behavior, and father Prosocial Behavior. Specifically, the referred father-child dyads showed more father Inappropriate Behavior (Critical Statement + Smart Talk), less child Compliance (defined in this study as the ratio of child compliance to direct or indirect commands that presented an opportunity to comply and less father Prosocial Behavior (Acknowledgement + Behavior Descriptions + Labeled Praise + Laugh + Reflection + Positive Touch). No group differences were found in father Total Commands (Direct Commands + Indirect Commands), child Inappropriate Behavior (Critical Statement + Smart Talk + Whine + Yell), or child Prosocial Behavior (defined in this study as Acknowledgement + Answer + Behavior Description + Labeled Praise + Positive Touch + Unlabeled Praise).

A second standardization study, examining mother-child interactions (Bessmer, Brestan, & Eyberg, 2005), found significant differences in six of seven composite categories examined. Specifically, the referred mother-child dyads showed significantly less mother Prosocial Behavior (defined in this study as Acknowledgement + Behavioral Description + Information Description + Labeled Praise + Laugh + Positive Touch + Reflection + Unlabeled Praise) and child Compliance Ratio (defined as compliance to commands that presented an opportunity to comply), and a significantly higher mother Direct Command Ratio (Direct Command ÷ Total Commands) mother Total Commands (Direct Commands + Indirect Commands), mother Inappropriate Behavior (Destructive + Negative Touch + Yell + Whine + Smart Talk + Critical Statement), and child Inappropriate Behavior (Destructive + Negative Touch + Yell + Whine + Smart Talk + Critical Statement). The referred and non-referred families showed no differences in the frequency of child Prosocial Behavior (Acknowledgement + Behavioral Description + Information Description + Labeled Praise + Laugh + Positive Touch + Unlabeled Praise).

Convergent Validity

Convergent validity refers to the extent to which a category score correlates with other similar measures (Kelley et al., 2003), either because the two measures assess the same construct or because there is overlap between the constructs assessed by the two measures. Bessmer, Brestan, and Eyberg (2005) examined the convergent validity of several DPICS composite categories with parent rating scale measures. Specifically, seven DPICS composite categories (*Inappropriate Behavior* [parent and child], *Prosocial Behavior* [parent and child], child *Compliance Ratio*, parent *Direct Command Ratio*, and parent *Total Commands*) accounted for significant variance in the ECBI Intensity Scale scores (40%), Parenting Stress Index (PSI) Child Domain scores (22%), PSI Parent Domain scores (19%), and Parental Locus of Control scores (22%). As the authors noted, the construct measured by the ECBI Intensity Scale (child disruptive behavior) is the one most closely related to behaviors observed during mother-child observations with the DPICS.

Brestan, Foote, and Eyberg (2005) examined the convergent validity of several DPICS composite categories with father-child dyads. Notably, they found that fathers' scores on the ECBI Intensity Scale were negatively correlated with child *Compliance* (defined as compliance to commands that provide opportunity to comply) and positively correlated with child *Inappropriate Behavior* (*Critical Statements* + *Destructive* + *Negative Touch* + *Smart Talk* + *Whine* + *Yell* +) and father *Inappropriate Behavior* (*Critical Statement* + *Destructive* + *Negative Touch* + *Smart Talk* + *Whine* + *Yell*). At the same time, ECBI Intensity Scale scores were not related to child *Prosocial Behavior* (*Acknowledgement* + *Behavioral Description* + *Labeled Praise* + *Laugh* + *Positive Touch* + *Unlabeled Praise*) with their fathers. Similarly, the PSI Child Domain scores were related as

expected to the DPICS child composite categories of *Compliance* and *Inappropriate Behavior* among father-child dyads.

Webster-Stratton (1985b) found that scores on the ECBI Problem Scale, which measures how problematic the child's disruptive behavior is to the parent, were positively correlated with child *Deviance* (defined as *Whine*, *Cry*, *Negative Touch*, *Smart Talk*, *Yell*, and *Destructive*) and child *Noncompliance* on the DPICS. Table 6 in Appendix C lists several additional studies that provide evidence of convergent validity.

Treatment Sensitivity

Sensitivity to treatment is a type of validity that refers to the ability of a measure to reflect change that occurs during treatment. (Note that the measure must also demonstrate stability, or the absence of change in the absence of treatment for treatment sensitivity to be an indicator of measurement validity).

Schuhmann et al. (Schuhmann, Foote, Eyberg, Boggs, & Algina, 1998) examined changes in the DPICS after parent-child interaction therapy (PCIT) with 64 families of children diagnosed with oppositional defiant disorder. This study used the DPICS-II to compare parent-child interactions of an immediate treatment (IT) group with a wait-list (WL) group. As expected, parents in the IT group showed a significantly higher praise ratio (praise ÷ total parent statements) after treatment than parents in the WL group. Parents in the IT group also gave less *Critical Statement* and more *Behavioral Description* after treatment than WL parents. Children in the IT group had a significantly higher compliance ratio after treatment than the WL children; child *Compliance* significantly increased for the IT group while remaining unchanged in the WL group.

Webster-Stratton and Hammond (1990) also used the DPICS to assess changes in parent-child interactions following parent-training. They found significant decreases in the frequency of *Critical Statement* and *Negative Touch* by both fathers and mothers in the programs as well as significant decreases in Child *Deviance* (defined in their study as *Noncompliance*, *Whine*, *Cry*, *Negative Touch*, *Smart Talk*, *Yell*, and *Destructive*).

Applications of the DPICS

Since its original development, the DPICS has been used to guide the course of treatment in parent-child interaction therapy and to evaluate changes following this treatment (e.g., (Eyberg & Matarazzo, 1980; Nixon, Sweeney, Erickson, & Touyz, 2003; Schuhmann et al., 1998). The DPICS has been used to measure treatment outcomes following other treatments for oppositional children as well. For example, Webster-Stratton (Webster-Stratton, 1994) evaluated changes in parent-child interactions following videotape-based parent-training, and found significant reductions in parent *Critical Statement*, and child *Deviance* (defined as *Whine*, *Cry*, *Negative Touch*, *Smart Talk*, *Yell*, *Destructive*, and *Noncompliance*) as well as an increase in parent *Praise* and parent *Reflective Statements*, similar to category changes following PCIT.

The DPICS has also been used to identify parent-child interaction patterns associated with significant child or family psychopathology, such as within neglectful (Aragona & Eyberg, 1981) or abusive families (Borrego Jr., Timmer, Urquiza, & Follette, 2004). For example, Borrego and colleagues used sequential analysis of selected DPICS-II categories to examine differences in the moment-to-moment verbal interactions of abusive versus nonabusive parents in the DPICS situations. Their study found that abusive parents were significantly more likely than non-abusive parents to respond negatively (e.g., *Yell*) within five seconds after child *Noncompliance* and were less likely than non-abusive parents to praise their child for *Compliance*.

Analyses of normal family interactions in the DPICS situations have also contributed to our understanding of family variables that affect child development. For example, Kniskern and colleagues (Kniskern, Robinson, & Mitchell, 1983) found that, in the presence of the child's sibling, mothers engaged in less conversation, gave less *Praise*, and issued fewer Commands than when alone with one child. Another study (Zangwill & Kniskern, 1982) found a high correlation between behavior in the clinic and behavior in the home for the child's rate of *Compliance* and the parent's rate of punishment (*Critical Statements* + *Physical Negative*) and reinforcement (*Physical Positive* + *Unlabeled Praise* + *Labeled Praise*).

Finally, applications of the DPICS to new dyadic populations, such as teacher-child interactions (McIntosh, Rizza, & Bliss, 2000) or the parent-child interactions of school-age children (Deskins et al., 2004, November)

are extending our knowledge of interaction effects to broader areas of social interaction as they affect child behavior and development.

Adapting the DPICS for New Applications

One common clinical use of the DPICS is to guide parent-child interaction therapy (PCIT) sessions and to determine movement from one phase of therapy to the next (see Herschell, Calzada, Eyberg, & McNeil, 2002a, 2002b for a description of the use of DPICS in PCIT). The DPICS may be adapted to other treatment programs for children and their parents for similar purposes. The DPICS provides a simple method for observing and recording a 5-minute sample of parent-child interaction at the beginning of a treatment sessions to obtain quickly the information needed about progress on parenting skills taught in treatment and changes in the child's behavior. The DPICS categories most often used in this way include the parent verbalization categories that represent positive attention (e.g., *Behavioral Description*, *Reflective Statement*), clear direction (e.g., *Direct Commands*), appropriate responses following compliance (e.g., *Labeled Praise*), and the child response categories following commands (e.g., *Compliance*, *Noncompliance*). The DPICS categories provide detailed information without requiring elaborate recording equipment, auxiliary coders, or lengthy observation periods.

As a measure of the quality of the parent-child relationship, the DPICS is designed to allow adaptations to new situations. The three standard DPICS situations (CLP, PLP, and CU) have been used in the standardization studies. However, other situations have been used effectively for certain populations or research questions. For example, a "parent teaching child" situation, a "forbidden toy" situation, and a "no interrupting" situation (in which a parent is asked to fill out a questionnaire silently and tell the child not to interrupt) have been reported. In addition, the DPICS can be adapted for use in settings other than the laboratory or clinic, such as observations in the child's school or home. For instance, Webster-Stratton (1985b) successfully used the DPICS to assess parent-child interactions in the child's living room.

The DPICS Categories

Evolution of the Categories

The first edition of the DPICS (Eyberg & Robinson, 1983) included categories to record the behaviors of young children and their parents during parent-child interactions. The child categories included observable disruptive behaviors and noncompliance, and the parent categories included parenting behaviors representing both (a) harsh parenting, giving negative attention and ineffective direction to the child; and (b) nurturant parenting, giving positive attention, clear guidance, and positive reinforcement to the child.

The second edition, called DPICS-II (Eyberg, Bessmer, Newcomb, Edwards, & Robinson, 1994) removed categories from the first version found to have low inter-observer reliability and expanded the DPICS to include experimental categories to be studied. One new set of categories resulted from separating certain existing categories into more discrete categories to isolate the important elements in the interaction contributing to child behavior change. For example, the category *Descriptive Statements* was separated into *Behavioral Descriptions* and *Information Descriptions*, and the category *Descriptive/Reflective Questions* was redefined to separate out the category *Information Questions*.

The second group of new categories in the DPICS-II were the "reflexive" categories (i.e., parent categories were examined as child categories, and child categories were examined as parent categories). The reflexive categories were considered important for the examination of reciprocity in parent-child interactions. Exploratory studies had identified differences in the verbal behaviors of disruptive and non-disruptive children (Forster, Eyberg, & Burns, 1990) as well as promising changes in child verbal behaviors during treatment (Mee, 1991). Conversely, the marital literature had identified negative adult interactive behaviors similar to the child categories in the first edition of the DPICS (e.g., yell, whine) that discriminated effective from ineffective partner interactions (Weiss & Heyman, 1990). Changes in these affective adult categories and in child verbal behaviors during treatment had not been studied in the parent-child treatment literature. Relations between these variables and other indicators of parent-child attachment were also unexamined, prompting us

to include them in the DPICS-II for further study. The categories in the second edition permitted exploration of many hypothesized treatment effects. Development of this third edition of the DPICS is based on extensive psychometric examination of the experimental categories included in the DPICS-II (Bessmer et al., 2005; Boggs, Nelson, & Eyberg, 2005; Brestan et al., 2005; Werba et al., 2001).

Categories were evaluated on four criteria: (a) adequate interrater reliability (kappa); (b) frequency of occurrence; (c) sensitivity to change during parent-child interaction therapy (PCIT); and (d) ability to discriminate the interactions of different types of adult-child dyads (e.g., children with disruptive behavior disorders from those of control children, abusive mothers from non-abusive mothers).

The parent categories of Contingent Praise, Warning, Laugh, Whine, Yell, and Destructive were removed from the coding system because they occurred too infrequently for meaningful analysis of interrater reliability. The child Destructive category was removed from the DPICS because accumulated evidence suggested that it could not be coded reliably. Play Talk (parent and child) was moved to the supplemental categories, in Appendix B, because although it can be coded reliably, evidence of discriminative validity has been inconsistent. Finally, the parent response categories (Answer, Compliance, No Answer, Noncompliance, No Opportunity for Answer, and No Opportunity for Compliance) were designated supplemental categories because, although they also can be coded reliably, researchers have not developed and tested hypotheses about these behaviors. Thus, these categories may have limited conceptual relevance for children with disruptive behavior.

Tables 7 and 8 (Appendix C) summarize the Kappa reliabilities and validity evidence for all DPICS categories that were included in the second edition. Frequency of occurrence data for the DPICS categories, which affect reliability, are provided in Tables 9 and 10 (Appendix C).

The New Categories

To make this third edition of the DPICS easier and more efficient to use, some individual categories were combined into broader individual categories. Among the parent verbalization categories, criteria for combining two categories into one included the following: (a) inter-rater reliability of each individual category was adequate; (b) confusion matrices suggested the two categories were difficult for coders to distinguish; and (c) most research using the two categories combined them (alone or with additional categories) after coding, either for analysis or presentation. As a result of these deliberations, the parent categories Smart Talk and Critical Statement were combined into one category, Parent Negative Talk (NTA). In addition, Parent Acknowledgement (AK) and Parent Information Description (ID) were combined into one category, Parent Neutral Talk (TA). The coding guidelines provide detailed information for coding these new categories.

Child verbalization categories, introduced as experimental categories in the second edition, were also combined into broader individual categories. All child verbalizations were collapsed into four categories (Prosocial Talk, Negative Talk, Command, and Question) to retain a measure of the reciprocal nature of the verbal interaction while simplifying the categories for coding. All child verbalizations that contribute positively to the dyadic interaction without leading the interaction (Acknowledgement, Behavioral Descriptions, Information Descriptions, Labeled Praise, Reflection, and Unlabeled Praise) were combined into one Prosocial Talk (PRO) category. Smart Talk and Critical Statements were combined into one Negative Talk (NTA) category, corresponding to the parent codes. Direct Commands and Indirect Commands were combined into a single Command (CM) category, and Descriptive Questions and Information Questions were combined into a more general Question (QU) category. Of note, the categories that were combined are not identical for parents and children because the verbalizations of clinical and experimental interest for parents and children differ. The new individual DPICS categories, along with the categories they replace, are shown in Table 11 (Appendix C). The specific coding guidelines, in the next major section of this manual, provide more information about coding these categories.

Composite Categories

Composite categories are created by combining two or more individual categories into a single category representing a more general construct. The individual categories within a composite category are often coded separately and combined later for analysis or reporting. For example, in reporting results, we often combine the categories Unlabeled Praise and Labeled Praise into the more general composite category Praise.

Psychometric analyses of specific individual categories of behavior provide important information about which behaviors can be usefully added or deleted from a composite category to strengthen the meaningfulness of the composite category. For example, if a frequently occurring individual category did not distinguish referred from nonreferred dyads, it would not be useful in a composite category intended to distinguish these groups.

On the other hand, in some samples the individual categories may occur too infrequently for statistical analysis. In this case, combining these categories into a larger, composite category, will increase the frequency of the composite category and may increase the power to detect meaningful differences. In these cases, it can be advantageous to code the behaviors into the composite category at the outset. For example, if you were interested in measuring parent Positive Attending in CLP, rather than coding Behavioral Descriptions, Reflections, Labeled Praise, and Unlabeled Praise each separately and later combining them into a single composite category, it would be more efficient (easier and faster to code accurately) to code them as a single category (Positive Attending) in the first place. One potential disadvantage to coding a composite category is that if the composite category does not demonstrate adequate reliability or sensitivity for your purpose, it is not then possible to decompose the category to understand the problem or to salvage component categories that might have adequately provided important information. Some commonly reported DPICS composite categories are listed in Tables 12 and 13 (Appendix C).

How to Conduct the DPICS Observations

The Setting

The DPICS observations are typically conducted in a playroom equipped with a table, two chairs, a time-out chair (placed in the corner of the room facing the wall), and five sets of toys. The toys are taken out of their containers, with two sets placed on the table and the remaining toy sets scattered on the floor near the remaining corners of the room. Parent-child dyads are typically observed and coded from behind a one-way mirror, using a bug-in-the-ear communication device to present the directions to the parent. During evaluation sessions involving two parents, the parents do not observe one another to prevent observation by the second parent from influencing their play with the child. [Observations during treatment are typically observed (and selected categories coded) by the second parent to increase parent skill acquisition.]

If a bug-in-the-ear device is not available, the observer may explain the situations that will be observed (described below) to the parents in advance, and then briefly enter the playroom before each new situation to remind the parent quietly of the directions. If observation room facilities are not available, the observer may code from within the playroom, sitting out of the child's direct line of vision. If interactions are recorded from outside the playroom, the child's behavior may be more typical of interactions at home when parent and child are not in the presence of a stranger. Although the information needed from an observation of parent-child interaction may still be useful, clinical judgment must be used in interpreting the findings based on normative data collected from interactions of parent and child alone in the playroom. The DPICS categories and situations may also be adapted for use in home observations of parent-child interaction. Similar cautions apply in these situations.

The Three Situations

The DPICS is used to code the behaviors of the parent and child in three standard situations that vary in the degree of parental control or directiveness. In this third edition, we have revised the names of the three situations to distinguish them from the phases of parent-child interaction therapy, which were previously given the same name. The first DPICS situation is called *Child Led Play (CLP)*. In this situation, the parent is instructed to allow the child to choose any activity and to play along with the child. In the second situation, *Parent Led Play (PLP)*, the parent is instructed to select any activity and to get the child to play along with the parent according to the parent's rules. In the third situation, *Clean-up (CU)*, the parent is instructed to tell the child to clean up all the toys in the room without assistance. In each situation, the behavior categories are coded continuously for 5 minutes, and yield a total frequency of each behavior per 5-minute situation. For pre- and post-treatment assessment purposes, coding begins after a 5-minute "warm-up" period for both CLP and PLP. Thus, the DPICS observations require a total of 25 minutes per parent to complete (i.e., 10 minutes of

CLP, 10 minutes of PLP, and 5 minutes of CU). Before treatment begins, these observations are conducted twice, usually one week apart, to increase the stability of the baseline scores.

Instructions for the Three Standard Situations

The directions are typically presented to the parent over a “bug-in-the-ear” microphone device from an observation room. In this way, the child hears the initial directions from the parent rather than from the therapist.

1) Child-Led Play

“In this situation tell _____ that he/she may play with whatever he/she chooses. Let him/her choose any activity he/she wishes. You just follow his/her lead and play along with him/her.”

After the 5-minute warm-up period, the parent is told:

“You're doing a nice job of letting _____ lead the play. Please continue to let him/her lead.”

2) Parent-Led Play

“That was fine. Please do not clean up the toys at this time. Now we'll switch to the second situation. Tell _____ that it is your turn to choose the game. You may choose any activity. Keep him/her playing with you according to your rules.”

After the 5-minute PLP warm-up period, the parent is told:

“You're doing a nice job of leading the play. Please continue to get _____ to play along with you according to your rules.”

3) Clean-Up

“That was fine. Now please tell _____ that it is time to leave the playroom and the toys must be put away. Make sure you have him/her put the toys away by him/herself. Have him/her put all the toys in their containers and all the containers in the toy box.”

The Toys

Table 14 (Appendix C) lists the kinds of toys that are and are not appropriate for use in DPICS observations. Appropriate toys are ones that encourage creativity and constructive play, such as building blocks, drawing materials, and toy animals. Inappropriate toys are ones that lead to noisy or aggressive behavior, are messy or difficult to clean up, elicit stereotyped responses, discourage conversation, or lead the parent or child to pretend they are a character in the play other than themselves. Board games with pre-set rules are also inappropriate during observation of the Child Led Play because it may be difficult to ignore rule-breaking and continue with a game. When the DPICS is used to measure treatment outcome, we recommend that the same toys be used during the pre- and post-treatment observations and that different toys be used during treatment sessions. Five different toy sets should be available in the playroom during the formal assessment sessions. This helps to ensure that an age-appropriate, appealing toy is available to the child, that the child will not become bored with the toys during the observation period, and that there will be enough toys to last throughout the 5-minute observation of Clean-up.

Coding the Observations

The observations of the dyadic interactions can be recorded either “live” or from videotapes of the interactions. Live coding is typically used during treatment sessions and general clinical assessment, and videotaped coding is typically used for research assessments. The continuous recording of behaviors during a 5-minute observation period contributes to the validity and utility of the DPICS by providing a complete account of the behaviors and permitting data to be collected in less time than is typically required by interval sampling methods. However, interval sampling of the DPICS has been used reliably (Bessmer & Eyberg, 1993, November). The full set of DPICS categories may be coded, or only a subset, depending on the purpose

of the parent-child assessment. Similarly, to measure a specific target behavior not currently in the system, the new behavior can be added to the recording sheet or computer-coding program.

For live coding with the DPICS, several coding sheets have been developed for different purposes. During parent-child interaction therapy, where a 5-minute situation is typically coded at the start of each session to provide immediate information to guide the session, shortened versions have been developed that focus specifically on parenting skills or child behaviors targeted for change (see Parent-Child Interaction Therapy Session Integrity Checklists and Materials on the PCIT website for examples). These coding sheets also contain sections for rating qualitative aspects of the interaction immediately following the 5-minute coding interval.

Figures 1 and 2 (on the following pages) are examples of coding sheets that contain all of the individual DPICS categories. These sheets are most commonly used in research to measure pre-treatment and post-treatment interactions for analyses of treatment change. They are also useful in general psychological assessment of parent-child behavior when access to data are needed rapidly and video-computer recording is not practical. Figure 1 shows a coding sheet for continuous recording during the 5-minute observation. With this sheet, the observer uses a stopwatch to time the 5-minute coding interval, and codes the behaviors by placing a tally mark in the appropriate space reserved for each behavior each time the behavior occurs.

In addition to continuous recording, the DPICS behaviors can be recorded sequentially for later sequential analysis of the data. Figure 2 illustrates a sequential data recording sheet. With sequential coding, the observer records the behaviors of interest in the order in which they occur. The recording sheet contains columns that each represent a 10 second interval. The interval columns are further divided into five sub-columns that allow the observer to record up to 5 behaviors in each 10-sec. interval by placing a tally mark in the row representing the appropriate category and the sub-column representing the next occurrence of any behavior within that 10 sec. interval. Each recording sheet captures 60-seconds of behavior interaction. In most instances, sequential coding of DPICS permits a break from coding (e.g., 30 sec) between sheets, which may increase reliability in some cases, although it also adds time to the total assessment. Sequential coding is also technically more complex in that it requires coders to listen to pre-recorded “beeps” that cue movement from one interval to the next during the observation.

When coding from videotape, data for any or all categories may be computer-recorded using a software program developed specifically for this third version of DPICS. In addition to permitting analyses of frequencies and sequences of coded behaviors, the program provides a record of the precise time that each behavior is coded. When a second coder recodes the same observation session for purposes of reliability assessment, the program is able to calculate a variety of reliability estimates, including Cohen’s kappa. Along with the kappa estimates, the program produces the confusion matrices for each class of behavior (i.e., verbalization, vocalization, physical behavior, response behavior), which show how often a category was coded by the two coders at the same time and also how often a different category within the same class was coded at that time by the reliability coder - and which other specific category it was that was coded. By pinpointing which categories have been confused with one another, confusion matrices help coders to maintain reliable coding over time.

The DPICS Coding Sheet

Subject #: _____ Date: _____ Observer: _____
 Child's Name: _____ Parent: ☐ Mother ☐ Father ☐ Other: _____
 Situation: ☐ CLP ☐ PLP ☐ CU Observation ID#: _____

PARENT BEHAVIOR	TALLY	CHILD BEHAVIOR	TALLY
Direct Commands (DC) followed by:		Negative Talk (NTA)	
Compliance (CO)		Prosocial Talk (PRO)	
Noncompliance (NC)			
No Opportunity (NOC)		Question (QU)	
Indirect Commands (IC) followed by:		Command (CM)	
Compliance (CO)			
Noncompliance (NC)		Whine (WH)	
No Opportunity (NOC)		Yell (YE)	
Information Questions (IQ) followed by:			
Answer (AN)		Positive Touch (PTO)	
No Answer (NA)		Negative Touch (NTO)	
No Opportunity (NOA)		Other (specify)	
Descriptive/Reflective Questions (DQ)			
Behavioral Descriptions (BD)			
Reflections (RF)			
Labeled Praise (LP)			
Unlabeled Praise (UP)			
Neutral Talk (TA)			
Negative Talk (NTA)			
Positive Touch (PTO)			
Negative Touch (NTO)			
		Notes:	

Figure 1. DPICS Continuous Data Recording Sheet.

Note. This recording sheet contains all individual categories of the DPICS. It is commonly used in research for live recording of pre-treatment-and post-treatment assessment observations when video-computer coding is not used.

DPICS Sequential Data Recording Sheet

Subject #: _____ Date: _____ Observer: _____

Child's Name: _____ Parent: ☐ Mother ☐ Father ☐ Other: _____

Observation #: _____ Situation: ☐ CLP ☐ PLP ☐ CU

Parent	Interval # _____	Interval # _____	Interval # _____	Parent	Interval # _____	Interval # _____	Interval # _____	Parent
DC-CO				DC-CO				DC-CO
DC-NC				DC-NC				DC-NC
DC-NOC				DC-NOC				DC-NOC
IC-CO				IC-CO				IC-CO
IC-NC				IC-NC				IC-NC
IC-NOC				IC-NOC				IC-NOC
IQ-AN				IQ-AN				IQ-AN
IQ-NA				IQ-NA				IQ-NA
IQ-NOA				IQ-NOA				IQ-NOA
DQ				DQ				DQ
BD				BD				BD
RF				RF				RF
LP				LP				LP
UP				UP				UP
TA				TA				TA
NTA				NTA				NTA
PTO				PTO				PTO
NTO				NTO				NTO
Child				Child				Child
NTA				NTA				NTA
PRO				PRO				PRO
QU				QU				QU
CM				CM				CM
WH				WH				WH
YE				YE				YE
PTO				PTO				PTO
NTO				NTO				NTO

Figure 2. DPICS Sequential Data Recording Sheet

Note. This recording sheet contains all of the individual DPICS categories. This single page captures behavior occurring during one minute of observation. Studies using live sequential recording typically complete 5 sheets per situation during each observation period, to record 5 minutes of child behavior per situation.

Basic Coding Rules

The Four Classes of Behavior

Certain basic coding rules apply to all categories coded in the DPICS (see below and Appendix A), and some rules refer to categories within specific classes of behavior. The DPICS categories are grouped into four distinct classes of behavior, including: (a) **Verbalizations** (e.g., *Direct Command*, *Labeled Praise*, *Neutral Talk*), which describe the content of the verbal behavior; (b) **Vocalizations** (*Whine*, *Yell*) which describe the tone of the verbal behavior; (c) **Physical behaviors** (*Positive Touch*, *Negative Touch*); and (d) **Response behaviors** (e.g., *Compliance to Command*, *No Opportunity to Comply*, *Answer to Question*, *No Answer*) which describe important sequences in the parent-child interaction.

The Priority Order

When a behavior contains elements of more than one category *within* a class of behavior, only one category is coded. For example, the sentence “Isn’t that pretty snowflake you drew!” has elements of two categories in the verbalization class: a *Descriptive/Reflective Question* and a *Labeled Praise*. A **Priority Order** has been established (shown in Table 15, Appendix C) that lists the categories for each class in the order of their importance to the quality of the parent-child interaction. Thus, in the example given, the priority order indicates that praise takes precedence over questions. Therefore, this verbalization is coded only as a *Labeled Praise*.

Decision Rules

There will be times when a coder is **not sure** which category in a class should be coded. Using the hypothetical sentence, “Isn’t that a brightlight snowflake you drew,” if you were unsure if “brightlight” is positive or neutral, you might be unsure if the sentence is a praise or a question. When a coder cannot decide between two categories, the manual has **Decision Rules** to guide the choice. The decision rules list the categories in exactly reverse order from the priority order (see Table 15, Appendix C). That is, when in doubt between two categories, the decision rules guide the coder to select the category that is least important to the quality of the parent-child interaction. The decision rules are intended to prevent over-coding of important behaviors when there is doubt. At the same time, they are intended to help prevent the coding of neither category when in doubt, so that the overall rate of behavior during the interaction is not underestimated.

Note that when a behavior contains elements of two categories in *different* classes of behavior, such as a yelled criticism, both elements (e.g., both the *Yell* and the *Critical Statement*) are coded. Similarly, if two behaviors from different classes occur simultaneously, such as child compliance and a child verbalization, both behaviors are coded.

The Complete Thought Rule

One unit of behavior is defined by a complete thought, which is often expressed in a sentence, and is considered one behavior. In conversation, however, people do not speak in complete, grammatically correct sentences. Rather, they may name a series of objects or say short phrases. Sentence **fragments** that do not contain independent meaning are not considered complete thoughts and, consequently, are not coded as separate verbalizations. However, if an initial sentence fragment (e.g., “This is a...”) is completed (that is, the thought is finished) after a pause of any length, the entire sentence is coded as one verbalization as long as there has been no intervening verbalization during the pause.

The Two-Second Rule

When it is unclear whether a verbalization is a separate, complete, meaningful thought or is part of a verbalization occurring immediately before or after it, the coder may apply the **two-second rule**. This rule states that when there is a pause of two or more seconds between verbalizations, the observer codes the verbalizations separately. When it is clear that two verbalizations constitute separate, meaningful thoughts, a two-second pause is not necessary for coding the verbalizations separately.

Talking to Oneself

Verbalizations must be directed to the other person in the parent-child dyad to be coded. If the speaker is clearly speaking to him or herself, to a person not in the room (e.g., an observer behind a one-way mirror, the

verbalization is not coded. If it is unclear whether the verbalization is directed to the other person, code the verbalization as if is directed to the other person. Note: If using the supplemental category “*Play Talk*,” speaking to inanimate objects may be coded. Please see Appendix B for guidelines for coding “*Play Talk*.” If not using the supplemental Play Talk categories, verbalizations directed to one’s own toy are not coded. However, speaking to the toy of the other is coded as if the verbalization were directed to the other person. See Appendix A for additional guidelines for verbalizations that are not coded.

Coding Yes and No

Because of their unique uses in language and interactions, the words “yes” and “no” are coded independently (as *Neutral Talk*, *Negative Talk*, or *Unlabeled Praise*) whether they occur alone or at the beginning of a sentence. The remainder of the sentence, if any, is then coded in its appropriate category.

Superfluous phrases

Words that have no distinct meaning other than to introduce the sentence, such as the superfluous phrases “I see,” “I guess,” “Now,” and “I said,” are ignored and are not coded separately. For example, if a parent said “I guess you are drawing a big bird,” one *Behavioral Description* would be coded. If the child asked, “What did you say,” and the parent repeated, “I said now you are drawing a big bird” again only one *Behavioral Description* would be coded.

PARENT CATEGORIES

NEGATIVE TALK (NTA)

Definition

Negative talk is a verbal expression of disapproval of the child or the child's attributes, activities, products, or choices. Negative talk also includes sassy, sarcastic, rude, or impudent speech.

Parent Negative Talk Examples	
You're being naughty.	I think you are being careless.
You put it in the wrong place.	I guess you did the whole thing wrong.
That's a messy picture.	(child trips and parent yells sarcastically) Way to go!
That's crooked.	You drew an ugly flower and you put it on the wrong side.
What do you think you're doing?	You made a horrible dog and made a worse cat.
You're working too slowly.	Don't eat that cookie in here and spill crumbs.
That's not quite right, sweetie.	Will you stop whining?
That's not red.	Clean up the mess you made.
No.	Children aren't supposed to yell when they're inside.
Stop that.	(whines, "You're cheating.")
You can't do that.	If you quit screaming, you'll have more time to play.
We did a bad job.	If you keep sassing, I'll put you in time-out.
(sarcastic tone) Whoopy-do.	If you stop fussing, I'll get out the new toys.
Shut up!	What's with you today?
I don't give a #@*!#*.	You are a spoiled brat!
Put it down or else!	If you do that again, I'm going to take out the switch.
(sarcastically) That was smart.	(following child command) No.
Bad, bad, bad.	What are you supposed to be doing now?

Decision rules

1. When uncertain as to whether a statement is coded a Negative Talk or a lower priority category such as a Neutral Talk, Reflective Statement, question, or command, do not code Negative Talk.
2. When uncertain as to whether a comment is Negative Talk or a neutral remark, do not code Negative Talk.

Parent NTA Guidelines

1. A comment that contains a negatively evaluative word(s) referring to an action, product, attribute, or choice of the child is a Negative Talk.

Examples	
Child: (drawing a house). Parent: What an <u>ugly</u> drawing. (NTA)	Child: (building) Do you like my fort? Parent: It's <u>not very -good</u> . (NTA)
Child: (throws a car) Parent: That's <u>naughty</u> . (NTA)	Child: Sissy's a show-off. Parent: That's not nice to say. (NTA)

2. **Negative talk does not need an explicitly stated negatively evaluative word if it is clear from the context that it is a negative evaluation.**

Examples	
Child: Do you like my picture? Parent: Actually, you've done better. (NTA)	Parent: Write your name as fast as you can. Child: (writes name) Parent: That was slow. (NTA) ----- BUT: Parent: Do it slowly. Child: (obeys) Parent: That was slow. (TA)
Parent: Draw a straight line. Child: (draws a crooked line) Parent: The line is crooked. (NTA) ----- BUT: Child: I'm drawing a path to the house. Parent: The path is crooked. (TA)	

3. **Ingenuine questions that specify or imply a negative evaluation of the attributes, activities, or products of the child are Negative Talk.**

Examples	
Parent: When is that assignment due? Child: I don't know. Parent: Why don't you ever listen? (NTA)	Child: (throwing blocks) Parent: Do you want to go to time-out? (NTA)
Child: You pig! Parent: What did I tell you about name-calling? (NTA)	Child: (taking candy from mother's purse) Parent: What do you think you're doing? (NTA)

4. **Negative talk may express an unacceptable level or degree of an attribute, activity, product, or choice of the child.**

Examples	
Child: (cutting out a picture) Parent: It could be better. (NTA)	Child: I'm not done yet. Parent: You're too slow. (NTA)
Child: (yells excitedly) I'm finished! Parent: You're talking too loudly. (NTA)	Child: Is this as good as Johnny's? Parent: You can't help not being as smart as your brother. (NTA)
Child: (continues crying after having been told to stop) Parent: That's enough! (NTA)	

5. **A description that corrects the child's behavior by pointing out what the child has done wrong is Negative Talk, even if delivered in honeyed or playful tones.**

Examples	
Child: (drawing flag) Parent: You're still not using quite the right colors for the American flag. (NTA)	Child: (puts puzzle piece in wrong place) Parent: That's not where it goes, honey. (NTA)
Child: Is this how my name goes? Parent: (laughs) My little sweetheart has spelled it wrong again. (NTA)	

6. Statements that directly tell the child that what the child has said is wrong are Negative Talk unless the parent is contradicting a negative child self-evaluation.

- a. Statements that “correct” the child's preceding statement are Negative Talk only if they directly negate the child's words. Statements that simply provide correct information without directly negating the child or the child's words are not Negative Talk.

Examples	
Child: This is red. Parent: That is not red. (NTA) ----- OR: Parent: You're wrong. (NTA) ----- BUT: Parent: This is blue. (TA)	Child: (holds up dog) “Moo!” (PT) Parent: (smiling) Dogs don't moo! (NTA) ----- BUT: Parent: Dogs say “Aarff”. (TA)
Child: Bert's driving to the market. Parent: That's not his name. (NTA) ----- OR: Parent: He's not Bert. (NTA) ----- BUT: Parent: You mean Ernie's driving to the market. (TA)	

- b. When a parent uses the word “No” or its synonyms to indicate that a preceding statement by the child is incorrect, the word “No” or its synonyms is coded as an independent Negative Talk. Any subsequent verbalization is coded separately.

Examples	
Child: This is the tallest one. Parent: No. (NTA) ----- OR: Parent: No, that's not the tallest. (NTA+NTA) ----- BUT: Parent: The one over there is the tallest one. (TA)	Child: Fish say meow. Parent: Uh-uh. Fish say glub-glub. (NTA+TA) ----- BUT: Parent: Fish say glub-glub. (TA)
Child: I drew three flowers. Parent: No, you drew two flowers. (NTA+BD)	Child: The doggy is red. Parent: No, he's not (NTA+NTA) Child: Yes, he is. (NTA+NTA) ----- BUT: Child: Yes, but he's just a dark red with some blue in it (TA+TA) Parent: Unh-unh (NTA) Child: Uh-huh (NTA)

- c. If a parent “corrects” a child's statement of negative self-evaluation by using the word “no” or its synonyms or by stating any direct negation of the child's statement, the parent's correction is not coded Negative Talk.

Examples	
Child: I broke the elevator. Parent: You didn't break it. (TA)	Child: I made a mess. Parent: You didn't make a mess. (TA) ----- OR: Parent: No, you didn't make a mess. (TA + TA)
Child: I can't do these any good. Parent: That's not true. (TA) ----- NOTE: Parent: You can do them very well. (LP)	

7. When the word “No” or its synonyms provides a negative appraisal of the child in response to a child’s self-evaluative question or statement, code Negative Talk.

Examples	
Child: Am I smart? Parent: No. (NTA)	Child: I am nice. Parent: No, you're not. (NTA + NTA)
BUT: Child: Am I stupid? Parent: No. (TA)	BUT: Child: I am bad. Parent: No, you're not. (TA + TA)
Child: Do you like my picture? Parent: Not really (no pause) what is it anyway? (NTA + IQ)	

8. When the word “No” or its synonyms is used to indicate that the child must not start or continue a behavior, it is coded as an independent Negative Talk.

Examples	
Child: (starting to scribble on wall with crayon) Parent: No. (NTA)	Child: (pulling back arm as if preparing to hit) Parent: No. (NTA)
OR: Parent: No, don't do that. (NTA + NTA)	OR: Parent: Whoa. Settle down. (NTA+ DC/NOC)
NOTE: Parent: No, no, no. (NTA)	
Child: (standing in chair) Parent: Uh-uh. (1 sec. pause) Get down now. (NTA + DC)	

9. When the child expresses a wish and the parent responds to the child's verbalization with “No” or its synonyms, the “No” is Neutral Talk not Negative Talk.

Examples	
Child: I want to dye my hair green for Halloween. Parent: No. (TA)	Child: I'd like to play with the Legos. Parent: No, it's time to clean up. (TA + TA)
Child: I wish we could take all the toys out. Parent: Uh-uh. (TA)	Child: I want a hamburger. Parent: No, we'll eat dinner when we get home. (TA + TA)

10. A statement that directly instructs the child not to perform some behavior that the child is engaged in, has just started, or has just completed, is a Negative Talk.

Examples	
Child: (making loud animal noises) Parent: Cut that out. (NTA)	Child: (just drew on wall) Parent: I told you not to write on the wall. (NTA)
Child: (whining) I want some candy. Parent: I want you to stop acting like a baby. (NTA)	Child: (yells) I won! I won! Parent: Please stop shouting. (NTA)
Child: (put crayons in mouth) Parent: I don't want you to do that again. (NTA)	Child: (making loud engine sound while playing with cars) Parent: Quit it. (NTA)
Child: (Raises arm to hit mother) Parent: Don't you hit. (NTA)	
BUT: Child: I'm going to the bathroom. Parent: Don't talk to strangers. (TA)	

- 11. Statements indicating that the child should not engage in behavior that the child is beginning, engaging in, or has just completed (e.g., “You can't...”, or “You are not allowed to..... You are not going to...” are Negative Talk. When such statements describe general rules for child behavior that do not relate to ongoing or immediately completed (< 5 sec.) behavior, code Neutral Talk.**

Examples	
Child: (begins drawing on parent's paper) Parent: You can't use this paper. (NTA) ----- BUT: Child: (drawing while parent works) Parent: (sets stack of bond paper on desk) Parent: You can't use this paper. (TA)	Child: (climbing on table) Parent: You aren't allowed to stand on the table. (NTA) ----- BUT: Child: (coloring quietly) Parent: You aren't allowed to leave the room while I'm gone. (TA)

- 12. A verbalization that expresses disapproval of both the child and the parent, and/or their shared attributes, activities, products, or choices, is coded as Negative Talk.**

Examples	
Child: (yells) Look at this one! Parent: We're talking too loudly. (NTA)	Dyad: (cutting out shapes) Parent: We shouldn't be using so much paper. (NTA)
Dyad: (looking at a drawing they both worked on) Parent: It's not very good. (NTA)	Child: We made a mess of this room. Parent: We did make a mess of it. (NTA) ----- OR: Parent: We made a mess of it, didn't we? (NTA)

- 13. A parent verbalization containing self-criticism is not coded as a Negative Talk.**

Examples	
Child: You're using a lot of brown. Parent: My picture looks pretty repulsive. (TA)	Child: You left the picnic box at home. Parent: That was an asinine thing to do, wasn't it? (DQ)
Child: I've got all our drawings. Parent: You picked up my ugly ones. (BD)	

- 14. The same single critical word repeated with no pause is coded as one Negative Talk.**

Examples	
Child: (reaching for gum in mother's purse) Parent: Uh-uh-uh-uh-uh (meaning stop). (NTA)	Child: (starting to throw toy) Parent: No, no, no. (NTA)
Child: (playing aggressively) Parent: Terrible, terrible. (NTA) ----- BUT: Child: (licking a toy plate) Parent: Bad, wrong, yuck. (NTA + NTA + NTA)	

15. When a critical statement contains two or more verb phrases describing the same behavior, only one Negative Talk is coded.

Examples	
Parent: Don't put that on the floor and get it dirty. (NTA)	Parent: Don't jiggle the table and make me mess up. (NTA)
Parent: I want you to stop being a pest and bugging me to go home. (NTA)	Parent: I don't want you to yell and give me a headache. (NTA)
Parent: I don't like it when you get mad and start crying about the doll. (NTA) ----- BUT: Parent: Don't press too hard. And draw a pretty flower. (NTA + DC) Parent: I don't like you jumping off the chairs and yelling at the top of your lungs. (NTA + NTA)	

16. Commands stated in the form of general rules for appropriate behavior are Negative Talk only when they serve to point out what is wrong about the child's ongoing or immediately completed behavior.

Examples	
Child: You're a dope. Parent: Children aren't supposed to call their parents' names. (NTA) ----- BUT: Parent: Children are supposed to talk politely to their parents! (IC/NOC)	Child: (yells) Parent: People shouldn't yell when they're inside. (NTA) ----- BUT: Parent: People should talk quietly when they're inside. (IC/NOC)
NOTE: Dyad: (overhears child screaming in another room) Child: I can hear that girl. Parent: People shouldn't yell when they're inside. (TA) Parent: People should talk quietly when they're inside. (TA)	

17. A statement that negatively evaluates or finds fault with objects in the environment not owned or created by the child is not Negative Talk.

Examples	
Dyad: (sitting at play table) Parent: These chairs are uncomfortable. (TA)	Dyad: (looking at book) Parent: These pages are dirty. (TA)
Dyad: (looking at picture on the wall) Parent: That picture is horrid. (TA) ----- BUT: Child: (draws picture) Parent: That picture is horrid. (NTA)	

18. Some conditional statements are Negative Talks. A conditional statement can be a Negative Talk only when the statement refers to an ongoing behavior of the child. If the statement refers to a behavior in which the child is not currently engaged, the statement is not considered a Negative Talk. See additional general guidelines for coding conditional statements in Appendix A.

- a. If a conditional statement refers to the natural consequences for discontinuing a behavior the child is doing, just starting to do, or has just done, the statement is coded Negative Talk, not Neutral Talk.

Examples	
Child: (pinching mother) Parent: If you stop pinching, we'll have more time to play. (NTA) ----- BUT: Child: (not pinching) Parent: If you don't pinch, we'll have more time to play. (TA)	Child: (raises fist to strike parent) Parent: If you don't hit, people will like you better. (NTA) ----- BUT: Child: I want to be the best fighter in kindergarten. Parent: If you don't hit, people will like you better. (TA)
Child: (biting nails) Parent: If you stop biting your nails, they'll be prettier. (NTA) ----- BUT: Child: (not biting nails) Parent: If you don't bite your nails, they'll be prettier. (TA)	

- b. If a conditional statement refers to a behavior the child is doing, just starting to do, or has just done, and the statement implies a conventional parent-imposed negative consequence for continuing the behavior, the statement is coded Negative Talk, not Neutral Talk.

Examples	
Child: (running) Parent: If you don't stop running around, I'll spank you. (NTA) ----- BUT: Child: (not running) Parent: If you don't stop running around at school, I'll take away TV for a week. (TA)	Child: (continues pinching) Parent: If you keep pinching, you'll have to sit on the chair. (NTA) ----- BUT: Child: (not pinching) Parent: If you keep pinching at school, you'll be grounded for a week. (TA)
Parent: Stop pinching. (NTA)	NOTE: Parent: Give me the car. Child: (ignores command) Parent: If you don't give me the car, you'll have to sit on the chair. (IC)

- c. If a conditional statement refers to a behavior the child is doing, is just starting to do, or has just done, and the statement implies a contingent reward from the parent for discontinuing the behavior, the statement is coded Negative Talk, not Neutral Talk.

Examples	
Child: (making racecar sounds) Parent: If you quit making that noise, I'll play any game you want. (NTA)	Child: (whining) Parent: If you stop fussing, I'll give you a new game. (NTA) BUT: Child: (playing happily) Parent: If you stop all that silly fussing you do at home, I'll buy you a new doll. (TA)

- d. In all conditional statements, when there are elements of more than one DPICS category, the priority order for coding categories is used.

Examples	
Parent: If you keep drawing, I'll give you candy. (IC) BUT: Parent: If you keep drawing that ugly picture, I'll tack it on your wall. (NTA)	Parent: If you keep on cleaning up, I'll buy you some ice cream on the way home. (IC) BUT: Parent: If you keep whining you'll be sorry. (NTA)

19. Statements made in a sassy or sarcastic tone of voice are coded Negative Talk.

Examples	
Child: (tugging on parent's sleeve) I want to ask you something. Parent: (sarcastic tone) I'm not surprised. (NTA)	Child: I dropped it. Parent: (sarcastic tone) Oh, that's great! (NTA)
Child: Can we go to Wendy's tonight? Parent: (sarcastic tone) Are you kidding? (NTA)	Child: We ran out of blocks before your turn. Parent: (sarcastic tone) Thanks a lot! (NTA)
Child: (whining) Will you please help me clean up? Parent: (mocking whine) Please help me clean up. (NTA)	Child: Daddy's cooking tonight. Parent: (sarcastic tone) Don't bet on it. (NTA)
Parent: (ties bow in child's hair) Child: (walks away without saying thank you) Parent: (sarcastic tone) You're welcome. (NTA)	

20. Sassy content, even without sassy tone, is coded Negative Talk.

Examples	
Child: Put the chimney on next. Parent: I'll do it when I'm good and ready. (NTA)	Child: Go pick up my shoes. Parent: Who do you think you're talking to? (NTA)
Child: Come over here. Parent: Like I've got nothing better to do? (NTA)	Child: Mrs. Brown said we're hicks. Parent: Where does she get off? (NTA)
Child: (whines) Please. Parent: Stifle it! (NTA)	Child: Put it on top. Parent: No way! (NTA)

21. Name-calling, by equating the child, other people, or any thing with a negatively evaluative word, is Negative Talk.

Examples	
Parent: You're stupid. (NTA) ----- BUT: Parent: That was a stupid thing to do. (NTA)	Parent: You're sloppy. (NTA) ----- BUT: Parent: Your drawing is sloppy. (NTA)
Child: Dad, the bus driver yelled at me again today. ----- Parent: He's a creep. (NTA) ----- BUT: Parent: He wasn't very nice to you. (TA)	Child: Somebody made a mess. Parent: This place is a dump. (NTA) ----- BUT: Parent: It is messy in here. (RF)

22. Comments containing swearing or profanity are Negative Talk.

Examples	
Parent: That was a _____ idiotic thing to do. (NTA)	Parent: (tries to draw with old magic marker) Parent: This pen doesn't work worth a _____. (NTA)
Child: The teacher said it's your fault. Parent: Your teacher is a _____. (NTA)	Parent: (spills drink) Parent: Oh, _____! (NTA) ----- OR: Child: (spills drink) Parent: Oh, _____! (NTA)

23. Parental verbalizations, including conditional statements, that contain a nonspecific or unconventional parent-imposed negative consequence, are coded as Negative Talk.

Examples	
Child: (uses profanity) Parent: Wait until your father hears about this! (NTA)	Child: (pinching parent's arm) Parent: Would you like to know how that feels? (NTA)
Child: (picks up toy car) Parent: If you throw that, I'll knock your block off. (NTA) ----- BUT: Parent: If you throw that, you will not get it back. (TA)	Parent: If you don't start behaving, I'll tar and feather you. (NTA) ----- OR: Parent: If you don't start behaving, I'll give you a swat on the bottom. (NTA)
Child: (drawing) Parent: If you stop being good, I'll tan your hide. (NTA) ----- BUT: Parent: If you stop being good, you won't be able to watch TV tonight. (TA)	Child: (whines, "I want to play with the my doll.") Parent: If you keep whining, I'll put you in a box and ship you off to China. (NTA) ----- OR: Parent: If you keep whining, I'll take away your doll for a week. (NTA)
NOTE: In <u>all</u> conditional statements, if the statement regarding the child's behavior contains elements of more than one DPICS category, the priority order for coding categories is used.	

24. When a parent responds to a child's command by saying "No" (or exact synonyms) and for 2 seconds issues no additional verbalizations, the "No" is a flat refusal and is coded as a Negative Talk, regardless of the parent's subsequent compliance. When a parent's "No" is followed by any other verbalization, even a counter-command, in less than 2 seconds, it is a Neutral Talk.

Examples	
Child: Set it on the table. Parent: No. (2 sec. elapse) (NTA) ----- BUT: Parent: No, (1 sec.) I can't lift it. (TA + TA)	Child: Look. Parent: No. (2 sec. elapse) (NTA) ----- OR: Parent: (shakes head no) (NTA) ----- OR: Parent: No, absolutely not. (NTA + NTA) ----- BUT: Parent: I don't feel like it. (TA)

Child: Will you pick up the toy soldiers? Parent: No. (2 sec. elapse) (NTA) OR: Parent: No. (begins picking up the soldiers) (NTA + CO) ----- BUT: Parent: No, I want to play with them. (TA + TA) Parent: No, you pick them up. (TA + DC)	NOTE: When a child responds to a parental command with “No” it is always coded Negative Talk regardless of subsequent compliance or other verbalizations by the child. (See Child Negative talk.)
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25. Negative Talk can occur simultaneously with behaviors in any non-verbalization category (e.g., vocalizations, physical behaviors, and responses following questions).

Examples	
Child: (throwing toys) Parent: (grabs child's arm while saying sarcastically, “Can you cool it!”) (NTO + NTA)	Child: (trips and begins crying) Parent: (hugs child while saying sarcastically “Aren't we coordinated today?”) (PTO + NTA)
Child: (whines “This is too hard.”) Parent: (in mocking whine says, “Poor helpless baby.”) (WH + NTA)	Child: Hurry up and hand over the car! Parent: (sarcastically) Who do you think you are? (hands child the car) (NTA + CO)
Child: Why can't we play with the chalk? Parent: Because you think it's bath powder. (AN + NTA)	

COMMANDS

Commands are statements in which the speaker (parent or child) directs the vocal or motor behavior of the other. Commands may be direct or indirect in form.

DIRECT COMMANDS (DC)

Definition

Direct commands are declarative statements that contain an order or direction for a vocal or motor behavior to be performed and indicate that the child is to perform this behavior.

Parent Direct Command Examples	
Take the dishes out of the box.	Listen.
Put your hands in your lap.	Look.
Please hand me the hippopotamus.	You have to call your grandmother on Saturday.
Susie, pick the crayon up off the floor.	You're going to tie your shoe before you trip.
Read this letter.	Why don't ... Use the larger wheel in the front.
Sing the alphabet song.	Wait, wait, wait.
You need to take the long stick.	Put the truck here and put the car beside it.
You should put the big one on top.	And turn it upside-down.
You must sit down.	Try and set it down on its edge.
I said put your feet on the floor.	Take this chalk and draw a circle.
Be courteous.	You made a sailboat but you need to draw a rudder.
Be careful.	Sit down and shut up.
Hurry up.	Touch them gently or I won't let you play with them.
Wait a sec.	Shhh. (i.e., Be quiet)

Decision rules

1. When uncertain whether the verbalization is coded Command, or Negative Talk, code Command.
2. When uncertain whether the verbalization is coded Indirect Command or Direct Command, code Indirect Command.
3. When uncertain whether the verbalization is coded Command or a lower priority category (e.g., Neutral Talk, Description, Praise), code the lower priority category.

Parent DC Guidelines

1. **Direct commands are always declarative statements. Commands in question form are always Indirect Commands.**

Examples	
Parent: Put the paper in the wastebasket. (DC)	
Parent: Sit in this chair by me. (DC) BUT: Parent: Sit in this chair by me, okay? (IC) Parent: Will you put the paper in the wastebasket? (IC)	Parent: Draw a horse in your picture. (DC) BUT: Parent: How about drawing a horse in your picture? (IC)

- 2. Direct (and indirect) commands are always worded positively. They tell the child what to do. Statements that tell the child what not to do are Negative Talk.**

Examples	
Dyad: (drawing in coloring book) Parent: Try to stay within the lines. (DC) BUT: Parent: Don't go outside the lines. (NTA)	Parent: Put the crayons in the drawer. (DC) BUT: Parent: Stop coloring on the walls. (NTA)
Parent: Put the hammer in the tool kit. (DC) BUT: Parent: Stop hammering on the mirror. (NTA)	Parent: Come here. (DC) BUT: Parent: Don't swing on the curtains. (NTA)
Parent: Stack the blocks in a tall tower. (DC) BUT: Parent: Quit throwing the blocks. (NTA)	

- 3. Direct commands always contain the imperative verb, where the subject of the sentence is an implied "you." The Direct Command may begin with the word "you" or its synonyms, or other words that do not change the meaning of the imperative verb.**

Examples
Parent: Put the doll in the high chair. (DC) Parent: Please turn on the light. (DC) Parent: Hey, sit down. (DC) Parent: Honey, give me the hammer. (DC) BUT: Parent: Honey (2 sec.) Give me the hammer. (IC/NOC + DC)

- 4. When the subject of the sentence is not "you," the sentence cannot be coded as a Direct Command. When the parent and child are both the subjects of the command (e.g., "let's..." and "we're"), the sentence is coded Indirect Command. When the sentence does not indicate who is to perform the behavior (i.e., the subject is "it"), the sentence is coded Neutral Talk.**

Examples	
Dyad: (building tower) Parent: Make the tower taller. (DC) BUT: Parent: Let's make the tower taller. (IC)	Parent: Clean up the Tinker Toys. (DC) BUT: Parent: We're going to clean up the Tinker Toys. (IC) Parent: The Tinker Toys should be cleaned up now. (TA)

- 5. Direct commands contain a verb phrase (often in imperative form) that indicates a vocal or motor behavior to be performed. Some parental statements may implicitly direct the child by providing information; however, code Command only when the statement contains a verb phrase calling for a vocal or motor behavior to be performed by the child.**

Examples	
Parent: Say "one." (DC) Child: One. Parent: Say, "Two." (DC) Child: Two. BUT: Parent: Three. (TA) Child: Three.	Dyad: (spelling words with alphabet blocks) Parent: Put an "A" here. (DC) Child: (puts correct block in place) (CO) BUT: Parent: A "T" goes next. (TA) Child: (looks for "T" block) Parent: Here's a "T". (points) (TA)
Parent: Find the word "go." (DC) Parent: Find the word "see." (DC) BUT: Parent: The next word is "stop." (TA)	Parent: Sit down. (DC) Child: (remains standing for 4 sec.) BUT: Parent: Now! (TA)

6. The verb phrase in a Direct Command may be modified by words that imply that compliance is a necessity, such as “must,” “should,” “have to,” “got to,” “need to,” “supposed to,” and “ought to.” When the modifiers of the verb phrase in a command do not indicate the necessity of compliance, (such as might, may, could, can, and their synonyms), code Indirect Command.

Examples	
Parent: You must hand me the doll. (DC)	Parent: You need to clean up the Legos. (DC)
Parent: You should push the car slowly. (DC)	Parent: You really should sit down. (DC)
Parent: You have to put the bigger one on first. (DC)	Parent: You ought to put the roof on now. (DC)
BUT: Parent: You could use bigger ones. (IC)	BUT: Parent: We must put the roof on. (IC)
Parent: You may want to use the green instead. (IC)	Parent: You might start with this side. (IC)
Parent: We need to draw flowers here. (IC)	Parent: I'd like you to take the square piece. (IC)
	Parent: You should probably take it off. (IC)
Parent: You are going to _____. (child not engaged in behavior) (DC)	Parent: You've got to sit down now. (DC)
BUT: Parent: You are going to _____. (child already engaged in behavior) (BD)	BUT: Parent: It would be nice if you sat here. (IC)

7. When Direct Commands are preceded by phrases such as “I said...” “I know...” “I'm sure...” and their synonyms that do not imply that compliance is optional, they remain Direct Commands. When preceding phrases imply that compliance is not a necessity such as “I think...” “I guess...” and their synonyms, code Indirect Command.

Examples	
Parent: Set it down. (DC)	Parent: You have to push it forward. (DC)
Child: (does nothing)	Child: It's not working.
Parent: I said set it down. (DC)	Parent: I know you have to push it forward. (DC)
	BUT: Parent: Put it away. (DC)
	Child: (does nothing)
	Parent: I think you should put it away. (IC)
Parent: Write the B next. (DC)	
Child: It doesn't fit.	
Parent: I guess you should go to the next line. (IC)	

8. The sentence structure of the command determines whether it is coded Direct Command or Indirect Command, regardless of the specificity of the requested behavior.

Examples	
Parent: Get down. (DC)	Parent: Be good. (DC)
Parent: Would you get down? (IC)	Parent: Will you be good? (IC)
Parent: Play nicely. (DC)	Child: (Pulling toys out of box.)
Parent: Play nicely, okay? (IC)	Parent: Be careful. (DC)
	Parent: Let's be careful. (IC)

9. Verb phrases calling for unobservable internal behaviors, when stated in imperative form, are coded Direct Commands (note: see Parent No Opportunity for Compliance).

Examples	
Parent: Calm down. (DC/NOC)	Parent: Concentrate on what you're doing. (DC/NOC)
Parent: Think hard. (DC/NOC)	Parent: Guess. (DC/NOC)
Parent: Settle down. (DC/NOC)	Parent: Remember you're in charge of the roof. (DC/NOC)
Parent: Just relax. (DC/NOC)	Parent: Hurry up. (DC/NOC)
Parent: Let me see if I can do it. (DC/NOC)	Parent: Listen to me. (DC/NOC)
Parent: Remember what I said. (DC/NOC)	Parent: Look. (DC/NOC)
Parent: See if it's in you're pocket. (DC/NOC)	Parent: Wait a sec. (DC/NOC)
Parent: Let me do it. (DC/NOC)	Parent: Come on (i.e., Hurry up) (DC/NOC)
Parent: Go ahead. (DC/NOC)	BUT: Parent: Look at what a pretty picture you made. (LP)

10. Direct commands include commands for behavior to occur in the future (> 5-seconds). (Note: see Child No Opportunity for Compliance).

Examples	
Child: (playing with dolls) Parent: Clean your room when we get home. (DC/NOC)	Child: I'm cold. Parent: Bring your sweater next time. (DC/NOC)
Child: (dumping blocks onto table) Parent: When we get through, you have to put these away. (DC/NOC)	Dyad: (drawing picture) Parent: After I finish this flower, you need to draw the leaves. (DC/NOC)

11. Statements beginning with "You are going to..." are coded as Direct Commands when they contain a specific suggestion for a vocal or motor behavior to be performed by the child and the behavior has not already been initiated by the child.

Examples	
Child: (stacking blocks into high tower) Parent: You're going to pick them up if they fall. (DC) BUT: Parent: You're going to make it high. (BD)	Child: (stretching chewing gum) Parent: You are going to hand me that gum. (DC) BUT: Child: (handing mom several dominoes) Parent: You are going to give me a bunch. (BD)

12. If the parent begins to give an Indirect Command but changes it to a Direct Command, code Direct Command.

Examples	
Parent: Why don't ... Put the bus in the toy box. (DC)	Parent: Shall we ... Mary, put the house here. (DC)
Parent: Let's ... You take the red one. (DC)	

13. The same single word command repeated without a 2 second pause is coded as one command.

Examples	
Parent: Wait, wait, wait. (DC)	
Parent: Look, look, look. (DC)	
BUT: Parent: Look. (2 sec.) Look. (D C + DC)	
Parent: Wait, wait. (2 sec.) Look. (DC + DC)	
Parent: Wait, see, look. (DC + DC + DC)	

14. When the child asks for guidance, the parent's response is coded Direct Command only when it contains a verb phrase indicating a vocal or motor behavior to be performed by the child.

Examples	
Child: Should I put it here?	Child: Where does this go?
Parent: Yes, put it here. (TA+DC)	Parent: Put it on top. (DC)
BUT: Parent: Yes. (TA)	BUT: Parent: There. (TA)
Parent: Yes, right here. (TA + TA)	Parent: Anywhere. (TA)
	Parent: How about over there? (DQ)

15. Direct commands can contain a specific, conventional, parent-imposed discipline technique as a consequence. If the parent-imposed consequence is a nonspecific or unconventional negative consequence, the statement is coded Negative Talk.

Examples	
Parent: Spit that out or I'll spank you. (DC)	Parent: Put the gun in the toy box now or there will be no ice cream on the way home. (DC)
BUT: Parent: Spit that out or else. (NTA)	BUT: Parent: Put the gun in the toy box now or I'll string you up by your ears. (NTA)
Child: (swears at parent)	
Parent: Apologize or I'll wash your mouth out with soap. (DC)	
BUT: Parent: Apologize or your dad will tar and feather you. (NTA)	

16. In sentences containing two or more verbs in imperative form that are joined by "and," where one verb phrase does not contain independent meaning, only one command is coded.

Examples	
Parent: Try and stay in the lines (DC)	Parent: Try and color it red (DC)
Parent: Check and see if it's in your pocket. (DC)	

INDIRECT COMMANDS (IC)

Definition

An Indirect Command is a suggestion for a vocal or motor behavior to be performed that is implied or stated in question form.

Parent Indirect Command Examples	
Turn the dial, all right?	Will you wait a minute?
How about putting your hands in your lap?	When we're done you can put the crayons away.
It's time for you to put the cars away.	Johnny?
Children should use their quiet voice inside.	Hey.
Let's draw a lion!	Please? (1 sec.) Please?
You and I will build a helicopter now.	Draw a square and then color it red, okay?
Will you tell me what letter this is?	Let's build a tower and make it high.
I want you to give me the red ones.	Will you take and lift the top off?
I'd like you to finish the picture.	Why don't you make a house and make it big?
Suppose you put that one away first.	You did a good job and now you can take out the cars.
I guess you should turn it first.	If you sit down, I'll give you some candy.
You can color it purple.	If you don't sit down, I'll spank you.
Can you put the red stick on top?	Remember what I said, okay?
We are going to build a tower now.	

Decision rules

1. When uncertain as to whether the command is direct or indirect, code Indirect Command.
2. When uncertain whether a sentence is an Indirect Command or a question, code the appropriate question category.
3. When uncertain whether the command is a Critical Statement or an Indirect Command, code Indirect Command.
4. When uncertain whether a sentence is an Indirect Command or Neutral Talk, code Neutral Talk.

Parent IC Guidelines

1. A question is an Indirect Command when it contains a suggestion for a vocal or motor behavior to be performed by the child. Questions tags added to the end of a Direct Command make it an Indirect Command.

Examples	
Dyad: (drawing) Parent: Why don't you use yellow? (IC) Parent: Color this one yellow, all right? (IC)	Dyad: (cleaning up) Parent: How about putting the dollhouse away? (IC) Parent: Put the dollhouse away, okay? (IC)
Dyad: (playing with blocks) Parent: Would you stack the blocks? (IC) Parent: Stack the blocks, would you? (IC)	Dyad: (playing with barnyard) Parent: Will you make a rooster sound? (IC) Parent: Make a rooster sound, why don't you? (IC)

2. **Indirect Commands** suggest a specific vocal or motor response to be performed by the child, whereas **Descriptive/Reflective Questions** request no more than a verbal Neutral Talk.

Examples	
Child: (barks like a dog) Parent: Can you make a cat sound now? (IC) BUT: Parent: Is there a dog in here? (DQ)	Dyad: (building tower) Parent: How about if you put this block on next? (IC) BUT: Parent: How about if I put this block on your tower? (DQ)
Dyad: (drawing pictures) Parent: Will you give me that green crayon? (IC) BUT: Parent: Will you need that green crayon? (DQ)	

3. **Indirect (and direct) commands** are always worded positively. They tell the child what to do. Statements that tell the child what not to do are Negative Talk (NTA).

Examples	
Parent: Will you sit next to me? (IC) Parent: Will you stop running around the room? (NTA)	Parent: Would you put the crayons in the drawer? (IC) Parent: Would you stop coloring on the wall? (NTA)
Parent: Why don't you whisper? (IC) Parent: Why don't you stop shouting? (NTA)	

4. **The subject of an Indirect Command** is a stated or implicit “you” indicating that the child is to perform the behavior. The generic use of “you” meaning “one” or “people” when providing information should not be confused with the “you” referring to a child in a command.

Examples	
Dyad: (drawing) Parent: Will you make a circle? (IC) BUT: Parent: (demonstrating) You make a circle like this. (TA)	Dyad: (finishing game) Parent: It's time for you to pick up. (IC) BUT: Parent: It's time to pick up. (TA)
Parent: (demonstrating how to use cash register) Parent: Press the buttons, okay? (IC) BUT: Parent: (pressing) All you do is press. (TA)	Child: Do we have to clean this up? Parent: You do it, okay? (IC) BUT: Parent: You always have to put back what you took out. (TA)

5. **A positively-worded statement that describes a rule about appropriate behavior in general, but does not imply that the child's ongoing or just-completed behavior should be performed differently in the future, is Neutral Talk not an Indirect Command.**

Examples	
Child: Her mother makes her say "please." Parent: Children should talk nicely to their parents. (TA) ----- BUT: Child: I hate you. Parent: Children should talk nicely to their parents. (IC)	Dyad: (looking at storybook) Child: Why are they putting them away? Parent: Children are supposed to pick up their toys. (TA) ----- BUT: Parent: Pick up the toys. Child: (whines) I don't want to pick up the toys. Parent: Children are supposed to pick up their toys. (IC)
Child: What are the rules in this game? Parent: People are supposed to take turns in this game. (TA) ----- BUT: Child: (child moves both players' pieces in a board game) Parent: People are supposed to take turns in this game. (IC)	Child: How come these don't fit in the box? Parent: The Tinker Toys have to be taken apart first. (TA) ----- BUT: Parent: Put the Tinker Toys away. Child: (jams construction at top of box) Parent: The Tinker Toys have to be taken apart first. (IC)

6. **When the subject of a command is not "you", it cannot be coded as a Direct Command. When the subject is "we" or its synonyms, the command is an Indirect Command. When the subject is "it", the sentence is Neutral Talk.**

Examples	
Child: There's no more blue. Parent: Let's use the green pieces! (IC) ----- BUT: Parent: The green pieces will work. (TA)	Child: The walls are done. Parent: We should put the roof on now. (IC) ----- BUT: Parent: It should have a roof on it. (TA)
Dyad: (cutting out paper snowflakes) Parent: You and I need to pick up all these scraps. (IC) ----- BUT: Parent: These scraps need to be picked up. (TA)	Parent: Can we build now? (IC) Parent: Can we go to McDonald's? (IC/NOC)

7. **If a parent repeats a child's command to engage in a joint activity, it is an Indirect Command rather than a reflection.**

Examples	
Child: Let's build a fort. Parent: Let's build a fort. (IC) ----- BUT: Parent: You would like us to build a fort. (RF)	Child: You and I should draw some stars on it. Parent: We should draw some stars. (IC) ----- BUT: Parent: You want us to draw stars on it. (RF)
Child: We have to do it real fast. Parent: We have to do it really fast. (IC) ----- BUT: Parent: You think we should do it fast. (RF)	

8. Many parent verbalizations implicitly call for a child response; however, commands are coded only when the parent's verbalization contains an imperative verb phrase calling for a verbal or motor behavior to be performed by the child.

- a. Indirect Commands in question form may be distinguished from Information Questions by the presence of an action verb phrase.

Examples	
Dyad: (looking at clock) Parent: Will you tell me what time it is? (IC) BUT: Parent: What time is it? (IQ)	Child: (reading aloud) Parent: Would you read that last word again? (IC) BUT: Parent: What was the last word? (IQ)
Dyad: (playing with toy farm) Parent: I want you to make a rooster sound, okay? (IC) BUT: Parent: What kind of sound does a rooster make? (IQ)	

- b. Indirect Commands in declarative form may be distinguished from Neutral Talks by the presence of an action verb phrase.

Examples	
Child: (puts coins on the keys) Parent: You might put the coins in the slot. (IC) BUT: Parent: The coins go in the slot. (TA)	Dyad: (building with Tinker toys) Child: (gives father some pieces) Parent: I want you to give me more short ones. (IC) BUT: Parent: I want more short ones. (TA)
Dyad: (building log cabin) Parent: We need to put another log right here. (IC) BUT: Parent: We need another log right here. (TA)	Child: (picking up toys) Parent: How about picking up the toys over there? (IC) BUT: Parent: Don't forget the toys over there. (TA)

9. A parental statement of feeling, expectation, or preference is an Indirect Command when it clearly calls for the child to complete an action.

Examples	
Parent: I want you to put the bird on the branch. (IC) BUT: Parent: I want the bird on the branch. (TA) Parent: Do you want to put the bird on the branch? (DQ)	Parent: I'd like you to comb your hair. (IC) BUT: Parent: I'd like to comb your hair. (TA)
Parent: I expect you to finish this part. (IC) BUT: Parent: I expect I'll finish this part. (TA)	Parent: I wish you'd make them bigger. (IC) BUT: Parent: I wish they were bigger. (TA)

10. When Direct Commands are preceded by phrases such as “I think,” “I guess” and synonymous phrases that imply compliance is optional, the commands become indirect.

Examples	
Child: It's not moving. Parent: I guess you have to push it forward. (IC)	Child: What's wrong with this? Parent: I suppose you need to turn it over. (IC)
Child: This is hard. Parent: Maybe you have to use the big ones first. (IC)	Parent: You should put it away. Child: (does nothing) Parent: I think you should put it away. (IC) ----- BUT: Parent: You should put it away. Child: (does nothing) Parent: I said you should put it away. (DC)

11. A statement beginning with “You can...” “You might...” “You could,” “You get to...” or “You may...” is an Indirect Command if the child has not already engaged in the behavior unless it is granting an immediately preceding request. If the statement follows a child's request to do something else, it is an Indirect Command.

Examples	
Child: (standing) Parent: You could sit down. (IC) ----- BUT: Parent: You should sit down. (DC)	Child: (putting caps on bottles) Parent: You might put the blue cap on the blue bottle. (IC) ----- BUT: Parent: You must put the blue cap on the blue bottle. (DC)
Child: I made the mommy horse! Parent: You can draw a pony now. (IC) ----- BUT: Parent: You have to draw a pony now. (DC)	Child: Will you help me? Parent: You can do it. (IC) ----- BUT: Parent: You do it. (DC)
Child: (scribbling on chalkboard) Parent: You can erase that. (IC) ----- BUT: Child: Can I start over and erase this? Parent: You can erase that. (TA)	Child: (coloring spaceship blue) Parent: You might color it silver. (IC) ----- BUT: Child: Can I color the spaceship silver? Parent: You may color it silver. (TA)
Child: (building tower of blocks) Child: Can I play with the dolls now? Parent: You can build the tower. (IC) ----- BUT: Child: (building tower of blocks) Child: Can I build a tower? Parent: You can build the tower. (TA)	Child: (building tower of blocks) Parent: You get to play with the horsies now (IC) ----- BUT: Child: (building tower of blocks) Child: Do I get to play with the sea creatures yet? (QU) Parent: You get to play with them now (TA)

12. Sentences beginning with “Can you...” are coded as Indirect Commands regardless of other possible intended meanings because of difficulty distinguishing among meanings in most cases.

Examples	
Dyad: (coloring in coloring book) Parent: Can you hand me the red crayon? (IC)	Dyad: (looking at workbook) Parent: Can you do this one? (IC)
Dyad: (cutting out paper doll clothes) Parent: Can you try this skirt? (IC)	Parent: (braiding child's hair) Parent: Can you sit still for a minute? (IC)
NOTE: Child: I want to play Nerf ball. Parent: Can you find one? (IC)	Child: (trying to get game off high shelf) Parent: Can you reach it? (IC)

13. Commands that call for internal or unobservable behavior in question form are coded Indirect Commands (See Child No Opportunity for Compliance).

Examples	
Parent: Will you please calm down? (IC/NOC)	Parent: Remember this, okay? (IC/NOC)
Parent: Why don't you wait awhile? (IC/NOC)	

14. Suggestions for behavior to occur in the future (> 5 sec.) are Indirect Commands (see Child No Opportunity for Compliance).

Examples	
Parent: You can fly it after we finish folding it. (IC/NOC)	Parent: Next time, how about measuring it before you cut? (IC/NOC)
Parent: Will you clean the cat's litter box tomorrow? (IC/NOC)	

15. The child's name or synonyms for it, whether in statement or question form, serve as “bid for attention” words (words that indirectly communicate “pay attention” or “listen to me”). When a parent uses a “bid for attention” word as the introductory or concluding word of a verbalization (separated by < 2 sec.) it is not coded separately. When a “bid for attention” word is separated from another parent verbalization by 2 seconds or longer, or by an intervening child verbalization, it is coded separately as an Indirect Command with No Opportunity for Compliance.

Examples	
Parent: Honey? (IC/NOC)	Parent: Hey. (IC/NOC)
BUT: Parent: Honey, (no pause) hand me the blue block. (DC)	BUT: Parent: Hey, (no pause) which car can I play with? (IQ)
Parent: Hand me the blue block, (no pause) honey. (DC)	Parent: Which car can I play with? (2 sec.) Hey! (IQ + IC/NOC)
Parent: Honey (2 sec), hand me the blue block (IC/NOC + DC)	
Parent: Hand me the blue block. (2 sec.) Honey? (DC + IC/NOC)	
Parent: Jeff! (IC/NOC)	Parent: Sally. (IC/NOC)
Child: This chair can tip far back.	BUT: Parent: Sally (no pause) be careful. (DC/NOC)
Parent: Let's sit up straight. (IC)	NOTE: Parent: Sally. (< 2 sec. later, Child says “What?”) Be careful. (IC/NOC + DC/NOC)
NOTE: Other “bid for attention” words include “hey you,” “you hoo,” “sweetie,” “baby,” “dear,” etc. The word “please” is often used as a bid for attention word. Words such as “carefully” or “quiet,” when said alone, do not constitute bids for attention. They are coded as TA because there is no meaningful verb phrase.	

16. When “bid for attention” words occur in a series without a 2 second pause between them, they are coded as one Indirect Command.

Examples	
Parent: Hey, (no pause) hey. (IC/NOC)	Parent: Hey, Sweetheart. (IC/NOC)
Parent: Johnny, Johnny, Johnny. (IC/NOC)	Parent: You hoo (no pause) you hoo (no pause) Susan. (IC/NOC)
	BUT: Parent: Honey (no pause) Honey (no pause), that's mine. (TA)
	Parent: Give me the hammer. (2 sec.) Please. (DC + IC/NOC)
	Parent: Give me the hammer please. (DC)
	Parent: Dear. (2 sec.) Dear? (IC/NOC + IC/NOC)
	Parent: Johnny. (2 sec.) Quiet. (IC/NOC + TA)

17. In sentences containing two or more verbs in imperative form that are joined by “and,” if the sentence begins with a phrase that changes the meaning of the first “Direct Command” to an Indirect Command, it also makes the second command indirect unless the second command has a clear inflection and pause indicating that the “and” starts a new sentence.

Examples	
Parent: Will you pick up the can and dump out the toys? Coded as: Will you pick up the can? (IC) AND (Will you) dump out the toys? (IC)	Parent: Can we draw a Christmas tree and put a star on top? Coded as: Can we draw a Christmas tree? (IC) AND (Can we) put a star on top? (IC)
BUT: Parent: Will you pick up the can? (looks for place to dump the toys) And dump out the toys. (IC + DC)	BUT: Parent: Can we draw a Christmas tree? (pause) And put a star on top. (IC + DC)
Parent: Why don't you bring over her bonnet and dress her for outside? Coded as: Why don't you bring over her bonnet? (IC) AND (Why don't you) dress her for outside? (IC)	
BUT: Parent: Why don't you bring over her bonnet? (child does) And dress her for outside. (IC + DC)	

18. In sentences containing two or more verbs in imperative form that are joined by “and,” where one verb phrase does not contain independent meaning, only one command is coded.

Examples	
Parent: Take and put the eyes on Mr. Potato Head, okay? (IC)	Parent: Will you try and color it red? (IC)
Parent: Could we check and see if it's in your pocket? (IC)	

- 19. In sentences that contain two or more verb phrases in imperative form joined by “and,” but the verb phrases refer to a single child behavior, the first verb phrase is a command with opportunity and the remaining verb phrase(s) is a command with no opportunity.**

Examples	
Parent: How about if you put this on top and make it the roof? (IC + IC\NOC)	Parent: Let's build a tower and make it high, okay? (IC + IC\NOC)
Parent: Why don't we make a house and make it big and make it red? (IC + IC\NOC + IC\NOC)	

20. Some conditional statements and questions are Indirect Commands.

- c. If a conditional statement refers to an ongoing behavior of the child or to behavior the child may initiate in the future, and specifies a contingent reward from the parent for continuing or initiating the behavior, the statement is an Indirect Command.

Examples	
Parent: If you keep minding so well, I'll make brownies for dessert tonight. (IC)	Parent: If you stay in your seat, I'll read Winnie the Pooh. (IC)
Parent: If you give me some blocks, I'll play with you. (IC)	Parent: I'll buy you new crayons if you draw with these now. (IC)
Parent: Will you settle down if I let you play with the Tinker Toys? (IC)	

- d. If a conditional statement specifies a parent-imposed conventional negative consequence that will follow if the child fails to initiate or continue a behavior, the statement is an Indirect Command (unless the statement is a “Warning” (see Appendix).

Examples	
Parent: If you don't finish cleaning up then you'll be grounded tonight. (IC)	Parent: If you don't start coloring like I asked, you're going to get a spanking. (IC)
Parent: If you don't start coloring like I asked, you'll have to sit in the timeout chair. (IC)	

- e. In all conditional statements, if the statement regarding the child's behavior contains elements of more than one DPICS category, the priority order for coding categories is used.

Examples	
Parent: If you quit whining, I'll give you some gum. (NTA)	Parent: Will you stop throwing toys if I play racecars with you? (NTA)
Parent: If you keep whining you'll be sorry. (NTA)	Parent: If you keep on asking, I'll have to spank you. (NTA)

PRAISE

Praise is a verbalization expressing a favorable judgment of an attribute, product, or behavior of the child. There are two types of praise: Labeled and Unlabeled Praise. Labeled praise is intended to teach the child specifically what he or she can do to receive further parent approval. Unlabeled Praise does not necessarily reinforce behavior, but it may enhance a child's self-esteem.

LABELED PRAISE (LP)

Definition

Labeled praise provides a positive evaluation of a specific behavior, activity, or product of the child.

Parent Labeled Praise Examples	
You did a great job of building the tower.	That's a terrific ship you made.
Your picture is pretty.	You sing so well.
That valentine you made is really special.	Your drawing is really cool.
You're considerate to share your crayons.	You're my little helper for putting the toys away.
Thank you for handing me the box.	I like the way you drew that circle.
You did know the right answer.	You counted the numbers perfectly.
Your fort is fabulous.	You're smart to gather the blocks up first.
You're a good builder.	You're a good girl for working on your letters.
It's nice how quietly you're playing with the blocks.	Nice idea to fix the car.
You did a good job of putting it together.	This is a terrific house we made.
You made a nice fort and it has a great roof.	I like the way you drew the sun and folded the paper.
You drew a marvelous dinosaur, didn't you?	Isn't that a lovely design you made!
Look at the adorable kitten you drew.	If you put your super tower up here, it will look taller.

Decision rules

1. When uncertain whether a statement is Labeled or Unlabeled Praise, code it Unlabeled Praise.
2. When uncertain whether a statement is a Labeled Praise or falls within another category such as Reflective Statement, Descriptive Statement, Descriptive/Reflective Question, Direct Command, Indirect Command or Neutral Talk, do not code Labeled Praise.

Parent LP Guidelines

1. Labeled Praises must contain both the positive evaluation and the description of the specific action or product in one sentence to be coded as Labeled Praise.

Examples	
Child: (builds log cabin) Parent: You built a super log cabin. (LP) BUT: Parent Super. You built a cabin. (UP + BD)	Child: (sings the alphabet song) Parent: It's terrific that you know all your letters. (LP) BUT: Parent: That's terrific. You know all your letters. (UP + BD)

2. Praises must include a positive evaluative word or phrase that describes the child or the child's behaviors, activities, or products.

- a. Positive evaluative words include good and all of its synonyms. Other descriptive words that are considered in DPICS as positive evaluative words include pretty, intelligent, neat, polite, well-behaved, right, thoughtful, creative, careful, superior, brilliant, beautiful, perfect, wonderful, handsome, patient, bright, special, considerate, fun, enjoyable, first-rate, top-notch, marvelous, nifty, neat, awesome, cool, imaginative, creative, and their synonyms.

Examples	
Child: Was I supposed to put this here? Parent: You put it in the correct place. (LP)	Dyad: (laughing) Parent: You're fun to play games with. (LP)
Child: (makes up fairy tale) Parent: That's a creative story you made up. (LP)	Child: (cleaning up) Parent: You're a good helper to clean up those toys. (LP)
Parent: Copy this number slowly. Child: (Copies number). Parent: That was so neatly copied! (LP)	Parent: Draw it straight. Parent: You drew it perfectly! (LP)

- b. Descriptive words not considered sufficiently positive to constitute a praise include quiet, fast, slow, alert, funny, interesting, strong, silly, exciting, energetic, straight, fine, okay, alright, fancy and their synonyms.

Examples	
Child: Was I supposed to put this here? Parent: That's an interesting place to put it. (TA)	Dyad: (laughing) Parent: You make up silly games. (BD)
Child: (makes up fairy tale) Parent: That's an exciting story you made up. (TA)	Parent: Draw it straight. Parent: How straight you drew it. (TA)
Parent: Copy this number slowly. Child: (Copies number). Parent: That was really slow the way you copied it! (TA)	

3. The positive evaluative component of a Labeled Praise may be a metaphor.

Examples	
Parent: What a sweetheart you are for sharing the blocks. (LP) BUT: Parent: What a sweetheart! (UP)	Parent: You're Daddy's little helper for bringing me the box. (LP) BUT: Parent: You're Daddy's little helper. (UP)

4. Verbalizations that clearly express the parent's appreciation or pleasure about a specific action or product of the child are Labeled Praise of the child.

Examples	
Dyad: (building fort) Parent: I'm having a great time building this with you. (LP)	Child: (draws a red apple) Parent: I'm glad that you colored the apple red. (LP)
Child: (hands mother a block) Parent: Thank you for helping me build this. (LP)	Child: (coloring) Parent: It makes me happy when you color so neatly. (LP)

5. The positive evaluative component must refer to a specific behavior of the child or the specific product resulting from the child's behavior.

- a. A Labeled Praise may provide an evaluation of the child's specific behavior.

Examples	
Parent: Your <u>coloring</u> is beautiful. (LP)	Parent: I like the way you <u>sit</u> so quietly. (LP)
Parent: That is beautiful. (UP)	Parent: I like the way you're acting. (UP)
Parent: You <u>stacked the</u> blocks perfectly. (LP)	
Parent: You did that perfectly. (UP)	

- b. A Labeled Praise may provide an evaluation of the child's specific product.

Examples	
Parent: <u>Your story</u> was very well organized. (LP)	Parent: The <u>dog you drew</u> is very pretty. (LP)
Parent: That was very well organized. (UP)	Parent: That is very pretty. (UP)
Parent: I love the <u>airplane you</u> made for me. (LP)	Child: (draws flower)
Parent: I love this. (UP)	Parent: It has <u>pretty leaves</u> on it. (LP)

- c. Praises describing mental or physical attributes of the child that include a description of the specific behavior or products related to these attributes are Labeled Praises.

Examples	
Child: (places big block at bottom)	Child: (tying ribbon around braid)
Parent: That was smart to put the big one there. (LP)	Parent: Your hair looks pretty the way you braided it. (LP)
BUT: Parent: You are smart. (UP)	BUT: Parent: Your hair looks pretty. (UP)
Child: (finishes putting Halloween make up on)	Child: And they all lived happily ever after.
Parent: Your eyes are cute the way you made them up. (LP)	Parent: You are imaginative when you tell stories. (LP)
BUT: Parent: Your eyes are cute. (UP)	BUT: Parent: You are imaginative. (UP)

- 6. Statements that equate the child with a noun are praises when the noun is modified by a positive evaluative word. These praises are labeled when the noun refers to behavior that is ongoing or immediately completed by the child.**

Examples	
Child: (builds a house)	Child: (folding paper into airplane)
Parent: You are a terrific builder. (LP)	Parent: You're a great airplane-maker. (LP)
BUT: Child: (points to picture on Lincoln log box)	BUT: Child: (picking up paper) I'm going to make a boat.
I built one just like that last time.	Parent: You're a great airplane-maker, too. (UP)
Parent: You're a terrific builder. (UP)	
Child: (drawing picture)	Child: And they all lived happily ever after.
Parent: You're a good artist. (LP)	Parent: You are imaginative when you tell stories. (LP)
BUT: Child: (watching parent draw) That's good.	BUT: Parent: You are imaginative. (UP)
Parent: You're a good artist too. (UP)	

7. When praises contain nonspecific verbs like “working,” “playing,” “acting,” and their synonyms, the verbs must be modified by a word or a phrase describing the action in order to be coded a Labeled Praise.

Examples	
Parent: I like the way you're working hard on the puzzle. (LP)	Parent: You're a good girl for playing quietly with the toys. (LP)
OR: Parent: I like the way you're working hard. (LP)	OR: Parent: You're a good girl for playing quietly. (LP)
OR: Parent: I like the way you're working on the puzzle. (LP)	OR: Parent: You're a good girl for playing with the toys while I was busy. (LP)
BUT: Parent: I like the way you're working. (UP)	BUT: Parent: You're a good girl for playing. (UP)
Parent: It's wonderful how well you work independently. (LP)	Parent: You're doing great coloring your picture. (LP)
OR: Parent: You work by yourself well. (LP)	BUT: Parent: You're doing that great. (UP)
BUT: Parent: It's wonderful how you work. (UP)	Parent: You're doing great. (UP)
Parent: You work well. (UP)	

8. Praises containing nonspecific nouns such as job, idea, work, and their synonyms are Labeled Praises only when these nouns are qualified by verbs or verb phrases describing more specific behavior.

Examples	
Parent: That's a good idea to put the block there. (LP)	Child: (cleaning up toys) Parent: You're doing a good job of cleaning up. (LP)
BUT: Parent: Good idea. (UP)	BUT: Parent: You're doing a good job. (UP)
Parent: Good idea there. (UP)	Parent: Good job of it. (UP)
Parent: Nice work building that bridge. (LP)	Child: (sorting Lincoln logs by size) Parent: Good thinking to sort them first. (LP)
BUT: Parent: Nice work. (UP)	BUT: Parent: Good thinking. (UP)
Parent: Nice work doing that. (UP)	Parent: That was good thinking. (UP)

9. Parental expressions of praise for joint activities or products created by the dyad are coded as praise of child.

Examples
Parent: We built a lovely house together. (LP)
Parent: Our picture is pretty good. (LP)
Parent: Didn't we make up a fun game! (LP)

- 10. If a statement contains two or more meaningful verb phrases describing clearly independent child behaviors and at least one positive evaluative word or phrase that modifies the verbs, each modified verb phrase is coded as a separate praise.**

Examples	
Parent: You are building a great house and humming a nice tune. (LP + LP)	Parent: I like the way you are playing and humming that tune. (UP + LP)
Parent: I like the way you are building that house and being so good today. (LP + UP)	Parent: The way you are humming that tune and building that house are both wonderful. (LP + LP)
Parent: Thank you for giving me the green and showing me where the red goes. (LP + LP)	Parent: You're being nice and being such a good girl today. (UP + UP)
BUT: Parent: Thank you for giving me the green and the red. (LP)	BUT: Parent: You're being nice and such a good girl today. (UP)
Parent: You did a great job of putting the toys in their containers and putting the containers in the toy box. (LP + LP)	Child: (drawing a house) Parent: The way you sit up straight in your chair and draw nice pictures is really neat. (LP + LP)
BUT: Parent: You did a great job of taking and putting it in the toy box. (LP)	BUT: Parent: Your windows and your door are neatly drawn. (LP)
Child: (playing with doll) Parent: It's nice the way you hold her gently and sing to her so sweetly. (LP + LP)	
BUT: Parent: It's nice and sweet the way you hold her so gently. (LP)	

- 11. Specific positive evaluative statements of the child's behavior or products are Labeled Praises even if they are stated in question form. (Refer to priority order.)**

Examples
Parent: You drew a lovely bouquet, didn't you? (LP)
Parent: Your snowflake turned out beautifully, didn't it? (LP)
Parent: Isn't that a super airplane you made! (LP)

- 12. Labeled praises that reflect the child's statements or answer the child's questions are coded as Labeled Praise rather than reflections or descriptions. (Refer to priority order.)**

Examples	
Child: I built a wonderful fort! Parent: You did build a wonderful fort. (LP)	Child: I made a pretty house, didn't I? Parent: You made a very pretty house. (LP)
Child: Do you like my picture? Parent: I like your picture very much. (LP)	

- 13. Commands with opportunity to comply that contain Labeled Praise of the child remain commands. Commands automatically coded no opportunity that contain praise, are coded as praise.**

Examples	
Child: (finishes drawing sailboat) Parent: Look what a great sailboat you drew! (LP not DC/NOC)	Child: This is hard! Parent: Remember to put it together as well as you did last time. (LP not DC/NOC)
BUT: Parent: How about putting your beautiful drawing on that pile? (IC)	BUT: Parent: Draw another flower just as perfectly as your first one. (DC)

14. Descriptions of actual behavior, rather than its quality, no matter how positive the behavior or how enthusiastically it is described, are not praise.

Examples	
Child: (places last puzzle piece) Parent: You finished it! (BD)	Parent: Pick up the red block. Parent: You're picking them all up! (BD)
BUT: Parent: You finished it perfectly. (LP)	BUT: Parent: You picked it up so carefully! (LP)
Child: (catches toy before it falls off the table) Parent: You caught it! (BD) Parent: Good catch! (LP)	

15. A statement that interprets the child's positive feelings about his or her behavior (but does not provide the parent's evaluation) is a Descriptive Statement rather than a Labeled Praise.

Examples
Parent: You seem happy that you fixed the piece. (TA)
Parent: You're so proud of the numbers you learned. (TA)
Parent: I think you like your new haircut. (TA)

16. Praises of objects that are not a product of the child are coded as Neutral Talks.

Examples	
Parent: I like the farm animals you picked to play with. (LP) BUT: Parent: I like these farm animals. (TA)	Parent: You made a terrific game. (LP) BUT: Parent: This is a terrific game they have. (TA)
Child: (draws truck on the Magna Doodle) Parent: That's a magnificent truck. (LP) BUT: Child: (pushes truck across table) Parent: That's a magnificent truck. (TA)	

17. Praise must provide the parent's evaluation. When the parent attributes praise of the child to someone or something outside the dyad, code Neutral Talk.

Examples	
Child: I'm making a picture for Nana. Parent: Your grandmother will think this is really special! (TA)	Child: (puts hat on Mr. Potato Head) Parent: Mr. Potato Head likes his new hat. (TA)
Parent: Draw a basket next to your bunny. Child: (begins drawing basket) Parent: That Easter bunny's going to love this basket. (TA)	

18. Certain words that typically provide positive evaluation may change meaning when modifying non-evaluative adjectives that describe the child's behavior, activity, or products. Those words do not make the verbalization a praise.

Examples	
Child: (asks parent a riddle) Parent: Your riddle is super. (LP) BUT: Parent: Your riddle is super hard. (TA)	Parent: You colored it great. (LP) BUT: Parent: You colored a great big tomato. (BD)
Parent: You made that puzzle look pretty. (LP) BUT: Parent: You made that puzzle look pretty easy. (BD)	

19. Neutral Talk in the form of a conditional statement become Labeled Praise if it contains a positive evaluation of the child's specific behavior, activity, or product.

Examples	
Parent: If you put your beautiful picture here, I can see it better. (LP) BUT: Parent: If you put your picture here, I can see it better. (TA)	Parent: Your wonderful tower may crash if you put it so close to the edge. (LP) BUT: Parent: Your tower may crash if you put it so close to the edge. (TA)

20. When a parent gives a praise “in role” during pretend play, the statement is coded as praise.

Examples	
Child: (talking to rabbit puppet) I saw you at the movies! Parent: (talking as rabbit puppet) You have a good memory, kid. (LP)	Child: (pushing car with boy doll in it) Parent: (leaning down to talk to boy doll) You're a great driver. (LP)

UNLABELED PRAISE (UP)

Definition

An Unlabeled Praise provides a positive evaluation of the child, an attribute of the child, or a nonspecific activity, behavior, or product of the child.

Parent Unlabeled Praise Examples	
Good.	Nice job.
Perfect.	First-rate.
Much better.	Great.
I like that.	Thank you.
I love you.	You're a pretty smart cookie.
What an angel.	All right!
Yea!	You are handsome.
Your eyes are pretty.	You're so thoughtful.
You're a good artist.	We colored it just right.
You are being so good and I like that.	The way you're playing and helping is super.
You did a great job, didn't you?	

Decision rules

1. When uncertain as to whether a statement is a labeled or Unlabeled Praise, code Unlabeled Praise.
2. When uncertain as to whether a statement is an Unlabeled Praise or falls within another code category such as Reflective Statement, Behavior Descriptions, Questions, or Neutral Talk, do not code Unlabeled Praise.

Parent UP Guidelines

1. **A verbalization that contains positive evaluative words or phrases but does not indicate the specific behavior, activity, or product of the child being evaluated is an Unlabeled Praise of child.**

Examples	
Child: (Draws a butterfly) Parent: Terrific! (UP)	Child: (sings "Jingle Bells") Parent: Good. (UP)
BUT: Parent: Terrific drawing! (LP) Parent: Terrific butterfly! (LP)	BUT: Parent: Good singing. (LP) Parent: Good song. (LP)
Child: (gives parent some blocks) Parent: Thank you. (UP)	Child: Excuse me. Parent: You're polite. (UP)
BUT: Parent: Thank you for sharing. (LP)	BUT: Parent: You're polite to say "Excuse me." (LP)

2. Praises must include a positive evaluative word or phrase that describes the child or the child's behaviors, attributes, activities, or products.

- a. Positive evaluative words include good and all of its synonyms. Other descriptive words that are considered in DPICS as positive evaluative words include pretty, nice, intelligent, neat, polite, well-behaved, right, thoughtful, careful, superior, brilliant, beautiful, perfect, wonderful, handsome, patient, bright, special, considerate, fun, enjoyable, first-rate, top-notch, marvelous, nifty, neat, awesome, cool, and their synonyms.

Examples	
Child: Was I supposed to put this here? Parent: It's correct. (UP)	Dyad: (laughing) Parent: You're fun. (UP)
Child: (makes up fairy tale) Parent: That's creative. (UP)	Child: (cleaning up) Parent: You're a good helper. (UP)
Parent: Copy this number slowly. Child: (Copies number). Parent: That was neat! (UP)	Parent: Draw it straight. Parent: Perfect! (UP)
Child: I made a circle. Parent: That's cool! (UP)	

- b. Descriptive words not considered sufficiently positive to constitute a praise include quiet, fast, slow, alert, funny, interesting, strong, silly, exciting, energetic, straight, fancy, and their synonyms.

Examples	
Child: Was I supposed to put this here? Parent: It's interesting. (TA)	Dyad: (laughing) Parent: You're silly. (TA)
Child: (building intently) Parent: (warmly) You're so quiet today. (TA)	Child: (makes up fairy tale) Parent: That's exciting. (TA)
Child: (cleaning up) Parent: You're helping. (BD)	Parent: Draw it straight. Parent: How straight. (TA)
Parent: Copy this number slowly. Child: (Copies number). Parent: That was really slow! (TA)	

3. Positively evaluative adverbs or adjectives describing or implying that the child's unspecified behavior is "good," "better," or "best" are Unlabeled Praise of child.

Examples	
Child: (drawing flower) Parent: That's good. (UP) BUT: Parent: That's colorful. (TA)	Child: (builds another tower) Parent: It's even nicer this time. (UP) BUT: Parent: It's even taller this time. (TA)
Child: (makes house of cards) Parent: I've never seen you be so careful. (UP) BUT: Parent: That's the biggest one I've ever seen! (TA)	

- 4. Verbalizations that express the parent's appreciation or pleasure about a nonspecific or unstated action or product of the child are Unlabeled Praise of the child.**

Examples	
Child: (hands father a block). Parent: Thank you. (UP)	Child: (draws a red apple). Parent: I like that. (UP)
Child: I won't do it again. Parent: I'm glad you understand. (UP)	Dyad: (coloring) Parent: It's fun to play with you. (UP)
Child: I'm cleaning up fast! Parent: I'm happy you're so fast. (UP)	

- 5. Descriptions of the child in terms of a positive metaphor commonly used to express approval are Unlabeled Praise.**

Examples	
Parent: You're my little helper. (UP)	Parent: Here comes Daddy's little princess. (UP)
Parent: What a sweetheart! (UP)	Parent: What a big boy! (UP)

- 6. Certain phrases of Neutral Talk are commonly used to express approval and positive evaluation of the child's activities, products or attributes. These idiomatic expressions are coded Unlabeled Praise, not Neutral Talk. The expressions, "There you go," "Alright," and "Yes," are also considered expressions of praise when, and only when, accompanied by nonverbal gestures clearly indicating approval (e.g., smiles, claps, Positive Touches).**

Examples	
Child: That piece fits here. Parent: You're right on top of things. (UP)	Child: (completes hard puzzle) Parent: That a boy! (UP)
Child: I can say the whole alphabet. Parent: Wow. (UP)	Child: (puts top block on tower) I did it. Parent: Right on! (UP)
Child: My car won. Parent: (holds out palm of hand) Give me 5! (UP)	Child: Me and Eddie got our badges at Cub Scouts. Parent: (ruffles child's hair) All right! (PTO + UP) BUT: Child: We got our badges at Cub Scouts. Parent: (without gesture) All right! (TA)

- 7. Praises that describe physical or mental attributes of the child but do not describe specific behavior or products related to these attributes are Unlabeled Praises.**

Examples	
Child: (combing hair) Parent: You have splendid hair. (UP) BUT: Child: (tying ribbon around braid) Parent: Your hair looks splendid the way you braided it. (LP)	Child: (putting Halloween make up on eyelids) Parent: You have cute eyes. (UP) BUT: Parent: Your eyes are cute the way you made them up for Halloween. (LP)
Child: (moves big box of toys) Parent: You have fantastic muscles. (UP) BUT: Parent: You have fantastic muscles to be able to pick that up. (LP)	Child: Let's pretend we're unicorns. Parent: You have a wonderful imagination. (UP) BUT: Parent: You have a wonderful imagination when you play pretend. (LP)

- 8. Statements that equate the child with a noun are praises when the noun is modified by a positive evaluative word. These praises are unlabeled when the noun refers to behavior that is not ongoing or immediately completed by the child.**

Examples	
Child: We colored at school today. Parent: You're a good artist. (UP)	Child: (accidentally breaks Tinker Toy car) Parent: You're a good mechanic. It'll be okay. (UP + TA)
BUT: Child: (coloring a picture) Parent: You're a good artist. (LP) Parent: You're an artist. (TA)	BUT: Child: (putting together Tinker toy car) Parent: You're a good mechanic. (LP) Parent: You're a mechanic. (TA)

- 9. Even though the parent specifically describes the child's behavior in a separate sentence following an Unlabeled Praise of the behavior, this does not make the Unlabeled Praise labeled.**

Examples	
Child: (builds log cabin) Parent: Super. You built a cabin. (UP + BD)	Child: (sings the alphabet song) Parent: That's terrific. You know all your letters. (UP + TA)

- 10. An Unlabeled Praise referring to joint activities, products, or attributes of the dyad, are coded as Unlabeled Praise of the child.**

Examples	
Parent: (Parent and child draw picture together) Parent: It's terrific! (UP)	Parent: We are doing a careful job. (UP)
Child: You're pretty. Parent: We're both pretty. (UP)	

- 11. If a statement contains two or more meaningful verb phrases describing clearly independent child behaviors, and at least one positive evaluative word or phrase that modifies the verbs, each modified verb phrase is coded as a separate praise.**

Examples	
Parent: You are building a marvelous house and humming a beautiful tune. (LP + LP)	Parent: I like the way you are playing and humming that tune. (UP + LP)
Parent: Thank you for giving me the green and showing me where the red goes. (LP + LP)	Parent: You're being nice and being such a good girl. (UP + UP)
BUT: Parent: Thank you for giving me the green and the red. (LP)	BUT: Parent: You're being nice and such a good girl. (UP)
Parent: You did a great job of putting the toys in their containers and putting the containers in the toy box. (LP + LP)	Child: (drawing a house) Parent: The way you sit up straight in your chair and draw nice pictures is really neat. (LP + LP)
BUT: Parent: You did a great job of taking and putting it in the toy box. (LP)	BUT: Parent: Your windows and your door are neatly drawn. (LP)

- 12. Nonspecific verbalizations that positively evaluate the child's activity, products, or attributes are Unlabeled Praise even if they are stated as questions.**

Examples	
Parent: That's terrific, isn't it? (UP)	Parent: I think that's beautiful, don't you? (UP)
Parent: You did that just right, didn't you? (UP)	Parent: Do you know how much I love you? (UP)

- 13. When a child asks a Descriptive/Reflective Question requesting an evaluative response, an affirmative response that would otherwise be Neutral Talk is coded an Unlabeled Praise.**

Examples	
Child: Do you like my dress? Parent: Yes. (UP)	Child: I did it good, didn't I? Parent: Of course. (UP)

- 14. When a child expresses a positive self-evaluation, an affirmative response that would otherwise be Neutral Talk is coded an Unlabeled Praise.**

Examples	
Child: I made it pretty. Parent: Sure did. (UP)	Child: My drawing is nice. Parent: It is. (UP) ----- BUT: Child: My tower is tall. Parent: It is. (TA)

- 15. A statement that interprets the child's feeling state is Neutral Talk, not an Unlabeled Praise.**

Examples	
Parent: You seem very happy. (TA)	Parent: You're pretty cheerful today. (TA)
Parent: You're feeling pleased with yourself. (TA)	

- 16. Neutral Talk that expresses positive evaluation of an object or event not created by the child is Neutral Talk, not praise.**

Examples	
Child: They have a Magna Doodle in the toy box. Parent: Yea! (TA)	Child: This is new chalk! Parent: Neat! (TA)
Child: The Gators won yesterday. Parent: Wow! (TA)	

- 17. Certain words that typically provide positive evaluation may change meaning when modifying non-evaluative adjectives describing the child's behavior, activity, or product. These words do not make the verbalization a praise.**

Examples	
Child: Okay, so that's how it goes. Parent: It looks pretty easy. (TA)	Child: My dinosaur's a Tyrannosaurs Rex. Parent: What a great big one. (TA)
Child: This puzzle has 500 pieces. Parent: It's super hard. (TA)	

18. When a parent makes a praise “in role” during pretend play, the statement is coded praise.

Examples	
Child: (playing teacher at chalk board) Now class, this says 1 + 1. Parent: (playing student) Teacher, you're smart. (UP)	Child: (pets alligator puppet) Parent: (talking as alligator puppet) Thank you. (UP)
Child: (hugs mom) Parent: (singing) I love you, (UP) a bushel and a peck. (TA)	Child: (playing gently with toy seal) Parent: You're being such a good seal! (UP)

QUESTIONS

Questions are verbal inquiries from one person to another that are distinguishable from declarative statements by having a rising inflection at the end and/or by having the sentence structure of a question. Questions request an answer but do not suggest that a behavior is to be performed by the other person. There are two types of questions: descriptive/reflective and Information Questions. Information Questions request a verbal response beyond a Neutral Talk while Descriptive/Reflective Questions request no more than a Neutral Talk in response.

INFORMATION QUESTIONS (IQ)

Definition

Questions that request specific information from the child other than a brief response (e.g., yes, no, maybe) are Information Questions, even if the child gives a brief response (e.g., “dunno”) or no response at all.

Parent Information Question Examples	
What did Santa bring you?	Where is your ear?
Do you want the red or the black pieces?	What do I always tell you?
What time is it?	Where is Mexico?
What is this called? (2 sec.) Huh?	Huh?
Where are the pretty blocks?	

Decision rules

1. When uncertain whether a verbalization is a Descriptive/Reflective Question or an Information Question, code Descriptive/Reflective Question.
2. When uncertain whether a statement is an Indirect Command or an Information Question, code Information Question.
3. When uncertain whether a statement is a Descriptive Statement, a Reflective Statement, or an Information Question, code Descriptive Statement or Reflective Statement.
4. When uncertain whether a question is a praise, Negative Talk, or Information Question, code Information Question.

Parent IQ Guidelines

1. An Information Question may be distinguished from a Descriptive/Reflective Question (DQ) by the type of response expected from the child.

- a. Information Questions ask for information beyond a simple response such as “yes” or “no.”. When questions ask for only an affirmative or negative response from the child, they are coded Descriptive/Reflective Question.

Examples	
Child: (drawing a clown) Parent: What's the clown's name? (IQ) BUT: Parent: Isn't that a colorful clown? (DQ)	Child: You have to put it the other way. Parent: What other way? (IQ) BUT: Parent: Like this, right? (DQ)
Child: (drawing a man) Parent: Is that his left arm or his right arm? (IQ) BUT: Parent: Is that his left arm? (DQ)	Child: (touching the A on the at alphabet board) Parent: What letter is that? (IQ) BUT: Parent: Is that an A? (DQ)

- b. The responses to both Information Questions and Descriptive/Reflective Questions may be communicated nonverbally, but the distinction between Information Question and Descriptive/Reflective Question still depends on whether the content of the expected response exceeds a simple affirmative or negative response (e.g., “yes” or “no”).

Examples	
Child: (looking at farmyard) Parent: Which is your favorite animal? (IQ) Child: (points to the cow) BUT: Child: (looking at farmyard) Parent: Isn't the cow your favorite animal? (DQ) Child: (nods head “yes”)	Parent: Where is your nose? (IQ) Child: (touches nose) BUT: Parent: (touches child's nose) Parent: Is this your nose? (DQ)

2. An Information Question may be distinguished from a Descriptive/Reflective Question by the form of the question.

- a. Open-ended questions are usually Information Questions. Closed-ended questions are usually Descriptive/Reflective Questions.

Examples	
Child: (drawing a tree) Parent: What is that? (IQ) BUT: Parent: Is that a tree? (DQ)	Child: I'm drawing a skeedle bee. Parent: What is a skeedle bee? (IQ) BUT: Parent: A skeedle bee? (DQ)
Child: This dog's name is Daisy. Parent: What did you call her? (IQ) BUT: Parent: Daisy, huh? (DQ)	Parent: Do you want the car or the truck? (IQ) BUT: Parent: Do you want the car? (DQ)

- b. Rhetorical questions can be Information Questions or Descriptive/Reflective Questions depending on whether the question is open-ended or closed-ended.

Examples	
Child: Can we go to McDonald's after this? Parent: How many times are you going to ask me? (IQ) BUT: Parent: Haven't I heard that before? (DQ)	Child: (going through mother's purse) Parent: What are you doing? (IQ) BUT: Parent: Are you into my purse? (DQ)

3. Information Questions request that the child provide information whereas Indirect Commands contain a specific command for a verbal or motor behavioral response.

Examples	
Dyad: (looking at clock) Parent: What time is it? (IQ) BUT: Parent: Will you tell me what time it is? (IC)	Child: (looking at map) Parent: What is this state? (IQ) BUT: Parent: Show me Florida, okay? (IC)
Child: (reading aloud) Parent: What was the last word? (IQ) BUT: Parent: Would you read that last word again? (IC)	

4. When a parent repeats a child's Information Question, where the meaning may change depending on the parent's inflection, code Information Question if the intended meaning of the question requests more than a simple affirmative or negative response (e.g., "yes" or "no") in response.

Examples	
Child: Which one is purple? Parent: Which one <u>is</u> purple? (IQ) (i.e., you tell me) BUT: Parent: Which one is <u>purple</u> ? (DQ) (i.e., is that what you said?)	Dyad: (returning to game after a distraction) Parent: Whose turn is it? (IQ) BUT: Child: (mumbling) Whose turn is it? Parent: Whose turn is it? (DQ) (i.e., is that what you said?) NOTE: Parent: You're asking whose turn it is. (RF)

5. If "Huh?" or one of its synonyms is stated within 2 seconds following an Information Question, it is not coded separately from the original question. If "Huh?" follows sequentially (i.e., no intervening verbalizations by parent or child) and by more than 2 seconds after an Information Question, it serves to repeat the question and is coded as a separate Information Question.

Examples	
Parent: Where does this go, (1 sec.) huh? (IQ)	Parent: Where does this go? (2 sec.) Huh? (IQ + IQ)
Parent: What was it you said (no pause) huh? (IQ)	Parent: What was it you said? (2 sec.) Huh? (IQ + IQ)
Parent: Would you like some help, (4 sec.) Hmm? (DQ + DQ) BUT: Parent: Would you like some help, (1 sec.) hmm? (DQ)	

6. The word "Huh" or one of its synonyms is an Information Question when its meaning is "What did you say?".

Examples	
Child: Put the top under the bottom. Parent: Hmm? (IQ) BUT: Child: Her name is Arista. Parent: Huh! (TA)	Child: (mumbles) Parent: Huh? (IQ) BUT: Parent: Do you like it? Child: (no response for over 2 sec.) Parent: Huh? (DQ)

7. Information Questions contain no praise or criticism of the child or the child's products or activities.

- a. When the questions include praise of the child or the child's products or activities, code the appropriate praise category.

Examples	
Child: Let's put our book together. Parent: Where did I put the cover? (IQ) OR: Parent: Where did I put my pretty picture? (IQ)	Child: (writing in cursive) I made a perfect A. Parent: Where did you learn to write? (IQ) BUT: Parent: Where did you learn to write so well? (LP)
Child: I made a house. Parent: Who lives in it? (IQ) BUT: Parent: Who lives in your pretty house? (LP)	

- b. When the parent's question includes criticism of the child or the child's products or activities, code Negative Talk.

Examples	
Dyad: (drawing a landscape). Parent: What are you putting at the top? (IQ) BUT: Parent: Why are you making the top part messy? (NTA)	Dyad: (working on a puzzle) Parent: What piece goes in next? (IQ) OR: Parent: Why can't I figure this out? (IQ) BUT: Parent: Why can't you figure out where they go? (NTA)

- c. When the parent's question contains evaluative references to both the parent and child, references to the child take precedence.

Examples	
Dyad: (building a fort) Parent: What part will you and I do next? (IQ) BUT: Parent: How could we have done such a sloppy job? (NTA) Parent: Why can't I make my side looks as good as yours? (LP)	Child: (trying to show parent finger movements to poem) Parent: How do you get the steeple up? (IQ) BUT: Parent: How come our people are on the wrong side? (NTA) BUT: Parent: Why can't we do this right? (NTA)

- d. When a parent's question includes praise or criticism of some aspect of the play situation (e.g., objects, activities, ideas) that is not owned or created by the child, it is coded the appropriate question category.

Examples	
Child: (picking up a toy cow) Parent: Where do you think they bought these neat toys? (IQ)	Child: (playing with broken horse) Parent: What's wrong with this horse? (IQ)
Dyad: (entering room, where Lincoln logs are scattered all over the floor) Parent: Who left such a mess in here? (IQ) BUT: Child: (walks away from the Lincoln logs, which she has left spread out all over the floor of the playroom) Parent: Who left such a mess in here? (NTA)	

- 8. Single word Information Questions repeated less than 2 seconds apart are coded as 1 Information Question.**

Example
Parent: Why, why, why? (IQ)

- 9. Multiple word Information Questions repeated less than 2 seconds apart are coded as separate questions and the response to the first question is coded as no opportunity to answer.**

Example
Parent: How long? How long? (IQ/NOA + IQ)

DESCRIPTIVE/REFLECTIVE QUESTIONS (DQ)

Definition

A Descriptive/Reflective Question is a descriptive or reflective comment or statement expressed in question form which requires no more than a brief affirmative or negative response (e.g., “yes” or “no”), even if the child gives additional information in response or does not respond.

Parent Descriptive/Reflective Questions Examples	
She is the princess?	How about if I use the green crayon?
Really?	Do you know what?
See?	Do you know what this letter is called?
You're pushing it along the floor, aren't you?	You want to play with Legos, don't you?
That's a red one, right?	Do you wanna build a castle?
That was fun, wasn't it?	Do you remember how to work that?
Wasn't that exciting?	Are you going to the toy box?
Should we call this dog Spot?	Can you wear blue jeans to the class party?
Is this the one you want?	Can I play with your car?
Is this my block?	Do you like this? (2 sec.) Huh?
An edifice??	Isn't that a pretty dolly?
Did you say 'is it big'?	

Decision rules

1. When uncertain as to whether a verbalization is a Descriptive/Reflective Question or an Information Question, code Descriptive/Reflective Question.
2. When uncertain as to whether a question is an Indirect Command or Descriptive/Reflective Question, code Descriptive/Reflective Question.
3. When uncertain as to whether a statement is a Descriptive Statement, a Reflective Statement, or a Descriptive/Reflective Question, code Descriptive Statement or Reflective Statement.

Parent DQ Guidelines

1. **Some Descriptive Statements, Reflective Statements, and Neutral Talk become Descriptive/Reflective Questions by inflection; the voice rises rather than falls at the end of the sentence.**

Examples	
Child: (Rocks a doll) Parent: That's the baby? (DQ)	Child: I have the cars. Parent: You have the cars? (DQ) ----- BUT: Parent: You have the cars. (RF)
Child: Where does it go? Parent: (puts coin in slot) See? (DQ)	Child: He's a princess. Parent: Oh? (DQ)
Child: It looks pretty good. Parent: Yeah? (DQ)	

2. Some Descriptive Statements, Reflective Statements, and Neutral Talk become Descriptive/Reflective Questions by the addition of a question tag at the end of the sentence.

Examples	
Child: (pushing racecar) Parent: You're driving fast, aren't you? (DQ)	Child: Mine is green. Parent: Yours is green, isn't it? (DQ)
Child: (setting up checkerboard) Parent: I want to be red, alright? (DQ)	Child: I'd like hot dogs for dinner. Parent: We'll see, okay? (DQ)

3. A Descriptive/Reflective Question is distinguished from an Information Question by the form of the question.

- a. Open-ended questions which request information beyond a brief affirmative or negative response (e.g., "yes" or "no") are Information Questions. Closed-ended questions are Descriptive/Reflective Questions.

Examples	
Parent: Is this my car? (DQ) BUT: Parent: Which one is mine? (IQ)	Parent: Is it okay if I use the green crayon now? (DQ) BUT: Parent: What crayon can I use now? (IQ)
Parent: If I turn the handle, will it go? (DQ) BUT: Parent: How does this thing work? (IQ)	

- b. Rhetorical questions, to which an answer is not expected, can be either Descriptive/Reflective Questions or Information Questions depending on whether the question is open or closed-ended.

Examples	
Dyad: (playing with farm) Child: This is a tractor. Parent: You're observant, aren't you? (DQ) BUT: Parent: How did you get so observant? (IQ)	Dyad: (playing with Mr. Potato Head) Child: He's got his lips where his ears should go. Parent: That's funny looking, isn't it? (DQ) BUT: Parent: How's he gonna drink his milk? (IQ)

4. A Descriptive/Reflective Question may be distinguished from an Information Question (IQ) by the type of response expected from the child.

- a. Descriptive/Reflective Questions ask for no more than a brief affirmative or negative response (e.g., "yes" or "no") from the child. When questions ask for information beyond a brief affirmative or negative response (e.g., "yes" or "no"), they are coded Information Questions, even if the child responds with a brief answer or does not respond.

Examples	
Child: It's high. Parent: Really? (DQ)	Parent: You know what? (DQ) BUT: Child: What? (IQ)
Child: You're making a valentine. Parent: (holds it up) Like it? (DQ) BUT: Parent: Huh? (IQ) (i.e., "what did you say?")	Child: (building with Legos) This is a dragon's house. Parent: Is that what it is? (DQ) BUT: Parent: Where is the dragon? (IQ)
Child: I want one. Parent: (points) This? (DQ) BUT: Parent: Which? (IQ)	Child: (knocks tower down) Parent: Didn't that make a big crash? (DQ) BUT: Parent: What do you want to do now? (IQ)

- b. The responses to both Descriptive/Reflective Questions and Information Questions may be communicated nonverbally, but the distinction between Descriptive/Reflective Questions and Information Questions still depends on whether the expected content in the response exceeds a brief affirmative or negative response (e.g., “yes” or “no”).

Examples	
Child: (looking at picture of rainbow) Parent: Isn't red your favorite color? (DQ) Child: (nods head “yes”)	Parent: Are you three? (DQ) Child: (shakes head “No”)
BUT: Child: (looking at picture of rainbow) Parent: Which is your favorite color? (IQ) Child: (points to the red stripe)	BUT: Parent: How old are you? (IQ) Child: (holds up four fingers)

5. When a parent repeats a child's Information Question, where the meaning may change depending on the parent's inflection, code Descriptive/Reflective Question if the intended meaning of the question requires no more than a brief affirmative or negative response (e.g., “yes” or “no”) in response.

Examples	
Child: Where is the block? Parent: Where is the <u>block</u> ? (DQ) (i.e., is that what you said?)	Child: (mumbling) Whose turn is it? Parent: Whose turn is it? (DQ) (i.e., is that what you said?)
BUT: Parent: Where <u>is</u> the block? (IQ) (i.e., you tell me)	BUT: Dyad: (returning to game after a distraction) Parent: Whose turn is it? (IQ)

6. When a parent repeats a child's Descriptive/Reflective Question, the repetition is always a Descriptive/Reflective Question, regardless of meaning, because the answer requires no more than a brief affirmative or negative response (e.g., “yes” or “no”).

Examples	
Child: Is it high enough? Parent: Is it enough? (i.e., is that what you said?) (DQ)	Child: Do you want to go next? Parent: Do <u>you</u> want to go next? (DQ)
BUT: Parent: You're wondering if it's high enough. (RF)	

7. Descriptive/Reflective Questions request no more than a brief affirmative or negative verbal response (e.g., “yes” or “no”) whereas Indirect Commands suggest a specific vocal or motor response to be performed by the child.

Examples	
Dyad: (building tower) Parent: How about if I put this block on your tower? (DQ)	Child: (barks like a dog) Parent: Is there a dog in here? (DQ)
BUT: Parent: How about if you put this block on next? (IC)	BUT: Parent: Can you make a cat sound now? (IC)
Dyad: (playing with cars) Parent: Will you need this car? (DQ)	Parent: You want to play with the truck, don't you? (DQ)
BUT: Parent: Will you give me the car? (IC)	BUT: Parent: Why don't you play with the truck? (IC)

8. Questions about the child's feelings, opinions, or preferences that contain two or more choices for the child to select are coded as Information Questions.

Examples	
Child: (pulls alphabet blocks out of box) Parent: Do you want to take out the blocks? (DQ) BUT: Parent: Do you want to stack them or spell your name? (IQ)	Parent: Do you want the red ones? (DQ) BUT: Parent: Do you want the red ones, green ones, or blue ones? (IQ)
Child: Put the next one on, daddy. Parent: Do you think it should go here? (DQ) BUT: Parent: Do you think it should go here or here? (IQ)	Child: Here's the Waffle Blocks. Parent: Would you like to build a house? (DQ) BUT: Parent: Would you like to build a house or a school? (IQ)

9. Because it is difficult to distinguish Descriptive/Reflective Questions from questions that may be intended by the parent to be Indirect Commands, questions beginning with “Do you know...,” “Do you want...,” “Do you remember...,” and “Are you going to...” are automatically coded as Descriptive/Reflective Questions.

Examples	
Child: I can't find the piece. Parent: Do you know what I think? (DQ)	Child: I have to go to the bathroom. Parent: Do you know how find it? (DQ)
Dyad: (looking at picture book) Parent: Know where the lion is? (DQ)	Child: (building block tower) Parent: Do you want to put another one on? (DQ)
Dyad: (folding paper hats) Parent: Wanna make an airplane? (DQ)	Child: (puts lid on Lego box) Parent: Do you remember where that goes? (DQ)
Child: I've got dolly. Parent: Remember dolly's name? (DQ)	Child: I can't find the porcupine. Parent: It's under the table, remember? (DQ)
Child: (putting doll in castle's dungeon) Parent: Are you going to put him in the dungeon? (DQ)	Child: (pushing car to toy farm) Parent: Are you going to the farm? (DQ) BUT: Child: (knocks over a tower of blocks accidentally) Parent: (sarcastically) Wanna trash the room? (NTA)

10. Because it is difficult to distinguish between Indirect Commands and questions, questions beginning with “Can you...” are coded as Indirect Commands regardless of other possible intended meanings.

Examples	
Child: (drops puzzle pieces on floor) Parent: Can you pick those up? (IC)	Dyad: (drawing shapes) Parent: Can you make a circle here? (IC)
Child: (struggling to open lid) Parent: Can you open it? (IC)	Child: Jimmy hit a fly ball right to me today. Parent: Can you catch those? (IC/NOC)

- 11. If “Huh?” or its synonyms is stated within 2 seconds of a Descriptive/Reflective Question, it is not coded separately from the original question. If “Huh?” follows sequentially (i.e., no intervening verbalizations by parent or child) and by more than 2 seconds after a Descriptive/Reflective Question, it serves to repeat the question and is coded as a separate Descriptive/Reflective Question.**

Examples	
Parent: Wouldn't that be fun (no pause) huh? (DQ) Parent: Wouldn't that be fun? (2 sec.) Huh? (DQ + DQ)	Parent: Isn't this a great game, (no pause) hmm? (DQ) Parent: Isn't this a great game? (2 sec.) Hmm? (DQ + DQ) ----- BUT: Parent: Whatcha got there, (no pause) huh? (IQ) Parent: Whatcha got there? (2 sec.) Huh? (IQ + IQ)

- 12. Descriptive/Reflective Questions contain no praise or criticism of the child, the child's products or activities.**

- a. When the questions include praise of the child or the child's products or activities, code the appropriate praise category. When the questions contain criticism of a person other than the child, code the appropriate question category.

Examples	
Child: I made a house. Parent: You made a house? (DQ) ----- OR: Parent: Aren't I making a pretty fence around your house? (DQ) ----- OR: Parent: Mary made a pretty house, didn't she? (DQ) ----- BUT: Parent: Isn't that a pretty house? (LP)	Dyad: (each copying letters on separate papers) Child (drawing) I'm making an A like yours. Parent: Didn't I do a terrific job on mine? (DQ) ----- BUT: Parent: Where did you learn to make such pretty letters? (LP)

- b. When the questions include criticism of the child or the child's products or activities, code the appropriate Negative Talk category. When the questions contain criticism of a person other than the child, code the appropriate question category.

Examples	
Dyad: (each copying letters) Child: I made an A. Parent: Is that a capital A? (DQ) ----- OR: Parent: Don't you think my A looks too messy? (DQ) ----- BUT: Parent: Isn't your A a little too big? (NTA)	Child: I made a house. Parent: Oh, you did? (DQ) Parent: Your baby brother can't draw well, can he? (DQ) Parent: Why can't I draw better? (IQ/NOA) ----- BUT: Parent: Why did you use such ugly colors? (NTA)

- c. When the parent's questions contain evaluative references to both the parent and child, references to the child take precedence.

Examples	
Dyad: (building a fort)	
Parent: Our fort is getting high, isn't it? (DQ)	
Parent: Our fort is ugly, don't you think? (NTA)	
Parent: Why can't I make my side looks as good as yours? (LP)	

- f. When a question includes praise or criticism of some aspect of the 'play-situation (e.g., objects, activities, ideas) that is not owned or created by the child, it is coded the appropriate question category.

Examples	
Child: (picking up a toy cow)	Child: (playing with blocks)
Parent: Doesn't it have cute spots on its ears? (DQ)	Parent: Do you think it smells musty in here? (DQ)
Dyad: (entering room, which has blocks scattered on the floor)	Child: (walks away from the blocks, which she has left spread out all over the floor)
Parent: This room is a mess, isn't it? (DQ)	Parent: This room is a mess, isn't it? (NTA)

REFLECTIVE STATEMENT (RF)

Definition

A Reflective Statement by the parent is a declarative phrase or statement that has the same meaning child verbalization. The reflection may paraphrase or elaborate upon the child's verbalization but may not change the meaning of the child's statement or interpret unstated ideas.

Parent Reflective Statement Examples	
Child: The pig is fat. Parent: The pig is fat	Child: The choo-choo go whiz. Parent: The train goes very fast.
Child: I put the car and the truck here. Parent: You put the car and the truck beside each other.	Child: This game is fun. Parent: You like playing this game.
Child: Give me the car. Parent: You want the car.	Child: That's a funny clown. Parent: You think he's funny.
Child: This is a cow. It gives milk. Parent: This one is a cow.	Child: I'm landing my helicopter. Parent: Okay, you're landing it.
Child: I drew a space ship. Parent: Super. You drew a space ship.	Child: Here's the chimney we need. Parent: You're right and that's the chimney we need
Child: It's a horsey. Parent: It is a horse. It's a brown horse.	Child: Big Bird's driving his car to work. Parent: Driving his car.
Child: Where's the blue piece? Parent: The blue.	

Decision rules

1. When uncertain as to whether a statement is a Reflective Statement or a Labeled Praise, Unlabeled Praise, Negative Talk, Direct Command, or Descriptive/Reflective Question, code Reflective Statement.
2. When uncertain as to whether a statement is a Descriptive Statement, Neutral Talk, or a Reflective Statement, do not code Reflective Statement.

Parent RF Guidelines

1. A Reflective Statement is a parental repetition or restatement of a child's verbalization.

Examples	
Child: The toy box is full. Parent: The toy box is full. (RF)	Child: My doll's name is Peter. Parent: His name is Peter. (RF)
Child: I'm driving the car fast. Parent: The car is going very fast. (RF)	

2. The Reflective Statement must retain the verbal content of the child's verbalization by including at least some of the child's words or exact synonyms of the child's words.

Examples	
Child: Daddy doesn't like Fido. Parent: Your father doesn't like our dog. (RF)	Child: The mommy and the daddy and the sister are eating dinner. Parent: The whole family is eating dinner. (RF)
Child: My teacher is taking us to the zoo. Parent: Oh, you're going to the zoo. (RF) OR: Parent: Your teacher is taking you to see the animals. (RF) OR: Parent: You're going to the place where they have a lot of different animals to watch. (RF) BUT: Parent: You're going to see some animals. (TA)	Child: The man with the straw hat is feeding the chickens. Parent: The farmer is feeding the chickens. (RF)

3. The Reflective Statement must retain the basic meaning of the child's statement.

- a. Restated descriptions that change the meaning by referring to the other person or the activity of the other person are descriptions rather than Reflective Statements.

Examples	
Child: My car goes fast. Parent: My car goes fast, too. (TA)	Child: I'm building a high tower. Parent: You're building a high tower. (RF) BUT: Parent I'm building a high tower. (TA)
Child: You're building a high tower. Parent: You're building a high tower. (BD) BUT: Parent: I'm building a high tower. (RF)	

- b. Rephrased statements that change the child's intent or contradict the child are not coded as Reflective Statements.

Examples	
Child: Build a wall. Parent: You want me to build a wall. (RF) BUT: Parent: You want us to build a fort. (TA)	Child: This is going to be my typewriter. Parent: You're pretending that's a typewriter. (RF)
Child: I don't like this game. Parent: You really do like this game. (TA)	Child: I put a big red block on top. Parent: You put a green block on top. (BD)
Child: Daddy said I can stay up till 10:00. Parent: Daddy said you can stay up till 9:00. (TA)	

4. The Reflective Statement may contain a descriptive elaboration or a grammatical correction of the child's message as long as the original meaning is retained.

Examples	
Child: The girl is in the green car. Parent: The green car has the girl and the boy in it. (RF) BUT: Parent: The boy is in the green car, too. (TA)	Child: I made a big square. Parent: You made a big square in the circle. (RF) BUT: Parent: You made a big circle. (BD)
Child: Cow moo. Parent: The cow says moo. (RF)	Child: This piece don't fit. Parent: This piece doesn't fit. (RF) OR: Parent: This piece doesn't fit even though you've tried almost every hole on the board. (RF)

5. A Reflective Statement may reflect the child's stated feeling content but does not interpret unstated feelings of the child.

Examples	
Child: I like playing with these Legos. Parent: You like this game. (RF) OR: Parent: You enjoy playing with these Legos. (RF)	Child: This is a stupid game. Parent: You think this game is dumb. (RF) BUT: Parent: I think you're getting tired. (TA)
Child: I'm mad at you. Parent: You're mad at me. (RF) OR: Parent: I'm sorry that you're mad at me. (RF) OR: Parent: You're angry with me. (RF) OR: Parent: You're mad at me because I won't let you play longer. (RF)	Child: I'm scared to make it higher. Parent: You're scared. (RF) OR: Parent: You're afraid. (RF) OR: Parent: You're scared to put another block. (RF) BUT: Parent: You're really just lazy. (NTA)
Child: I can't put the puzzle together. Parent: You're feeling you can't get the pieces to fit together. (RF; same meaning) BUT: Parent: You're feeling frustrated with that puzzle. (TA; interpretation of unstated feeling) BUT: Parent: You're working on the puzzle. (BD)	Child: I'm happy that we found the cookie monster. Parent: You're glad that we found him. (RF) OR: Parent: You're happy that we found him. (RF) BUT: Parent: You're feeling hungry for cookies too. (TA)
Child: I can't find any more white cards. Parent: You seem upset because you can't find them. (TA)	Child: This game takes a long time. Parent: This is a long game. (RF) BUT: Parent: You're getting bored with this game. (TA)

6. Reflective Statements by the parent contain no praise or criticism of the child.

Examples	
Child: This is a tower. Parent: This is a tall red tower. (RF) BUT: Parent: I like your tower. (LP)	Child: I drew a house. Parent: You drew a ranch style house. (RF) BUT: Parent: You drew a sloppy house. (NTA)
Child: I'm going to use this board to be my fence. Parent: You're using the board for a fence. (RF) BUT: Parent: That's a good idea to use the board for a fence. (LP)	Child: My picture turned out ugly. Parent: You don't like the way your picture turned out. (RF) BUT: Parent: It did turn out ugly. (NTA) BUT: Parent: Your picture isn't ugly. (TA) BUT: Parent: You drew a pretty picture. (LP) BUT: Parent: It's pretty. (UP)
Dyad: (playing pick up sticks) Child: You're good at this. Parent: I am pretty good at this game. (RF)	Child: This is a good game. Parent: This is a pretty good game. (RF)

7. If a child issues more than one verbalization uninterrupted by parent talk, the parent's restatement of any of these child verbalizations can be coded as a Reflective Statement.

Examples	
Child: Here's Ernie. He's fixing the car. Parent: That's Ernie. (RF)	Child: I'm in the big chair. (3 sec.) When's the lady coming back? Parent: You're in the adult chair. (RF)
Child: I'm making a city. These are the buildings. And this is a swimming pool with a diving board. Parent: You've made buildings. (RF)	

8. A Reflective Statement by the parent must be the first parent verbalization following the child's verbalization with the exception of Acknowledgments and Unlabeled Praises. A brief Neutral Talk or Unlabeled Praise (generally no more than one word) by the parent may precede the Reflective Statement.

Examples	
Child: I drew a turtle. Parent: You made a green turtle. (RF)	Child: I drew a rabbit. Parent: Yes. That is a big rabbit. (TA + RF)
Child: I drew a dinosaur. Parent: Good, you drew a stegosaurus. (UP + RF)	Child: I drew a circle. Parent: Pretty! It's a round circle. (UP + RF)

9. When a parental restatement of a child verbalization is preceded by any parental verbalization other than a Neutral Talk or Unlabeled Praise, the restatement is not coded as a Reflective Statement.

Examples	
Child: I drew a dog. Parent: You put big ears on him. You drew a dog with big ears. (BD + BD)	Child: I drew a house. Parent: That's a beautiful house. You made a house with shutters. (LP + BD)
Child: I drew a snake. Parent: Ick! You drew a snake. (NTA + BD)	

10. If a parent restates a child's verbalization more than once, only the first restatement is coded a Reflective Statement. Any subsequent restatement of the child's verbalization is not coded as a reflection and is coded the appropriate verbalization category.

Examples	
Child: I drew a cat. Parent: You drew a fluffy cat. You drew a big fluffy cat. (RF + BD)	Child: I'm building an ugly fence. Parent: You're building a fence. You don't think it looks good. (RF + TA)
Dyad: (looking at clown picture) Child: His collar is white and black circles. Parent: It has big black polka dots. It's a black and white collar. (RF + TA)	Child: I put her red dress on her. Parent: Oh the red dress. You put the red dress on her. (RF + BD)

- 11. A repetition of a single word or a phrase from a child's preceding statement, which often serves to indicate that the parent heard the verbalization, may be a Reflective Statement if it does not change the meaning of the child's verbalization.**

Examples	
Child: I can build it. Parent: You can. (RF) ----- BUT: Child: I made a picture. Parent: You did. (TA)	Child: There's the little chair in there. Parent: A chair. (RF) ----- BUT: Parent: A big chair. (TA)
Child: A "B" goes next. Parent: A "B" as in boy. (RF) ----- BUT: Parent: "B" is my first initial. (TA)	Child: Pick up the yellow. Parent: Yellow. You want me to pick up the yellow one. (RF + TA)

- 12. Sentence fragments that have no meaning are not reflections even if they contain words or phrases from a previous child verbalization.**

Examples
Child: The farmer's getting hay for the cows. Parent: He's getting.... (doesn't finish sentence) (not coded) ----- BUT: Child: The teacher's writing letters on the chalkboard. Parent: The teacher's writing. (RF)

- 13. Parental repetitions of meaningful words or phrases from a child's preceding question are coded as Reflective Statements if they do not become questions and simply indicate that the question was heard.**

Examples	
Child: Which one is the zebra? Parent: The zebra. It's the striped one. (RF + TA) ----- BUT: Parent: Which one is it? (DQ; meaning "is that what you said?")	Child: He's got a thingymagobber on his head, doesn't he? Parent: A big thingymagobber. (RF) ----- BUT: Parent: He's got something on his head, doesn't he? (DQ)

- 14. Repetitions of a child's question, which become questions for the child to answer, are not Reflective Statements.**

Examples	
Child: Is it high enough? Parent: <u>Is</u> it high enough? (DQ ; asks child the same DQ)	Child: What should we name him? Parent: What <u>should</u> we name him? (IQ ; asks the child the same IQ)
OR: Parent: Is it enough? (DQ ; asks, "Is that what you said?")	OR: Parent: What should we <u>name</u> him? (DQ ; asks, "is that what you said?")
BUT: Parent: You're wondering if it's high enough. (RF)	BUT: Parent: You're thinking about what his name should be. (RF)

15. Answers to a child's questions are not Reflective Statements.

Examples	
Child: Is this where the arm goes? Parent: That's where the arm goes. (TA)	Child: Can I have some gum? Parent: Yes, you can have some gum. (TA + TA)
Child: How many blocks are in the box? Parent: You put four blocks in the box. (BD)	Child: Should I put his nose on? Parent: Yes, you should put his nose on. (TA + DC)

16. A parent's repetition of a child's description or suggestion for a future activity is a command, not a Reflective Statement, when the repetition is directing the child to do something.

Examples	
Child: I'm going to put a hat on Mr. Potato Head. Parent: You're going to put a hat on him. (RF)	Child: Let's build an airport. Parent: You would like to build an airport. (RF)
BUT: Parent: Put a hat on Mr. Potato Head. (DC)	BUT: Parent: Let's build an airport. (IC)
OR: Parent: Why don't you put a hat on him? (IC)	
Child: I need to color this part. Parent: You think you should color that part. (RF)	
BUT: Parent: You need to color that part. (DC)	

17. Parental compliance to child commands for verbal behavior are not Reflective Statements.

Examples	
Child: Say "A". Parent: "A". (TA + DC/CO)	Child: Say "B". Parent: "B". (TA + DC/CO)
BUT: Child: This is an "A". Parent: "A". (RF)	BUT: Child: "B" Parent: "B". (RF)

18. A Reflective Statement must be in declarative rather than in question form. When a parent repeats a child's verbalization in a question form (i.e., using a question tag or a questioning inflection), the parent's question is coded as a Descriptive/Reflective Question.

Examples	
Child: My doll has blue eyes. Parent: She does have blue eyes. (RF) BUT: Parent: Your doll has blue eyes, doesn't she? (DQ) OR: Parent: Blue eyes? (DQ)	Child: I smeared the paint. Parent: It looks like you smeared a little paint. (RF) BUT: Parent: You smeared the paint? (DQ) OR: Parent: The paint is smeared, isn't it? (DQ)
Child: There's a monster in the closet. Parent: A monster in the closet. (RF) BUT: Parent: There's a monster in the closet? (DQ) OR: Parent: A monster? (DQ)	

19. Negative talk responses to a child's verbalization are not reflections.

Examples	
Child: (in baby talk) This game isn't any fun. Parent: (mocking imitation in baby talk) This game isn't any fun. (NTA) .	Child: I did my best. Parent: If you did your best I feel sorry for you. (NTA)
Child: I want a doll like this. Parent: You want too many #!@?* dolls. (NTA)	

20. When the parent restates what the child has said "in role" during pretend play, code Reflective Statement.

Examples	
Child: (talking for monkey) I'm swinging on the branch. (PT) Parent: (talking for the same monkey) I'm swinging on the high branches. (PT) BUT: Parent: (talking for self) The monkey is swinging on the branch. (RF)	Child: (talking for self) Mr. Potato Head is driving to the store. Parent: (talking for Mr. Potato Head) I'm driving to the store. (PT) BUT: Parent: Mr. Potato Head is driving to the store. (RF)
Child: (sings, "The itsy bitsy spider.....") Parent: (sings, "The itsy bitsy spider climbed up the water spout.") (PT)	

BEHAVIORAL DESCRIPTIONS (BD)

Definition

Behavioral Descriptions are non-evaluative, declarative sentences or phrases in which the subject is the other person and the verb describes that person's ongoing or immediately completed (< 5 sec.) observable verbal or nonverbal behavior.

Parent Behavioral Descriptions Examples	
You're building a truck.	You're putting (4 sec.) the green block on.
You're singing a song.	You're making [interruption] it high.
I see you're coloring those apples pink.	You drew a rabbit and you gave it long ears
I know you're trying hard to put that piece in.	You're making the sun yellow and long rays on it.
Drew a heart.	You're drawing a tree (2 sec.) putting on bark
You're looking at the picture book.	Okay, and now you're using chalk.
You just finished the red one.	You're driving the car (1 sec.) fast.
You're calling the dolly Jessica.	You can draw flowers.
We're building a house for the princess.	You're going to fix this wall.
You and I are making a big fort.	

Decision Rules

1. When uncertain whether the verbalization is a Descriptive Statement, Reflective Statement, question, command, question, praise, or Negative Talk, code Descriptive Statement.
2. When uncertain as to whether a statement is a Descriptive Statement or a Neutral Talk, code Neutral Talk.
3. When uncertain as to whether a description is a Behavioral Description or a Neutral Talk, code Neutral Talk.

Parent BD Guidelines

1. **Behavioral Descriptions can be distinguished from Neutral Talks by the subject of the sentence which must be the child. In a Neutral Talk, the subject may be the child, but can also be other objects or people.**

Examples	
Child: (drawing apple) Parent: You're drawing a big apple. (BD) OR: That's a big apple you drew. (BD) BUT: Parent: That's a big apple. (TA)	Child: (feeding toy cows) Parent: You're feeding the cows hay. (BD) BUT: Parent: Farmers feed their cows hay. (TA)
	Dyad: (building with Legos) Parent: You're making a house. (BD) BUT: Parent: I'm making a helicopter. (TA)

2. The subject of the sentence in a Behavioral Description is always the child. In speaking, parents may omit the word “you” but the subject (i.e., the child) can usually be inferred from the context, the parent's inflection, or the verb tense.

Examples	
Child: (draws sun) Parent: Drew a big sun. (BD)	Child: (puts Lincoln log on wall) Parent: Building the wall. (BD)
Child: (sets chimney on house) Parent: Put the chimney on. (BD) (parent's inflection sounds like the sentence begins with “You have”)	

3. Behavioral Descriptions can be distinguished from Neutral Talks by their content. Behavioral Descriptions use action verbs to describe actual observable child behavior and do not interpret thoughts, motivations, feelings, or events. Verbs that are not considered action verbs include “got,” “have,” “want,” “know,” “are,” “decide,” and “try to decide.”

Examples	
Parent: You are smelling the crayons. (BD) BUT: Parent: You smell like soap. (TA)	Child: (gently places block on tall tower) Parent: You are placing them carefully. (BD) BUT: Parent: You are careful. (TA)
Parent: You are looking at the book. (BD) BUT: Parent: You look puzzled. (TA) Parent: You're looking angry. (TA) Parent: You have a book (TA)	Child: (standing by parent's side) Parent: You're waiting for me. (BD) BUT: Parent: You're wanting something. (TA)
Parent: You are smiling. (BD) BUT: Parent: You appear to like this game. (TA) Parent: You seem happy. (TA)	Parent: You're doing that fast. (BD) BUT: Parent: You're almost done. (TA)
Child: (counting) Parent: You're counting. (BD) BUT: Parent: You know your numbers. (TA)	Child: (reaching for paper) Parent: You're getting more paper. (BD) BUT: Parent: You have lots of paper. (TA)

4. Noncritical statements that describe what the child is not doing are coded as Neutral Talk, not Behavioral Descriptions.

Examples	
Child: (building a small fort) Parent: You're using the short ones for this fort. (BD) BUT: Parent: You're not using the long ones for this fort. (TA)	Child: (putting the eyeglasses on Mrs. Potato Head) Parent: You're putting her glasses on first. (BD) BUT: Parent: You aren't putting her eyes on yet. (TA)

5. **Behavioral Descriptions can be distinguished from Neutral Talk by the time frame. A Behavioral Description gives only an account of the child's current or immediately completed behavior. Descriptions of past (more than 5-seconds) or future behaviors are not Behavioral Descriptions.**

Examples	
Child: (climbing on cabinet to reach a game) Parent: You're trying to get the game. (BD) BUT: Parent: You played with that game last week. (TA)	Parent: You're going to fall. (TA) Child: (pushing car up ramp to garage) Parent: You're making it go up the ramp. (BD) BUT: Parent: You made it go down the ramp last time. (TA) Parent: You're going to have a full garage pretty soon. (TA)
Child: (draws a blue star; then draws a red star) Parent: You made a red star. (BD) Parent: You made two stars. (BD) BUT: Parent: You made a blue star there. (TA) Parent: You will have a colorful sky. (TA)	

6. **A parent's Behavioral Description may be prompted by the child's verbal behavior.**

Examples	
Child: (pulls horse out of box) Child: This is Flicka. Parent: You named your horse. (BD)	Child: (bounces horse's nose on table) Child: Horsey's eating. Parent: You're making him eat. (BD) BUT: Parent: He's hungry. (TA)
Child: Can we play with those? Parent: You want to play with those again. (TA)	

7. **When the subject of a parent's description is both the parent and the child, it is coded Behavioral Description.**

Examples	
Dyad: (drawing picture together) Parent: We're drawing a house. (BD) Parent: You're drawing a house. (BD) BUT: Parent: I'm drawing a house. (TA)	Dyad: (completing block tower) Parent: We did it! (BD) BUT: Parent: Our tower is finished. (TA)
Child: Next, here come the elephants. Parent: We're lining up the animals. (BD) BUT: Parent: These animals are going to line up. (TA)	

8. **When the parent elaborates on a meaningful Behavioral Description with words or phrases not containing verbs, the elaboration is coded as a separate verbalization only if it is separated by a pause of 2 seconds or more and contains independent meaning.**

Examples	
Parent: You're pushing the truck (2 sec.) up the hill. (BD + TA) BUT: Parent: You're pushing the truck (1 sec.) up the hill. (BD)	Parent: You're coloring the bunny (3 sec.) pink. (BD + TA) BUT: Parent: You're coloring the bunny (no pause) pink. (BD)

9. When a statement contains two or more complete descriptions (i.e., each description having a subject and a verb) joined by “and” or “but,” code each sentence separately. Complete Behavioral Descriptions must include a verb phrase describing the child's ongoing or immediately completed behavior, but do not require an explicitly stated subject.

- a. When a statement contains two or more complete descriptions (i.e., each having a verb phrase) joined by “and” or “but,” code each description separately.

Examples	
Dyad: (coloring) Parent: You drew a heart and you colored it hot pink. (BD + BD)	Dyad: (coloring) Parent: You're drawing an apple but you're making it green. (BD + BD)
Dyad: (building house with Legos) Parent: The wall is blue but you're making the roof red and it's going to fall. (TA + BD + TA)	Dyad: (playing tea party) Parent: The table is set and you're pouring the tea. (TA + BD)
Dyad: (building with Lincoln logs) Parent: You built a house but there's nobody home. (BD + TA)	Dyad: (playing with marbles) Parent: You're sorting them and making little piles. (BD + BD)
Child: (playing with toy circus) Parent: You put the elephant in the circus train and laid him down and covered him. (BD + BD + BD)	Child: (building with blocks) Parent: Putting on a red one now and putting on a green one and putting a yellow one on. (BD + BD + BD)
Child: (playing with toy garage) Parent: You're driving Big Bird to the gas pump and putting lots of gas in his car and driving away. (BD + BD + BD)	Child: (working on puzzle) Parent: You're turning over all the pieces, but only putting in the big ones. (BD + BD)

- b. When a parent lists a series of verb phrases that are not connected by “and” or “but,” each verb phrase is coded as a separate sentence regardless of pauses.

Examples	
Parent: You're drawing the tree, drawing the branches, coloring the leaves. (BD + BD + BD)	Parent: We're snapping on the pieces, connecting the track, making it curve around the mountain. (BD + BD + BD)

- c. When a parent issues a series of descriptive phrases, an action verb must be present that describes the child's ongoing or immediately completed behavior for the phrase to be a behavioral description. Without the verb, the phrase is Neutral Talk.

Examples	
Parent: You're pushing the truck (1 sec.) driving to the dump (1 sec.) unloading your cargo. (BD + BD + BD)	Parent: You're putting on the green triangle (2 sec.) putting on the blue circle (3 sec.) now the red square. (BD + BD + TA)
Parent: You're putting on the green triangle (2 sec.) the blue circle (2 sec.) the red square. (BD + TA + TA)	

- 10. Statements beginning with “You can...” are Behavioral Descriptions only when the child has already begun to perform the behavior described by the parent in the “You can...” statement. Statements beginning with “You can...” are Neutral Talks when the statement is in response to the child's request for permission or for a specific suggestion about what to do. Statements beginning with “You can...” are Indirect Commands only when the child has not sought direction and the child has not actually begun to perform the behavior.**

Examples	
Child: (draws race car) Parent: You can draw big racecars. (BD) ----- BUT: Child: What can I draw now? Parent: You can draw big racecars. (TA)	Child: (returns from bathroom) Parent: You can go to the bathroom all by yourself. (BD) ----- BUT: Child: Can I go to the bathroom? Parent: Yes, you can go. (TA+TA)
Child: (fidgeting with legs crossed) Parent: You can go to the bathroom. (IC)	

- 11. Statements beginning with “You are going to...” are coded as Behavioral Descriptions only when the child has already initiated the behavior being described in the statement and when the statement does not contain a specific suggestion for a new or different behavior to be performed by the child.**

Examples	
Child: (stacking Lincoln Logs) Parent: You're going to make log piles. (BD) ----- BUT: Child: (stretching chewing gum) Parent: You are going to put that gum in your mouth. (DC)	Child: (drawing) Parent: You are going to draw a picture. (BD) ----- BUT: Child: (throwing crayons) Parent: You are going to draw a picture. (DC)

- 12. When a parent makes a Behavioral Description “in role” during pretend play with toy characters, the statement is coded Behavioral Description.**

Examples	
Child: (child's hand-puppet grabs mother's puppet) Parent: (talking as puppet) You grabbed me. (BD) ----- NOTE: Child: (child's “puppet” hits mother) Parent: (talking for self in neutral tone) You hit me. (BD)	Child: (rocking baby doll) Parent: (talking to doll) You're sleeping. (BD) ----- NOTE: Child: (puts head on table and closes eyes) Parent: (talking to child) You're sleeping. (BD)

NEUTRAL TALK (TA)

Definition

Neutral talk is comprised of statements that introduce information about people, objects, events, or activities, or indicate attention to the child, but do not clearly describe or evaluate the child's current or immediately completed behavior.

Parent Neutral Talk Examples	
I'm making my rainbow just like yours.	Children are supposed to take turns.
The dolly is going to sleep.	Children aren't supposed to hit.
I want to draw with you.	I need a few more of those big ones.
I need to pull up my chair.	It's your turn to choose the game.
I wonder if I left the iron on.	Over there.
That's a tall tower you're making.	Your dad made a nice sail.
That's a new song you sang.	This dollhouse is attractive.
You seem to be feeling very happy today.	I'm feeling tired too.
You used the green sticks last time.	A, B, C, D.
The boat has a smokestack and four portholes.	I see that you look bored.
Slowly.	The doll has red hair and she has green eyes.
All you have to do is hold it steady like this.	Blue, but it's red on the back.
It looks like you might be getting ready to build.	You're making a fort (2 sec.) with tall windows.
Then, you'll need more blocks.	If you put another one on, there will be five.
You're going to fall.	If you don't rip it, I'll let you have more.
Careful.	Quietly
Gentle.	Gently
Just a sec.	Oh!
We'll see.	I'll be!
I see.	Oh my goodness!
How about that.	Hi!
Mmm.	You're welcome.
Oh dear.	Gesundheit.
Ooops!	Excuse me.
Uh-huh.	Bye.
Sorry.	There you go.
Maybe.	Why not.
I don't know.	Darn.
Sure does.	Well.
Okay.	Now.
Alright.	Sure.

Decision Rules

1. When uncertain whether the verbalization is Neutral Talk or any other verbalization category, code Neutral Talk.
2. When uncertain whether a statement is a Behavioral Description or Neutral Talk, code Neutral Talk.
3. When uncertain whether Neutral Talk words strung together are one sentence or separate sentences, code one sentence.

Parent TA Guidelines

1. Neutral Talk may give an account of:

- a. the parent's independent behavior

Examples	
Dyad: (playing with barnyard) Child: (putting cow in barn) Parent: I'm putting the horse in the barn. (TA) BUT: Parent: You're putting the cow in the barn. (BD)	Child: (sorting out blocks) Parent: I'm picking out all the blue ones. (TA) BUT: Parent: You're picking out all the red ones. (BD)

- b. toys, objects, people, and activities

Examples	
Child: (rocking a doll) Parent: The dolly is going to sleep. (TA)	Dyad: (talking about their trip to Spain) Parent: There's a world map on that bulletin board. (TA)
Child: (playing with Tinker Toys) Child: I'm going to play with Legos. Parent: You want to change games now. (TA)	Child: (working a puzzle with her mother) Parent: I think your Dad is standing in the hall. (TA)
Child: Why can't grandpa come over tonight? Parent: Grandpa's cow had a new calf. (TA)	Dyad: (drawing numbers) Parent: There was a cute rabbit in our yard today. (TA)

- c. feelings or motivations

Examples	
Child: This puzzle won't work. Parent: You seem upset because of the missing pieces. (TA) OR: Parent: I'm getting upset with all the missing pieces. (TA)	Child: I'm feeling tired. Parent: I'm feeling happy. (TA) OR: Parent: I'm feeling tired, too. (TA)
Child: (starting to build tower) Parent: You want to build a tower. (TA) OR: Parent: I want to build with you. (TA)	Child: Give me the robot. Parent: I don't want to. (TA)
Child: (scowls and throw toys out of box) Parent: You're looking angry. (TA) BUT: Parent: You're looking for the cow. (BD)	

- d. general comments that do not describe the child's behavior

Examples	
Child: (playing with colored straws) Parent: (playing with puzzle) This puzzle is hard. (TA)	Child: I don't know where his hat is. Parent: I don't know either. (TA)
Dyad: (drawing at chalkboard) Child: I drew a man. Parent: I'm going to draw a hat on him. (TA)	Dyad: (Looking at puzzle of map) Child: Here's Florida. Parent: I need to sit closer so I can see this. (TA)

2. **Neutral Talk can be distinguished from Behavioral Description by the subject of the sentence. Although the subject of Neutral Talk may be the child, when the subject of a Descriptive Statement is other than the child, it is always a Neutral Talk.**

Examples	
Parent: The red car is touching you (TA) BUT: Parent: That's a red car you're touching. (BD) BUT: Parent: You're touching the red car. (BD)	Child: (drawing a house) Parent: That house looks like ours. (TA) BUT: Parent: You're drawing a house like ours. (BD)

3. **When the subject of the Descriptive Statement is the child, the statement can only be Neutral Talk if it does not use action verbs to describe the child's behavior. Neutral Talk uses state-of-being verbs to describe thoughts, feelings, motivations, or facts.**

Examples	
Child: (petting toy cat) Parent: You're feeling really happy. (TA) BUT: Parent: You're feeling the kitty's soft fur. (BD)	Child: (putting alphabet blocks in order) Parent: You are thinking about the order. (TA) BUT: Parent: You are putting them in order. (BD)
Parent: (hides queen doll) Child: (begins searching for doll) Parent: You're wondering where she went. (TA) BUT: Parent: You're looking for the queen. (BD)	Parent: You have a blue dog, a red parrot, and a green bear. (TA) BUT: Parent: You're holding the blue dog, the red parrot, and the green bear. (BD)
Child: (fixing plane) Parent: You want to fix the plane. (TA) BUT: Parent: You are fixing the plane. (BD)	Parent: You're almost through. (TA) BUT: Parent: You're working hard. (BD)
Parent: You lost a wheel. (TA)	

4. **Neutral Talk may be distinguished from Behavioral Description by the time frame. Description of past behavior (> 5 sec.) is Neutral Talk, in contrast to Behavioral Description which gives only an account of the child's current or immediately completed behavior.**

Examples	
Parent: You played with that game last week. (TA) BUT: Child: (climbing on cabinet to reach a game) Parent: You're trying to get the game. (BD)	Child: (pushing car up ramp to garage) Parent: You made it go down the ramp last time. (TA) BUT: Parent: You're making it go up the ramp. (BD)
Child: (draws a blue star; then draws a red star) Parent: You made a blue star there. (TA) BUT: Parent: You made a red star. (BD) Parent: You made two stars. (BD)	

5. Noncritical statements that describe what the child is not doing are coded as Neutral Talk, not Behavioral Descriptions.

Examples	
Child: My pinwheel is real big. Parent: You didn't make it too big. (TA)	Child: I'm coloring the hat. Parent: You're not using the green crayons. (TA) BUT: Parent: You're using the red ones. (BD)
Child: (drawing red flowers) Parent: You're not drawing yellow flowers today. (TA) BUT: Child: (drawing guns) Parent: You're not drawing guns today. (NTA)	

6. Neutral Talk does not contain orders or demands.

- a. The generic use of “you” meaning “one” or “people” when providing information should not be confused with the “you” referring to a child in a command.

Examples	
Dyad: (drawing) Parent: You make a circle like this. (draws) (TA) BUT: Parent: Will you draw a circle? (IC)	Parent: (demonstrating how to use cash register) Parent: (pressing) All you do is press. (TA) BUT: Parent: Press the buttons, Okay? (IC)

- b. A permission statement beginning with “You can...,” “You might...,” “You could.....” or “You may...” and following a request for that permission is Neutral Talk. If a parent offers an unsolicited permission statement suggesting a specific behavior the child is to perform, it is an Indirect Command.

Examples	
Child: Can I take the red crayon? Parent: You can take the red crayon. (TA) BUT: Child: I want to color. Parent: You can take the red crayon. (IC)	Child: May I eat that candy? Parent: You may eat the candy. (TA) OR: Parent: You may have the candy. (TA) BUT: Parent: (takes candy out of purse) Parent: You may eat the candy. (IC)
Child: Can I have a Kleenex? Parent: Yes, you can have a Kleenex. (TA + TA) Parent: Yes, you can get it yourself. (TA + IC)	

- c. Statements about future behaviors are Neutral Talk when they describe what will likely happen to the child in the future. They are commands when they directly instruct the child to perform a future behavior.

Examples	
Child: Can we go down this hallway? Parent: You'll beg for candy if we pass the vending machines. (TA)	Child: I want to build another tower. Parent: Then you need more blocks. (TA) BUT: Parent: Then you need to get more blocks. (DC)
Child: (standing on chair) Parent: You are going to fall. (TA) BUT: Parent: You are going to get down. (DC)	Child: Tomorrow is a holiday. Parent: Tomorrow you get to visit Grandma. (TA) Parent: Tomorrow you have to visit Grandma. (DC)

7. Statements that provide general rules for appropriate behavior can be Neutral Talk, Indirect Commands, or Negative Talk.

- a. A positively-worded statement that describes a rule about appropriate behavior in general, but does not imply that the child's ongoing or just-completed behavior should be performed differently in the future, is coded Neutral Talk.

Examples	
Child: Her mother makes her say "please." Parent: Children should talk nicely to their parents. (TA) ----- BUT: Child: I hate you. Parent: Children should talk nicely to their parents. (IC)	Dyad: (looking at storybook) Child: Why are they putting them away? Parent: Children are supposed to pick up their toys. (TA) ----- BUT: Parent: Pick up the toys. Child: (whines) I don't want to pick up the toys. Parent: Children are supposed to pick up their toys. (IC)
Child: What are the rules in this game? Parent: People are supposed to take turns. (TA) ----- BUT: Child: (child moves both players' pieces in a board game) Parent: People are supposed to take turns. (IC)	Child: How come these don't fit in the box? Parent: The tinker toys have to be taken apart first. (TA) ----- BUT: Parent: Put the Tinker Toys away. Child: (jams construction at top of box) Parent: You might take them apart first. (IC)

- b. A negatively-worded statement (i.e., tells the child what not to do) that describes a rule about appropriate behavior in general and that does not criticize the child's ongoing or immediately completed behavior is coded Neutral Talk.

Examples	
Child: (reaches for crayon) Parent: You can't hold them too tightly. (TA) ----- BUT: Child: (crayon breaks in child's fist while drawing) Parent: You can't hold them so tightly. (NTA)	Child: Johnny called his mom a witch. Parent: Children aren't supposed to call their parents names. (TA) ----- BUT: Child: You're a witch. Parent: Children aren't supposed to call their parents names. (NTA)
Child: What does that sign say? Parent: It says that no drinks are allowed in this room. (TA) ----- BUT: Child: (brings drink into room) Parent: No drinks are allowed in this room. (NTA)	Dyad: (enters playroom) Parent: You are not allowed to run in here. (TA) ----- BUT: Child: (running around playroom) Parent: You are not allowed to run in here. (NTA)

- 8. Some parent statements may implicitly direct the child by providing information; however, code command only when the statement contains an action verb calling for a vocal or motor behavior to be performed by the child.**

Examples	
Child: (puts coins on the keys) Parent: The coins go in the slot. (TA) BUT: Parent: Put the coins in the slot. (DC)	Child: (gives father some Lincoln Logs) Parent: I want more short ones. (TA) Parent: Give me more short ones. (DC)
Dyad: (building log cabin) Parent: We need another log right here. (TA) BUT: Parent: We need to put another log right here. (IC)	Parent: Sit down. (DC) Child: (remains standing for 4 sec.) Parent: (loudly) Now. (TA)
Parent: Find the word "go." (DC) Parent: Find the word "see." (DC) Parent: The next word is "stop." (TA)	Parent: Up! (TA) BUT: Parent: Go up the stairs. (DC)
Parent: Gently. (TA) Parent: Quiet. (TA) Parent: In the toy box. (TA) Parent: Quietly. (TA)	Parent: Careful. (TA) BUT: Parent: Be careful (DC/NOC) Parent: Please. (IC/NOC) Parent: Hey! (IC/NOC)
Parent: Say "one." (DC) Child: One. Parent: Say "Two." (DC) Child: Two. Parent: Three. (TA)	Dyad: (spelling words with alphabet blocks) Parent: Put an "A" here. (DC) Child: (puts correct block in place) Parent: A "T" goes next. (TA) Child: (looks for "T" block) Parent: Here's a "T". (points) (TA)

- 9. Neutral Talk contains no praise or criticism of the child's products or activities.**

- a. Certain Neutral Talk phrases are commonly used to express approval and positive evaluation of the child's activities, products or attributes. These idiomatic expressions are coded Unlabeled Praise. The expressions, "There you go," "Alright," and "Yes," are considered expressions of Unlabeled Praise only when accompanied by nonverbal gestures clearly indicating approval (e.g., smiles, claps, Positive Touches).

Examples	
Child: (drawing) See my car? Parent: (holds hand out for a high five) Alright! (UP) BUT: Child: Can we play with the cars? Parent: Alright. (TA)	Parent: Find the "A." Child: (points to "A") Parent: (claps and exclaims) "Yea!" (UP) BUT: Parent: Find the "A." Child: (points to "A") Parent: Yes. (TA)
Child: Dog is spelled D. O. G. Parent: Wow! (UP) BUT: Parent: Golly. (TA)	Child: I did it! Parent: Way to go! (UP) BUT: Parent: Yup. (TA)
Child: (finishes puzzle) Parent: (hugs child) There you go! (PTO + UP) BUT: Parent: (hands child a pencil) Parent: (matter-of-factly) There you go. (TA)	

- b. When the statements include criticism of the child, code Negative Talk. When the statements contain criticism of a person other than the child, code Neutral Talk.

Examples	
Child: Do you like my A? Parent: That's a big A. (TA)	Child: I made a house. Parent: I'm making a fence around your house. (TA)
OR: Parent: I don't like mine. (TA)	OR: Parent: The fence I'm making around your house is not looking good. (TA)
BUT: Parent: I think it's too big. (NTA)	BUT: Parent: I'm making a fence around your ugly house. (NTA)

- c. When a statement includes praise or criticism of some aspect of the play situation (e.g., objects, activities, ideas) that is not owned or created by either person, it is coded as Neutral Talk.

Examples	
Child: (picking up a toy cow) Parent: It has beautiful spots on its ears. (TA)	Child: (playing with blocks) Parent: There is a bad smell in this room. (TA)
Child: They don't have any dolls today. Parent: Darn. (TA)	Child: (smells bad smell and makes a face) Parent: Yuck. (TA)
Child: The Gators won yesterday. Parent: Wow! (TA)	Child: This is new chalk! Parent: Neat! (TA)
Child: They have a Magna Doodle in the toy box. Parent: Yea! (TA)	Dyad: (entering room, where Lincoln Logs are scattered all over the floor) Parent: Someone left a mess in here! (TA) BUT: Child: (walks away from the Lincoln Logs, which she has left spread out all over the floor of the playroom) Parent: Someone left a mess in here! (NTA)

- d. Certain phrases of Neutral Talk are commonly used to express disapproval and negative evaluation of the child's activities, products or attributes. These expressions (e.g., "darn," "yuck," "ick") are coded Negative Talk, not Neutral Talk.

Examples	
Child: I'm building a gun. Parent: Yuck. (NTA)	Child: I'm coloring my fingernails. Parent: Blech! (NTA)
Child: I chose red. Parent: Darn. (NTA)	

- 10. When a child's Prosocial Talk is repeated by the parent using the same or synonymous words, the parent's statement is Neutral Talk only when it changes the meaning of the child's statement.**

Examples	
Child: I'm feeling tired. Parent: I'm feeling tired. (TA)	Child: My car is red and white. Parent: My car is red and white, too. (TA)
BUT: Parent: You're feeling tired. (RF)	BUT: Parent: The red and white car is yours. (RF)

11. When Neutral Talk statements are strung together and the end of a particular sentence is unclear, it is necessary to distinguish separate statements by attending to the thought being conveyed.

- a. Each conceptually self-contained thought is given one Neutral Talk code.

Examples	
Child: (looking at alphabet blocks) Parent: (pointing and naming each block) A. B. C. D. (TA + TA + TA + TA) BUT: Child: What is the alphabet? Parent: A, B, C, D. (TA)	Child: How do you spell my name? Parent: J, U, L, I, E. (TA) BUT: Child: Write my name. Parent: (as parent writes each letter, says) J. U. L. I. E. (TA+TA+TA+TA+TA)
Child: What are the colors in the flag? Parent: Red, white, and blue. (TA) BUT: Child: Look at my drawing. Parent: (pointing) Red. White. And blue. (TA+TA+TA)	Dyad: (playing with four cars) Parent: Red. Green. Blue. Purple. (TA+TA+TA+TA) BUT: Parent: These cars are red, green, blue and purple. (TA)
Child: Count to five. Parent: One, two, three, four, five. (TA) BUT: Child: How many blocks do I have? Parent: (points while counting) One. Two. Three. Four. Five. (TA+TA+TA+TA+TA)	

- b. Meaningful descriptions strung together but separated by a pause of 2 seconds or more are coded as separate sentences. Sentence fragments with no meaning are not coded.

Examples	
Child: Tell me the alphabet. Parent: A, B, C (2 sec. pause while parent picks up block from floor) D, E, F, G. (TA + TA)	Dyad: (looking at toy zoo) Parent: Here's a little lake where all the animals can come to drink the water (2 sec.) if they're thirsty although the water might not be very cold if it's a hot day which might mean they wouldn't want to drink it (2 sec.) so then they'd get more thirsty. (TA + TA + TA)
Child: (getting two dolls from toy cupboard) Parent: That looks like Raggedy Ann and Andy. (TA) OR: Parent: That looks like Raggedy Ann (2 sec.) and Andy. (TA + TA) BUT: Parent: That looks like (2 sec.) Raggedy Ann and Andy. (fragment not coded; TA)	

12. When a parent issues a series of neutral statements, an action verb must be present that describes the child's ongoing or immediately completed behavior for the phrase to be a Behavioral Description. When the verb is absent, the phrase is coded Neutral Talk.

Examples	
Parent: You're putting on the green triangle (2 sec.) the blue circle (2 sec.) the red square. (BD+TA+TA)	Parent: You're putting on the green triangle (2 sec.) putting on the blue circle (3 sec.) adding the red square. (BD + BD + BD)
Parent: You're pushing the truck (no pause) to the dump (1 sec.) to unload your cargo. (BD) Parent: You're pushing the truck (2 sec.) up the hill. (BD + TA) Parent: You're pushing the truck (1 sec.) up the hill. (BD)	

13. Some conditional statements are Neutral Talk. Also see Appendix A for general guidelines for coding conditional statements.

- a. If a conditional statement specifies a natural consequence or a neutral parent response that is likely to occur as a result of the child's behavior, the statement is a Neutral Talk.

Examples	
Parent: If you say thank you, people will like you. (TA)	Parent: If you put it there, it might fall. (TA)
Parent: If you say thank you, I'll say you're welcome. (TA)	Parent: If you put it there, I'll put mine over here. (TA)

- b. If a conditional statement refers to a contingent reward from the parent that will follow if the child doesn't initiate an aversive behavior, code Neutral Talk.

Examples	
Parent: If you don't leave your room a mess tonight, I'll take you to the park tomorrow. (TA)	Parent: As long as you don't start acting sassy today, I'll take you to McDonald's on the way home. (TA)

- c. If a conditional statement indicates the parent-imposed conventional negative consequence that will follow if the child initiates an aversive behavior, code Neutral Talk.

Examples	
Parent: If you break your sister's headphones, I'll use your allowance money to replace them. (TA)	Parent: If you throw any of these crayons, I'll put you in time out. (TA)

- d. In any conditional statement, if the statement regarding the child's behavior contains elements of more than one DPICS category, the priority order for coding categories is used.

Examples	
Parent: If you say thank you, people will like you. (TA)	Parent: If you throw any of these crayons, I'll put you in time out. (TA)
BUT: Parent: If you are always as polite as you are right now, people will like you. (UP)	BUT: Parent: If you throw any of these crayons, I guarantee you'll regret it. (NTA)
Parent: If you don't get sassy in here, I'll give you bonus stickers tonight. (TA)	
BUT: Parent: If you don't get sassy in here, I won't tell your mom what a bad boy you were all morning. (NTA)	

14. Neutral Talk includes brief responses indicating to the child that the parent is watching or listening to them.

Examples	
Child: I drew a fat clown Parent: Hmmm. (TA)	Child: (drawing an ice cream cone) Parent: Yeah. (TA)
Child: It goes fast. Parent: Sure does. (TA)	

- 15. Neutral Talk includes exclamations of surprise that carry no information beyond the element of surprise. Neutral Talk does not necessarily contain intelligible content (i.e., it may be nonsense words commonly used to express surprise, such as “oops”).**

Examples	
Child: (pops up from under the table) Parent: Oh! (TA)	Child: (child's tower of blocks begins to sway) Parent: Ah-ah! (TA)
Child: I drew a four! Parent: Gosh! (TA)	ALSO: Oops! Whoops! Oh dear! Uh-oh! My goodness! Oh my! Goodness gracious! Oh my gosh! I'll be darned! Well I'll be. Huh!

- 16. Neutral Talk includes “automatically given” social phrases that do not actually describe, reflect, praise, or direct the child's behavior.**

Examples	
Child: (sneezes) Parent: Bless you. (TA)	Child: (bumps into parent) Ouch. Parent: I'm sorry. (TA)
NOTE: “Thank you” is an Unlabeled Praise.	Parent: (hiccups) Excuse me. (TA)
Child: I'm going to fly my rocket to the moon. Parent: Bye-bye. (TA)	BUT: Child: (curses) Parent: Excuse me? (NTA)

- 17. When a child asks a Question requesting agreement or disagreement with a positive or negative self-evaluation, the parental response may contain implicit praise or criticism, which would then be coded as Labeled Praise, Unlabeled Praise, or Negative Talk.**

Examples	
Child: Is my picture good? Parent: Yes. (UP)	Child: (puts on mother's lipstick) Am I pretty? Parent: No. (NTA)
Child: Is my picture good? Parent: Not really. (NTA)	

- 18. When Neutral Talk is stated sarcastically, they are coded Negative Talk.**

Examples	
Parent: (ties bow in child's hair) Child: (walks away without saying thank you) Parent: (sarcastic tone) You're welcome. (NTA)	Child: (burps) Parent: (sarcastically) Excuse me. (NTA)
Child: I'm a fairy princess. Parent: (sarcastically) Sure. (NTA)	

- 19. Phrases of Neutral Talk stated with questioning inflection are coded as Descriptive/Reflective Questions.**

Examples	
Child: My car can fly. Parent: Oh? (DQ)	Parent: (tries to fit piece in puzzle) Parent: How about that? (DQ)
Child: This dolly's name is Cher. Parent: Really? (DQ)	Child: Is that really gonna work? Parent: (does it) See? (DQ)

20. The word “no” is sometimes coded Neutral Talk depending on the preceding child behavior or verbalization.

- a. When the child issues a statement or question expressing a feeling, wish, or other internal state and the parent responds to the child’s verbalization with “No” or its synonyms, the “No” is coded Neutral Talk.

Examples	
Child: I want to make a helicopter. Parent: No, there aren’t enough pieces. (TA + TA)	Child: Wouldn’t it be fun if I were a big spider? Parent: Nope. (TA)

- b. When a parent uses the word “No” or its synonyms to indicate that a preceding statement by the child is incorrect, the word “No” or its synonyms is coded as Negative Talk rather than Neutral Talk, unless the parent is contradicting a negative child self-statement.

Examples	
Child: This is a red crayon. Parent: No. It's blue. (NTA + TA) ----- BUT: Child: Is this red? Parent: No, it's blue. (TA + TA)	Child: (holding doll) She wants to play now. Parent: No, she wants to sleep. (NTA + TA) ----- BUT: Child: I want to play now. Parent: No, it's time to clean-up. (TA + TA)
Child: I put it here. Parent: No, it goes over here. (NTA + TA) ----- BUT: Child: I did it wrong. Parent: No. It looks good. (TA + UP)	Child: I'm ugly. Parent: No, you're not. (TA + TA)

- c. When a parent responds to a child's command by saying “No” or its synonyms followed in less than 2 seconds by another verbalization, the word “No” or its synonyms is not coded. The word “No” or its synonyms is coded as a Negative Talk when the parent responds to a child's command with a flat refusal (i.e., by saying “No” or its synonyms and issuing no additional verbalizations for 2 seconds).

Examples	
Child: Give me the blue one. Parent: No, (1 sec) get the blue one yourself. (DC)	Child: Let's put the green one on next. Parent: No, (no pause) the red one would look better. (TA) ----- BUT: Child: Give me the blue one. Parent: No. (3 sec.) The blue one is broken. (NTA + TA)
NOTE: When a child responds to a parental command with “No” or its synonyms, it is always coded as a Negative Talk regardless of subsequent compliance or other verbalizations by the child.	

21. Words that have no distinct meaning other than to introduce a sentence are not coded separately.

Examples	
Child: What should we play? Parent: Here, I have a great idea. (TA) BUT: Child: I need another block. Parent: (hands block) Here. (TA)	Child: I put the green one on. Parent: Now, put the red one on. (DC) BUT: Child: When can we go home? Parent: Now. Put your coat on. (TA + DC)
Child: I put long ears on it. Parent: There, it's a rabbit. (TA) BUT: Child: I don't know where it goes. Parent: (points) There. (TA)	Child: It's your turn. Parent: Let's see, I think I'll use green. (TA) BUT: Child: I drew a rabbit. Parent: Let's see. (IC; i.e., meaning Show me)
Child: Why do we have to stop? Parent: See, (1 sec.) the little hand is on 10. (TA) BUT: Parent: See? (1 sec.) The little hand is on 10. (DQ + TA)	

22. When a Neutral Talk follows a complete sentence by the parent in which the subject or focus of the sentence is the child, code Neutral Talk. When the subject of the preceding sentence is other than the child, do not code Neutral Talk.

Examples	
Child: (building a train) Parent: That train has a red caboose. My goodness. (TA) BUT: Parent: You built such a long train, my goodness. (BD + TA)	Child: (puts Mr. Potato Head in the toy box) Parent: They have a nice toy box, yeah. (TA) BUT: Parent: I like how you're putting the toys away, yeah. (LP + TA)

23. A verbalization cannot be simultaneously coded as Neutral Talk and any other verbalization category.

Examples	
Child: I did my best. Parent: (sarcastically) Oh yeah. (NTA not TA)	Child: (holds up her own drawing) Pretty! Parent: Sure is! (UP not TA)
Child: I'm gonna make her dress orange. Parent: Yuck. (NTA not TA)	

24. When acknowledgments accompany a physical behavior (i.e., Positive Touch, Negative Touch), both Neutral Talk and the physical behaviors are coded.

Examples	
Child: (tries to grab toy from parent) I need this one. Parent: (restrains child's arm and says in neutral tone, "Maybe.") (TA + NTO)	Child: Can I make one for you? Parent: (hugs child and says in neutral tone, "Sure.") (TA + PTO)

TOUCH

Physical touch categories provide information regarding some of the non-verbal communication that takes place within the parent-child dyad. Any physical touch between the members of the dyad is coded, with the exception of accidental touch. Touches are categorized as Positive Touch (PTO) or Negative Touch (NTO).

NEGATIVE TOUCH (NTO)

Definition

A Negative Touch is any physical touch that is intended to be directive, antagonistic, aversive, hurtful, or restrictive of the child's activity.

Parent Negative Touch Examples	
(hits child)	(shakes child)
(touches child tauntingly after child says "Leave me alone")	(raps child's knuckles with Lincoln Log)
(kicks child)	(holds child's arm to prevent throwing)
(drags child by arm from underneath table)	(spanks child with three successive swats)
(grabs and shakes child)	(pins child's arms while he sits on parent's lap)
(knocks child's hand making toy crash on floor)	(restrains child's arm while saying "Stop that")

Decision rules

1. When uncertain whether physical contact has occurred, do not code either Positive Touch or Negative Touch.
2. When uncertain whether negative physical contact is accidental or intentional, do not code Negative Touch.
3. When uncertain whether physical contact has been negative or positive, code Positive Touch.
4. When uncertain whether Negative Touch is one or two occurrences, code one Negative Touch.

Parent NTO Guidelines

1. **Any intentional touching of the child by the parent is coded either Positive Touch or Negative Touch. Neutral touch is coded Positive Touch. Accidental touching is not coded.**

Examples
Parent: (taps child on shoulder to get attention—physical redirection) (NTO) Parent: (hits child) (NTO)
BUT: Parent: (hugs child) (PTO) Parent: (holds child's fingers around crayon to draw) (PTO) Parent: (pats child on the shoulder) (PTO) Parent: (incidentally touches child while reaching for object) (not coded)

2. It is often necessary to use context to determine whether parent touch is coded **Positive Touch** or **Negative Touch**. When judgment is based on context, it is the intent of the parent, rather than the effect on the child, that is judged.

Examples	
Child: (draws valentine) Parent: (pats child's leg while saying, " Good job.") (PTO + UP) Child: (yells) My bruise!	
BUT: Child: Don't touch me! Parent: (pats child's leg while saying, "Settle Down.") (NTO + DC)	
Child: while giggling, says "Peek-a-boo!" Parent: (tweaks child's nose while saying, "You're a sweetie.") (PTO + UP)	
BUT: Child: (while giggling, says "Peek-a-boo!") Parent: (tweaks child's nose while saying with angry tone, "Quit acting silly.") (NTO + NTA)	
Child: (reaching to knock over tower) Parent: (elbows child to block child from knocking over tower) (NTO)	
BUT: Dyad: (building tall block tower) Parent: (grabs at falling tower and accidentally elbows child) (not coded)	

3. A parent **Negative Touch** includes negative touching of the child with any part of the parent's body or with an object. Actual physical contact must occur.

Examples	
Child: I'm gonna bite him if I want. Parent: (bites child's arm) That's what it feels like. (NTO + TA)	Child: (jumps on couch next to parent) Parent: (shoves child with knee, saying with irritation, "Move over.") (NTO + DC)
Parent: (swings fist and hits child) (NTO) BUT: Parent: (swings fist threateningly toward child, but makes no physical contact) (not coded)	Child: (knocks down cabin parent built) Parent: (strikes child with Lincoln Log) (NTO)
Dyad: (coloring) Child: (reaches for more paper) Parent: (pushes child's hand away from paper) (NTO) BUT: Parent: (pushes paper away from child's hand) (not coded)	Parent: (throws block at child, hitting child) (NTO) BUT: Child: (heading toward parent) I'm gonna sit on you. Parent: (holds child's shoulders to prevent it) (NTO) BUT: Parent: (holds up hands in stop gesture, not touching child) (not coded)

4. If two (or more) distinct types of **Negative Touch** behavior begin exactly at the same time, only one **Negative Touch** is coded.

Examples
Parent: (grabs child's shoulder and swats child at the same time) (NTO) BUT: Parent: (grabs child's shoulder; 2 sec. pause; swats child) (NTO + NTO)

5. Any single type of Negative Touch that is continuous is coded only at its termination. Separate types of Negative Touch behaviors that occur simultaneously are also coded.

Examples	
Child: I don't want to clean up.	
Parent: (pulls child by pigtail toward toy box) (not yet coded)	
Parent: (keeps hold of child's pigtail while child puts toys in box) (not coded)	
Parent: (while still holding child's pigtail, grabs child's hand to prevent child from throwing a toy)(NTO)	
Parent: (after 35 sec. of holding pigtail, releases it) (NTO)	
Child: (trying to leave room)	
Parent: (starts restraining child by arm) (not yet coded)	
Parent: (while still restraining child, slaps child) (NTO)	
Parent: (after 10 sec., releases child's arm) (NTO)	

6. Any discontinuous type of Negative Touch that occurs repeatedly in rapid succession (< 2 sec. apart) is coded as one Negative Touch. If there is a pause of 2 seconds or longer between successive Negative Touches of the same type, a second Negative Touch is coded for each series.

Examples	
Parent: (spanking child's bottom: swat, swat, swat, (2 sec. pause] swat, swat, swat) (NTO + NTO)	
BUT: Parent: (poking child tauntingly: poke, poke, poke, [no pause] grabs child's hand to prevent child from hitting parent) (NTO + NTO)	
Parent: (spanking child's bottom: swat, swat, swat) (NTO)	

7. Parent Negative Touch cannot be coded simultaneously with Positive Touch. If a parent touches a child gently while simultaneously delivering a Negative Touch, code Negative Touch.

Examples	
Parent: (touches child's arm while slapping child with other hand) (NTO)	Child: (climbing up bookcase) Parent: (hugs child while removing child from bookcase) (NTO)

8. A parent Negative Touch can occur simultaneously with any verbalization or vocalization category.

Examples	
Parent: (pulls child's hair while saying, "Stop that.") (NTO + NTA)	Parent: (has "doll" shove child, while parent is saying, "She wants you to move.") (NTO + TA)
Child: (tries to grab toy from parent while saying, "I need this one.")	
Parent: (restrains child's arm and says in neutral tone, "Maybe.") (NTO + TA)	

9. Parent actions that restrict the activity of the child by taking away objects directly touching the child are coded as Negative Touch.

Example
Parent: (pulls Lincoln log from child's grasp) (NTO)

POSITIVE TOUCH (PTO)

Parent Positive Touch Examples	
(puts arm around child)	(puts hand on child's leg)
(grabs child to keep child from falling)	(has teddy bear kiss child's cheek)
(hugs child who hugs parent back)	(holds child on lap for 2 min.)
(pets child's arm several times in quick succession)	(lifts child up and hugs child)
(while combing child's hair, kicks chair out of way)	

Decision rules

1. When uncertain whether physical contact has occurred, do not code either Positive Touch or Negative Touch.
2. When uncertain whether positive physical contact is accidental or intentional, do not code Positive Touch.
3. When uncertain as to whether the contact has been positive or negative, code Positive Touch.
4. When uncertain whether Positive Touch is one occurrence or two, code one Positive Touch.

Parent PTO Guidelines

1. **Any intentional touching of the child by the parent is coded either Positive Touch or Negative Touch. Incidental touching is not coded.**

Examples
Parent: (hugs child) (PTO) Parent: (places hand on child's knee) (PTO) Parent: (hits child) (NTO) ----- BUT: Parent: (hands child a pencil) (not coded)

2. **It is often necessary to use context to determine whether the touch is coded positive or negative. When judgment is based on context, it is the intent of the parent, rather than the effect on the child, that is judged.**

Examples	
Child: (playing happily) Parent: (gently touches child) (PTO) ----- BUT: Child: Don't touch me! Parent: (gently touches child) (NTO)	Child: (shows parent finished picture) Parent: (ruffles child's hair) Good job! (PTO + UP) ----- BUT: Child: (combs hair carefully) Parent: (ruffles child's hair with taunting laugh) (NTO)

3. A parent Positive Touch includes both neutral and Positive Touching of the child with any part of the parent's body or with an object.

Examples	
Parent: (touches leg to child's leg) Whose leg is longer? (PTO + IQ)	Parent: (touches child's nose with a furry toy) You're cute. (PTO + UP)
	BUT: Child: May I have that crayon? Parent: (drops crayon in child's hand) (not coded)

4. A parent Positive Touch can be coded only if there is actual physical contact with the child.

Examples	
Parent: (kisses child) (PTO)	Child: I did a good job.
BUT: Parent: (blows a kiss to the child) (not coded)	Parent: (shakes child's hand) (PTO)
	BUT: Parent: (claps) (not coded)
Child: (holding up clay doll) I made it for you.	
Parent: (touches child's hand) Thank-you. (PTO + UP)	
BUT: Parent: (touches doll in child's hand) Thank-you. (UP)	

5. If a parent Positive Touch is reciprocated by a child Positive Touch, or vice versa, both the parent Positive Touch and the child Positive Touch are coded.

Examples	
Parent: (hugs child) (PTO)	Parent: (kisses child on cheek) (PTO)
Child: (puts arms around parent to hug) (PTO)	Child: (kisses parent on cheek) (PTO)
Child: Give me five!	
Dyad: (clap each other's hands) (PTO by parent + PTO by child)	

6. Any single type of Positive Touch that is continuous is coded only at its termination. Separate types of Positive Touch that occur simultaneously are also coded.

Examples	
Parent: (holding child on lap, kisses child) (PTO)	Parent: (puts arm around child) (not yet coded)
Parent: (after 30 sec., sets child down) (PTO)	Parent: (with arm still around child, playfully touches child's nose) (PTO)
	Parent: (after 20 sec., removes arm from child) (PTO)

7. Any **discontinuous** type of **Positive Touch** that occurs repeatedly in rapid succession (< 2 seconds apart) is coded as one **Positive Touch**. If there is a pause of 2 seconds or longer between successive **Positive Touches** of the same type, a second **Positive Touch** is coded after each pause.

Examples	
Parent: (stroking child's hair) (stroke, stroke, stroke) (PTO)	Parent: (patting child's back) (pat, pat, [2 sec.] pat, pat, pat, pat,[4 sec.] pat, pat)
Parent: (stroking child's hair) (stroke, stroke, stroke, [2 sec. pause] stroke, stroke, stroke) (PTO + PTO)	(PTO + PTO + PTO)

8. If two (or more) distinct types of **Positive Touch** behavior begin and end simultaneously, only one **Positive Touch** is coded.

Examples
Parent: (puts hands on child's shoulders and kisses child at the same time) (PTO)
BUT: Parent: (puts hands on child's shoulders [2 sec.] kisses child) (PTO + PTO)

9. **Parent Positive Touch** cannot be coded simultaneously with **Negative Touch**. If a parent touches a child while simultaneously delivering a **Negative Touch**, code **Negative Touch**.

Examples	
Parent: (touches child's arm while slapping child with other hand) (NTO)	Child: (raises fist to knock over tower) Parent: (gently takes child's hand to restrain it) (NTO)

10. A parent **Positive Touch** can occur simultaneously with any verbalization or vocalization category.

Examples	
Parent: (touches child's mouth while saying, "This is your mouth") (PTO + TA)	Parent: (walks toy kitten along child's arm while saying, "Meow, meow".) (PTO + PT)
Child: Will you comb my hair? Parent: (runs comb through child's hair while saying, "Sure") (PTO + TA)	Dyad: (sing, "Pat-a-cake" and clap each other's hands) (PT + PTO) (sing, "Pat-a-cake" and clap each other's hands) (PT + PTO) (sing, "Baker's man" and clap each other's hands) (PT + PTO) (sing, "Bake me a cake" and clap each other's hands) (PT + PTO) (sing, "As fast as you can" and clap each other's hands) (PT + PTO)

CHILD CATEGORIES

NEGATIVE TALK (NTA)

Definition

Negative talk is a verbal expression of disapproval of the parent or the parent's attributes, activities, products, or choices. Negative talk also includes sassy, sarcastic, rude, or impudent speech.

Child Negative Talk Examples	
Parent: Bring the box over here. Child: Get it yourself.	Parent: Put your shoes on. Child: No.
Parent: (spills all the Tinker Toys on the floor) Child: Smart move.	Parent: You can't chew gum in this room. Child: If you don't give me my gum, I'll hit you.
You're being nasty.	Stop stop stop!
That's not very good.	She looks scraggly and you drew her arms too short.
Your picture is ugly.	I'm mad at you for telling dad and for taking my stuff.
You are mean.	Don't be so bossy and tell me to do everything.
I bet you got it wrong.	Will you stop acting dopey.
Why don't you leave me alone.	Move your junky things.
You made it too little.	Yuck.
(giggles, "You're silly for doing it wrong.")	(yells, "Don't sit there!")
That's not slime!	If you stop talking so much, it will be quieter.
You can't use crayons on this.	If you stop yelling, I'll put everything where it goes.
Quit that.	We goofed.
Parent: You'll like this game. Child: (sarcastic tone) I bet.	Parent: We're going to pick up now. Child: Says who?
Parent: The teacher said you started the fight. Child: She's a liar.	Parent: If you don't behave, you'll be grounded. Child: I don't give a _____.
Parent: Should you make it a little higher? Child: (answers sarcastically, "Whose tower is it?")	Parent: I can't let you go to the picnic. Child: I'm gonna get you back.

Decision rules

1. When uncertain whether a verbalization is a Negative Talk or a lower priority category such as a Descriptive Statement, Reflective Statement, question, command, or Neutral Talk, do not code Negative Talk.
2. When uncertain whether a comment is a Negative Talk or a neutral remark, do not code Negative Talk.

Child NTA Guidelines

1. A comment that contains a negatively evaluative word(s) referring to the parent or an action, product, attribute, or choice of the parent is Negative Talk.

Examples	
Parent: (drawing a dog). Child: You're making him <u>ugly</u> . (NTA)	Parent: (building) Do you like my rocket ship? Child: It's <u>not very good</u> . (NTA)
Parent: I'm moving my king back. Child: That's <u>stupid</u> . (NTA)	Parent: I had my hair colored. Child: It looks <u>awful</u> . (NTA)
Child: I hate you! (NTA) BUT: Child: I hate this game! (PRO)	Child: You're not fair! (NTA) BUT: Child: It's not fair! (PRO)

2. **Negative talk does not need an explicitly stated negatively evaluative word if it is clear from the context that it is a negative evaluation.**

Examples	
Child: Did you make the flower? Parent: I did my best. Child: It doesn't look like a flower. (NTA) ----- BUT: Parent: Guess what I made. Child: It doesn't look like a flower. (PRO)	Child: Write your name as fast as you can. Parent: (writes name) Child: That was slow. (NTA) ----- BUT: Child: Do it slowly. Parent: (obeys) Child: That was slow. (PRO)
Parent: Do you like my game? Child: Nope. (NTA)	

3. **Insincere questions used to correct the parent by pointing out what is wrong are Negative Talk.**

Examples	
Parent: You silly-billy! Child: Don't you know that's not nice? (NTA)	Parent: I'll wipe up the soda myself. Child: Why can't you let me do anything? (NTA)
Parent: The wings fit on the side. Child: Why do you always have to have your own way? (NTA)	

4. **Negative talk may express an unacceptable level or degree of an attribute, activity, product, or choice of the parent.**

Examples	
Parent: (describing toys) Child: You're talking too much. (NTA)	Parent: Is this the way it goes? Child: Daddy does it better. (NTA)
Parent: I finished mine. Child: You're going too fast. (NTA)	

5. **A description that corrects the parent's behavior by pointing out what the parent has done wrong is Negative Talk, even if delivered in honeyed or playful tones.**

Examples	
Parent: (holds up Bert) "Ernie!" Child: (giggles) That's not Ernie! (NTA) ----- BUT: Child: That's Bert! (PRO)	Parent: I'm doing my best to make it fit. Child: (smiling and saying playfully, "It's not quite right.") (NTA) ----- BUT: Child: It's almost right. (PRO) ----- NOTE: Child: It's right. (PRO)

6. **When the word "No" or its synonyms is used to indicate that the child doesn't want the parent to continue a behavior, it is coded as an independent Negative Talk.**

Examples	
Parent: (starting to put blocks away) Child: No. (NTA)	Parent: (rolling car up ramp) Child: (tries to block car) Uh-uh. (1 sec. pause) Give it to me. (NTA + CM)
Parent: (starts to take apart Mrs. Potato Head) Child: Stop! (NTA)	

7. Statements that directly tell the parent that what the parent has said is wrong are critical statements unless the child is contradicting a negative parent self evaluation.

- a. Statements that “correct” the parent's preceding statement are critical statements only if they directly negate the parent's words. Statements that simply provide correct information without directly negating the parent or the parent's words are not critical statements.

Examples	
Parent: This is Barney. Child: That is not Barney. (NTA)	Parent: The pig's eating. Child: That's not a pig. (NTA)
OR: Child: You're wrong. (NTA)	OR: Child: He's not eating. (NTA)
BUT: Child: That is Baby Bop. (PRO)	BUT: Child: The <u>dog</u> is eating. (PRO)

- b. When a child uses the word “No” or its synonyms to indicate that a preceding statement by the parent is incorrect, the word “No” or its synonyms is coded as an independent critical statement. Any subsequent verbalization is coded separately.

Examples	
Parent: This is the tallest one. Child: No. (NTA)	Parent: Flowers are yellow. Child: Uh-uh. Flowers are red. (NTA + PRO)
	BUT: Child: Flowers are red too. (PRO)

8. When the word “No” or its synonyms provides a negative appraisal of the parent in response to a parent's self-evaluative question or statement, code Negative Talk.

Examples	
Parent: Am I a good mommy? Child: No. (NTA)	Parent: I am a good builder. Child: Not! (NTA)
BUT: Parent: Am I a bad mommy? Child: No. (PRO)	BUT: Parent: I'm a terrible builder. Child: No you're not. (PRO + PRO)
Parent: Do you like my construction? Child: No (no pause) what is it anyway? (NTA + QU)	
BUT: Parent: Do you know what I made? Child: No (no pause) what is it anyway? (PRO + QU)	

9. When the parent expresses a wish to do or have something him or herself, and the child responds to the parent's verbalization with “No” or its synonyms, the “No” is coded Prosocial Talk not Negative Talk.

Examples	
Parent: I'd like to tuck your shirt in. Child: No. (PRO)	Dyad: (playing with Mr. Potato Head) Parent: I want the green hat. Child: Nope, the blue one goes with his eyes. (PRO + PRO)
Parent: I wish I could have the big stick. Child: No, I'm using it. (PRO + PRO)	NOTE: Parent: I want you to give me the blue piece. Child: No, I'm using it. (NTA + PRO)

10. A statement that directly instructs the parent not to perform some behavior that the child is engaged in, has just started, or has just completed, is a Negative Talk.

Examples	
Parent: I cleaned up your toys this morning. Child: Don't touch my stuff. (NTA)	Parent: (working on puzzle) Child: I told you not to play with that. (NTA)
Parent: (opening lid of container of Legos) Child: Don't take out the small Legos yet. (NTA)	Parent: (hugging child) Child: Cut that out. (NTA)
Parent: Put that away. Child: I want you to quit bossing me. (NTA)	Parent: It's time to clean this up. Child: Please don't take it. (NTA)
Parent: I'm going to the waiting room. Child: I don't want you to leave me alone. (NTA)	Parent: (smashes car into child's car) Child: Quit it. (NTA)

11. Statements indicating that the parent should not engage in behavior that the parent is engaged in, has just started, or has just completed (e.g., "You can't...", "You are not allowed to...", "You are not going to...") are coded Negative Talk. When such statements describe general rules for behavior that do not relate to ongoing or immediately completed behavior, code Neutral Talk.

Examples	
Child: You aren't allowed to draw on this. (NTA) ----- BUT: Dyad: (drawing with crayons on paper) Child: You aren't allowed to use crayons on the chalk board. (PRO)	
Parent: (starting to draw on child's picture) Parent: (begins putting pieces in child's puzzle) Child: You can't use this one. (NTA) ----- BUT: Parent: (watching child put pieces in puzzle) Child: You can't use a picture to figure this one out. (PRO)	

12. A verbalization that expresses disapproval of both the parent and the child, and/or their shared attributes, activities, products, or choices, is coded as Negative Talk.

Examples	
Dyad: (looking at a building they both worked on) Child: It's not very good. (NTA)	Dyad: (following diagram to make a windmill) Child: We're making it wrong. (NTA)
Dyad: (cutting out shapes) Child: We shouldn't be using so much paper. (NTA)	Parent: We messed up this room. Child: We did mess it up. (NTA)

13. A child verbalization containing self-criticism is not coded as a Negative Talk.

Examples	
Parent: You're making him very big. Child: I can't draw horses right. (PRO)	Parent: You forgot his hair. Child: That was stupid, huh? (QU)
Parent: I tossed out the used ones. Child: You tossed out my ugly ones. (PRO)	

14. The same single critical word repeated with no pause is coded as one Negative Talk.

Examples	
Parent: (reaching for toy child has hidden) Child: Uh-uh-uh-uh-uh (meaning stop). (NTA)	Parent: (starting to clean up) Child: No, no, no. (NTA)
Parent: Let's play with the dolls. Child: Yuck, Yuck. (NTA) ----- BUT: Parent: (trying to blow child's nose) Child: No, stop, yuck. (NTA + NTA + NTA)	

15. If a statement contains two or more meaningful verb phrases describing clearly independent parent behaviors and at least one negative evaluative word or phrase that modifies the verbs, each modified verb phrase is coded as a separate Negative Talk.

Examples
Child: That's not nice to take away the paper and take away the crayons. (NTA + NTA) ----- BUT: Child: That's not nice to take away the paper and crayons. (NTA)
Child: I don't like you for taking my turn and turning the board so I can't see it. (NTA + NTA)

16. When a critical statement contains two or more verb phrases describing the same behavior, only one Negative Talk is coded.

Examples	
Child: Don't drop my coat and get it dirty. (NTA)	Child: Don't bump the table and knock down my tower. (NTA)
Child: Stop being so bossy and telling me everything to do. (NTA)	Child: Don't put the red nose on her. And put the green earrings on her. (NTA + CM)
Child: I don't want you to get mad and yell. (NTA) ----- BUT: Child: I don't want you to yell at me and take away my stuff. (NTA + NTA)	

17. Negative talk is a verbal behavior that cannot be coded simultaneously with any other parent verbalization category. Negative talk takes precedence over all other verbalizations.

- a. Questions containing a critical evaluation of a behavior, product, or attribute of the parent are Negative Talk.

Examples	
Parent: I finished my picture first. Child: (sarcastically) So what? (NTA)	Parent: (continues picking up toys against child's wishes) Child: Didn't you hear me? (NTA)
Child: Why are you acting so bossy? (NTA)	Child: Will you quit being mean? (NTA)
Child: That's not very good, is it? (NTA)	

- b. Commands containing a critical evaluation of an activity, product, or attribute of the parent are Negative Talk.

Examples	
Child: (yells, "Get your stupid hand off my car.") (YE + NTA)	Child: Why don't you take apart your yucky design? (NTA)
Parent: It's time to clean up. Child: Don't bug me. (NTA)	Parent: Did you hear me? Child: Shut up. (NTA; not CM)
Child: You need to do better than that. (NTA)	

- c. Commands or statements made in the form of general rules for appropriate behavior are Negative Talk only when they serve to point out what is wrong about the parent's ongoing or immediately completed behavior.

Examples	
Parent: You're a brat. Child: Parents aren't supposed to call their kids names. (NTA) ----- BUT: Child: Parents are supposed to talk nice to their kids! (CM + NOC)	NOTE: Parent: Mommy said you were a brat today. Child: Parents aren't supposed to call their kids names. (PRO)
Parent: (yells) Child: People shouldn't yell when they're inside. (NTA) ----- BUT: Child: People should be quiet when they're inside. (CM + NOC)	NOTE: Dyad: (overhears child tantrumming in another room) Parent: That child is loud. Child: People shouldn't yell when they're inside. (PRO) Child: People should be quiet when they're inside. (PRO)

- d. Phrases of Prosocial Talk commonly used to express disapproval, when they refer to an activity, product, or attribute of the parent, are coded as Negative Talk.

Examples	
Parent: I drew a snake. Child: Ick! (NTA)	Child: It's sticky. Parent: I'm going to wash it. Child: (scowls) Yuck! (NTA)
Parent: It looks like I cluttered up the room. Child: You cluttered up the whole thing. (NTA)	Parent: My picture is ugly. Child: Your picture is ugly. (NTA)
Parent: (fumbles putting Tinker Toys together) I can't do anything right. Child: You can't do it right. (NTA)	Parent: Your father is lazy. Child: He's a lazy pig. (NTA)
Parent: Let's play house. Child: (frowns) No! (NTA)	Parent: It will be fun. Child: Not. (NTA)
Parent: (accidentally knocks over child's block tower). Child: (sarcastically) Cool move. (NTA)	

18. When a child makes a Negative Talk “in role” during pretend play, it is coded Negative Talk.

Examples	
Dyad: (playing with medical kit) Parent: Are you pretending to be the doctor? Child: (in deep voice, “You look very bad today.”) (PT)	Dyad: (playing with farm animals) Child: (bouncing rooster, and speaking in high-pitched voice, “You're selfish to your little boy!”) (PT)

19. Some conditional statements are Negative Talk. A conditional statement can be Negative Talk only when the statement refers to an ongoing behavior of the parent. If the statement refers to a behavior in which the parent is not currently engaged, the statement is not considered a Negative Talk. See Appendix A for general guidelines for coding conditional statements.

- a. If a conditional statement refers to the natural consequences for discontinuing a behavior the parent is doing, just starting to do, or has just done, code Negative Talk not Neutral Talk.

Examples	
Parent: (licking ice cream cone) Child: If you don't stop eating my ice cream, I won't get any. (NTA)	Parent: (coloring on child's drawing) Child: If you don't quit coloring on my paper, it'll get used up. (NTA)

Parent: (ruffling child's hair) Child: If you don't stop, my hair will be messy. (NTA)	
---	--

- b. Any conditional statement that specifies a negative consequence to be applied to the parent by the child is Negative Talk.

Examples	
Parent: (holding child on lap) Child: If you don't let go of me, I'll kick you. (NTA)	Parent: (changing child's Lego creation) Child: If you mess that up, I'm not gonna play with you any more. (NTA)
Parent: (drawing house on paper) Child: Stop drawing houses or I'll rip up your paper. (NTA)	Parent: It's my turn to have the red ones. Child: If you take the red ones, you'll have to go to the time out chair. (NTA)
Parent: I want you to sit down. Child: If you touch me, you'll be sorry. (NTA)	Parent: (picking up the toys) Child: Give me back those men or else! (NTA)
Parent: (raises hand to swat child) Child: If you hit me, I'm gonna tell daddy on you. (NTA)	

- c. If a conditional statement refers to a behavior the parent is doing, is just starting to do, or has just done, and the statement implies a contingent reward from the child for discontinuing the behavior, the statement is coded Negative Talk, not Neutral Talk.

Examples	
Parent: (humming) Child: If you quit making that noise, I'll come back to the table. (NTA)	Parent: Pick up these blocks. Child: If you stop acting so bossy, I'll clean up the whole room. (NTA)

- d. In all conditional statements, when there are elements of more than one DPICS category, the priority order for coding categories is used.

Examples	
Child: If you don't stop jiggling, your super tower will fall down. (NTA)	Child: Stop saying that or I'll cream you. (NTA)

20. A statement that negatively evaluates or finds fault with objects in the environment not owned or created by the parent is not Negative Talk.

Examples	
Dyad: (sitting at play table) Child: This table is wobbly. (PRO)	Dyad: (looking at book) Child: This story is boring. (PRO)
Dyad: (looking at picture on the wall) Child: That picture is ugly. (PRO) ----- BUT: Parent: (draws picture) Child: That picture is ugly. (NTA)	Parent: (holding child's hands away from delicately balanced tower parent built on the table) Child: If you don't let go, I'll kick the table. (NTA)

21. Statements made in a sassy or sarcastic tone of voice are coded Negative Talk.

Examples	
Parent: I didn't draw it quite right. Child: (sarcastic tone) No kidding. (NTA)	Parent: I said pick them up quickly. Child: (sarcastic tone) I heard you. (NTA)

Parent: I guess I'm losing this game. Child: (rude, singsong tone) Na-na-na-na-na. (NTA)	Parent: How bout we clean up now? Child: (sarcastic tone) How bout it. (NTA)
Parent: Want me to show you how that song goes? Child: (sarcastic tone) Spare me. (NTA)	Parent: Put these cars away now. Child: (sarcastic tone) You took them out. (NTA)

22. Sassy content, even without sassy tone, is coded Negative Talk.

Examples	
Parent: (lifting toy box) Will you help me? Child: I'm not your slave. (NTA)	Parent: Come over here. Child: Later alligator. (NTA)
Parent: Big boys don't bang on the table. Child: So what. (NTA)	Parent: Put your shoes back on this instant! Child: What will you give me if I do? (NTA)
Parent: This is a nice picture. Child: Have you lost your brain? (NTA)	Parent: You need to settle down. Child: Why should I? (NTA)
Parent: I want you to get off the table. Child: You can't make me. (NTA)	Parent: I'm the boss. Child: I'm the boss! (NTA)
Child: Mom, I <u>told</u> you to clean up! (NTA)	Child: You have to do whatever I say (NTA)

23. Comments containing swearing or profanity are Negative Talk.

Examples	
Parent: That's a hard puzzle. Child: I can't work this _____ puzzle. (NTA)	Child: (breaks crayon) Child: Oh, _____! (NTA)
Parent: (breaks crayon) Child: Oh, _____! (NTA)	Parent: You can try this crayon. Child: That thing's a useless piece of _____. (NTA)

24. Name calling, by equating the parent, other people, or any thing with a negatively evaluative word, is Negative Talk.

Examples	
Child: You're stupid. (NTA)	Child: You're messy. (NTA)
Parent: Your teacher said you started a fight today. Child: She's a liar. (NTA)	Parent: This room is dirty. Child: This place is a dump. (NTA)
BUT: Child: I did not. (PRO)	BUT: Child: This place is real dirty. (PRO)

25. A counter-command, in which a child tells the parent to perform the action just requested of the child, is Negative Talk.

Examples	
Parent: I wonder if you could find the crayons. Child: Find them yourself. (NTA)	Parent: We need to lay the sticks flat. Child: You do it. (NTA)
	BUT: Parent: Put the red one on next. Child: Put the green one on next. (CM)
NOTE: Counter-commands given to a child by a parent are not Negative Talk unless stated in sarcastic tone.	

26. When a child responds to a parental command with "No" (or an exact synonym), it is coded a Negative Talk regardless of subsequent compliance or other verbalizations by the child.

Examples	
Parent: Set it on the table. Child: No. (2 sec. elapse) (NTA) ----- OR: Child: No, (no pause) I can't lift it. (NTA + PRO) ----- OR: Child: No, you do it. (NTA + NTA) ----- OR: Child: Oh, Man. (NTA)	Parent: Why don't you draw snowflakes with me? Child: No. (2 sec. elapse) (NTA) ----- OR: Child: No. (begins drawing snowflakes) (NTA + CO) ----- BUT: Child: It's too hard. (PRO)
Parent: Look. Child: No. (NTA) ----- OR: Child: Uh-uh. (NTA)	
NOTE: When a <u>parent</u> responds to a child's command by saying "No" (or exact synonym) and for 2 seconds issues no additional verbalization, the "No" is considered a flat refusal and is coded Negative Talk. When "No" is a Negative Talk, it is coded as an individual and separate verbalization. When a parental "No" to a command is followed by another verbalization in less than 2 seconds, the "No" is considered to be qualified by the subsequent verbalization and is coded a Neutral Talk.	

27. Negative talk can occur simultaneously with behaviors in any non-verbalization category (e.g., vocalizations, physical behaviors, responses following questions).

Examples	
Parent: Help me put your coat on. Child: (grabs parent's arm) and says "No." (NTO + NTA)	Parent: This will be a good puzzle. Child: (yells, " That's a @\$% puzzle!" (YE-NTA)
Parent: Show me the A. Child: (whines "No" while touching the A) (WH-NTA + CO)	

28. A statement is considered Negative Talk if it is clear that it is a lie. If the statement is in an attempt to answer a parent's question, and it is not clear whether the child lied or simply did not know the correct answer, then the statement is coded Prosocial Talk

Examples	
Child: (knocks over tower purposely) Parent: "Stop knocking it down!" (NTA) Child: "I didn't touch it! It fell!" (NTA + NTA)	Parent: (holding up red block) "What color is this?" (IQ) Child: "Orange." (PRO)

COMMAND (CM)

Definition

Commands are statements in which the child directs the vocal or motor behavior of the parent.
Commands may be given directly, as an order, or implied, as a suggestion.

Child Command Examples	
Give me a car.	Wait.
Be nice to me.	Look.
Please lift me again.	Buy me one of these for Christmas.
Hey, move over.	You're gonna help me put these away.
Tell me what time we go.	Will you give ... hand me all of them.
Make that crash noise.	Look, look.
You need to listen to me.	Put the queen here and put the king here.
You should give me more paper.	And open it.
I said watch.	Look and see if you have any candy.
Watch out.	Put the cat in the window and let him look out.
Hurry up.	It's okay but draw a bigger one.
Set it here, okay?	Will you wait?
Would you draw on your own paper?	Would you sew my doll when we get home?
Mommies are supposed to be nice.	Mom?
Let's put the tiger together.	It would be fun if you let me ride on your back.
We need to put on his tail.	Dad? (1 sec.) Dad?
Will you tell me what time it is?	Please (1 sec.) please.
I want you to give me the red.	Draw a heart and color it red, okay?
Hey.	Will you get the blocks and build with me?
You could color it purple.	Will you try and help me?
I guess you need to turn it.	We can erase the chalkboard and get all the chalk off.
You can draw big circles.	This is neat, but can we try the other one?
Can you think of what should go here?	If you give me that candy, I'll be good.
Watch out, okay?	If you stop drawing on my paper, I'll do it better.

Decision rules

1. When uncertain whether the verbalization is coded Command or Negative Talk, code Command.
2. When uncertain whether the verbalization is a Command or a lower priority category (e.g., Question, Prosocial Talk), code the lower priority category.

Child CM Guidelines

1. Commands may be declarative statements or stated in question form.

Examples	
Child: Give me the purple crayon. (CM)	Child: Tell me the alphabet. (CM)
Child: Will you give me the purple crayon? (CM)	Child: Would you tell me the alphabet? (CM)
Dyad: (playing with blocks)	Dyad: (playing with toy farm)
Child: Will you make a tower? (CM)	Child: Could you make the pig sound? (CM)
Child: Make a tower, okay? (CM)	Child: Make that pig sound, alright? (CM)
Child: You take the little blocks. (CM)	Child: You take the little blocks, okay? (CM)
Dyad: (coloring)	
Child: Why don't you do it yellow? (CM)	
Child: Do this one yellow, okay? (CM)	

2. **Commands are always worded positively. They tell the parent what to do. Statements that tell the parent what not to do are Negative Talk.**

Examples	
Dyad: (drawing in coloring book)	Child: Read this page again. (CM)
Child: Make that man's hat blue. (CM)	BUT: Child: Stop turning the page. (NTA)
BUT: Child: Don't make his hat red. (NTA)	
Child: Sing that little lamb song. (CM)	Child: Make a train with the blocks. (CM)
BUT: Child: Stop singing that twinkle song. (NTA)	BUT: Child: Quit building that tower. (NTA)

3. **Commands always contain the imperative verb, where the subject of the sentence is an implied "you." A Command may begin with the word "you" or its synonyms, or other words that do not change the meaning of the imperative verb.**

Examples	
Child: Put the girl in the house. (CM)	Child: You do it. (CM)
	OR: Child: Maybe you could do it. (CM)
Child: You need to give me some. (CM)	Child: Mom, give me a car. (CM)
Child: Please help me pick these up. (CM)	Child: Hey, let me put on the roof. (CM)
Child: Okay, use this one. (CM)	

4. **The subject of the sentence in a Command is always a stated or implied "you" or "we." When the sentence does not indicate who is to perform the behavior (i.e., the subject is "it"), the sentence is coded Prosocial Talk.**

Examples	
Dyad: (building a house)	Child: Draw a yellow sun. (CM)
Child: Let's make the house bigger. (CM)	
Dyad: (building a house)	Child: We're gonna draw a yellow sun now. (CM)
Child: Make the house bigger. (CM)	BUT: Child: The sun should be yellow. (PRO)
BUT: Child: It needs to be bigger (PRO)	

5. **The verb phrase in a Command may be modified by words that imply that compliance is a necessity (such as "must," "should," "have to," "got to," "need to", and "ought to") or words that suggest compliance is optional (such as might, may, could, can, and their synonyms).**

Examples	
Child: You must close your eyes. (CM)	Child: You need to push it hard. (CM)
Child: You ought to use the new pieces. (CM)	Child: You should take the red ones. (CM)
Child: We should tell dad what we made. (CM)	Child: You gotta cross the two sticks. (CM)
Child: We need to draw the grass here. (CM)	Child: You have to start here. (CM)
Child: You could put the chimney here. (CM)	Child: You could probably move it. (CM)
Child: Maybe you'll let me have the green. (CM)	

6. **Commands may be preceded by phrases such as “I said,” “I know,” “I’m sure,” “I think,” or “I guess” and their synonyms.**

Examples	
Child: Give me my quarter. (CM) Parent: (does nothing) Child: I said give me my quarter. (CM)	Child: You need to take another turn. (CM) Parent: I can't remember the rule. Child: I know you have to take another turn. (CM)
Child: Write your name in the box. (CM) Parent: It doesn't fit. Child: I guess you can write your name anywhere. (CM)	Child: Draw the boat. (CM) Parent: (does nothing) Child: I think you should draw the boat. (CM)

7. **Verb phrases calling for unobservable internal behaviors, when stated in imperative or question form, are coded Commands (see also Parent Response to Commands [In supplemental categories, detailed in Appendix B]).**

Examples	
Child: Let me see if I can find it. (CM)	Child: Wait a minute. (CM)
Child: Look. (CM)	Child: Let me do it. (CM)
Child: Remember you're the green man. (CM)	Child: Come on. (i.e., Hurry up; “Come” not meant literally) (CM)
Child: Would you watch out? (CM)	Child: Will you let me Do it? (CM)
Child: Remember this, okay? (CM)	Child: Why don't you wait till I say ready? (CM)
Child: Listen to me. (CM)	Child: Hurry up. (CM)
Child: See if it's in the cupboard. (CM)	

8. **Commands include commands for behavior to occur in the future (> 5 seconds). (Note: see Parent No Opportunity for Compliance [In supplemental categories, detailed in Appendix B]).**

Examples	
Parent: (playing with stuffed animals) Child: You need to sew Sylvester when we get home. (CM)	Parent: They don't have very many Lincoln Logs. Child: Bring my Lincoln Logs next time. (CM)
Child: You can fix my bike when we get home. (CM/NOC)	Child: After I put her pajamas on you can put her in bed. (CM/NOC)
Child: Will you buy some cookies when we're at the store? (CM/NOC)	Dyad: (drawing picture) Child: When I finish my boat, you need to draw the water. (CM)

9. **The same single word command repeated without a 2 second pause is coded as one Command.**

Examples
Child: Wait, wait, wait. (CM)
Child: Look, look, look. (CM)
BUT: Child: Look. (2 sec.) Look. (CM +CM)
Child: Wait, wait. (2 sec.) Look. (CM +CM)
Child: Wait, see, look. (CM+CM +CM)

- 10. Statements beginning with “You are going to...” are coded as Commands when they contain a specific suggestion for a vocal or motor behavior to be performed by the parent and the behavior has not already been initiated by the parent.**

Examples	
Parent: (stacking blocks into high tower) Child: You're going to pick them up if they fall. (CM)	Parent: What can I do? Child: You're going to push the trucks up after I hook up the ramp. (CM)
BUT: Child: You're going to make it high. (PRO)	BUT: Parent: (Pushing the trucks up a ramp on the garage) Child: You're going to push up the trucks while I find the cars. (PRO)

- 11. When the parent asks for permission or guidance, the child's response is a Command only when it contains a verb phrase indicating a verbal or motor behavior to be performed by the parent.**

Examples	
Parent: Can I use the green sticks? Child: Use the green sticks. (CM)	Parent: Who do you want to sit in the wagon? Child: Put the dog in the wagon. (CM)
BUT: Child: Yes. (PRO) Child: That's okay. (PRO)	BUT: Child: The dog. (PRO) Child: Any of the animals. (PRO) Child: How about the dog? (QU)
Parent: Is it okay to put my animals in your barn? Child: Put them in the yard. (CM)	Parent: Can I be the duck? Child: Yes, you need to say 'quack quack'. (PRO + CM)
BUT: Child: Only in the loft. (PRO)	BUT: Child: Yes, you can be the duck. (PRO + PRO)

- 12. If two or more complete commands are joined by “and” or “but” in a single sentence, the “and” or “but” function as a period and each command is usually coded independently.**

Examples	
Child: Put the oval here and put the triangle here. (CM + CM)	Child: Give me the little ones but give me the big ones too. (CM + CM)
Child: Will you hand me a red one but can you sharpen it first? (CM + CM)	Child: Put her ear on and would you give her an earring too? (CM + CM)
Child: Put on her hat and put on her high heels, okay? (CM + CM)	Child: Draw your picture here but why don't you help me draw mine first. (CM + CM)

- 13. In sentences containing two or more verb phrases in Command form that are joined by “and,” where one verb phrase does not contain independent meaning, only one command is coded.**

Examples	
Child: Try and lift this box. (CM)	Child: Take and put the chalk on the table. (CM)
Child: Would you look and see if it's in your purse? (CM)	Child: How 'bout you take and put on her glasses? (CM)
Child: Could you try and do it fast? (CM)	Child: Will you try and make him eat? (CM)
Child: Check and see where the horse is. (CM)	Child: Look and see if it's under the table. (CM)

- 14. In sentences that contain two or more verb phrases in Command form joined by “and,” but the verb phrases refer to a single parent behavior, both verb phrases are coded Command. (Note: see Parent Response to Command Guidelines [In supplemental categories, detailed in Appendix B]).**

Examples	
Child: Take my dolly and hold her. (CM+CM)	
Child: Use this color and make it red. (CM+CM)	
Child: Take the cover off his cage and let him look out. (CM+CM)	
Child: How bout if we stack these papers and make them neat. (CM+CM)	
Child: We could draw an apple and use the red. (CM+CM)	
Child: You might give it to me and let me hold it. (CM+CM)	

- 15. In sentences containing two or more verb phrases in Command form that are joined by “and,” if the sentence begins with a phrase that changes the meaning of the first “Direct Command” to another verbalization category (e.g., Question, Prosocial Talk), it also changes the meaning of the second “command” unless there is a clear inflection and pause indicating that the “and” starts a new sentence.**

Examples	
Child: Do you want to turn the crank and unload the hay? Coded as: Do you want to turn the crank (QU) AND (Do you want to) unload the hay? (QU)	Child: Now it's our turn to sit and draw. Coded as: Now it's our time to sit (PRO) AND (it's our time to) draw. (PRO)
Child: You promised to play checkers and let me win. Coded as: You promised to play checkers (PRO) AND (You promised to) let me win. (PRO)	Child: Will you get the gum and unwrap it? Coded as: Will you get the gum? (CM) AND (Will you) unwrap it. (CM) ----- BUT: Child: Will you get the candy? (gets candy) And unwrap it. (CM + CM)
Child: Do you want to turn the handle and bring down the hay? Coded as: Do you want to turn the handle (QU) AND (Do you want to) bring down the hay? (QU) ----- BUT: Child: Do you want to turn the handle? (pause) And bring down the hay. (QU + CM)	Child: Would you open the can and get out the sticks? Coded as: Would you open the can? (CM) AND (Would you) get out the sticks. (CM)
Child: Would you open the cupboard and get the crayons? Coded as: Would you open the cupboard? (CM) AND (Would you) get the crayons? (CM) ----- BUT: Child: Would you open the cupboard? (looks to see what to play with) And get the crayons. (CM+CM)	

16. When a Command is joined to another complete verbalization by “and” or “but,” both the command and the other verbalization category are coded.

Examples	
Parent: Look at my picture. Child: You made a neat picture, but you need to make stars on it. (PRO+CM)	
Parent: What should I draw? Child: Draw a heart and draw an arrow in it. (CM+CM)	
Parent: This is yours. Child: It's mine, but can I use yours? (RF+CM)	
Dyad: (playing school) Child: (talking for self) You can give me the chalk, (talking for teacher) and you take a piece too. (CM+NO CODE)	
Parent: I drew this car for you. Child: You drew a super car, but will you draw a bigger one for me? (PRO+CM)	
Parent: This is yours. Child: Okay, but can I have yours too? (PRO+CM)	
Parent: I made this snake for you. Child: I like it and you could make another one. (PRO+CM)	
Parent: Is this tower okay? Child: It's sort of wobbly and you might need to straighten it. (PRO+CM)	
Parent: The baby's sleeping. Child: You're rocking the baby, but let me do it. (PRO+CM)	
Parent: What do you want to do? Child: Draw a heart and let's make valentines. (CM+CM)	
Parent: Where should I put this? Child: Put it here, but what's this part? (CM+QU)	
Parent: How does this work? Child: Put the round one on top and don't knock it down. (CM+NTA)	
Parent: Here's the cow. Child: This is the cow, but give me the goat. (PRO+CM)	
Parent: What do you want to play with? Child: Give me the car, but isn't the wheel gone? (CM+QU)	
Parent: Here's the goat. Child: Yeah, and give me the lamb. (PRO+CM)	

17. Commands by the child that contain phrases threatening or implying negative consequences for not obeying the command are coded Negative Talk, not Command.

Examples	
Child: Give me the car. (CM) BUT: Child: Give me the car or else! (NTA)	Child: Let me have two. (CM) BUT: Parent: Let me have two or I'll kick you. (NTA)
Child: Put this together. (CM) BUT: Child: Put this together or you'll have to go to the time out chair. (NTA)	

18. Commands suggest a specific vocal or motor response to be performed by the parent, whereas Questions request no more than a verbal Neutral Talk.

Examples	
Dyad: (coloring picture) Child: How about if I make this part blue? (QU) BUT: Child: How about if you make this part blue? (CM)	Parent: (reaching for orange sticks) Child: You want the orange ones, huh? (QU) BUT: Child: (puts orange Tinker Toy sticks in front of parent) Child: Why don't you use the orange ones? (CM)
Parent: (puts animals in toy barn) Child: Is there a horse in here? (QU) BUT: Child: Can you put the tractor in there too? (CM)	Dyad: (playing with cars) Child: Will you need this car? (QU) BUT: Child: Will you give me the car? (CM)

19. A positively-worded statement that describes a rule about appropriate behavior in general, but does not imply that the parent's ongoing or just-completed behavior should be performed differently in the future, is coded Prosocial Talk, not Command.

Examples	
Child: (jumps on the table) Parent: What is the rule? Child: Mommies are supposed to say nice things in the play room. (PRO) BUT: Parent: You are a bad boy. Child: Mommies are supposed to say nice things in the play room. (CM)	Parent: What did your teacher say about wearing jeans on the last day? Child: Parents are supposed to let the children choose. (PRO) BUT: Parent: I'll take the red and you take the black. Child: Parents are supposed to let the children choose. (CM)
Parent: What are the rules in this game? Child: People are supposed to take turns in this game. (PRO) BUT: Parent: (parent moves child's piece in a board game) Child: People are supposed to take turns. (CM)	

20. When the subject of a command is not "you" or "we" or its synonyms, the sentence is coded Prosocial Talk.

Examples	
Dyad: (cutting out paper snowflakes) Child: You could pick up these scraps. (CM) BUT: Child: I should pick up these scraps. (PRO) Child: Someone should pick up these scraps. (PRO)	Parent: We used all short sticks. Child: Let's use the long ones! (CM) BUT: Child: The long sticks will work. (PRO)
Parent: Barbie looks ready to go to church. Child: We should put on her raincoat. (CM) BUT: Child: She needs a coat. (PRO)	

21. If a child repeats a parent's command to engage in a joint activity, it is a Command rather than Prosocial Talk.

Examples	
Parent: Let's try to draw a television. Child: Let's try it. (CM) ----- BUT: Child: You think we should try a television! (PRO)	Parent: We should put wheels on it. Child: Okay, we can put wheels on it. (CM) ----- BUT: Child: Oh, you want wheels on it. (PRO)

22. Many child verbalizations implicitly call for a parent response; however, Command is coded only when the child's verbalization contains an imperative verb phrase calling for a verbal or motor behavior to be performed by the parent.

- a. Commands in question form may be distinguished from Questions by the presence of an action verb phrase.

Examples	
Dyad: (looking at local map) Child: Will you show me where our house is? (CM) ----- BUT: Child: Where is our house? (QU)	Parent: (finishing a fairy tale) Child: Would you read the end again? (CM) ----- BUT: Child: What happened at the end? (QU)
Dyad: (playing with toy farm) Child: I want you to talk like a cow, okay? (CM) ----- BUT: Child: What kind of sound does a cow make? (QU)	

- b. Commands in declarative form may be distinguished from Prosocial Talk by the presence of an action verb phrase.

Examples	
Parent: (teasing child, puts doll's hat on the cat) Child: You should put the hat on the man! (CM) ----- BUT: Child: The hat goes on the man! (PRO)	Dyad: (building with Tinker Toys) Parent: (gives child some pieces) Child: I want you to give me the long ones. (CM) ----- BUT: Child: I want the long ones. (PRO)
Dyad: (building a house) Child: We need to put the chimney on. (CM) ----- BUT: Child: We need the chimney on. (PRO)	

23. A child's statement of feeling, expectation, or preference is a Command when it clearly calls for the parent to complete an action.

Examples	
Child: I want you to put it this way. (CM) ----- BUT: Child: I want it that way. (PRO)	Child: I'd like you to bring Sara next time. (CM) ----- BUT: Child: I'd like to bring Sara next time. (PRO)
Child: It would be fun if you'd jump rope with me. (CM) ----- BUT: Child: It would be fun if I could jump rope. (PRO)	

- 24. A statement beginning with “You can...”, “You might...”, “You could...” or “You may...” is a Command if the statement is granting an immediately preceding request by the parent OR if the parent is not already engaged in the behavior.**

Examples	
Parent: (making long train track) Child: You could make it shorter. (CM) Child: You need to make it shorter. (CM)	Parent: (putting small block on top) Child: What about if you put the big one on top. (CM) Child: You should put the big one on top. (CM)
Parent: I drew a robin. Child: You can put a worm in his mouth. (CM) Child: You have to draw a nest for her. (CM)	Parent: We'll ask her later. Child: Could we ask now? (CM) Child: Ask now. (CM)
Parent: You're taking the trucks, I see. Child: You can take all the cars. (CM) ----- BUT: Parent: Can I have the cars? Child: You can take all the cars. (PRO)	Parent: (drives car very slowly down ramp) Child: You could do it fast now. (CM) ----- BUT: Parent: (runs car very fast across table) Child: You could do it fast! (PRO)

- 25. Sentences beginning with “Can you...” are coded as Commands regardless of other possible intended meanings because of difficulty distinguishing among meanings in most cases.**

Examples	
Dyad: (making paper airplanes) Child: Can you give me more paper? (CM)	Dyad: (putting puzzle piece together) Child: Can you put this piece in? (CM)
Parent: I want to use the clay. Child: Can you find it? (CM)	Parent: (trying to get game off high shelf) Child: Can you reach it? (CM)
Parent: Registration for space camp is over. Child: Can you sign me up anyway? (CM)	Parent: This piece is tough. Child: Can you see where it goes? (CM)

- 26. The parent's name or synonyms for it, whether in statement or question form, serve as “bid for attention” words (words that indirectly serve to communicate “pay attention” or “listen to me”). When a child uses a “bid for attention” word as the introductory or concluding word of a verbalization (separated by < 2 sec.) it is not coded separately. When a “bid for attention” word is separated from another child verbalization by 2 seconds or longer, or by an intervening parent verbalization, it is coded separately as a Command (see Parent No Opportunity for Compliance in the Supplemental Categories listed in Appendix B for more information).**

Examples	
Child: Mom. (CM) ----- BUT: Child: Mom (2 sec.) Hand me the crayon. (CM + CM) ----- BUT: Child: Mom, hand me the crayon. (CM)	Child: Dad? (CM) ----- BUT: Child: Dad? (1 sec. pause) let's build a helicopter. (CM) ----- BUT: Child: Dad? (2 sec.) Let's build a helicopter. (CM + CM)
Child: Hey you. (CM) ----- BUT: Child: Hey you, (no pause) which car can I play with? (QU) BUT: Child: Which car can I play with? (2 sec.) Hey you! (QU + CM)	Child: You hoo. (CM) ----- BUT: Child: You hoo (no pause) watch out. (CM) BUT: Child: You hoo. (parent says “What?”) Watch out. (CM + CM)
NOTE: The word “please” is often used as a bid for attention word.	

27. When “bid for attention” words occur in a series without a 2 sec. pause between them, they are coded as one Command.

Examples	
Child:	Hey, (no pause) hey. (CM)
Child:	Hey, Mom. (CM)
Child:	Please, please, please. (CM)
BUT:	Child: Dad. (2 sec.) Dad. (CM + CM)
	Child: Hey (no pause) Mom (no pause), that's mine. (PRO)

28. Some conditional statements and questions are Commands.

- a. If a conditional statement refers to an ongoing behavior of the parent or to behavior the parent may initiate in the future, and specifies contingent good behavior or a reward from the child for continuing or initiating it, the statement is a Command.

Examples	
Child: If you get out the blocks I'll play with you. (CM)	Child: I'll be good as long as you keep drawing with me. (CM)
Child: I'll give you this picture if you get me some more paper. (CM)	Child: Can you give me the chalk if I promise not to get it on my dress? (CM)

- b. If a conditional statement refers to an ongoing behavior of the parent and specifies a contingent reward from the child for stopping the behavior, the statement is coded Negative Talk, not Command.

Examples	
Child: If you quit holding me, I promise to sit still. (NTA)	Child: Will you stop drawing on my picture if I put the sun in myself? (NTA)
Child: If you stop bossing me, I'll do it better. (NTA)	

- c. Any conditional statement that specifies a negative consequence to be applied to the parent by the child is Negative Talk.

Examples	
Child: If you don't start coloring, I'll scribble on your page. (NTA)	Child: If you don't start coloring like I asked, you'll have to sit in the timeout chair. (NTA)
Child: If you touch my tower I'll hit you. (NTA)	Child: I'll spit if you don't let go. (NTA)

- d. In all conditional statements, if the child's statement regarding the parent's behavior contains elements of more than one DPICS category, the priority order for coding categories is used.

Examples	
Child: If you clean up this time, I'll do it next time. (CM)	Child: If you give me that horse you made, I'll make a picture for you. (CM)
BUT: Child: If you clean up your big mess over there, I'll pick up these blocks. (NTA)	BUT: Child: If you give me that neat horse you made, I'll make a picture for you. (PRO)

RESPONSES TO COMMANDS

After a member of the dyad issues a command, the other member has five seconds to respond. There are three categories describing responses to commands: **Compliance (CO)**, **Noncompliance (NC)**, and **No Opportunity for Compliance (NOC)**. Compliance is coded when the command is obeyed or beginning to be obeyed within the 5-second interval. Noncompliance is coded when the command is not obeyed or attempted within 5-seconds or when a behavior incompatible with the command is performed. No Opportunity for Compliance is coded when an adequate chance to comply has not been given.

Note: Parent Responses to Commands are included in the supplemental coding system described in Appendix B.

GENERAL CHILD RESPONSE TO COMMANDS GUIDELINES

1. When a command is followed within 5 seconds by a command that is automatically coded No Opportunity for Compliance (e.g., bid for attention commands, vague commands, commands for internal, unobservable behavior), the second command does not interrupt the 5-second compliance interval of the original command.

Examples	
Parent: Put your coat on. Child: (picks up coat) Parent: Hurry up! (DC/NOC) Child: (puts arm in coat sleeve as 5 sec. elapse) (DC/CO)	Parent: You might use the big ones first. Child: (searches through Lincoln Logs) Parent: Look here. (points to big ones) (DC/NOC) Child: (picks up big Lincoln logs) (IC/CO)
Parent: Hand me the pink car, okay? Parent: (after 2 sec.) Honey? (IC/NOC) Child: (hands pink car) (IC/CO)	Parent: Put the cars away. Parent: (waits 3 sec.) Come on! (DC/NOC) Child: (puts one car away) (DC/CO)
Parent: Put the blocks in the box. Hurry up. Child: (puts blocks in box) (DC/CO + DC/NOC)	Parent: Hand me the doll, alright? (3 sec.) Susie? Child: (hands doll to parent) (IC/CO + IC/NOC)
Parent: Put your coat on. Child: (picks up coat) Parent: Go ahead. (DC/NOC) Child: (puts arm in sleeve as 5 sec. elapse) (DC/CO)	Parent: Let's clean up. Child: (continues pushing car) Parent: (waits 2 sec.) Susie! (IC/NOC) Child: (puts car in toy box before the 5 sec. elapse) (IC/CO)
Parent: Will you get out from under the table? Child: (after 2 sec., no response) Parent: Honey? (IC/NOC) Child: (crawls out from under table 4 sec. after first command) (IC/CO)	Parent: You might use the big ones first. Child: (searches through Lincoln logs for 4 sec.) Parent: Look here. (points to big ones) (DC/NOC) Child: (picks up big Lincoln logs after 6 sec.) (IC/NC)
Parent: Put the blocks in their container. (DC) Parent: (waits 3 sec.) Please. (IC/NOC) Child: (Starts to put blocks in container) (CO) BUT: Parent: Put the blocks in their container (DC) Child: (throws blocks in container) (CO) Parent: (waits 3 sec.) Gently (TA) Child: (puts blocks in quietly) (No code) BUT: Parent: Put the blocks in their container (DC) Parent: (waits 3 seconds). Johnny! (IC/NOC) Child: (continues to dawdle for 2 more seconds) (NC)	

2. Within the 5-second interval following a command, if a parent issues a second command before the child has completed the first and the second command is not automatically coded No Opportunity for Compliance, the second command is coded for compliance and the first command is coded No Opportunity for Compliance.

Examples	
Parent: Give me the Bullwinkle hat. Child: What? Parent: (1 sec.) Give me that hat. (DC/NOC + DC)	Parent: Put this smile in the puzzle. Child: Where does it go? Parent: (1 sec.) Put it here. (DC/NOC + DC)
Parent: Put it here. (no pause) Put it here. (DC/NOC + DC)	Parent: Put it here. (no pause) Put it here. (DC/NOC + DC)
Parent: Put the book away now. Child: Can I finish this story first? Parent: (1 sec.) No, put it away. (DC/NOC + TA + DC)	Parent: Hand me a round one. Child: (reaches for round one) Parent: I want you to give me a square instead. (DC/NOC + IC)
Parent: Color the sun yellow. Child: (continues to draw a black bat 4 sec.) Parent: Draw yellow rays on it, too. (DC/NOC + DC)	Parent: Put it here. Put it here. Child: (puts log where parent indicated) (DC/NOC + DC/CO)
Parent: Pick the farm animals up off the floor. Child: (after 3 sec. no response) Parent: Did you hear me? (DQ) Child: (ignores parent) (NC)	Parent: Color the sun yellow. Child: (continues to color the grass green 2 sec.) Parent: Draw a horse, too. (DC/NOC + DC)
Parent: Will you hand me some more little ones? Child: (searches for little pieces) Parent: (after 3 sec.) No, give me the long one instead. Child: (gives long one) (IC/NOC + DC/CO)	Parent: Why don't you sit down? Child: (hesitates for 2 sec.) Parent: (pats chair seat next to parent) By me. (TA) Child: (5 sec. after command, still standing) (NC)
Parent: Comb your hair. Child: (doesn't comb hair) Parent: (waits 4 sec.) I said comb your hair. (DC/NOC + DC)	Parent: Comb your hair. Child: (doesn't comb hair) Parent: (waits 4 sec.) Comb your hair. (DC/NOC + DC)
Parent: How about cleaning up now? Child: (no response for 1 sec.) Parent: Pick up all the crayons and put them in the box. (IC/NOC + DC + DC)	Parent: Give me the airplane. Child: What? Parent: (1 sec.) Give me the airplane. (DC/NOC + DC)
Parent: Put the container away. Child: (picks up container) Where do you want it? Parent: (1 sec.) Put it in the toy box. (DC/NOC + DC)	Parent: Put the book away now. Child: Can I finish this story first? Parent: (1 sec.) No, put it away. (DC/NOC + TA + DC)
Parent: Hand me Ernie. Child: (reaches for figure) Parent: Give me Big Bird instead. (DC/NOC + DC)	Parent: Put the doll on the shelf. Child: (continues playing 3 sec.) Parent: Put the trucks in the toy box. (DC/NOC + DC)
Parent: Sit down here. Child: (remains standing 4 sec.) Parent: Color this picture. (DC/NOC + DC)	

3. When one sentence contains a series of commands joined by “and” or “but,” each command and its response are coded separately. The timing of the 5-second interval begins after the entire sentence has been completed.

- a. When the series of commands in the sentence are not sequential (i.e., commands can be completed in any order), the commands may have opportunity for compliance or noncompliance. Any command that could not be started within the 5-second interval because the child is still completing another command is coded as No Opportunity for Compliance.

Examples	
Parent: Sit down and take off your coat. Child: (runs around room evading parent) (NC + NC) Child: (takes off coat) (CO), (walks around room as 5 sec. elapse) (NC) Child: (sits down) (CO), (draws as 5 sec. elapse) (NC)	Parent: Pick the toys up off the floor and put them on the table. Child: (picks up one toy at a time, setting each on the table) (CO + CO)
Parent: Put the red buttons in the blue box and the blue buttons in the red box. Child: (puts one red button in the blue box and one blue button in the red box) (CO + CO)	OR: Child: (collects all toys into a pile begins to put them all on the table as the 5 sec. elapse) (CO + CO)
OR: Child: (carefully putting each red button in the blue box when the 5 sec. elapse) (CO + NOC)	BUT: Child: (collects all toys into a pile; 5 sec. elapse before child begins to put them on the table) (CO + NOC)
OR: Child: (putting all the blue and red buttons in the blue box) (CO + NC)	
Parent: Sit down and take off your coat. Child: (struggles to remove coat for 5 sec.) (DC/CO) (command to “Sit down” is coded NOC)	Parent: Put the blocks on the table and make a tower. Child: (puts all the blocks on the table; 5 sec. elapse before child begins to make a tower) (DC/CO + DC/NOC)
	BUT: Child: (puts one block at a time on the table, putting the second on top of the first as the 5 sec. elapse) (DC/CO + DC/CO) Child: (puts the blocks on the table and starts a tower as the 5 sec. elapse) (DC/CO + DC/CO)
Parent: Draw a circle on mine and draw a square on yours. Child: (draws a square on parent's and a circle on his) (CO + CO)	Parent: Sit down and take off your coat. Child: (takes off coat and sits down) (CO + CO)

- b. When the series of commands in the sentence “should be” completed in a specific order, the child’s compliance to any command, regardless of the order it “should be” completed in, is still coded as Compliance. Any command that cannot be begun within the 5-second interval because the child is still completing another command is coded No Opportunity for Compliance.

Examples	
Parent: Take the yellow crayon and draw a sun. Child: (picks up yellow crayon) (CO), (draws sun) (CO) ----- OR: Child: (draws sun with the red crayon she had been holding) (CO), (picks up yellow crayon) (CO) ----- BUT: Child: (draws a sun with the red crayon she had been holding as 5 sec. elapse) (CO), (doesn't take the yellow crayon) (NOC)	Parent: Get a Kleenex and wipe your nose. Child: (gets Kleenex) (CO), (uses it to wipe nose) (CO) ----- Child: (wipes nose on sleeve) (CO), (walks toward Kleenex box as 5 sec. elapse) (CO) ----- BUT: Child: (wipes nose on sleeve as 5 sec. elapse) (CO), (doesn't get Kleenex) (NOC) Child: (gets Kleenex as 5 sec. elapse) (CO), (NOC for wiping nose) Child: (gets Kleenex) (CO), (doesn't wipe nose as 5 sec. elapse) (NC)
Parent: Put on your coat and zip it up. Child: (struggles to zip coat without putting it on as 5 sec. elapse) (DC/CO + DC/NOC for putting coat on)	Parent: Put the brushes in the cabinet, but first dry them. Child: (starts putting wet brushes in cabinet as 5 sec. elapse) (DC/CO + DC/NOC for drying the brushes)
Child: (knocks over chair) Parent: Pick up the chair and sit down. Child: (sits down on floor as 5 sec. elapse) (DC/CO + DC/NOC for picking up chair)	Parent: Get a Kleenex and wipe your nose. Child: (wipes nose on sleeve as 5 sec. elapse) (DC/CO + DC/NOC for command to get Kleenex) ----- OR: Child: (gets Kleenex as 5 sec. elapse) (DC/CO + DC/NOC for wiping nose) ----- BUT: Child: (wipes nose on sleeve and walks toward Kleenex box as 5 sec. elapse) (DC/CO + DC/CO)
Parent: Clear off a space on the table, but first shut the door. Child: (clears table until 5 sec. elapse) (NOC + CO)	Parent: Take the tractor and drive to the barn. Child: (drives to barn with truck) (see 8b)
Parent: Put the toys in their containers and put the containers in the toy box. Child: (puts containers in toy box and draws on chalkboard) (CO + NC)	Parent: Take the red and draw a heart. Child: (takes the red crayon and scribbles on paper) (CO + NC) ----- BUT: Child: (draws a heart in green and then takes the red crayon) (CO + CO)

- c. When the series of commands in the sentence are sequential (i.e., they physically cannot be completed out of order), the commands that cannot be begun within 5 seconds following the end of the sentence are coded No Opportunity for Compliance.

Examples	
Parent: Open the crayon box and hand me the purple one. Child: (opens box) (CO), (gives parent purple crayon) (CO)	
OR: Child: (opens box) (CO), (searches for purple crayon as 5 sec. elapse) (CO)	
BUT: Child: (opens box) (CO), (draws with purple crayon) (NC)	
Parent: Find Mr. Potato Head's nose and put it on him. Child: (searches for nose for 5 sec.) (DC/CO + DC/NOC for command to put nose on)	
BUT: Child: (finds nose and is putting it on as 5 sec. elapse) (DC/CO + DC/CO) Child: (picks up nose and continues to look at pieces as 5 sec. elapse) (DC/CO + DC/NC)	
Parent: Open the crayon box and hand me the purple one. Child: (opens box as 5 sec. elapse) (DC/CO + DC/NOC for handing parent crayon)	
BUT: Child: (opens box and searches for purple crayon as 5 sec. elapse) (DC/CO + DC/CO) Child: (opens box and draws with purple crayon as 5 sec. elapse) (DC/CO + DC/NC)	
Parent: Open the cabinet and take out the blocks. Child: (does not open cabinet for 5 sec.) (NC + NOC)	Child: (drops Mr. Potato Head's hat) Parent: Pick up his hat and put it on his head. Child: (doesn't pick up hat) (NC + NOC)

4. If a parent command is followed by a parent verbalization that is not a command, the verbalization is coded but does not interrupt the 5-second response interval of the original command provided that the verbalization does not serve to cancel the original command. Note. Parent verbalizations occurring less than 5-seconds after a command that serve to cancel the command or interrupt compliance are coded the appropriate verbalization category and the original command is coded No Opportunity for Compliance.

Examples	
Dyad: (playing racecars) Parent: On your mark. (TA) Child: (places car at start line) (No code) Parent: Get set. (DC/NOC) Child: (waits) Parent: Go! (DC) Child: (pushes car) (CO)	Parent: You can put it in the corner. Child: (hesitates for 2 sec.) Parent: (points) Right there. (TA) Child: (puts puzzle where parent pointed) (CO) BUT: Parent: Turn the handle. Child: (reaches for handle) Parent: Let me try it first. (DC/NOC + DC/NOC)
Parent: Pick the farm animals up off the floor. Child: (after 3 sec. no response) Parent: Did you hear me? (DQ) Child: (at 4 sec. begins picking up animals) (CO)	Parent: (drawing Christmas tree) Parent: Why don't you put a star on top? Child: Okay. (PRO) Parent: But first I need to finish putting these ornaments on the branches. (DC/NOC + TA)
Parent: Put the big box on top. Oh, let me do it. (DC/NOC + DC/NOC)	Parent: Put the red one on top. I mean put the blue one on top. (DC/NOC + DC)
Parent: Draw a star on top. Actually, do you want to make more ornaments on our Christmas tree first? (DC/NOC + DQ)	

5. When a command appears to be outside the child's competence or ability, code **No Opportunity for Compliance** rather than **Noncompliance** if the child does not attempt to obey. Code **Compliance** if the child attempts to obey the command. If child is out of sight or it is otherwise unclear if the child complied, code **Compliance** if the parent praises the child for complying or **Noncompliance** if the parent gives a time-out warning ("If you don't do . . ., you'll have to go to the time-out chair").

Examples	
Parent: Put the canister on the top shelf. (shelf is too high to reach) Child: (stretches to try to put it on the shelf) (CO) ----- BUT: Child: I can't reach it. (does not try) (PRO + NOC)	Dyad: (looking at picture of wild animals in book) Parent: Point to the orangutan. Child: (points to any animal) (CO) ----- BUT: Child: (does nothing) (NOC)
Parent: (says to 2-year-old) Find the chartreuse crayon. Child: (goes to crayon box and looks inside) (CO) ----- BUT: Child: (continues coloring) (NOC)	Parent: Hand me the red Lego block (DC) Child: (can't see child) Parent: Thank you for minding me and handing me the red block Child: (CO)
Parent: Put the canister on the top shelf. (shelf is too high for child to reach) Child: I can't reach it. (doesn't) (DC/NOC) BUT: Child: (stretches to try to put it on the shelf) (DC/CO)	Parent: Hand me the chartreuse crayon. Child: (doesn't attempt) What is chartreuse? (NOC) ----- BUT: Child: (picks up a crayon and says, "is this chartreuse?") (CO) Child: (goes to crayon box and looks inside) (DC/CO)
Parent: Please hand me the car. Child: (cannot see child) Parent: (after 5 sec.) If you do not hand me the car, you will have to go to time-out. (Code NC)	Parent: Please put the car in the container (DC) Child: (view blocked). Parent: Thank you. Child: (CO)

COMPLIANCE (CO)

Definition

Child compliance occurs when the child performs, begins to perform, or attempts to perform a behavior requested by the parent within the 5-second interval following the command.

Note: Parent Compliance is included in the supplemental coding system found in Appendix B.

Child Compliance Examples	
Parent: Will you hand me the purple one? Child: (after 2 sec. hands parent purple block)	Parent: Will you please close the door? Child: No! (deliberately slams door)
Parent: Pick up all the toys. Child: (picks up one toy as 5 sec. elapse)	Parent: Can you fix the roof on the fort? Child: I don't know how. (begins working on roof)
Parent: Put all the blue ones in a pile. Child: (after 2 sec. child begins to put blue blocks in a pile and continues until 5 sec. elapse)	Parent: Draw a straight line. Child: (carefully draws line)

Decision rules

1. When uncertain whether the child complied, noncomplied, or has had no opportunity to comply, code no opportunity.
2. When uncertain whether the child has complied or noncomplied, code compliance.

Child CO Guidelines

1. **When a child complies to the command by completing the requested behavior, compliance is immediately coded and the 5-second interval stops.**

Examples	
Parent: Put the King on his throne. Child: (no pause) (puts king doll on throne) (CO)	Parent: Why don't you use the red crayon? Child: (1 sec.) (draws with red crayon) (CO)
Parent: Tell me what time it is. Child: (3 sec.) It's 4:00. (CO + PRO)	

2. **If the child has begun but not completed the requested behavior within the 5-second interval, the child must be continuing to attempt to obey and not have begun a behavior incompatible with compliance during the remainder of the 5-second interval for compliance to be coded.**

Examples	
Parent: Bring me the red sticks, okay? Child: (has brought half of the red sticks to the parent when 5 sec. elapse) (CO)	Parent: Sing the Bumble Bee song. Child: (4 sec.) (sings, "Buzz, buzz, little bee...") (CO)
Parent: Draw a tree. Child: (drawing outline of tree until 5 sec. elapse) (CO)	Parent: Will you find the cars? Child: (at 4 sec. heads toward toy box) (CO) BUT: Parent: Hand me the puppet. Child: (picks up puppet and puts it under the table.) (NC)

3. **Compliance is coded if the child obeys or attempts to obey the command regardless of accompanying inappropriate behavior.**

Examples	
Parent: Give me the marbles. Child: (whines, "No fair," but hands parent the marbles) (WH-PRO + CO)	Parent: Take it apart first. Child: Shut up. (begins to take Legos apart) (CO + NTA)
Parent: Straighten up the blocks, okay? Child: Don't boss me. (begins to straighten blocks) (CO + NTA)	

- 4. If the child indicates verbal unwillingness to comply, but obeys the command within 5-second interval, code compliance.**

Examples	
Parent: You can draw a rainbow. Child: I want to play with the farm. (colors on page) (CO + PRO)	Parent: Put the toys away now. Child: I don't want to. (puts blocks in box) (CO + PRO)
Parent: Sit on the chair, will you please? Child: Can't I sit on the floor? (3 sec.) (sits on chair) (CO + QU)	Parent: Give me the doll in the blue dress. Child: She's the one <u>I</u> want. (gives doll to parent) (CO + PRO)

- 5. If the child performs the commanded action, the quality of the response is not considered unless it is unquestionably incompatible with the command.**

Examples	
Parent: Draw neatly. Child: (draws) (CO) ----- BUT: Parent: Draw neatly. Child: (scribbles wildly) (NC)	Parent: Set it down gently. Child: (places doll house on table) (CO) ----- BUT: Parent: Set it down gently. Child: (deliberately drops doll house onto floor) (NC)
Parent: Hand me the block Child: (places block near parent on table; CO) ----- BUT: Parent (with hand out): Hand me the block. Child: (Puts block on table near parent; NC)	

NONCOMPLIANCE (NC)

Definition

Noncompliance is coded following a Direct or Indirect Command given the parent when the child does not perform, attempt to perform, or stops attempting to perform the requested behavior within the 5-second interval following the command.

Note: Parent Noncompliance is included in the supplemental coding categories in Appendix B.

Child Noncompliance Examples	
Parent: Sit down. Child: (continues running around room for 5 sec.)	Parent: Pick the doll up off the floor. Child: (colors for 6 sec. then picks up doll)
Parent: Erase the chalkboard. Child: (begins erasing but stops to draw)	Parent: Let's play with the Lincoln Logs now. Child: I don't want to. (and does not begin to)
Parent: Pick up the Legos. Child: You made the mess. (continues to play with Legos)	

Decision rules

1. When uncertain whether the child has complied, noncomplied, or been given no opportunity, code either Compliance or No Opportunity for Compliance.
2. When uncertain whether the child has complied or noncomplied, code Compliance.

Child NC Guidelines

1. **Noncompliance is coded after a command when a child performs a behavior that is incompatible with the parent's request. When Noncompliance is coded, the timing of the 5-second interval is stopped.**

Examples	
Dyad: (playing with coloring book) Parent: Color this hat black. (points to black crayon) Child: (colors hat red) (NC)	Parent: Give me the doll. Child: (pushes doll in opposite direction) (NC)
Parent: Let's play with the farm. Child: (picks up the chalk board) (NC)	

2. **Failure to begin or attempt to obey a command within 5-seconds is coded Noncompliance. Noncompliance is coded after 5-second elapse with no response from the child.**

Examples	
Parent: Come here. Child: (continues playing and ignores parent for 5 sec.) (NC)	Parent: Let's put everything away. Child: (continues playing with truck for 5 sec.) (NC)
Parent: Bring the circus train over here. Child: (after 6 sec., child begins to move the train toward the parent) (NC)	Parent: Why don't you draw -a picture of a tree? Child: (continues to draw a sun for 5 sec.) (NC)
Parent: I want you to put the dress back on the doll. Child: (after 6 sec., picks up doll dress) (NC)	

3. If the child has begun but not completed the requested behavior within the 5-second interval, Noncompliance can be coded only if the child purposefully engages in a behavior incompatible with completion of the command or ceases to attempt to obey the command for the remainder of the 5-second interval.

Examples	
Parent: Will you put Mr. Potato Head in his car? Child: (picks up Mr. Potato Head and pushes the car off the table) (NC)	Parent: Pick up the blocks. Child: (puts one block away and begins building new tower with the other blocks) (NC)
Parent: You must put the airplane away. Child: (flies airplane to the toy box (2 sec.) but continues flying it until 5 sec. elapses) (NC)	

4. Noncompliance is coded when the child fails to obey or attempt to obey a command within the 5-second interval regardless of the child's verbal statements indicating willingness to comply.

Examples	
Parent: Tell me a story. Child: Okay, I'll tell you one. Child: (after 5 sec., child hasn't started story) (NC)	Parent: Pick out all the red tiles. Child: Sure. (continues putting blue tiles on board for 5. sec.) (NC)
Parent: Let's pick up the cars Child: I'll do it later. (races cars throughout 5 sec.) (NC)	

5. Noncompliance is coded if the child does not obey or attempt to obey the command regardless of accompanying inappropriate behavior.

Examples	
Parent: Sit down. Child: No! (NTA) (remains standing) (NC)	Parent: Why don't you clean up now? Child: (yells, "I don't want to go home yet.") (YE-PRO) (gets another toy out of toy box) (NC)
Parent: How about sitting down? Child: (whines, "I'm tired of sitting.") (WH-PRO) (continues to shoot baskets) (NC)	Parent: Close the coloring book. Child: You can't make me! (NTA) (continues coloring) (NC)

NO OPPORTUNITY FOR COMPLIANCE (NOC)

Definition

No opportunity for compliance is coded when the child is not given an adequate chance to comply with a command.

Note. Parent No Opportunity for Compliance is included in the supplemental coding system found in Appendix B.

Child No Opportunity for Compliance Examples	
Parent: You should clean your room when we get home.	Parent: Be nice.
Parent: Hang your coat up. (parent puts coat on hook)	Parent: Listen.
Parent: (After child yells) People should talk quietly inside.	Parent: Johnny.
Parent: Look.	Parent: Please.
Parent: Can you be fast like a bunny?	

Decision rule

1. When uncertain as to whether the parent has or has not had an adequate chance to comply, code No Opportunity for Compliance.

Child NOC Guidelines

1. **Commands that request a behavior to be performed in the not-immediate future (> 5 sec.) are coded No Opportunity for Compliance.**

Examples	
Dyad: (building walls of house) Parent: You can put the chimney on when we finish. (IC/NOC)	Child: I'm getting my report card tomorrow. Parent: Give it to me as soon as you get home. (DC/NOC)
Child: (dumps out crayons) Parent: You have to put them away when you're done. (DC/NOC)	

2. **When the parent completes the action requested in the parent's command in such a way as to prevent the child's compliance, No Opportunity for Compliance is coded. However, if the parent simply joins in the requested activity and does not prevent compliance, do not code No Opportunity for Compliance.**

Examples	
Parent: Let's pick the cash register up off the floor. Child: (continues playing with cars) Parent: (after 4 sec. picks cash register up off floor) (IC/NOC)	
BUT: Parent: Let's pick up these Tinker toys. Parent: (after 1 sec. begins putting the toys in their container) Child: (after 3 sec. begins putting the toys in their container) (IC/CO)	

3. **Positively stated commands in the form of general rules for appropriate behavior that immediately follow the commission of an inappropriate behavior are coded No Opportunity for Compliance.**

Examples	
Child: You're a dope. Parent: Children are supposed to talk nicely to their parents. (IC/NOC)	Child: (yells) Parent: People should talk quietly when they're inside. (IC/NOC)
Child: (chewing gum noisily) Parent: It's polite to keep your mouth closed when you chew. (IC/NOC)	Child: I told Susie she was ugly. Parent: Children are supposed to say nice things to other kids. (IC/NOC)
BUT: Child: Why did Sissy let Angie play with my Barbie doll? Parent: It's important to share your toys with your friends. (TA)	BUT: Child: I told Susie she was ugly. Parent: Children shouldn't say mean things to their friends. (NTA)

4. **Verb phrases in a command that do not provide sufficient information for the child to perform the expected behavior are coded as No Opportunity for Compliance. These verb phrases include those that call for internal or unobservable behavior or those that are too vague to judge compliance.**

Examples	
Parent: Pretend ... (DC/NOC)	Parent: Be patient. (DC/NOC)
Parent: Hurry up. (DC/NOC)	Parent: Be nice. (DC/NOC)
BUT: Parent: Quickly. (TA)	BUT: Parent: Nicely. (TA)
Parent: Watch out. (DC/NOC)	Parent: Be neat. (DC/NOC)
Parent: Be careful (DC/NOC)	Parent: Get ready. (DC/NOC)
BUT: Parent: Carefully. (TA)	
Parent: Behave yourself. (DC/NOC)	Parent: Sshh. (i.e., Be quiet) (DC/NOC)
Parent: Listen. (DC/NOC)	Parent: Will you calm down? (IC/NOC)
Parent: Wait a moment. (DC/NOC)	Parent: Remember this, okay? (IC/NOC)
Parent: Look. (DC/NOC)	Parent: Let me try. (DC/NOC)

5. **When a child's name, or a synonym for it, is used as a bid for attention and is separated from another verbalization by 2 seconds or longer, it is coded as an Indirect Command with No Opportunity for Compliance (see Indirect Command, guideline 15).**

Examples	
Parent: Sara? (IC/NOC)	Parent: Hey. (IC/NOC)
BUT: Parent: Do you need more paper, Sara? (DQ)	BUT: Parent: Hey, (< 2 sec.) what should we do next? (IQ)
Parent: Johnny, (> 2 sec.) That's an orange one. (IC/NOC + TA)	
BUT: Parent: Johnny, (< 2 sec.) that's an orange one. (TA)	
Parent: That's an orange one, (no pause) Johnny. (TA)	

6. When the word “please” is separated from other verbalizations by 2 second or longer and functions as an implied command to perform a preceding command, “please” is coded as an Indirect Command with No Opportunity for Compliance.

Examples	
Parent: Hand me the small piece. Child: No. Parent: (after 2 sec. pause) Please. (IC/NOC)	Parent: Draw me an airplane. Child: I don't want to. Parent: Please. (IC/NOC)

QUESTIONS (QU)

Definition

Questions are verbal inquiries from one person to another that are distinguishable from declarative statements by having a rising inflection at the end and/or by having the sentence structure of a question. Questions request an answer but do not suggest that a behavior is to be performed by the other person.

Child Question Examples	
What do you wanna play?	Which piggy goes to market?
Do you want this one or that one?	Where is Oregon?
Who's in the dungeon? (2 sec.) Huh?	Huh?
When can I play with the good toys?	Isn't that a neat truck?
This is the runway?	Did you say 'Is it done'?
Honest?	How about if I use the big one?
That's a big one, isn't it?	Do you know what?
You're making it higher, aren't you?	Do you know what this is?
That was cool, huh?	You want to play hangman, don't you?
Was that your favorite?	Do you wanna build a car?
Should we call him Spike?	Do you remember Donald Duck?
Is this it?	Are you going to the table?
Where is the <u>block</u> ?	Do you like this? (2 sec.) Huh?
A stanza??	

Decision rules

1. When uncertain whether a verbalization is a Command or a Question, code Question.
2. When uncertain whether a statement is Prosocial Talk or a Question, code Prosocial Talk.

Child QU Guidelines

1. **Some Prosocial Talk statements become Questions by inflection; the voice rises rather than falls at the end of the sentence.**

Examples	
Parent: (builds a block bridge) Child: That's a bridge? (QU)	Parent: This is a cow. Child: A cow? (QU)
Parent: Do you still have your quarter? Child: (pulls coin out of pocket) See? (QU)	Parent: He's got rocket boosters on his shoes. Child: Really? (QU)
Parent: All these toys are new. Child: Yeah? (QU)	Parent: You're drawing yellow rays on your sun. Child: These are rays? (QU)
Parent: I'm drawing a dinosaur. Child: Yeah? (QU)	

2. **Some Prosocial Talk statements become Questions by the addition of a question tag at the end of the sentence.**

Examples	
Parent: Yours is bigger. Child: It's really bigger, huh? (QU)	Parent: (setting up dollhouse) Child: You're only using new furniture, right? (QU)
Parent: Are you going to spend it on candy? Child: I want candy, okay? (QU)	Parent: Your dog is on top. Child: He's the smartest, no? (QU)

3. **When a child repeats a parent's Information Question or Descriptive/Reflective Question, code Question.**

Examples	
Parent: Where is the red block? Child: Where is the <u>red</u> block? (QU) (i.e., is that what you said?)	Parent: (mumbling to self) What goes next? Child: What goes next? (QU) (i.e., is that what you said?)
Parent: Where is the blue car? Child: Where <u>is</u> the blue car? (QU) (i.e., you tell me)	Dyad: (putting Tinker Toy race car together) Child: What goes next? (QU)
Parent: That's the chimney, isn't it? Child: The chimney? (QU)	Parent: Have you found all the pieces? Child: All? (QU)

4. **Questions request no more than a verbal answer from the parent, whereas Indirect Commands suggest that the parent perform a specific verbal or motor behavior.**

Examples	
Dyad: (coloring picture) Child: Can I make this part blue? (QU) ----- BUT: Child: Can you make this part blue? (CM)	Parent: (looks in the box of animals) Child: Is there a horse in there? (QU) ----- BUT: Child: Would you get the horse in there (CM)
Parent: (looking at toy clock) Child: What time is it? (QU) ----- BUT: Child: Will you tell me the time? (CM)	Dyad: (playing with farm animals) Child: What does a duck say? (QU) ----- BUT: Can you make a duck noise? (CM)

5. **Because it is difficult to distinguish a child's genuine questions from question intended to be commands, sentences that begin with certain question-phrases are coded as Questions (QU)**

rather than Commands (CM), regardless of which meaning was intended by the child. These question-phrases are: “Do you know...,” “Do you want...,” “Do you remember...,” and “Are you going to....”

Examples	
Dyad: (coloring) Child: Do you know what? (QU)	Parent: Your teacher's on vacation. Child: Do you know where she went? (QU)
Dyad: (playing with magnetic shapes) Child: (picks up hexagon) Child: Know what this is? (QU)	Parent: There are lots of colors. Child: (hold ups fuschia) Do you remember this one? (QU)
Parent: This one's a tricky shape. Child: Are you going to tell me? (QU)	Dyad: (dressing Mrs. Potato Head) Child: Do you know where this goes? (QU)
Parent: They have new crayons. Child: Want to color? (QU)	Parent: I can't find the lid to the box. Child: It's on the floor, remember? (QU)
Dyad: (dressing Mrs. Potato Head) Child: Know where I'm gonna put this? (QU)	Child: (struggling to make puzzle piece fit) Child: Do you remember how it goes? (QU)
Child: (struggling to hold tall tower from falling) Child: Want to help me? (QU)	Dyad: (drawing a dog) Child: Do you remember Pokey? (QU)
Parent: (pushing tractor to toy farm) Child: Are you going to the farm? (QU) ----- BUT: Parent: (cutting out a large pink heart) Child: Are you gonna let me have that awesome valentine? (PRO)	Parent: I found a nickel in the hall. Child: Gonna let me have it? (QU) ----- BUT: Parent: (starts straightening pile of drawings and drops them on floor) Child: Are you gonna quit messing up my stuff? (NTA)

- 6. Because it is difficult to distinguish a child's genuine questions from commands in question form, sentences that begin with “Can you...” are coded as Commands (CM) rather than Questions (QU), regardless of the child's actual meaning.**

Examples	
Parent: (holding box of train track pieces) Child: Can you give me some? (CM)	Dyad: (drawing shapes) Child: Can you make a square for me? (CM)
Parent: I need the yellow crayon. Child: Can you use the green? (CM)	Parent: Jennifer's going to Disney this weekend. Child: Can you take me there? (CM)
Child: (building a tall tower) Child: Can you do this? (CM)	

- 7. If “Huh?” or its synonyms is stated within 2 seconds of a Question, it is not coded separately from the original question. If “Huh?” follows sequentially (i.e., no intervening verbalizations by child or parent) by more than 2 seconds after a Question, it serves to repeat the question and is coded as a separate Question.**

Examples	
Child: Do you like it (no pause) huh? (QU) ----- BUT: Child: Do you like it? (2 sec.) Huh? (QU+ QU)	Child: Whatcha got there, (no pause) huh? (QU) Child: Whatcha got there? (2 sec.) Huh? (QU+ QU)

- 8. Questions contain no praise or criticism of the parent or the parent's products or activities.**

- a. When the child's questions include praise of the parent or the parent's products or activities, code Prosocial Talk. When the questions contain praise of a person other than the parent, code Question.

Examples	
Mother: I'm building a train track for you. Child: Daddy makes cool tracks, doesn't he? (QU)	Dyad: (each drawing dinosaurs) Child: Isn't my dinosaur great? (QU)
BUT: Child: You're making it nice and long, aren't you? (PRO)	BUT: Child: You draw cool dinosaurs, don't you? (PRO)

- b. When a question includes criticism of the parent or the parent's products or activities, code Negative Talk. When the questions contain criticism of a person other than the parent, code Question.

Examples	
Dyad: (each copying letters) Child: My A isn't very good, is it? (QU)	Dyad: (drawing houses) Child: My brother can't draw good houses, can he? (QU)
BUT: Child: Your A doesn't look right, does it? (NTA)	BUT: Child: You made a boring old house, didn't you? (NTA)

- c. When the child's questions contain evaluative references to both the child and parent, references to the parent take precedence.

Examples	
Dyad: (building block tower) Child: Our tower is getting high, isn't it? (QU)	Dyad: (drawing squiggles on Magna Doodle) Child: We're making snakes, aren't we? (QU)
BUT: Child: Our tower is not very good, is it? (NTA)	BUT: Child: We're making cool snakes, aren't we? (PRO)
Child: Our tower looks super, doesn't it? (PRO)	Child: We're not making very good snakes, are we? (NTA)

- d. When a question includes praise or criticism of some aspect of the play situation (e.g., objects, activities, ideas) that is not owned or created by the parent, it is coded Question.

Examples	
Parent: (looking at Mrs. Potato Head) Child: Doesn't she have a neat purse? (QU)	Parent: (playing with blocks) Child: Do you think it smells yucky in here? (QU)
Dyad: (entering room, where Lincoln logs are scattered all over the floor) Child: It's messy in here, huh? (QU)	Parent: We've put away all the toys. Child: Isn't their toybox cool? (QU)

RESPONSES TO QUESTIONS

Information Questions request specific information beyond a simple Neutral Talk. The appropriate response to question category is coded based on the events that occur during the 5-second interval immediately following the Information Question. One of three response categories is coded following Information Questions: Answer, No Answer, or No Opportunity for Answer. In addition to coding the type of response to the question, the content (i.e., verbalization category) and, if applicable, the tone (i.e., vocalization category) of the answer are also coded.

Note: Parent responses to questions are included in the supplemental coding system found in Appendix B.

GENERAL CHILD RESPONSE TO QUESTIONS GUIDELINES

1. **When a child's response to a parent's Information Question (or lack of response in the case of No Answer) is also a codable verbalization category (e.g., Question, Prosocial Talk), code both the verbalization category and the applicable response to question category.**

Examples	
Child: (reading a book) Parent: What's that story about? Child: It's about a princess. (AN + PRO)	Parent: Where does this piece go? Child: (places it correctly while saying sarcastically, "Can't you see?") (AN + NTA)
Parent: Where should I put my car? Child: Put it in the garage. (AN + CM)	Parent: Where is the biggest one? Child: Is it this one? (AN + QU)
Parent: Which one is blue? Child: I want to use the red one first. (NA + PRO)	Parent: What toy can I play with? Child: You can't play with any because you're no fun. (NA + NTA)

2. **Answers to questions do not have to be the correct answer. Code Answer if the child appears to have attempted to respond with the requested information. If it is unquestionably clear that the child is providing a deliberately wrong answer, code No Answer.**

Examples	
Parent: (holding red block) What color is this one? Child: (asks genuinely, "Blue?") (AN + QU) BUT: Child: (covers eyes and says, "Blue. I mean green. I mean pink.") (NA + PRO + PRO + PRO)	Parent: How much is two plus one? Child: Four. (AN + PRO) BUT: Child: (smirks and says, "Six thousand.") (NA + PRO)
Parent: When is your class picnic? Child: Saturday or Sunday. (AN + PRO) BUT: Child: (says sarcastically, "Last Christmas.") (NA + NTA)	Parent: (points to pig in picture book) Parent: What is this? Child: (smirks and says, "You?") (NA + NTA) BUT: Child: A pig. (AN + PRO)

3. **Nonspecific answers to Information Questions** such as “I don't know,” and “Anywhere” may be acceptable as answers to Information Questions. However, if it is unquestionably clear that the child is deliberately not giving an answer the child knows, code No Answer.

Examples	
Parent: What do you want to play with? Child: (searching through toy box, and says, “I don't know.”) (AN + PRO) BUT: Child: (turns back on mother and says in angry tone, “I don't know.”) (NA + PRO)	Parent: How do you play this game? Child: I'm not sure. (AN + PRO) BUT: Child: I don't care! (NA + NTA)
Parent: What do you want to play with? Child: (turns back on mother and says, “Who cares?”) (NA + NTA) BUT: Child: (pulling up chair next to mom, and says, 'I don't care.?’) (AN + PRO)	Parent: How do you put this together? Child: (pushes pieces away and says in angry tone, 'I don't know.’) (NA + PRO) BUT: Child:(picks up a piece and says, “I can't tell.”) (AN + PRO)
Parent: What should I put at the top? Child: (walks away and says, “Whatever.”) (NA + PRO) BUT: Child: Anything is okay. (AN + PRO)	Parent: Where do you want this to go Child: Anywhere. (AN + PRO) BUT: Child: (walks away from table and says in bored tone, “Wherever.”) (NA + PRO)

4. **If the child's response to question is whined, yelled, or laughed (supplemental code), code the vocalization category as well as the applicable response to question category.**

Examples	
Parent: What time should we make bedtime now? Child: (whines, “Can it be nine o'clock?”) (AN + WH + QU)	Parent: Where are you going on your field trip? Child: (yells, “To the zoo.”) (AN + YE + PRO)
Child: (drawing) Parent: What are you making? Child: (yells, “Nothing!”) (NA + YE + PRO)	Parent: What game would you like to play? Child: (whining, “I don't want to play.”) (NA + WH + PRO)
Parent: (points to Bozo) What's the clown's name? Child: (laughs while saying “I'm not telling.”) (NA + LA + PRO)	Parent: Who's inside the toy box? Child: (while laughing, jumps out and says, “I am!”) (AN + LA + PRO)

5. **If an response to question (or lack thereof in the case of No Answer) occurs simultaneously with a physical behavior category, code both the response to question category and the physical behavior category.**

Examples	
Parent: Which car can I play with? Child: This one. (throws car, hitting parent with it) (AN + PRO + NTO)	Parent: Where is my nose? Child: (touches parent's nose) (AN + PTO)
Parent: What's the matter? Child: (hits parent while saying, “I hate you.”) (NA + NTA + NTO)	

6. When one sentence contains a series of questions joined by “and” or “but,” each question and its response are coded separately. The timing of the 5-second interval begins after the entire sentence has been completed.

- a. If the child answers both questions in 5 seconds, Answer is coded for both questions. If the child does not attempt to answer either question within 5 seconds, both questions are coded as No Answer.

Examples	
Parent: What's that game and how do you play it? Child: (within 5 sec., says while demonstrating, “It's called 'pick up sticks'. It goes like this.”) (AN + PRO + AN + PRO)	
BUT: Child: (pushes sticks away and picks up doll) (NA + NA)	
Parent: What should be his name and what should be her name? Child: They could be Mickey and Minnie. (AN + AN + PRO)	
BUT: Child: I don't care. (NA + NA + PRO)	

- b. If the child is answering one question as the 5-second window elapses, the other question is coded No Opportunity for Answer. However, if the child answers one question while time remains to answer the other question and the child does not attempt to answer the question, the unanswered Information Question is coded No Answer.

Examples	
Dyad: (playing with Disney toy) Parent: What's her name and what's his name? Child: I think he's a duck so his name should be ... umm ... Donald (5 sec. Elapse) (NOA + AN + PRO)	
BUT: Child: He's Donald Duck. (for the next 3 sec. silently puts pieces on him) (NA + AN + PRO)	
Dyad: (looking at picture in color book) Parent: What is this animal called and what color should we color it? Child: It's a great, big, huge, giant, gorilla (5 sec. elapse). (AN + PRO + NOA)	
BUT: Child: (yells) I think it could be a big monkey! (5 sec. elapse) (AN + NA + PRO + YE)	

7. If the parent asks a question that is clearly outside the child's competence or ability to answer, code No Opportunity for Answer rather than No Answer if the child does not attempt to answer. Code Answer if the child attempts to answer the question.

Examples	
Parent: What part looks like a toupee? (IQ) Child: (with puzzled look searches through Mr. Potato Head's parts) (AN) ----- BUT: Child: (gives puzzled look, and says, “A toupee?”) (NOA + QU)	Dyad: (building a castle) Parent: What can we use for a turret? Child: A what? (NOA + QU)
Parent: (points to word “xylophone”) Parent: What's this word? (IQ) Child: (says nothing) (NOA) ----- BUT: Child: (tries to sound out the word) (AN)	Parent: What's five times five? (IQ) Child: (says nothing) (NOA) ----- BUT: Child: I don't know. (AN)
Parent: How do you (unintelligible)? (IQ) Child: What? (NOA)	

8. When a Parent Information Question is followed by another verbalization within 5 seconds and before the child has attempted to answer, the verbalization generally eliminates the child's opportunity to answer. The verbalizations that do not interrupt the opportunity to answer are brief prompting statements, bids for attention, commands for internal, unobservable behavior, and the word "Huh?" and its synonyms. Parent Information Questions followed by these brief verbalizations are coded Answer or No Answer depending on the child's response.

- a. If the parent issues a statement following an Information Question that serves to clarify or prompt the answer to the Information Question and does not take the focus off the question, the statement does not interrupt the 5-second interval. However if the parent's statement after the Information Question leaves no time for the child to begin to answer (i.e., the parent is still clarifying the question or prompting an answer as the 5-second interval elapse), code No Opportunity for Answer.

Examples	
Parent: What is that? Parent: The thing in your hand. Child: (says, "A frog" before the 5 sec. elapse) (AN)	
BUT: Parent: Where's that little bird? Parent: (no pause) The little one that kind of looks like our robins (1 sec.) only it's colored blue. It's here somewhere. (5 sec. elapse) (IQ/NOA + TA + TA)	
Parent: What is that? Parent: The thing in your hand. Child: (puts hand behind back and says, "What thing?" as the 5 sec. elapse) (NA + QU)	
BUT: Parent: Where's that little animal? Parent: The little one that kind of looks like a sheep (1 sec.) only it's colored blue. It's here somewhere. (5 sec. elapse) (IQ/NOA + TA + TA)	

- b. Bid for attention commands and commands for internal unobservable behavior which are automatically coded as no opportunity commands and that do not redirect the child from answering the question do not interrupt the 5-second interval of opportunity for the child to answer an Information Question. When these commands direct the child's attention away from the Information Question, the Information Question is coded No Opportunity for Answer.

Examples	
Dyad: (coloring) Parent: How was school today? Parent: (3 sec.) Sarah? (IC/NOC) (initial question still has opportunity for answer)	Parent: (points at shapes and says, "Which one is bigger?") Child: (no response for 3 sec.) Parent: Oh, look at this chicken. (IQ/NOA + DC/NOC)
Parent: What's this called? (points to Mr. Potato Head's ear) Child: (no response for 3 sec.) Parent: Honey? (IC/NOC) Child: His ear. (AN + PRO)	Parent: How was school today? Parent: (3 sec.) Christopher? (IC/NOC) Child: I don't want to talk about it. (NA + PRO)
BUT: Child: (rudely) I'm busy. (NA + NTA)	
Parent: What's this called? (points to Mr. Potato Head's ear) Child: (no response for 1 sec.) Parent: Honey? (IC/NOC) Child: I'm working on this letter, mommy. (NA + PRO)	

- c. When “Huh?” or its synonyms (i.e., Eh?, Hmm?) follow an Information Question by more than 2 seconds and has no meaning except to prompt the answer to the Information Question, “Huh?” is coded as an Information Question with No Opportunity for Answer. Because in this case it has no opportunity, “Huh?” does not interrupt the 5-second response interval for the original question.

Examples	
Parent: What kind of bird is that? Child: (no response for 2 sec.) Parent: Huh? (IQ/NOA) Child: It's a chicken. (AN + PRO)	
BUT: Parent: What kind of dinosaur is that? Child: Tyrorex. (AN + PRO) Parent: Huh? (meaning “What did you say?”) (IQ)	
Parent: What kind of bird is that? Child: (no response for 2 sec.) Parent: Huh? (IQ/NOA) Child: (no response) (NA for initial question)	
BUT: Parent: What kind of dinosaur is that? Child: Stegarex? (AN + QU) Parent: Huh? (meaning “What did you say?”) (IQ with opportunity)	

9. If the parent asks an Information Question that is clearly rhetorical to which no answer is expected, code No Opportunity for Answer rather than No Answer if the child does not attempt to answer. Code Answer if the child attempts to answer the rhetorical Information Question.

Examples	
Parent: (looking in box of crayons and finds Lego) How in the world did that get in there! (IQ) Child: Someone must have put it in there. (AN + PRO)	Parent: (playing with broken cash register) Parent: What's wrong with this thing? (IQ) Child: I don't know. (AN + PRO)
BUT: Child: (looks over at parent but makes no comment) (NOA)	BUT: Child: (continues playing with doll) (NOA)
Dyad: (playing with Mr. Potato Head) Child: You put a girl's hat on him. (PRO) Parent: What was I thinking! (IQ/NOA)	Child: There's a dinosaur in the Legos. (PRO) Parent: How did that get in here! (IQ/NOA)
Dyad: (playing checkers) Child: King me! (CM) Parent: Who made up these rules! (IQ/NOA)	

10. If the child responds to an information question with “What?” or its synonyms only code No Answer if the child appears to be deliberately avoiding answering the question. If it appears as if the child did not hear or understand the question, code No Opportunity for Answer.

Examples	
Dyad: (building a castle) Parent: What can we use for a turret? (IQ) Child: A what? (NOA + QU)	Parent: How many legs does this caterpillar have? (IQ) Child: (with puzzled look) What? (NOA + QU)
	BUT: Parent: How many legs does this caterpillar have? (IQ) Child: (hiding under table, saying “What? What? What?”) (NA + QU + QU + QU)

ANSWER (AN)

Definition

An answer is a verbal or nonverbal response to an Information Question that provides or attempts to provide the information requested in the question.

Note: Parent Answer is included in the supplemental coding system found in Appendix B.

Child Answer Examples	
Parent: Where is Mr. Potato Head's nose? (IQ; AN) Child: Under the table. (PRO)	Parent: How does this work? (IQ; AN) Child: Turn the handle. (PRO)
Parent: How do you spell ball? (IQ; AN) Child: B. A. L. (5 sec. elapse) (PRO)	Parent: What colors are on the flag? (IQ; AN) Child: Red and blue. (PRO)

Decision Rules

1. When uncertain as to whether the response to an Information Question is coded Answer or No Answer to an Information Question, code Answer.
2. When uncertain as to whether the child is intentionally not answering a question, do not code No Answer.

Child AN Guidelines

1. Verbal responses from the child that provide the requested information or attempt to provide it within 5 seconds are coded Answer to question. When the child provides the requested information, Answer is immediately coded and the 5-second interval stops.

Examples	
Parent: (holding blue block) What color is this one? (IQ; AN) Child: Blue. (PRO)	Parent: How are you feeling today? (IQ; AN) Child: I'm hungry. (PRO)
Parent: (points to ten blocks) How many are there? (IQ; AN) Child: ("one, two, 1 sec. pause, three, four" as 5 sec. elapse) (PRO)	

2. If the child has begun but not completed the answer within the 5-second interval, the child must be continuing to attempt to provide the answer during the remainder of the 5-second interval for Answer to be coded.

Example
Parent: (points to ten blocks) How many are there? (IQ; AN) Child: (looks at blocks for 4 sec. and says, "One, two...") (PRO)
BUT: Parent: (points to ten blocks) How many are there? (IQ; NA) Child: ("one, two Hey there's the one we couldn't find before.") (PRO + PRO)

3. **If an Information Question has numerous possible answers that would be adequate, the child must provide at least one of the possible answers for Answer to be coded. Answer is only coded once regardless of the number of sentences in the answer.**

Examples	
Parent: What's Barbie wearing? (IQ; AN) Child: She's wearing her purse, a dress, high heels, and a green hat. (PRO)	Parent: What's Barbie wearing? (IQ; AN) Child: She has on her purse and her high heels look the same color. (PRO + PRO)
Parent: What's Barbie wearing? (IQ; AN) Child: She has on her purse and she's wearing a dress. She has high heels on her feet too. (PRO + PRO + PRO)	

4. **Nonverbal responses that intentionally provide or attempt to provide the requested information are coded Answer.**

Examples	
Parent: How many crayons do I have? (IQ; AN) Child: (holds up three fingers)	Parent: What animal says Cock-a-doodle-doo? (IQ; AN) Child: (picks up rooster and shows to parent)
Parent: (playing with MagnaDoodle) How do you erase this thing? (IQ; AN) Child: (reaches over and moves bar to erase parent's drawing) ----- BUT: Child: (erases own drawing without showing parent) (NA)	Parent: Which one is the square? (IQ; AN) Child: (points to a circle)

5. **Answer is coded only when the child actually provides or attempts to provide within the 5-second interval the information requested. Responses that do not attempt to provide the information regardless of their appropriate or pleasant nature are coded No Answer.**

Examples	
Child: (building block house) Parent: How many doors does it have? (IQ; NA) Child: Just a second. (PRO)	Child: (drawing) Parent: What's that? (IQ; NA) Child: Guess. (CM)
Dyad: (playing zoo) Parent: Where is the hippo gonna live? (IQ; NA) Child: It's a surprise! (PRO)	Dyad: (playing with plastic letters) Parent: Which letter does 'cat' start with? (IQ; NA) Child: You made an easy one! (PRO)

6. **If the child is attempting to answer an Information Question and the parent issues another verbalization within the 5-second interval, the attempt to answer the initial question is coded Answer.**

Examples	
Parent: How many cars are there? (IQ; AN) Child: (counting out loud) Parent: (4 sec. after initial question) How many are there?	Parent: How do you make him pop up? (IQ; AN) Child: (explores Jack-in-the-box for 2 sec.) Parent: Turn the handle. (DC)
Parent: Which one is green? (IQ; AN) Child: (hands parent a teal-colored crayon) Parent: This one isn't really green. (NTA)	

NO ANSWER (NA)

Definition

No Answer to Information Question occurs when the child does not attempt to provide the information requested in the question.

Note: Parent No Answer is included in the supplemental coding system described in Appendix B.

Child No Answer Examples	
Parent: How old are you? (IQ; NA) Child: (No Answer)	Parent: What color is the bunny's nose? (IQ; NA) Child: Leave me alone. (NTA)
Parent: Which one do you like? (IQ; NA) Child: Can't I have more than one?	Parent: How many do you have? (IQ; NA) Child: One ... two ... (begins playing as 5 sec. elapse)

Decision Rules

1. If uncertain whether a child's response to an Information Question is coded Answer or No Answer, code Answer.
2. If uncertain whether a child's response to an Information Question is No Answer or No Opportunity for Answer, code No Opportunity for Answer.

Child NA Guidelines

1. If the child gives no verbal or nonverbal response to a question that could be answered, it is coded as No Answer.

Examples	
Parent: What do you want to play with? (IQ; NA) Child: (sits in chair sulking for 5 sec.)	Parent: What's your dolly's name? (IQ; NA) Child: (no response)
Parent: (pointing to red car) What color is this? (IQ; NA) Child: (No Answer and continues playing with cars)	

2. If the child's response does not provide or attempt to provide the information requested in the question, code No Answer.

Examples	
Parent: What are you playing? (IQ + NA) Child: Go away. (CM)	Parent: What game do you want to play with? (IQ; NA) Child: I don't want to play. (PRO)
Parent: Which car do you want? (IQ; NA) Child: Which one do you want? (QU)	Parent: How old are you? (IQ; NA) Child: You know already. (PRO)

3. If a child has begun but not completed the answer to an Information Question, code **No Answer** only if the child has not provided an adequate answer and ceases to continue to attempt to answer for the remainder of the 5-second interval.

Examples	
Parent: How many pieces of paper do you have? (IQ; NA) Child: One, Two ... (stops counting and begins drawing) (PRO)	Parent: What are the three colors in the flag? (IQ; NA) Child: Red. (2 sec. pause) We have a big flag at school. (PRO + PRO) ----- BUT: Parent: What is Barbie wearing? (IQ; AN) Child: She's got on a purse. (tries to open purse for remainder of 5 sec.) (PRO)

NO OPPORTUNITY FOR ANSWER (NOA)

Definition

No Opportunity for Answer is coded when the child does not have an adequate chance to provide the information requested by a parent in an Information Question.

Note: Parent No Opportunity for Answer is included in the supplemental coding system described in Appendix B.

Child No Opportunity for Answer Examples	
Parent: What's this letter? (3 sec.) It's a P.	Parent: Where would you like me to put this? (no pause) I like your drawing very much. (no pause) It's colorful.
Parent: How does this work? (keeps talking for 5 sec.)	Parent: What? (1 sec.) What did you say?
Parent: What do you have in your hand? What is that?	Parent: What did you do in school today? (loud noise occurs) What was that noise?
Parent: When do you want to eat? (2 sec.) Huh?	Parent: What color is this? Tell me what color this is.
Parent: How does this look? (2 sec.) Honey?	Parent: Where are you going to put those? Be careful.

Decision Rule

1. If uncertain whether the child had sufficient opportunity to respond, code No Opportunity for Answer.

Child NOA Guidelines

1. **If a parent makes any statement after an Information Question within the 5-second interval before the child has attempted to answer, these parental statements, with the exception of brief clarifications of the question, eliminate the child's opportunity to answer the Information Question.**
 - a. When a parent asks an Information Question but follows quickly (< 5 sec.) with the answer, No Opportunity for Answer is coded.

Examples	
Parent: Which one is red? (IQ + NOA) Child: (looking at blocks) Parent: (3 sec.) This one is red. (TA)	Parent: Which one goes here? (IQ + NOA) Child: (no response) Parent: (2 sec.) The small round one goes here. (TA)

- b. If the parent follows an Information Question within the 5-second interval with a statement that does not serve to prompt the answer to the question or takes the focus off the question before the child has begun to answer, the Information Question is coded No Opportunity for Answer.

Examples	
Parent: What is this? (IQ + NOA) Parent: Oh, I see a better toy. He's bigger than this. (TA + TA)	Parent: What are you drawing? (IQ + NOA) Child: (no responses for 3 sec.) Parent: You're using lots of colors. (BD)
Parent: Which stick is longest? (IQ + NOA) Child: (no response in 4 sec.) Parent: You're using the wrong stick, sweetie. (NTA)	

- c. If the parent asks an Information Question but continues talking for the 5-second interval following the question, the Information Question is coded No Opportunity for Answer.

Example	
Parent: How does this work? (IQ + NOA)	
Parent: Oh I see. If you press on this button, the bell rings. When you turn the handle, the cash drawer opens. This is a lot of fun. (TA + TA + TA + TA)	

- d. If the parent issues a statement(s) following an Information Question that serves to clarify or prompt the answer to the Information Question and does not take the focus off the question, the statement(s) does not interrupt the 5-second interval. However, if the parent's statement(s) after the Information Question leaves no time for the child to begin to answer (i.e., the parent is still clarifying the question as the 5-second interval elapses), code No Opportunity for Answer.

Examples	
Parent: Where is that game? (IQ + NOA) Parent: You know, the one with the little cars and you drive around. You get money for landing on certain spaces (5 sec. elapse).(TA + TA + TA)	Dyad: (beginning game of checkers) Parent: Which color do you want to be? (IQ) Parent: (2 sec.) I asked you a question. (TA) (question still has opportunity for answer)
BUT: Parent: What is that? (IQ + AN) Parent: The thing in your hand. Child: (says, "A frog." before the 5 sec. elapse) (PRO)	
Parent: How do you make him pop up? (IQ) Child: (no response for 2 sec.) Parent: I'm waiting. (TA) (question still has opportunity for answer)	

2. If a parent follows an Information Question with another question within the 5-second interval before the child has attempted to answer, any question except for "Huh?" and its synonyms eliminates the child's opportunity to answer the Information Question.

- a. If the parent repeats the Information Question within the 5-second interval before the child has attempted to answer, the first question is coded No Opportunity for Answer as soon as the second question is issued.

Examples	
Parent: What is your dolly's name? (IQ + NOA) Parent: (2 sec.) What's her name, huh? (IQ)	Dyad: (playing with toy farm) Parent: What do cows eat? (IQ + NOA) Parent: (3 sec.) Do they eat cookies? (DQ)
Dyad: (playing with zoo) Parent: What is this animal? (IQ + NOA) Child: (no response for 3 sec.) Parent: What animal has a trunk and likes peanuts? (IQ)	Parent: Who do you like best on Sesame Street? (IQ + NOA) Child: (no response for 2 sec.) Parent: You like Big Bird best, don't you? (DQ)

- b. If the parent issues an Information Question and then, within 5-seconds and before the child attempts to answer, issues another unrelated question that changes the subject, the first question is coded No Opportunity for Answer.

Examples	
Parent: What do you want to play with? (IQ + NOA) Child: (looking on the floor) Parent: What are you looking at? (IQ)	Parent: Where is the red crayon? (IQ + NOA) Child: (no response for 3 sec.) Parent: What do you want for dinner? (IQ)

- c. When “Huh?” or its synonyms (i.e., Eh?, Hmm?) follow an Information Question by more than 2 seconds and has no meaning except to prompt the answer to the Information Question, “Huh?” is coded as an Information Question with no opportunity. Because in this case “Huh?” has no opportunity, it does not interrupt the 5-second response interval for the original question.

Examples	
Parent: What kind of truck is that? (IQ + AN) Child: (no response for 2 sec.) Parent: Huh? (IQ + NOA) Child: It's a dumptruck. (AN is for the initial question)	
BUT: Parent: What kind of animal is that? (IQ + AN) Child: Gnu. (PRO) Parent: Huh? (meaning “What did you say?”) (IQ with opportunity)	

3. If the parent issues a command within the 5-second interval following an Information Question before the child has attempted to answer, commands with opportunity eliminate the child's opportunity to answer the Information Question.

- a. If the parent issues a command for an observable behavior within the 5-second interval following an Information Question before the child has attempted to answer, the Information Question is coded No Opportunity for Answer and the command and its response are coded.

Examples	
Parent: Where is the green one? (IQ + NOA) Parent: (3 sec.) Show me the green one. (DC)	Parent: Which pieces go together? (IQ + NOA) Child: (no response) Parent: Put these two pieces together. (DC + CO) Child: (2 sec.) (begins trying to put the pieces together)
Parent: Where did you put your coat? (IQ + NOA) Child: (no response for 3 sec.) Parent: Answer me. (DC)	

- b. Bid for attention commands and commands for unobservable internal behavior which are automatically coded as no opportunity commands and that do not redirect the child from answering the question do not interrupt the 5-second interval of opportunity for the child to answer an Information Question. When these commands direct the child's attention away from the Information Question, the Information Question is coded No Opportunity for Answer.

Examples	
Parent: (points at towers) Which one is bigger? (IC with opportunity for answer) Child: (no response for 3 sec.) Parent: (3 sec.) Sarah? (IC + NOC) ----- BUT: Parent: (points at towers) Which one is bigger? (IQ + NOA) Child: (no response for 3 sec.) Parent: Wait a minute. (while putting more blocks on big one as 5 sec. elapse) (DC + NOC)	Parent: (places bunny under a tissue) Parent: Where's Bunny? (IC with opportunity for answer) Child: (no response for 2 sec.) Parent: Honey? (IC + NOC) ----- BUT: Parent: Where's Bunny? (IQ + NOA) Child: (no response for 2 sec.) Parent: (points to Bunny's empty cage) Look. (DC + NOC)

PROSOCIAL TALK (TA+BD+UP+LP+RF+AK)

Definition

Prosocial Talk incorporates several categories of verbalizations which contribute positively to the parent-child interaction. Prosocial Talk includes all statements that positively evaluate an attribute, product, or behavior of the parent (specifically or generally); describe the parent's behavior; provide neutral information; reflect the parent's verbalizations; or acknowledge the parent.

Child Prosocial Talk Examples	
I see.	Hi!
Sure does.	(yells) Yikes!
The cow is eating the hay.	I need one more pink stick.
I want to sit on your lap.	It's your turn to draw a card.
You seem sort of mad.	A, B, C, D.
I love you.	You're a supermom.
Alright!	Yea!
You're pretty.	Your hair is so nice.
You're a good artist.	We made it look perfect.
You are fun and I like how you're playing.	I like the way you're working and being good.
You did a great job coloring my picture.	That's a nifty elephant you drew.
Your Potato Head is good.	Your singing is pretty.
That helicopter you made is super.	Your dinosaur drawing is really cool.
This is a terrific rainbow we colored.	You drew a pretty girl, didn't you?
Isn't that a neat clown you drew!	Look at the fantastic ship you made.
If you put your super tower PRO here, it will look taller.	Parent: Are there any more long sticks? Child: Long sticks.
You are making a hat.	You put one here and you put it on the circle.
You're singing a song.	You're coloring the flowers and making them red.
I know you're building a square thing.	You're drawing a car (2 sec.) putting on wheels.
You're making it right now.	You put the dolly in the pretty room.
Parent: Oh, here's where it goes. Child: That's where it goes. It goes on top.	Parent: The farmer's feeding his cows. Child: Feeding his cows.

Decision rules

1. When uncertain as to whether a statement is a Prosocial Talk, Negative Talk, Command, or Question, code Prosocial Talk.
2. When uncertain as to whether the verbalization is a Prosocial Talk or any other verbalization category, code Prosocial Talk.
3. When uncertain as to whether a verbalization is a Prosocial Talk or 'no code', do not code.
4. When uncertain whether descriptive words strung together are one sentence or separate sentences, code one sentence.
5. When uncertain as to whether a child's Prosocial Talk is an independent verbalization (i.e., is in response to the parent), code Prosocial Talk.

Child PRO Guidelines

1. Brief responses indicating to the parent that the child is watching or listening to the parent are coded **Prosocial Talk**.

Examples	
Parent: (building an extremely high tower of blocks) Child: Oooh. (PRO)	Parent: It fell down. Child: Yup. (PRO)
Parent: (tower of blocks collapses) Child: Oh no. (PRO)	

2. **Prosocial Talk** may give an account of:
 - a. the child's independent behavior;

Examples	
Dyad: (playing with toy airport) Parent: (landing airplane) Child: I'm landing my helicopter. (PRO) BUT: Child: You're landing the airplane. (PRO)	Dyad: (building a Lego house) Child: I'm building a wall. (PRO) BUT: Child: You're building a wall. (PRO)

- b. toys, objects, people, and activities;

Examples	
Parent: (putting train track together) Child: The train can go fast now. (PRO)	Dyad: (cleaning PRO toys) Child: There's the toy box we need to put these in. (PRO)
Dyad: (playing with Tinker Toys) Parent: There are four red wheels. Child: You have all of them. (PRO)	Parent: How was school? Child: My teacher gave me a sticker today. (PRO)
Parent: These pieces are stuck. Child: Batman could take them apart. (PRO)	Dyad: (drawing numbers) Child: I'm four years old. (PRO)

- c. feelings or motivations;

Examples	
Parent: Aunt Sharon is very sick. Child: You're sad she's sick. (PRO) OR: Child: I'm sad she's sick. (PRO)	Parent: (starting to draw a boat) Child: You want to make a sailboat. (PRO) OR: Child: I want to draw with you. (PRO)
Parent: I'm hungry. Child: I'm hungry too. (PRO) OR: Child: I'm thirsty. (PRO)	Child: (spills soda on table) Child: You look mad at me. (PRO) OR: Child: I'm sorry. (PRO)
Parent: Put your shoes on. Child: I don't want to. (PRO)	Child: You're in a good mood. (PRO)
Child: You look happy, mommy. (PRO)	Child: I bet you're proud of me. (PRO)

- d. the parent's current, recently completed, past, or future behavior.

Examples	
Parent: (standing on tiptoes to reach a game) Child: You're trying to get the game. (PRO) ----- BUT: Child: You got that game last week. (PRO) Child: You're going to drop it. (PRO)	Parent: (pushing car PRO ramp to roof) Child: You're driving it up to the top. (PRO) ----- BUT: Child: Last week you drove it PRO there too. (PRO) Child: You're gonna have lots of cars PRO there pretty soon. (PRO)
Parent: (draws a small rabbit and then draws a large horse) Child: You made a horse. (PRO) ----- OR: Child: You made two animals. (PRO)	Child: You made a bunny. (PRO) Child: You'll have a farm when you're done. (PRO)

- e. general comments.

Examples	
Parent: (playing with cars) Child: (playing with doll) Her hair is blond. (PRO)	Parent: They've got lots of toys. Child: They have some toys we don't have at home. (PRO)
Dyad: (drawing at chalkboard) Parent: I drew a garden. Child: I'm going to draw a flower. (PRO)	Parent: Oh there's a game on the top shelf. Child: I can't see it. (PRO)

3. **The child's acknowledgment of the parent must be in response to the parent's verbal or nonverbal behavior to be coded Prosocial Talk. When the parent is out of the child's range of vision and the parent is not speaking to the child, Prosocial Talk is not coded.**

Examples	
Parent: This is fun. Child: Um-hmm. (PRO)	Child: Put that truck on top, Mommy. Parent: (complies) Child: Okay. (PRO)
Parent: Can I put it here? Child: Sure. (PRO)	Parent: (gives child a red crayon). Child: Yeah. (PRO)
Parent: Let me do it. Child: (neutral tone) Not yet. (PRO)	Parent: (accidentally drops a block) Child: Uh-oh. (PRO) ----- BUT: Child: (with back to parent, accidentally drops block) Child: Uh-oh. (not coded)
Parent: Honey? Child: Just a sec. (PRO)	Parent: Can I have that one? Child: You're asking for the best one. (PRO) ----- OR: Child: You want the one I want. (PRO)
Parent: (pulls horse out of box) Parent: This is Secretariat. Child: You gave him a big name. (PRO)	Parent: (puts sheep's nose in trough) Parent: She's thirsty. Child: You're giving her a drink. (PRO) ----- BUT: Child: She's drinking Kool-Aid. (PRO)

4. **Brief answers to Descriptive/Reflective Questions are coded Prosocial Talk. These answers include “yes”, “no”, “I don't know”, “maybe”, and their synonyms.**

Examples	
Parent: Is this where it goes? Child: It is. (PRO) ----- OR: Child: Nope. (PRO) Child: Possibly. (PRO) Child: I guess so. (PRO)	Parent: Do you want to eat at McDonald's tonight? Child: Sure. (PRO) ----- OR: Child: Of course! (PRO) Child: Not really. (PRO)
ALSO: Uh-huh. Sure. Yes sir. Alright. Okay. We'll see. Fine. Probably (or Probably not). Possibly. Might be. Could be. I guess so.	
NOTE: “I don't know” in response to an Information Question is coded as Prosocial Talk.	

5. **Prosocial Talk includes exclamations of surprise that carry no information beyond the element of surprise.**

Examples	
Parent: (accidentally breaks crayon) Child: Hey! (PRO)	Parent: I made a dinosaur! Child: Oh, man! (PRO)
Parent: (turns handle and Jack-in-Box pops out) Child: Yikes! (PRO)	ALSO: Oops! Whoops! Aw, hey! Uh-oh! Oh my! Golly! My goodness! Oh my gosh! I'll be darned! Well I'll be!

6. **Prosocial Talk includes “automatically given” social phrases.**

Examples	
Parent: (sneezes) Child: Bless you. (PRO)	Parent: (peeks around a Tinker Toy tower) Child: Hi. (PRO)
Parent: Thanks. Child: You're welcome. (PRO)	ALSO: I'm sorry. Bye. Excuse me. Gesundheit.
NOTE: “Thank you” is coded Prosocial Talk.	

7. **Phrases of Prosocial Talk that are stated with questioning inflection become rhetorical questions and are coded as Questions. When a child repeats a parent's verbalization in a question form (e.g., using a question tag or a questioning inflection), the child's question is coded as a Question.**

Examples	
Parent: My car can fly. Child: Oh? (QU)	Parent: (fits piece in puzzle) Child: How about that? (QU)
Parent: The red car is faster. Child: It is faster. (PRO) ----- BUT: Child: The red car is faster, isn't it? (QU) ----- OR: Child: The red car? (QU)	Parent: My house is almost finished. Child: Your house is almost done. (PRO) ----- BUT: Child: Your house is almost done? (QU) ----- OR: Child: Your house is almost done, isn't it? (QU)
Parent: This dolly's name is Madonna. Child: Really? (QU)	

8. Verbalizations that clearly express the child's appreciation or pleasure about a specific action or product of the parent are Prosocial Talk.

Examples	
Parent: (hands child a picture parent drew) Child: I like this one. (PRO)	Parent: (draws a red apple) Child: You made it look pretty. (PRO)
Parent: Mine is a tall block tower. Child: I like 'em tall. (PRO)	Parent: (coloring) Child: Good coloring, Mom. (PRO)
Dyad: (building fort) Child: It's fun building with you. (PRO)	

9. Phrases that include a positive evaluative word or phrase that describes the parent or the parent's behaviors, activities, or products are coded Prosocial Talk.

- a. Positive evaluative words include good and all of its synonyms. Other descriptive words that are considered in DPICS as positive evaluative words include pretty, intelligent, neat, polite, well-behaved, right, thoughtful, fun, careful, superior, brilliant, smart, well, beautiful, perfect, wonderful, handsome, patient, bright, special, considerate, fun, enjoyable, first-rate, top-notch, marvelous, nifty, neat, awesome, cool, imaginative, creative, and their synonyms.

Examples	
Parent: Is this how it goes? Child: You did that just right. (PRO)	Dyad: (laughing) Child: You're fun to play with. (PRO)
Parent: (makes PRO fairy tale) Child: That's a neat story. (PRO)	Child: Draw a dinosaur. Parent: (draws a dinosaur) Child: Cool picture! (PRO)

- b. Descriptive words not considered sufficiently positive to constitute a praise include quiet, alright, okay, fine, fast, slow, alert, funny, interesting, strong, silly, exciting, energetic, straight, fancy, and their synonyms.

Examples	
Parent: Is this an okay place to put it? Child: That's a silly place. (PRO)	Parent: The cow's driving the tractor. Child: You're so goofy when we play. (PRO)
Child: Make it go up slow. Parent: (pushes train up mountain track) Child: You pushed that slow! (PRO)	Child: Will you help me? Parent: (picks up toy box) Child: You're strong to pick that up. (PRO)
Parent: (makes PRO fairy tale) Child: That's a funny story. (PRO)	

- c. The positive evaluative component of Prosocial Talk may be a metaphor.

Examples	
Child: You're a supermom for helping me with this. (PRO)	Child: You're a cool dude for playing with me. (PRO)
BUT: Child: You're a supermom! (PRO)	BUT: Child: You're a cool dude. (PRO)

10. Children's expressions of praise for joint activities or products created by the dyad are coded as Prosocial Talk.

Examples	
Child: We made a super space shuttle! (PRO)	
OR: Child: Our snake picture looks awesome! (PRO)	
OR: Child: Didn't we build a wonderful house! (PRO)	

11. If a statement contains two or more meaningful verb phrases describing clearly independent parent behaviors, and has at least one positive evaluative word or phrase that modifies the verbs, each modified verb phrase is coded as a separate Prosocial Talk.

Examples	
Child: You're drawing wonderful squiggles and coloring them with pretty colors. (PRO + PRO)	Child: I like how you're working and singing that cool song. (PRO + PRO)
Child: It's neat how you're drawing those bugs and being so much fun today. (PRO + PRO)	Child: The way you're drawing those dinosaurs and coloring them in is so awesome. (PRO + PRO)
Child: Thank you for giving me the wrecker and showing me where the hook goes. (PRO + PRO)	Child: You're being nice and being fun today. (PRO + PRO)
BUT: Child: Thank you for giving me the wrecker and the car. (PRO)	BUT: Child: You're being nice and so much fun today. (PRO)
Child: I like that you take my hand and put a sticker on, it. (PRO + PRO)	Parent: (playing with garage)
BUT: Child: I like that you take and put stickers on my hand. (PRO)	Child: It's fun when you play trucks with me and when you act like Big Bird. (PRO + PRO)
	BUT: Child: You're funny when you act like Big Bird. (PRO)

12. Specific positive evaluative statements of the parent's behavior or products are Prosocial Talk even if they are stated in question form. (Refer to priority order.)

Examples	
Child: You fixed it perfectly, didn't you? (PRO)	Child: That's a beautiful cat you drew, isn't it? (PRO)
Child: That's neat, isn't it? (PRO)	Child: I think that's super, don't you? (PRO)
Child: You made that pretty, didn't you? (PRO)	Child: Do you know how much I love you? (PRO)
Child: (looking at parent's fort) Isn't that an excellent hide-out? (PRO)	

13. Commands automatically coded no opportunity that contain a positive evaluation of the parent are coded as Prosocial Talk.

Examples	
Parent: (built robot)	Parent: I finished my tower.
Child: Look what a cool robot you made! (PRO not CM)	Child: Let me see if I can build one as good as yours. (PRO not CM)
BUT: Child: How about building another cool robot for me? (CM)	BUT: Child: Build another tower as good as your first one. (CM)

14. Positive evaluations of objects that are not a product of the parent also are coded as Prosocial Talk.

Examples	
Parent: (puts train cars together to make a long train) Child: That's a cool train. (PRO) BUT: Parent: (takes train set out of box) Child: That's a cool train. (PRO)	Parent: (makes Lego car) Child: Neat car, mom. (PRO) BUT: Parent: (pushes car on table) Child: Neat car, mom. (PRO)

15. When a child uses Prosocial Talk "in role" during pretend play, the verbalization is coded Prosocial Talk.

Examples	
Parent: (drawing spider web on Magna Doodle) Child: (talking for Spiderman doll) Thanks for making me a web. (PRO)	Parent: (talking for mother doll) Goodnight baby. Child: (talking for baby doll) Goodnight Mommy. (PRO)
Parent: (holding unicorn stuffed animal) Child: (talking to animal) You're beautiful, Charlie. (PRO)	Parent: (puts child on his lap) Child: (singing Barney song "I love you, you love me.") (PRO + PRO)
Parent: (talking to alligator puppet on own hand) You are a very scary alligator. Child: (talking as puppet) Alligator, you are opening your mouth wide! (PRO)	Parent: You be the cowboy. Child: (holds out hand like gun) You're wearing a badge, sheriff. (PRO)
Parent: Oscar the Grouch, my car needs a wash. (PRO) Child: (talking for Oscar) Your car does need a wash. (PRO) AND: Child: (talking for self) Your car does need a wash. (PRO)	Parent: (talking for self) Mr. Potato Head is driving to the store. Child: (talking for Mr. Potato Head) I'm driving to the store. (PRO) AND: Child: Mr. Potato Head is driving to the store. (PRO)
Parent: (sings, "The itsy bitsy spider.....") Child: (sings, "The itsy bitsy spider climbed up the water spout.") (PT)	Parent: (talking for alligator puppet) You look good enough to eat. Child: (talking to alligator puppet) You have pretty teeth. (PT)
Parent: (bouncing toy mouse) Squeak, squeak, squeak. Child: (talking to mouse) Mister Mouse, you are bouncing all over the place. (PT)	

16. When a parent expresses a positive self-evaluation, an affirmative acknowledgement by the child is coded Prosocial Talk.

Examples	
Parent: (fixes roof on house) Now I got it right. Child: Sure did. (PRO)	Parent: (looking at own drawing) This looks pretty good. Child: Yeah. (PRO) BUT: Parent: My house is red. Child: It is. (PRO)

17. If a verbalization contains an evaluation of the attributes, products, or activities of the parent, the evaluation must be positive or neutral for Prosocial Talk to be coded. Negative evaluations are coded Negative Talk.

- a. Certain phrases are commonly used to express approval and positive evaluation of the child's activities, products or attributes are coded Prosocial Talk.

Examples	
Parent: I did it! Child: (hugs parent) Hurray! (PRO)	Parent: Let me guess. Your favorite color is ... blue!? Child: (claps) Yea! (PRO)
Parent: (building a cabin with Lincoln Logs) Child: You're making a cabin. (PRO) ----- BUT: Child: You're making a weird-looking cabin. (NTA)	Parent: (sings while building) Child: You're singing that television song. (PRO) ----- BUT: Child: You're not very good at singing. (NTA)
Child: Do you know what I drew? Parent: That's you and Grandma at the store. Child: (claps and exclaims) "Yes!" (PRO)	Parent: I bought chocolate bars this morning. Child: (holds hand out for a high five) Alright! (PRO)

- b. Certain phrases are commonly used to express disapproval and negative evaluation of the parent's activities, products, or attributes. These expressions (e.g., "Darn," "Yuck," and "Ick") are coded as Negative Talk, not Prosocial Talk.

Examples	
Parent: You throw it so it goes back in the cupboard. Child: (shouts, "Aw, darn!") (YE-NTA)	Parent: I want to play with the magnetic numbers. Child: Yuck. (NTA)

- c. Prosocial Talk that indicates a negative evaluation of objects or events not created by the parent are coded Prosocial Talk, not Negative Talk.

Examples	
Parent: There aren't enough Tinker Toy sticks. Child: Darn. (PRO)	Parent: They have a doll in the toy box. Child: Yea! (PRO)
Parent: They have a doll in the toy box. Child: Yea! (PRO)	Parent: This a new game! Child: Neato! (PRO)

- d. Statements that equate the parent with a noun are Prosocial Talk when the noun is modified by a neutral or positive evaluative word.

Examples	
Parent: (coloring picture) Child: You're a good colorer. (PRO) ----- OR: Parent: (watching child draw) You're a good colorer. Child: You're a good colorer too. (PRO)	Parent: (pushes car) Child: You're a super race car driver. (PRO) ----- OR: Parent: Let's race our cars like we did last week. Child: You're a super race car driver. (PRO)
Parent: (folding paper into airplane) Child: You're a great airplane-maker. (PRO) ----- OR: Parent: (picking PRO paper) I'm gonna make a boat. Child: You're a great airplane-maker, too. (PRO)	

- 18. When a parent asks a Descriptive/Reflective Question requesting agreement or disagreement with a positive or negative self-evaluation, the child's response may contain an implicit positive evaluation or criticism, which would then be coded as Prosocial Talk or Negative Talk.**

Examples	
Parent: (puts on lipstick) Do I look any better? Child: No. (NTA)	Parent: Is my drawing good? Child: Not really. (NTA)
Parent: Do you like my picture? Child: Yes. (PRO)	Parent: Mine's pretty, isn't it? Child: Uh-huh. (PRO)

- 19. The word “no” is sometimes coded as Prosocial Talk depending on the preceding parent verbalization or behavior.**

- a. When the parent issues a statement or question expressing a feeling, wish, or other internal state and the child responds to the parent's verbalization with “No” or its synonyms, the “No” is coded as Prosocial Talk.

Examples	
Parent: Don't these crackers taste great? Child: No. (PRO)	Parent: I need to put the plane's wings on better. Child: No, I want to fly it first. (PRO)
Parent: I'd like to work on the fort now. Child: No, let's finish building our house. (CM)	

- b. When a child uses the word “No” or its synonyms to indicate that a preceding statement by the parent is incorrect, the word “No” or its synonyms is coded as Negative Talk rather than Prosocial Talk, unless the child is contradicting a negative parent self-statement.

Examples	
Parent: He's the mechanic. Child: No, he's the car wash person. (NTA + PRO)	Parent: It's time to go now. Child: No, I haven't finished playing yet. (NTA + PRO)

- c. When a child responds to a parental command with “No” or its synonyms, it is always coded as Negative Talk regardless of subsequent compliance or other verbalizations by the child.

Examples	
Parent: Give me the blue one. Child: No, (1 sec) get it yourself. (NTA + CM)	Parent: Give me the blue one. Child: No, (no pause) the blue one is broken. (NTA + PRO)
Parent: Give me the blue one. Child: (says, “No” but hands parent blue crayon anyway). (NTA + CO)	

- 20. When Prosocial Talk is stated sarcastically, it is coded Negative Talk.**

Examples	
Parent: I finished mine first. Child: (sarcastic tone) Whoopy. (NTA)	Parent: This will be fun. Child: (sarcastically) Ri-ight. (NTA)

21. Phrases or words of Prosocial Talk that are appropriate answers to Information Questions are coded as Prosocial Talk (and the appropriate Response to IQ category is coded).

Examples	
Parent: What color do you want? Child: Red. (PRO/AN)	Parent: Which one is prettier? Child: I don't know. (PRO/AN)

22. Noncritical statements that describe what the parent is not doing are coded as Prosocial Talk.

Examples	
Parent: (building a paper airplane) Child: You're not using construction paper this time. (PRO) ----- OR: Child: You're using construction paper this time. (PRO)	Parent: (putting some Nesting Animals on the table) Child: You aren't putting out those sticky ones. (PRO) ----- OR: Child: You're putting out their new animals. (PRO)
Parent: (drawing rain in a picture) Child: You're not drawing the sun in this one. (PRO) ----- OR: Child: You're drawing a rainy day. (PRO)	

23. Statements beginning with “You can...” are Prosocial Talk only when the parent has already begun to perform the behavior described by the child in the “You can...” statement. Statements beginning with “You can...” are Prosocial Talk when the statement is in response to the parent's request for permission or for a specific suggestion about what to do. Statements beginning with “You can...” are Commands only when the parent has not sought direction and the parent has not actually begun to perform the behavior.

Examples	
Parent: (draws a dinosaur) Child: You can draw dinosaurs! (PRO) ----- BUT: Parent: What do you want me to draw now? Child: You can draw dinosaurs! (PRO)	Parent: (taking blocks from box) Child: You can take some. (PRO) ----- BUT: Parent: Can I take a few of those blocks? Child: You can take some. (PRO)

24. Statements beginning with “You are going to...” are coded as Prosocial Talk only when the parent has already initiated the behavior being described in the statement and when the statement does not contain a specific suggestion for a new or different behavior to be performed by the parent.

Examples	
Parent: (stacking Lincoln Logs) Child: You're going to make log piles. (PRO) ----- BUT: Child: (whining, “Gimme, gimme, gimme.”) Parent: (ignoring child) Child: You're going to give it to me. (CM)	Parent: (starting to draw a picture) Child: You're going to draw a picture. (PRO) ----- BUT: Parent: It's time to go home. Child: I want you to draw me another picture. Parent: (putting crayons in their box) Child: (yells, “You're going to draw a picture.”) (YE-CM)

25. Prosocial talk does not contain orders or demands.

- a. The generic use of “you” meaning “one” or “people” when providing information should not be confused with the “you” referring to a parent in a command.

Examples	
Dyad: (playing with blocks) Child: You make a tower like this (puts block on top of a block) (PRO) ----- BUT: Child: You can make a tower. (CM)	Child: (demonstrating how to use the elevator in toy garage) Child: (turning crank) You turn the handle to make the elevator go PRO. (PRO) ----- BUT: Child: Turn the handle, okay? (CM)

- b. A permission statement beginning with “You can...,” “You may...,” “You might...” or “You could...” and following a request for permission is Prosocial Talk. If a child offers an unsolicited permission statement, it is a Command

Examples	
Parent: Can I take these pieces? Child: You can take them. (PRO)	Parent: (reaching for green pieces) Child: You can take the red ones. (CM)
Parent: Can I take this blue one? Child: Take the blue one. (CM)	Parent: Is it okay if I draw a rake? Child: You could draw a rake. (PRO)
Child: You're dressing the doll. (PRO) ----- BUT: Child: You could dress the doll. (CM)	Child: You're moving next to my king. Parent: This doesn't count. Child: No, you're taking your turn. (NTA + PRO) ----- BUT: Child: It's your turn. Parent: I want to skip my turn. Child: No, you're taking your turn! (NTA + CM)
Parent: (watching child draw) Child: You could draw a rake if you want. (CM)	Parent: (watching child draw) Child: Draw a rake. (CM)

- c. Statements about future behaviors are Prosocial Talk when they describe what will likely happen in the future whereas they are commands when they directly instruct the parent to perform a future behavior.

Examples	
Parent: Tomorrow is the parent-teacher conference. Child: Tomorrow you get to go to my school. (PRO) ----- BUT: Child: Tomorrow you have to go to my school. (CM)	Parent: Here's my house. Child: You need a door on it. (PRO) ----- BUT: Child: You need to put a door on it. (CM)
Parent: I want to play with the Legos. Child: You'll make me clean them up. (Prediction; PRO)	

- 26. Some Prosocial Talk implicitly suggests that the parent should perform some behavior; however, a command is coded only when the statement contains a verb phrase calling for a vocal or motor behavior to be performed by the parent.**

Examples	
Dyad: (pushing race cars around track) Child: The blue one goes next. (PRO) ----- BUT: Child: Push the blue one next. (CM)	Dyad: (setting PRO checker board) Child: I want the red men. (PRO) ----- BUT: Child: I want you to give me the red men. (CM)
Parent: I found the chimney. Child: (points to roof top) It should go right here. (PRO) ----- BUT: Child: (points to roof top) We should put it here. (CM)	Parent: What do you want? Child: I want some gum. (PRO) ----- BUT: Child: Give me some gum. (CM)
Child: Will you hand me his nose? Parent: (looks through Mr. Potato Head's parts for 3 sec.) Child: A blue nose, please. (PRO)	NOTE: Child statements beginning with, "It's time for you to..." or "It's your turn to..." followed by an action verb are coded Prosocial Talk.

- 27. When a parent asks for direction with an Information Question, a direct answer is Prosocial Talk unless it contains an action verb directing the parent to perform a behavior.**

Examples	
Parent: What should I put up here? Child: A sun could go there. (PRO) ----- BUT: Child: Will you make a dinosaur? (CM)	Parent: Which color can I have? Child: Red. (PRO) ----- BUT: Child: Take red. (CM)
Parent: Where does this go? Child: On top. (PRO) ----- BUT: Child: Try the top. (CM)	

- 28. Statements that provide general rules for appropriate behavior can be Prosocial Talk, Commands, or Negative Talk.**

- a. A positively-worded statement that describes a rule about appropriate behavior in general, but does not imply that the parent's ongoing or just-completed behavior should be performed differently in the future, is Prosocial Talk.

Examples	
Parent: Someone scribbled in this coloring book. Child: People should color inside the lines. (PRO) ----- BUT: Parent: I'm going to draw rain and hail. Child: People should color inside the lines. (CM)	Parent: It's almost time to go home. Child: I'll put away the toys. Child: If you play with toys, you're supposed to pick them up. (PRO) ----- BUT: Parent: Pick up the toys by yourself. Child: You played with them too. Child: If you play with toys, you're supposed to pick them up. (CM)
Parent: Johnny's mother won't let him stay overnight. Child: Moms are supposed to be nice to their kids. (PRO) ----- BUT: Parent: Yea, I won. Child: Moms are supposed to be nice to their kids. (CM)	

- b. A negatively-worded statement (i.e., tells the parent what not to do) that describes a rule about appropriate behavior in general and that does not criticize the parent's ongoing or immediately completed behavior is Prosocial Talk.

Examples	
Child: Close your eyes, daddy. Child: You're not supposed to peek. (PRO)	Child: (sits in child-sized chair) Child: Grown-ups aren't allowed to sit in these. (PRO)
BUT: Child: (hides toy while parent watches) Child: You're not supposed to peek. (NTA)	BUT: Parent: (sits in child-sized chair) Child: Grown-ups aren't allowed to sit in those. (NTA)
Child: What did you learn at school today? Child: It's bad to tell a lie. (PRO)	
BUT: Parent: I don't have any money for Coke. Child: It's bad to tell a lie. (NTA)	

29. Phrases or words of Prosocial Talk that are appropriate answers to Information Questions are coded as Prosocial Talk.

Examples	
Parent: Where should I put this one? Child: I don't know. (AN + PRO)	Parent: What does Y. E. S. spell? Child: Yes. (AN + PRO)
	BUT: Parent: Isn't this fun? Child: Yes. (PRO)

30. Some conditional statements are Prosocial Talks.

- a. If a conditional statement specifies a natural consequence or a neutral child response that is likely to occur as a result of the parent's behavior, code Prosocial Talk.

Examples	
Child: If you let go of my hand I might get lost. (PRO)	Child: If you put the blocks together like this, they'll stay together better. (PRO)
Child: If you break these crayons, they won't have any good ones left. (PRO)	Child: The house will get built faster if you help me. (PRO)

- b. A conditional statement that refers to contingent good behavior or a reward from the child if the parent doesn't initiate a new aversive behavior is coded Prosocial Talk.

Examples	
Child: I'll clean PRO my room tonight if you don't make me eat broccoli for dinner. (PRO)	Child: If you don't make me sit in the corner today, I'll play any game you want. (PRO)

- c. Any conditional statement that indicates negative consequences to be applied to the parent by the child are Negative Talk, not Prosocial Talk.

Examples	
Child: If you don't start coloring like I asked, you're gonna get in trouble. (NTA)	Child: If you don't give me the crayons, you'll have to sit in the time-out chair. (NTA)
Child: If you color on my picture, I'll break all the crayons. (NTA)	

- d. In any conditional statements, if the statement contains elements of more than one DPICS category, the priority order for coding categories is used.

Examples	
Child: If you clean PRO the room this time, I'll do it next time. (CM)	Child: If you give me the horse you made, I'll make a picture for you. (CM)
BUT: Child: If you clean up your big mess over there, I'll pick up these blocks. (NTA)	BUT: Child: If you give me the neat horse you made, I'll make a picture for you. (PRO)
Child: If you'll give me the broken one, I'll fix it. (CM)	
BUT: Child: If you'll just shut PRO about it, I'll fix it. (NTA)	

31. A child's repetition or restatement of a parent's verbalization is coded as Prosocial Talk.

Examples	
Parent: I put the monkey in the tree. Child: He's in the tree. (PRO)	Parent: The horse is sleeping. Child: She's sleeping. (PRO)
Parent: I'm making the train track go through the tunnel. Child: The track is going through the tunnel. (PRO)	

32. If a child restates a parent's verbalization it is coded Prosocial Talk because it is a reflection. Any subsequent restatement of the parent's verbalization is coded the appropriate verbalization category, including Prosocial Talk if it is the equivalent of the parent categories TA, BD, UP, LP, or AK.

Examples	
Parent: I drew a bunny. Child: You drew a fluffy bunny. You drew a big fluffy bunny. (PRO + PRO)	Parent: Bert's driving the tractor to the barn. Child: He's driving the tractor. He's going to the barn. (PRO + PRO)
Dyad: (looking at clown picture) Parent: His collar has white and black circles. Child: It has big black polka dots. It's a black and white collar. (PRO + PRO)	Parent: I'm coloring my flag orange, blue, and white. Child: Orange and blue. You're coloring with my team colors. (PRO + PRO)

33. A child's repetition of a parent's description or suggestion for a future activity is a Command, not Prosocial Talk, when the repetition is directing the parent to do something.

Examples	
Parent: I'm going to take this race car apart. Child: You're going to take it apart. (PRO) ----- BUT: Child: Take it apart. (CM) ----- OR: Child: Why don't you take it apart? (CM)	Parent Let's color together. Child: You want to color. (PRO) ----- BUT: Child: Let's color. (CM)
Parent: I've got to fix this. Child: You think you've got to fix it. (PRO) ----- BUT: Child: You've got to fix it. (CM)	

- 34. When the child elaborates on a meaningful Prosocial Talk with words or phrases not containing verbs, the elaboration is coded as a separate verbalization only if it is separated by a pause of 2 second or longer and contains independent meaning.**

Examples	
Child: You're rolling the ball (2 sec.) down the ramp. (PRO + PRO) ----- BUT: Child: You're rolling the ball (1 sec.) down the ramp. (PRO)	Child: You're making the snake (3 sec.) long. (PRO + PRO) ----- BUT: Child: You're making the snake (no pause) long. (PRO)

TOUCH

Physical touch categories provide information regarding some of the non-verbal communication that takes place within the parent-child dyad. Any physical touch between the members of the dyad is coded, with the exception of accidental touch. Touches are categorized as Positive Touch (PTO) or Negative Touch (NTO).

NEGATIVE TOUCH (NTO)

Definition

A Negative Touch is any physical touch that is intended to be directive, antagonistic, aversive, hurtful, or restrictive of the child's activity.

Child Negative Touch Examples	
(slaps parent)	(pinches parent)
(touches tauntingly after parent says "Stop poking me")	(hits parent with Lincoln Log)
(kicks parent)	(snatches airplane out of parent's hand)
(throws character at parent but misses)	(holds parent's arm to prevent putting away toys)
(pulls parent's arm toward door)	(kicks parent three times in succession)
(grabs and bites parent's arm)	(touches parent's cheek when spitting at parent)
(knocks parent's hand making toy crash on floor)	(pushes parent into chair while saying "Sit down")

Decision rules

1. When uncertain whether physical contact has occurred, do not code either Positive Touch or Negative Touch.
2. When uncertain whether negative physical contact is accidental or intentional, do not code Negative Touch.
3. When uncertain whether physical contact has been negative or positive, code Positive Touch.
4. When uncertain whether Negative Touch is one or two occurrences, code one Negative Touch.

Child NTO Guidelines

1. **Any intentional touching of the parent by the child is coded either Positive Touch or Negative Touch. Neutral touch is coded Positive Touch. Accidental touching is not coded.**

Examples	
Child:	(hits parent) (NTO)
BUT:	Child: (hugs parent) (PTO)
	Child: (leans against parent while drawing) (PTO)
	Child: (hands parent a pencil) (not coded)
	Child: (incidentally touches parent while reaching across for object) (not coded)

2. It is often necessary to use context to determine whether child touch is coded Positive Touch or Negative Touch. When judgment is based on context, it is the intent of the child, rather than the effect on the parent, that is judged.

Examples	
Parent: (draws valentine for child) Child: (jumps onto parent's lap) I love you! (PTO + UP) Parent: (yells "Ouch")	Parent: Toss me a piece of track. Child: (tosses piece, which parent misses, accidentally hitting parent in face) (not coded)
BUT: Parent: Settle down. Child: (jumps into parent's lap) No! (NTO + NTA)	BUT: Parent: Your track is crooked. Child: (throws pieces of track at parent, which hits parent's face) (NTO)
Parent: (reaching to knock over tower) Child: (elbows parent to block parent from knocking over tower) (NTO)	
BUT: Dyad: (building tall block tower) Child: (grabs at falling tower and accidentally elbows parent) (not coded)	

3. A child Negative Touch includes Negative Touching of the parent with any part of the child's body or with an object.

Examples	
Child: (bites parent) (NTO)	Child: (pulls parent's hair) (NTO)
Child: (twists parent's finger) (NTO)	Child: (stands on parent's toe) (NTO)
Child: (strikes parent's hand with Lincoln Log) (NTO)	Child: (throws doll into parent's back) (NTO)
Child: (has hand-puppet hit parent's arm) (NTO)	Child: (hangs from mother's skirt) (NTO)

4. A child Negative Touch includes taking away an object that the parent is holding unless it occurs with implicit or explicit prior permission. NOTE: This rule does not apply to parents.

Examples	
Dyad: (playing with train set) Child: (grabs piece of track out of parent's hand while saying, "I need this piece.") (NTO+PRO)	Parent: (building a hotel with Lincoln logs) Child: (grabs chimney out of parent's fingers) You can't have this 'cuz you aren't doing it right. (NTO + NTA)

5. A child Negative Touch can be coded only if there is actual physical contact with the parent.

Examples	
Child: (swings fist and hits parent) (NTO) BUT: Child: (swings fist threateningly toward parent, but makes no physical contact) (not coded)	Child: (throws block at parent, hitting parent) (NTO) BUT: Dyad: (coloring) Parent: (reaches for more paper) Child: (pushes parent's hand away from paper) (NTO) BUT: Child: (pushes paper away from parent's hand) (not coded)

6. Any single type of Negative Touch that is **continuous** is coded only at its termination. Separate types of Negative Touch behaviors that occur simultaneously are coded separately.

Examples
Parent: It's time to clean up.
Child: (pulls parent's arm toward door) I want to leave! (PRO ; NTO not yet coded)
Child: (continues the pull on parent's arm) Let's go! (IC ; NTO not yet coded)
Child: (while still pulling on parent's arm, spits at parent) (NTO)
Child: (lets go of parent's arm) (NTO)

7. Any **discontinuous** type of Negative Touch that occurs repeatedly in rapid succession (< 2 sec. apart) is coded as one Negative Touch. If there is a pause of 2 seconds or longer between successive Negative Touches of the same type, a separate Negative Touch is coded for each series.

Examples
Child: (hitting parent's arm) (swat, swat, swat) (NTO)
Child: (hitting parent's arm) (swat, swat, swat, [2 sec. pause] swat, swat, swat) (NTO + NTO)
BUT: Child: (poking parent tauntingly) (poke, poke, poke, [no pause] kicks parent) (NTO + NTO)

8. If two (or more) distinct types of Negative Touch behavior begin and end simultaneously, only one Negative Touch is coded.

Examples
Child: (grabs and bites parent's arm at the same time) (NTO)
BUT: Child: (grabs parent's arm; 2 sec. pause; bites parent's arm) (NTO + NTO)

9. Child Negative Touch cannot be coded simultaneously with Positive Touch. If a child touches a parent gently while **simultaneously** delivering a Negative Touch, code Negative Touch.

Examples	
Child: (rests hand on parent's arm while hitting parent with other hand) (NTO)	Child: (hugs parent while simultaneously spitting in parent's face) (NTO)

10. A child Negative Touch can occur simultaneously with any verbalization of vocalization category.

Examples	
Child: (puts hand over parent's mouth while saying, "Shut up.") (NTO + NTA)	Child: (has "doll" shove parent, while saying in doll's voice, "Move over!") (NTO + PT)
Parent: (tries to take toy from child) I need this one. Child: (restrains parent's arm and says, "No, it's mine!") (NTO + NTA + PRO)	

11. Restricting activities of the parent by taking away objects directly touching the child are coded Negative Touch.

Examples
Child: (pulls Lincoln log from parent's grasp) (NTO)

POSITIVE TOUCH (PTO)

Definition

A Positive Touch is any intentional positive physical contact between parent and child.

Child Positive Touch Examples	
(puts arm around parent)	(rubs parent's arm)
(grabs parent's arm to keep from tripping)	(has teddy bear kiss parent's cheek)
(hugs parent who hugs child back)	(sits on parent's lap for 2 min.)
(pets parent's arm several times in quick succession)	(hugs and kisses parent)
(stands on box to hug parent)	(rubs father's stubbly cheek)
(playfully pokes parent's nose and laughs)	

Decision rules

1. When uncertain whether physical contact has occurred, do not code either Positive Touch or Negative Touch.
2. When uncertain whether positive physical contact is accidental or intentional, do not code Positive Touch.
3. When uncertain as to whether the contact has been positive or negative, code Positive Touch.
4. When uncertain whether Positive Touch is one occurrence or two, code one Positive Touch.

Child PTO Guidelines

1. **Any intentional touching of the parent by the child is coded either Positive Touch or Negative Touch. Incidental touching is not coded.**

Examples
Child: (hugs parent) (PTO)
Child: (hits parent) (NTO)
BUT: Child: (hands parent a car) (not coded)

2. **It is often necessary to use context to determine whether the touch is coded positive or negative. When judgment is based on context, it is the intent of the child, rather than the effect on the parent, that is judged.**

Examples	
Parent: (playing with Legos)	Parent: (gives child Tinker Toy rocketship)
Child: (gently touches parent) (PTO)	Child: (hugs parent) Neato! (PTO + UP)
BUT: Parent: Stop touching me!	BUT: Parent: Keep your hands to yourself.
Child: (gently touches parent) (NTO)	Child: (hugs parent with taunting laugh) (NTO)

3. A child **Positive Touch** includes both neutral and positive touching of the parent with any part of the child's body or with an object.

Examples	
Child: (climbs on parent's lap) Can I have a drink? (PTO + DQ)	Child: (tickles parent and laughs) (PTO + LA)
Child: (gently touches parent's lips with a toy) Kiss-kiss. (PTO + PT)	
BUT: Parent: May I have Big Bird? Child: (places Big Bird in parent's hand) (not coded)	

4. A child **Positive Touch** can be coded only if there is actual physical contact with the parent.

Examples	
Child: (kisses parent) (PTO)	Parent: You did great.
BUT: Child: (blows a kiss to parent) (not coded)	Child: (puts arm around parent) (PTO)
Parent: (gives child a doll) Her name is Sally. Child: (cuddles against parent) Thank-you. (PTO + UP)	BUT: Child: (claps hands together) (not coded)
BUT: Child: (cuddles doll) Thank-you. (UP)	

5. If a child **Positive Touch** is reciprocated by a parent **Positive Touch**, or vice versa, both the child **Positive Touch** and the parent **Positive Touch** are coded.

Examples	
Child: (hugs parent) (PTO)	Child: (kisses parent on cheek) (PTO)
Parent: (puts arms around child to hug back) (PTO)	Parent: (kisses child on cheek) (PTO)
Parent: Give me five! Dyad: (clap each other's hands) (PTO by child + PTO by parent)	

6. Any single type of **Positive Touch** that is continuous is coded only at its termination. Separate types of **Positive Touch** that occur simultaneously are also coded.

Examples	
Child: (climbs onto parent's lap) (not yet coded)	Child: (puts arm around parent) (not yet coded)
Child: (after 30 sec. of sitting on parent's lap, kisses parent) (PTO)	Child: (with arm still around parent, playfully touches parent's cheek) (PTO)
Child: (climbs off parent's lap) (PTO)	Child: (after 20 sec., removes arm from around parent) (PTO)

7. If two (or more) distinct types of **Positive Touch** behavior begin and end simultaneously, only one **Positive Touch** is coded.

Examples	
Child: (puts arms around parent and kisses parent at the same time) (PTO)	
BUT: Child: (puts arms around parent [2 sec.] kisses parent) (PTO + PTO)	

8. Any **discontinuous** type of **Positive Touch** that occurs repeatedly in rapid succession (< 2 sec. apart) is coded as one **Positive Touch**. If there is a pause of 2 seconds or longer between successive **Positive Touches** of the same type, a second **Positive Touch** is coded after each pause.

Examples	
Child: (patting parent's arm) (pat, pat, pat) (PTO)	Child: (patting parent's arm) (pat, pat, pat, [2 sec. pause] pat, pat, pat) (PTO + PTO)
Child: (patting parent's arm) (pat, pat, [2 sec.] pat, pat, pat, [4 sec.] pat, pat) (PTO + PTO + PTO)	

9. **Child Positive Touch** cannot be coded simultaneously with **Negative Touch**. If a child touches a parent while simultaneously delivering a **Negative Touch**, code **Negative Touch**.

Examples	
Child: (while sitting on parent's lap, slaps parent with other hand) (NTO)	Parent: We have to go now. Child: (wraps arms around parent's legs to keep parent from leaving) (NTO)

10. A **child Positive Touch** can occur simultaneously with any verbalization or vocalization category.

Examples	
Child: (touches parent's mouth while saying, "Here's your mouth.") (PTO + PRO)	Child: (hugs parent while saying, "I love you.") (PTO + UP)
Parent: Am I the best daddy? Child: (touches parent while saying, "Yes.") (PTO + UP)	Dyad: (sing, "Pat-a-cake" and clap each other's hands) (PT + PTO) (sing, "Pat-a-cake" and clap each other's hands) (PT + PTO) (sing, "Baker's man" and clap each other's hands) (PT + PTO) (sing, "Bake me a cake" and clap each other's hands) (PT + PTO) (sing, "As fast as you can" and clap each other's hands) (PT + PTO)

VOCALIZATIONS

Vocalizations refer to aspects of the tone of voice used in dyad verbal communications, including Laugh, Whine, and Yell. These vocalizations may impact the nature of the interaction positively or negatively. Note: Child Laugh is included in the supplemental coding system described in Appendix B. Parent Laugh is not included in the DPICS.

YELL (YE)

Definition

A Yell is a screech, scream, or shout, or any verbalization or vocalization that is so loud as to be aversive. Note: Parent Yell is included in the supplemental coding system described in Appendix B.

Decision rules

1. When uncertain whether or not a Yell has occurred, do not code Yell.
2. When uncertain as to whether a vocalization is a Whine or a Yell, code Whine.
3. When uncertain as to whether a vocalization is a Laugh or a Yell, code Laugh.

Child YE Guidelines

1. **A Yell is a vocalization that may occur simultaneously with a verbalization. When a child yells a verbalization (including sound effects), both the appropriate verbalization category and the vocalization (Yell) are coded.**

Examples	
Parent: (putting block on top of tower) Child: (screams, "Stop!") (YE-NTA)	Dyad: (playing game of checkers) Child: (shouts, "Yea, I won!") (YE-PRO)
Child: (pushes car into parent's car) Child: (makes loud crashing noise) (YE)	

2. **Vocalizations (i.e., Laugh, Whine, Yell) without intelligible content are coded the appropriate vocalization category and no verbalization category is coded.**

Examples	
Parent: I might tickle you! Child: (yells, "Augh!") (YE)	Parent: I'm the Lion King. Child: (giggles) (LA)
Parent: You shouldn't press so hard. Child: (whines, "Aaw.") (WH)	

3. **The affect expressed in a Yell may be either positive or negative. It is the potentially aversive loudness that characterizes a Yell.**

Examples	
Child: (finds rubber spider in toy box) Child: (unintelligible screech) (YE)	Parent: (pulls candy out of pocket for child) Child: (unintelligible scream) (YE)
Parent: (touches child lightly on arm) Child: (unintelligible yell) (YE)	

4. If a child vocalizes unintelligible yelling, one Yell is coded at the termination of the yelling episode. Each episode of yelling is terminated by either a verbalization or by a 2 second pause in yelling. When consecutive verbalizations are yelled, each verbalization is coded as a separate Yell.

Examples	
Parent: (tickles child) Child: (yells loud nonverbal sound for 3 sec.; 2 sec. pause; yells again) (YE + YE)	Dyad: (building very high tower that is teetering) Child: (makes unintelligible screech; yells, "It's falling!"; makes another unintelligible screech) (YE + YE-PRO + YE)
Child: (rolls dice) Child: (yells, "It's a six! It's a six!") (YE-PRO + YE-PRO)	Parent: (repeats a question for fifth time) Child: (yells, "I already told you! Quit asking me!") (YE-PRO + YE-NTA)

5. Even if a single vocalization contains elements of more than one vocalization category (i.e., Laugh, Whine, or Yell), it can only be coded as one type of vocalization. When a vocalization is both a yell and another vocalization category, Yell takes precedence.

Examples	
Parent: (reading funny story) Child: (laughs extremely loudly) (YE)	Parent: I want to play with the blocks. Child: (whines extremely loudly, "I don't want to play that.") (YE-PRO)

6. Yell is a vocal behavior and can occur simultaneously with a physical child behavior (i.e., Negative Touch or Positive Touch).

Example
Parent: (taking toy from table) Child: (yells, "That's mine!", and simultaneously grabs toy from parent) (YE-PRO + NTO)

WHINE (WH)

Definition

A Whine is an utterance or verbalization emitted in a slurring, moaning, high-pitched, or falsetto voice.

Note: Parent Whine is included in the supplemental coding system described in Appendix B.

Decision rules

1. When uncertain as to whether the, child's voice quality is actually a Whine or normal voice quality, do not code Whine.
2. When uncertain as to whether the vocalization is a Whine or a Yell, code Whine.
3. When uncertain as to whether a vocalization is a Whine or a Laugh, code Laugh.

Child WH Guidelines

1. **A Whine is a vocalization that may or may not occur simultaneously with a verbalization. When a child whines a verbalization, both the vocalization and the verbalization category are coded.**

Examples	
Parent: I want to color now. Child: (whines, "I'm sick.") (WH-PRO)	Parent: (knocks over house child was building) Child: (says in falsetto voice, "You're being mean.") (WH-NTA)

2. **Vocalizations (i.e., Laugh, Whine, Yell) without intelligible content are coded the appropriate vocalization category and no verbalization category is coded.**

Examples	
Parent: We have to go home. Child: (whines, "Ooo.") (WH)	Parent: This is a picture of our fish. Child: (laughs) (LA)
Parent: (grabs child's wrist and says, "Stop!") Child: (yells, "Aaugh!") (YE)	

3. **Voice quality is the primary distinguishing element for coding Whine. If the whine contains intelligible content, the content may be positive, negative, or neutral.**

Examples	
Parent: Put the toy on the table. Child: (whines, "But it's too heavy.") (WH-PRO)	Dyad: (building fort) Parent: Now we're going to put on the roof. Child: (whines, "But you're a better builder.") (WH-UP)
Parent: I want to play with the castle. Child: (whimpers, "You don't love me.") (WH-NTA)	

4. If a child vocalizes unintelligible whining, one Whine is coded at the end of the whining episode. Each episode of whining is terminated by either a verbalization or by a 2-second pause in whining.

Examples	
Parent: Honey, are you okay? Child: (unintelligible groan) (WH)	Parent: (ignoring child) Child: (unintelligible whine; 2 sec. pause; unintelligible whine) (WH + WH)
Child: (trying to get out of playroom) Child: (unintelligible whine; whines, "I want out;" unintelligible whine) (WH + WH-PRO + WH)	

5. Each whined verbalization constitutes a separate Whine. Whined fragments separated from one another by a pause of 2 seconds or longer are coded as separate Whines.

Examples	
Child: (whines, "I want it. I want it.") (WH-PRO + WH-PRO)	Child: (looking through blocks, whines, "I want..."; 3 sec. pause while child searches; whines, "I want to have it.") (WH + WH-PRO)

6. Whine is a vocalization and cannot be coded simultaneously with any other vocalization category (i.e., Yell, Laugh). If a child simultaneously whines and yells, code Yell. It is not possible for a vocalization to be both a Whine and a Laugh.

Examples	
Child: (yells in whining tone, "Quit it.") (YE-NTA)	Child: (whines very loudly, "I <u>want</u> that one!") (YE-PRO)
Child: (whines very loudly, "You ruined it!") (YE-NTA)	

7. Whine is a vocal behavior and can occur simultaneously with a physical child behavior (i.e., Negative Touch, Positive Touch).

Examples	
Child: (hugs parent and whines, "I want you to <u>held</u> me.") (PTO + WH-IC\NOC)	Child: (restrains parent's arm from building, while whining, "Don't put that there.") (NTO + WH-NTA)

Appendix A: ADVANCED CODING GUIDELINES

Coding the Time-Out (TO)

The five-minute observation periods are intended to capture specific types of interaction. Although rare, the occurrence of a time-out within the observation period significantly alters the dyadic interaction and therefore, is not coded as part of the 5min. observation period. The symbol (TO) can be used during coding to signify that a pause in coding has occurred because of a time-out. Within a five minute period of observation, if a child is sent to time-out by the parent, the coding of both parent and child behavior ceases beginning the moment the child enters time-out (e.g., sits on chair, stands in corner, goes into time-out room) and the timing of the five minute interaction is interrupted until the time-out episode has ended.

Coding of the parent-child interaction resumes most commonly when the parent verbally or physically releases the child from time-out. Coding begins with the first parent or child behavior that occurs following the parent's indicating that the child has completed time-out. If the child leaves time-out without permission, coding is not resumed unless it is clear that time-out is over 'as judged by the parent's lack of attempt to continue the time-out. This judgment is determined by whether the parent makes any physical attempts or statements related to returning the child to time-out. If the parent "gives up" trying to return the child to time-out, coding resumes with the parent behavior used to make the determination that the TO episode is finished*. Observers resume coding until they have coded a total of five minutes of interaction as defined in the three structured situations.

Parent: Hand me the box. (DC)
Child: (ignores parent for 5 sec.) (NC)
Parent: If you don't hand me the box, you'll have to sit on the time-out chair. (IC)
Child: (hands parent the box). (CO)
Parent: Thank you for handing me the box. (LP)
Parent: Give me the yellow crayon. (DC)
Child: (crawls under table and says, "No") (NC + NTA)
Parent: If you don't give me the yellow crayon, you'll have to sit on the timeout chair. (IC)
Child: Shut up. (NTA)
Parent: You didn't do what I told you to do, so now you'll have to go to the timeout chair (TA) (places child on time-out chair) (CODING CEASES)
Parent: (after the three minute time-out, says, "Are you ready to give me the yellow crayon?") (NOT CODED)
Child: (nods, "Yes" and is allowed off chair) (CODING RESUMES)
Child: (obeys original command) (not coded; no preceding command)
Parent: Thank you for handing me the crayon. (LP)
Parent: Would you help me build this? (IC)
Child: Do it yourself. (NTA)
Child: (doesn't help build) (NC)
Parent: Do you want to sit in the corner? (DQ)
Child: (doesn't help build)
Parent: (drags child to corner of room) (CODING STOPS)
Child: I hate you! (not coded)
Child: (leaves corner)
Parent: Get back there this minute! (not coded)
Child: (yells, "Make me!" and crawls under table) (not coded)
Parent: (ignores child for 10 sec.)
Parent: Would you rather play with the castle? (appears that parent has given up; RESUME CODING) (DQ)

*Coders coding from videotapes are advised to keep a log where they record which statement they used to resume coding after a time-out episode in order to maintain interobserver agreement.

Coding Conditional Statements

Conditional statements are vocalizations that generally take the form of "If ..., then" such as "If you are nice, then you will have more friends." These statements do not have to use the specific words "if" or "then," but the relationship between behavior or characteristic and consequence should be clear. Depending on

content, conditional statements may be coded as Direct Commands (**DC**), Indirect Commands (**IC**), Neutral Talk (**TA**), Labeled Praises (**LP**), or Negative Talk (**NTA**) for parents. For children, conditional statements may be coded as Command (**CM**), Prosocial Talk (**PRO**), or Negative Talk (**NTA**).

General rule: In all conditional statements, if the statement contains elements of more than one DPICS category, the priority order for coding categories is used.

Parent or Child Issued Statements			
If you. . .	Then I will. . .	Relative to	Code
Continue or initiate positive behavior	Reward	Ongoing behavior or behavior child may initiate in the future	IC (Parent) CM (Child)
Do not initiate or fail to continue a behavior	Issue conventional negative consequence	Behavior to be initiated or continued	IC or DC (Parent) CM (Child)
Any behavior	Give neutral remark or consequence	Any behavior	TA (Parent) PRO (Child)
Do not initiate an aversive behavior	Reward	A behavior not yet initiated	TA (Parent) PRO (Child)
Continue negative behavior	Apply a conventional negative consequence	Behavior just started, ongoing, or just completed	NTA
Stop an ongoing negative behavior	Reward	Behavior just started, ongoing, or just completed	NTA
Stopping a behavior just started, ongoing, or just completed	Give natural consequences	Behavior just started, ongoing, or just completed	NTA
Child Issued Statements			
Stop a behavior	Reward	Parent behavior just started, ongoing, or just completed	NTA
Stop, start, or continue any parent behavior	Punish	Any prior, current, or future parent behavior	NTA
Parent Issued Statements			
Any child behavior	Nonspecific or unconventional parent-imposed negative consequence	Any child behavior	NTA

* Neutral Talk in the form of conditional statements are coded Labeled Praise (**LP**) if they contain a positive evaluation of the child's specific behavior, activity, or product.

Verbalizations/Vocalizations that are not coded

The goal of the DPICS is to describe the parent-child interaction. In the course of an observation, however, some verbalizations and vocalizations may be present which do not contribute to the interaction. These vocalizations and verbalizations are not coded.

Guidelines for *No Code*

- 1. Incomplete statements are not coded. A statement is considered incomplete if it is meaningless as stated or if it is clear the speaker did not finish their thought.**

Examples	
Parent: Why don't you . . . (not completed) (no code)	Parent: Get me . . . umm . . . (2 sec.) Hand me the block. (no code + DC)
Child: How bout . . . (tower falls) Now we'll have to make a new one (no code + CM)	Child: I'm going to . . . (2 sec.) I'm going to get the barn (no code + PRO)

- 2. Statements parents make to themselves, such as "thinking aloud" comments, are not coded. It must be clear that the comment is not intended for the child for no code to be given. Exception: Statements made when the child is being actively ignored but are clearly intended for the child to hear may be coded as the appropriate category.**

Examples	
Parent: (building tower while child is in time-out, tower falls) Oops. (no code) ----- BUT: Child: (kicking the wall) Parent: (ignoring child while playing with blocks) I'm having so much fun playing with these blocks! (TA)	Dyad: (sitting next to each other at table playing with gears) Parent: (bumps knee on table) Ouch. (no code) ----- BUT: Child: (points to band-aid on his arm) Parent: Ouchie. (TA) ----- BUT: Parent: (burps) Excuse me. (TA)
Parent: (talking to clinician in observation room) How do you get this thing to stay in your ear? (no code)	Parent: Oh! That was a question! (no code)
Parent: (bending over, digging in toy box): I don't know if . . . wait, no, that's not the one either (no code)	

- 3. Random noises and sound effects are not coded**

Examples	
Child: (building with blocks) bum-bum-di-po-dee (no code) ----- BUT: Parent: (making funny face) Child: Yuck! (NTA)	Child: (playing with toy food): brrrrrrrrrrrr rrrrr rrrr brrrr rrrr (no code) ----- BUT: Child: (flying toy airplane around room) brrrrrrrrrrrr rrrrr rrrr brrrr rrrr (PT) Child: (singing) Zip-a-dee-doo-dah (PT)

Coding compound sentences

1. When two complete sentences are joined by “and” or ‘but,’ each sentence is coded independently.

Examples	
Parent: Hand me a red one but first put the green one away. (DC + DC)	Parent: Put the flowers here and put the grass here. (DC + DC)
Parent: Give me the big car but why don't you put the little cars away first. (DC + IC)	Parent: Take off her red hat and put on her black hat, okay? (DC + IC)
Dyad: (playing with waffle blocks) Child: Your fort is cool and -it has neat windows in it. (PRO + PRO) ----- BUT: Child: Your fort is cool and it has windows in it. (PRO + PRO)	Parent: (drawing picture of sailboat) Child: The boat is neat and it has a fantastic sail. (PRO + PRO) Child: The boat is in high waves and you're making a fantastic sail (PRO + PRO)
Child: Will you give me the truck and I'm going to drive to the circus. (CM + PRO).	Child: You have all the big logs and what are you going to make? (PRO + QU)
Parent: Here's the princess. Child: She <u>is</u> a princess, but she doesn't have a crown. (PRO + PRO)	Parent: What color is this? Child: Blue, and what color is this? (PRO + QU)
Dyad: (playing with wooden pegs and hammer) Child: You hammered the wood and you made it flat. (PRO + PRO)	Dyad: (coloring) Child: You're making an apple but you're coloring it brown. (PRO + PRO)
Dyad: (playing with doll house) Child: You're putting her in bed and tucking her in. (PRO + PRO)	Dyad: (playing with Tinker Toys) Child: You're sticking in red ones and putting yellow ones on the end. (PRO + PRO)
Parent: (playing with toy garage) Child: You put the car in the elevator and went to the roof and parked by the sign. (PRO + PRO + PRO)	Dyad: (working on puzzle box) Child: You're putting in big ones, but giving me the hard ones. (PRO + PRO)
Dyad: (drawing on Magna Doodle) Child: Going up to the top and going over to that corner and going down to the bottom. (PRO + PRO + PRO)	Parent: I'm putting Mr. Potato Head's purse on. Child: Okay, but it's Mrs. Potato Head's. (PRO + PRO)
Parent: (playing with Nesting Animals) Child: You're putting the mouse in the chicken, but I want to do it. (PRO + PRO)	Parent: (playing with alphabet blocks) Child: You're spelling my name and how do you spell your name? (PRO + QU)
Parent: (accidentally tears drawing paper) Child: You ripped your paper, but you can still use it. (PRO + CM)	Parent: (coloring) Child: You're drawing on my picture but you're ruining it. (PRO + NTA)
Parent: (builds windmill) Child: Awesome and you're turning it. (PRO + PRO)	Parent: Now I'm doing the roof. Child: Okay, (2 sec.) and you're making it orange. (PRO + PRO)
Parent: (stacking blocks) Child: You're putting the blue one on, and whoops! (PRO + PRO)	Dyad: (building with Lincoln logs) Child: You built a house but there's no people. (PRO + PRO)
Parent: Did I do it right? Child: You did the building right and you're doing good. (PRO + PRO) ----- BUT: Child: You did it just like I wanted, and it turned out great. (PRO + PRO)	

2. When two complete phrases are joined by “so” or “because”, only the phrase that does not include “so” or “because” is coded.

Examples	
Parent: Please put the toys in the toybox because it's time for us to leave. (DC)	Child: I want to go to McDonald's so I can play on the slide. (PRO)
Parent: How about a yellow one so we can put a yellow roof on it? (DQ)	Child: Take me home 'cause I don't like playing here. (CM)

3. If a statement contains two or more meaningful verb phrases, both phrases are coded.

Examples	
Child: You're drawing wonderful squiggles and coloring them with pretty colors. (PRO + PRO)	Child: I like how you're working and singing that cool song. (PRO + PRO)
Child: It's neat how you're drawing those bugs and being so much fun today. (PRO + PRO)	Child: The way you're drawing those dinosaurs and coloring them in is so awesome. (PRO + PRO)
Child: Thank you for giving me the wrecker and showing me where the hook goes. (PRO + PRO)	Child: You're being nice and being fun today. (PRO + PRO)
BUT: Child: Thank you for giving me the wrecker and the car. (PRO)	BUT: Child: You're being nice and so much fun today. (PRO)
Child: You're brushing her hair, putting on her barrette, making her look pretty. (PRO + PRO + PRO)	Child: We're building a track, making it go around us, making it long. (PRO + PRO + PRO)
Child: I like that you take my hand and put a sticker on, it. (PRO + PRO)	Parent: (playing with garage)
BUT: Child: I like that you take and put stickers on my hand. (PRO)	Child: It's fun when you play trucks with me and when you act like Big Bird. (PRO + PRO)
	BUT: Child: You're funny when you act like Big Bird. (PRO)

4. In sentences containing two or more verb phrases that are joined by “and,” if the sentence begins with a phrase that changes the meaning of the first verbalization to another verbalization

category (e.g., from command to question), it also changes the meaning of the second verbalization unless there is a clear inflection and a 2-second pause indicating that the “and” starts a new sentence.

Examples	
Parent: Do you want to get the crayons and draw a picture? Coded as: Do you want to get the crayons (DQ) AND (Do you want to) draw a picture? (DQ) ----- BUT: Parent: Do you want to get the crayons? (2 sec. pause) And draw a picture. (DQ + DC)	Parent: I hoped that you would draw a rabbit and give it to Mom for a present. Coded as: I hoped that you would draw a rabbit (TA) AND (I hoped you would) give it to Mom for a present. (TA) ----- BUT: Parent: I hoped that you would draw a rabbit. (pause) And give it to Mom for a present. (TA + DC)
Parent: It's time to take him apart and put him in the container. Coded as: It's time to take him apart (TA) AND (it's time to) put him in the container. (TA) ----- BUT: Parent: It's time to take him apart. And put him in the container. (TA + DC)	Parent: Will you pick up the can and dump out the toys? Coded as: Will you pick up the can? (IC) AND (Will you) dump out the toys? (IC) ----- BUT: Parent: Will you pick up the can? (looks for place to dump the toys) And dump out the toys. (IC + DC)

5. In sentences that contain two or more verb phrases in Parent Direct Command form joined by “and,” but the verb phrases refer to a single child behavior, both verb phrases are coded Parent Direct Command. (Note: see Child Response to Command Guidelines to code the child’s response). Likewise, in sentences that contain two or more verb phrases in Child Command form joined by “and,” but the verb phrases refer to a single parent behavior, both verb phrases are coded Child Command.

Examples	
Dyad: (stacking Waffle Blocks to build a building) Parent: Put this one on top and make the fifth story. (DC + DC\NOC)	Child: This is rabbit. Parent: Give the rabbit a name, but make it a funny name. (DC + DC\NOC)
Parent: (playing with farm house) Child: Put the cowboy to bed and let him sleep. (CM + CM\NOC)	

6. When a Direct Command is joined to another complete verbalization by “and” or “but,” both the command and the other verbalization category are coded.

Examples	
Parent: It's pretty, but you need to finish it. (UP + DC)	Parent: Draw a heart and how about using red? (DC + IC)
Parent: Put it here, but what's this part? (DC + IQ)	Parent: You're building a fort, but take it down. (BD + DC)
Parent: It's tall and you need to be careful. (TA + DC)	Parent: Put that piece here and don't mess it up. (DC + NTA)
Parent: Sit down and shut up. (DC + NTA)	Parent: Take it out, but isn't that broken? (DC + DQ)
Parent: (talking for self) Put the throne down, (talking for queen doll) and let me sit on it. (DC + PT)	

7. A unit of verbal behavior is defined as one sentence (i.e., a complete thought).

- a. Each conceptually self-contained unit of meaning is coded as a separate verbalization.

Examples	
Dyad: (playing with alphabet blocks) Parent: I spelled my name. Child: (pointing to each block) M. O. M. (PRO+PRO+PRO)	Parent: Give me the orange ones. Child: (handing orange sticks to parent while saying, "One. Two. Three.") (PRO+PRO+PRO)
BUT: Child: You spell "Mom" M, O, M. (PRO)	BUT: Parent: Count to three. Child: One, two, three. (PRO)
Parent: Name these letters. Child: P. L. D. B. (PRO + PRO + PRO + PRO)	Parent: (pointing to picture of flowers) What colors are in this picture?
BUT: Parent: Say the alphabet. Child: A, B, C, D, E, F. (PRO)	Child: Pink. Blue. Green. (PRO + PRO + PRO)
	BUT: Child: Pink and blue and green. (PRO) Child: I see pink, blue and green. (PRO)

- b. Meaningful verbalizations strung together but separated by a pause of 2 seconds or longer are coded as separate sentences. Sentence fragments with no meaning are not coded.

Examples	
Parent: (shows child a family picture) Who is this? Child: There's me and dad and you. (PRO)	Parent: (playing with two figures) Child: That's Bert and Ernie. (PRO)
OR: Child: There's me and dad. (drops picture and takes > 2 sec. to pick it up) And you. (PRO + PRO)	OR: Child: That's Bert (2 sec.) and Ernie. (PRO + PRO)
	BUT: Child: That's (2 sec.) Bert and Ernie. (PRO)
Parent: How many pieces are left? Child: One, two (2 sec. pause while child looks for more) three, four. (PRO + PRO)	

- c. When a child begins a verbalization but pauses before the completion of a meaningful thought, one verbalization is coded if the child completes the thought, regardless of the length of the pause.

Examples	
Child: I think you're (5 sec.) coloring it purple. (PRO)	Child: It looks like (2 sec.) you're drawing a key. (PRO)
BUT: Child: I think you're coloring it (5 sec.) purple. (PRO + PRO)	BUT: Child: It looks like you're drawing (2 sec.) a key. (PRO + PRO)

- d. If the child issues an intervening verbalization during the pause between parts of the child's initial verbalization, both parts of the verbalization must be considered separately and coded based on their independent meaning. A sentence fragment containing no independent meaning is not coded.

Examples	
Child: It looks like you're taking...	Child: We're stacking our blocks...
Child: That's green.	Parent: (hands child a drink)
Child: ... the red ones for the roof. (first part not coded + PRO + PRO)	Child: Thanks.
	Child: .. in a tower. (PRO + PRO + PRO)
	BUT: Child: You're walking the bear through...
	Parent: It's a rhino.
	Child: ... the grass. (PRO)

8. When a child issues a series of phrases, each phrase may be coded Prosocial Talk even if a verb is absent.

Examples	
Child: You're putting on the green one (2 sec.) putting on the blue one (3 sec.) putting on the red one. (PRO + PRO + PRO)	Child: You're driving the car (1 sec.) driving to the house (1 sec.) parking in front. (PRO + PRO + PRO)

9. In sentences containing two or more verb phrases in Parent Direct Command or Child Command form that are joined by “and,” where one verb phrase does not contain independent meaning, only one command is coded.

Examples	
Parent: Take and put the eyes on Mrs. Potato Head. (DC)	Parent: Try and color it red. (DC)
Child: Look and see if it's under the table. (CM)	Child: Check and see what time it is. (CM)

Appendix B: SUPPLEMENTAL CATEGORIES

PARENT CATEGORIES

Play Talk	Answer	Compliance
Yell	No Answer	Noncompliance
Whine	No Opportunity for Answer	No Opportunity for Compliance

PLAY TALK (PT)

Definition

Play Talk is any verbal or vocal behavior that is not a direct form of verbal communication from one person to the other.

Parent Play Talk Examples	
(talking for King doll) Kneel before me.	(talking for rabbit) What's up doc?
(puts bottle in baby doll's mouth) Drink your milk.	(trying to pull apart Legos) What's wrong with you?
(talking into toy telephone) Hello?	(playing with toy plane) Vroom!
(moving toy pig) Oink-oink.	(singing) "Mary had a little lamb..."
(reciting) Jack and Jill went up the hill...	(reading words in book) "I will not eat green eggs..."
(reading) "A is for Apple"	(yells) Bombs away!
(talking as whining doll) I'm hungry.	(parent's dinosaur rips paper) Grrrr!
Three blind mice, See how they run	Jack be nimble, Jack be quick

Decision Rules

1. When uncertain as to whether the verbalization is Play Talk or another DPICS category, do not code Play Talk.
2. When uncertain as to whether the parent has made one or more than one distinct sound effect Play Talks, code one Play Talk.

Parent PT Guidelines

1. Play Talk includes verbalizations spoken directly to a toy or object in which the parent addresses the toy or object by name.

Examples	
Parent: (puts doll in bed)	Parent: (trying to take Big Bird up the elevator)
Parent: I'll see you tomorrow, Miss Tabitha. (PT)	Parent: Get in there, Big Bird. (PT)
Parent: (drawing characters on the Magna Doodle)	
Parent: Where did you come from, Hammerhead? (PT)	

2. **Play Talk includes any verbalization stated as “pretend talk”, where the parent is talking as a toy or character other than him or herself. Talking as a toy or character is recognized by a) a change in voice quality, or b) synchronous movement of the toy with the verbalization. If you cannot see that the parent is moving a toy with their verbalization, do not code Play Talk.**

Examples	
Parent: (talking in “fairy princess” voice) Hello there, little girl. (PT)	Parent: (talking in “monster” voice) Shall I eat you? (PT)
Parent: (while moving plastic figure back and forth) I'm going to hit you. (PT)	Parent: (moving doll up and down) I don't want you to go home now. (PT) Child: (talking in “child doll” voice) I hate you, daddy. ----- OR: Parent: (talking in “parent doll” voice) You're a bad boy. (PT) ----- BUT: Parent (talking in own voice about doll) He's a bad boy. (TA)

3. **Play Talk includes talk as a character in a make-believe play. Code Play Talk only when you are certain the parent's verbalization is “in role”.**

Examples
Dyad: (talking into toy telephones) Parent: Hello? (PT) Child: Hello. Parent: How are you? (PT) Child: I'm fine. How are you? Parent: I'm fine, too. Goodbye. (PT + PT)

4. **Play Talk includes singing and reciting poems or nursery rhymes. Direct communication made in a sing-song voice and humming are not coded Play Talk.**

Examples	
Child: I've got the boat. Parent: (singing) Row, row, row your boat ... (PT) ----- BUT: Child: (picking up Legos) Parent: (singing) You are doing a great job! (UP)	Child: Hickory, dickory, dock Parent: The mouse ran up the clock. (PT)

5. **Play Talk includes reading text.**

Examples	
Dyad: (looking at primer) Parent: (reading) “See Jane run. See Spot run.” (PT + PT)	Dyad: (reading from book) Child: “A is for apple.” Parent: “B is for ball.” (PT) ----- BUT: Dyad: (playing with alphabet blocks) Child: (points to “A” on block) What's this? Parent: A. (TA) ----- OR: Parent: A is for apple. (TA)

6. Individual sentences of direct communication to the child that incorporate Play Talk fragments are not coded as Play Talk.

Examples	
Child: What does this say? Parent: It says, "The balloons floated up." (TA) BUT: Parent: (reads) "The balloons floated up." (PT)	Dyad: (looking at storybook) Parent: These words say, (reading) "Where is Piglet's hat?" (TA) BUT: Parent: (continuing to read) "I hid it, said Rabbit." (PT)
Child: What does the rooster say? Parent: It says, (crowing) "Cock-a-doodle-do." (TA) BUT: Parent: (crowing) "Cock-a-doodle-do." (PT)	Child: We sang the alphabet. Parent: Did you learn (sings) "a, b, c, d, e, f, g" ? (DQ) BUT: Parent: (sings) "A, b, c, d, e, f, g." (PT)

7. Physical behavior categories (Negative Touch, Positive Touch) are not coded as Play Talk, even if the "toy" is engaging in the physical behavior.

Examples	
Parent: (pretending his/her puppet is hitting child) (NTO)	Parent: (touches child's face with puppet) He's kissing you. (PTO + TA)

8. When Play Talk verbalizations or vocalizations occur in a series, use the one sentence rule and 2 second rule to determine when one Play Talk ends and the next one begins. For standard rhymes and songs, each "line" is considered a sentence.

Examples	
Child: (draws a star) Parent: (sings) Twinkle, twinkle, little star/How I wonder what you are/ Up above the world so high / Like a diamond in the sky / Twinkle, twinkle, little star / How I wonder what you are (PT + PT + PT + PT + PT + PT)	Child: Do the church one. Parent: (uses fingers to illustrate) Here is the church And here is the steeple Open the door And see all the people (PT + PT + PT + PT)
Parent: (sings) Twinkle, twinkle, little star How I wonder (pause 3 sec. to pick up paper that dropped) what you are. (PT + PT + PT)	

YELL (YE)

Definition

A Yell is a screech, scream, or shout, or any verbalization or vocalization that is so loud as to be aversive.

Decision rules

1. When uncertain whether or not a Yell has occurred, do not code Yell.
2. When uncertain as to whether a vocalization is a Whine or a Yell, code Whine.

Parent YE Guidelines

1. **A Yell is a vocalization that may or may not occur simultaneously with a verbalization. When a parent yells a verbalization, both the vocalization and the appropriate verbalization category are coded.**

Examples	
Child: (starts to jump from table to parent's lap) Parent: (screams, "Stop!") (YE-NTA)	Child: (wins game of checkers) Parent: (shouts, "Yea, Johnny!") (YE-UP)
Child: (starting to pull bottom block from high tower) Parent: (yells, "Holy cow!") (YE - TA) ----- BUT: Parent: (working alone in corner of the room, sees tower about to fall) Parent: (yells, "Holy cow!") (YE)	Child: I spilled it on your coat. Parent: (whines, "Oh no!") (WH - TA) ----- BUT: Parent: (spills own drink on coat) Parent: (whines, "Oh no!") (WH)
Child: (pushes car into parent's car) Parent: (makes loud crashing noise) (YE-PT)	

2. **Vocalizations (i.e., Whine, Yell) without intelligible content are coded the appropriate vocalization category and no verbalization category is coded.**

Examples	
Child: (pretends to be a shark) Parent: (yells, "Aaugh!") (YE)	Child: You're losing! Parent: (whines, "Ooo.") (WH)

3. **The affect expressed in a Yell may be either positive or negative. It is the potentially aversive loudness that characterizes a Yell.**

Examples	
Child: (finds rubber snake and puts it in front of parent) Parent: (unintelligible screech) (YE)	Child: (puts surprise birthday present on table) Parent: (unintelligible scream) (YE)
Child: (hits parent with Lincoln Log) Parent: (unintelligible yell) (YE)	

4. If a parent vocalizes unintelligible yelling, one Yell is coded at the end of the yelling episode. Each episode of yelling is terminated by either a verbalization or by a 2 second pause in yelling.

Examples	
Child: (tickling parent) Parent: (yells loud unintelligible sound for 3 sec.; 2 sec. pause; yells again) (YE + YE)	Child: (building very high tower that is teetering) Parent: (makes unintelligible screech; yells, "It's falling!"; makes another unintelligible screech) (YE + YE-TA + YE)

5. When consecutive verbalizations are yelled, each verbalization is coded as a separate Yell.

Examples	
Child: (rolls dice) Parent: (yells, "It's a six! It's a six!") (YE-TA + YE-TA)	Child: (repeats a question for fifth time) Parent: (yells, "I already told you! Quit asking me!") (YE-TA + YE-NTA)

6. Even if a single vocalization contains elements of more than one vocalization category (i.e., Whine or Yell), it can only be coded as one type of vocalization. When a vocalization is both a yell and another vocalization category, Yell takes precedence.

Example
Child: I want to play with the Legos. Parent: (whines extremely loudly, "I don't want to play that.") (YE-TA)

7. Yell is a vocal behavior and can occur simultaneously with a physical parent behavior (i.e., Negative Touch or Positive Touch).

Examples	
Child: (breaks toy) Parent: (yells, "Bad boy!" and simultaneously slaps child) (YE-NTA + NTO)	Child: I finished it. Parent: (while yelling, "Great!", hugs child) (YE-UP + PTO)

WHINE (WH)

Definition

A Whine is an utterance or verbalization emitted by the parent in a slurring, moaning, high-pitched, or falsetto voice.

Decision rules

1. When uncertain as to whether the parent's voice quality is actually a Whine or normal voice quality, do not code Whine.
2. When uncertain as to whether the vocalization is a Whine or a Yell, code Whine.

Parent WH Guidelines

1. A Whine is a vocalization that may or may not occur simultaneously with a verbalization. When a parent whines a verbalization, both the vocalization and the verbalization category are coded.

Examples	
Child: Daddy is more fun. Parent: (whines, "You hurt my feelings.") (WH-TA)	Child: (knocks over house mother was building) Parent: (says in falsetto voice, "You're mean.") (WH-NTA)
Dyad: (drawing a man) Child: (draws a frown on the face) Parent: (says in baby-talk, "Do you want him sad?") (WH-DQ)	

2. Vocalizations (i.e., Whine, Yell) without intelligible content are coded the appropriate vocalization category and no verbalization category is coded.

Examples	
Child: I'm not playing with you. Parent: (unintelligible whine) (WH)	Child: (jumps up from under table and yells, "Boo!") Parent: (unintelligible Yell) (YE) ----- BUT: Child: You can be the baby. Parent: (bounces baby doll and has it whine unintelligibly, "Wa-Augh") (WH-PT)

3. Voice quality is the primary distinguishing element for coding Whine. If the Whine contains intelligible content, the content may be positive, negative, or neutral.

Examples	
Child: I have to go to the bathroom. Parent: (moans, "It's all the way down the hall.") (WH-TA)	Child: Mine's better than yours. Parent: (whimpers, "I guess yours is prettier.") (WH-UP)
Child: I get two turns. Parent: (whines, "You're not playing fair.") (WH-NTA)	

4. If a parent vocalizes unintelligible whining, one Whine is coded at the onset of the whining episode. Each episode of whining is terminated by either a verbalization or by a 2-second pause in whining.

Examples	
Child: Mom, are you okay? Parent: (unintelligible groan) (WH)	Child: (cheating by moving checkers backward) Parent: (unintelligible whine; 2 sec. pause; unintelligible whine) (WH + WH)
Child: (refusing to help clean up toys) Parent: (unintelligible whine; whines, "I need help;" unintelligible whine) (WH + WH-TA + WH)	

5. Each whined verbalization constitutes a separate Whine. Whined fragments separated from one another by a pause of 2 seconds or longer are coded as separate Whines.

Examples	
Child: (scribbling on mother's drawing) Parent: (whines, "Stop it. Stop it.") (WH-NTA + WH-NTA) Parent: (whines, "Stop it;" 2 sec. pause; whines, "Stop it.") (WH-NTA + WH-NTA)	Child: Where is your coin purse? Parent: (while looking in purse, whines, "I can't..."; 3 sec. pause while mother searches; whines, "I can't find it.") (WH + WH-TA)

6. Whine cannot be coded simultaneously with another vocalization category (Yell). If a parent simultaneously whines and yells, code Yell.

Examples	
Parent: (yells in whining tone, "Don't do that.") (YE-NTA)	Parent: (whines very loudly, "I want that one!") (YE-TA)
Parent: (whines very loudly, "You ruined it!") (YE-NTA)	

7. Whine can occur simultaneously with a physical parent behavior (i.e., Negative Touch, Positive Touch).

Examples	
Parent: (hugs child and whines, "I want you to play nice.") (PTO + WH-IC/NOC)	Parent: (restrains child's hand from coloring on table, while whining, "Don't color on the table.") (NTO + WH-NTA)

RESPONSE TO QUESTIONS

Response to Question categories (Answer, No Answer, or No Opportunity for Answer) are coded based on the events that occur during the 5-second interval immediately following any child Question. In addition to coding the type of response to the question, the content (i.e., verbalization category) and, if applicable, the tone (i.e., vocalization category) of the answer are also coded.

GENERAL PARENT RESPONSE TO QUESTIONS GUIDELINES

1. When a parent's response to a child Question is also a codable verbalization category (e.g., Information Question, Descriptive Statement), code both the verbalization category and the applicable response to question category.

Examples	
Parent: (reading a book) Child: What's that story about? Parent: It's about a frog prince. (AN + TA)	Child: Where should I put this sun? Parent: Put it at the top. (AN + DC)
Child: Which one is Ernie? Parent: I want to see Big Bird. (NA + TA)	Child: What can I draw? Parent: Don't draw on my papers. (NA + NTA)
Child: Where is the littlest one? Parent: Is it this one? (AN + DQ)	Child: Where does this train go? Parent: (points to track while saying, "Don't do it too fast.") (AN + NTA)
Child: Do you have a red one? Parent: Yes. (AN + TA)	Child: Am I the prettiest? Parent: Yes. (AN + UP)

2. If the parent's response to a child Question is whined or yelled, code the vocalization category as well as the applicable response to question category.

Examples	
Child: Why do I have to clean up by myself? Parent: (whines, "Because they said I can't help.") (AN + WH + TA)	Child: Where are you going? Parent: (yells, "To sit down.") (AN + YE + TA)
Parent: (playing with child's log cabin) Child: What are you doing? Parent: (yells, "Nothing!") (NA + YE-TA)	Child: What toy do you want to play with? Parent: (whining, "I'm too tired.") (NA + WH-TA)

3. If a response to a child Question (or lack thereof) occurs simultaneously with a physical behavior category, code both the applicable response category and the physical behavior category.

Examples	
Child: Where does the red one go? Parent: (no answer and grabs toy from child's hand) (NA + NTO)	Child: What do I do now? Parent: (ruffles child's hair while saying, "I love you.") (NA + UP + PTO)
Child: What else do I have to clean up? Parent: This one. (pushes toy container to child, hitting child with it) (AN + TA + NTO)	Child: Where is my belly button? Parent: (tickles child on the stomach gently) (AN + PTO)

4. **Answers to questions do not have to be the correct answer. Code Answer if the parent appears to have attempted to respond with the requested information. Nonspecific answers such as “I don't know,” and “Anywhere” may be acceptable as answers to child Questions. If it is unquestionably clear that the parent is providing a deliberately wrong answer, code No Answer.**

Examples	
Child: What am I getting for my birthday? Parent: A scooter. (AN + TA) ----- BUT: Parent: (smiles and says, “Some broccoli.”) (NA + TA)	Child: How much is two plus two? Parent: Four. (AN + TA) ----- BUT: Parent: (smirks and says, “Six thousand.”) (NA + NTA)
Child: (drawing circle) What shape is this? Parent: (covers eyes and says, “Square. I mean a rectangle. I mean a trapezoid.”) (NA + TA + TA + TA) ----- BUT: Parent: (asks genuinely, “An oval?”) (AN + DQ)	Child: Why does it rain? Parent: (says sarcastically) “To scare bad children like you.” (NA + NTA) ----- BUT: Parent: To help the plants grow. (AN + TA)
Child: What did they do with the transformers? Parent: (searches through toy box and says, “I don't know.”) (AN + TA) ----- BUT: Parent: (turns back on child and says in angry tone, “I don't know.”) (NA + TA)	Child: How come these crayons don't have paper on them? Parent: I'm not sure. (AN + TA) ----- BUT: Parent: How should I know! (NA + NTA)
Child: What's in the box? Parent: (turns back on child and says, “Who cares?”) (NA + NTA) ----- BUT: Parent: (looking in box) I can't tell. (AN + TA)	Child: How do you make a castle? Parent: (pushes pieces away and says in angry tone, “I don't know.”) (NA + TA) ----- BUT: Parent: (picks up a piece and says, “I don't know.”) (AN + TA)

5. **When one sentence contains a series of questions joined by “and” or “but,” each question and its response are coded separately. The timing of the 5-second interval begins after the entire sentence has been completed.**

- a. If the parent answers both questions in 5-seconds, Answer is coded for both questions. If the parent does not attempt to answer either question in 5-seconds, both questions are coded as No Answer.

Examples	
Child: What's that toy and how do you work it? Parent: (within 5 sec., says while demonstrating, “It's a cash register. It goes like this.”) (AN + TA + AN + TA) ----- BUT: Parent: (pushes cash register away and picks up blocks) (NA + NA)	
Child: What's this and how does it work? Parent: (within 5 sec., says while demonstrating, “It's a Magnadoodle. This is how you work it.”) (AN + TA + AN + TA) ----- BUT: Parent: (ignores child and begins playing with blocks) (NA + NA)	

- b. If the parent is answering one question as the 5-seconds elapse, the other question is coded No Opportunity for Answer. However, if the parent answers one question while time remains to answer the other question and the parent does not attempt to answer the question, the unanswered Information Question is coded No Answer.

Examples	
Dyad: (playing with Mr. and Mrs. Potato Head)	
Child: What's her name and what's his name?	
Parent: I think he's a farmer so his name should be ... umm ... McDonald (5 sec. elapse)	(NOA + AN + TA)
BUT: Parent: He's Mr. McDonald. (for the 3 sec. remaining silently puts pieces on him)	(NA + AN + TA)
Child: (pointing to two Sesame Street figures) What's his name and what's her name? (QU + QU)	
Parent: He's big and yellow, so his name is ... umm ... Big Bird (5 sec. elapse) (AN + TA + NOA)	
BUT: Parent: Well, this one's Big Bird (for the 3 sec. remaining silently playing with Big Bird)	(NA + AN + TA)

- 6. When a child Question is followed by another verbalization within 5-seconds before the parent has attempted to answer, the verbalization generally eliminates the parent's opportunity to answer. The verbalizations that do not interrupt the opportunity to answer are brief prompting statements, bids for attention, commands for internal, unobservable behavior, and the word "Huh?" and its synonyms. Child Questions followed by these verbalizations are coded Answer or No Answer depending on the parent's response.**

- a. If the child issues a statement(s) following a Question that serves to clarify or prompt the answer to the Question and does not take the focus off the question, the statement(s) does not interrupt the 5-second interval. However if the child's statement(s) after the Question leaves no time for the parent to begin to answer (i.e., the child is still clarifying the question or prompting an answer as the 5-second interval elapse), code No Opportunity for Answer.

Examples	
Child: What is that?	
Child: In the barn.	
Parent: (says, "A bale of hay." before the 5 sec. elapse) (AN + TA)	
BUT: Child: Where's that little animal?	
Child: The little one that kind of looks like a sheep (1 sec.) only it's blue. It's here somewhere. (5 sec. elapse) (QU/NOA + PRO + PRO)	
Child: What's that?	
Child: That thing there.	
Parent: (says, "Hand me the pink one" as the 5 sec. elapse) (NA + DC)	
BUT: Child: Where's that funny piece?	
Child: The one we used to make a plane. We used it last time. (5 sec. elapse) (QU/NOA + PRO + PRO)	

- b. Bid for attention commands and commands for internal unobservable behavior, which are automatically coded as No Opportunity for Answer commands and that do not redirect the parent from answering the question, do not interrupt the 5-second interval of opportunity for the parent to answer an Information Question. When these commands direct the parent's attention away from the Information Question, the Information Question is coded No Opportunity for Answer.

Examples	
Dyad: (coloring) Child: Where did mommy go? Child: (3 sec.) Daddy? (IC/NOC) (initial question still has opportunity for answer)	Child: (points at shapes and says, "Which one is the star?") Parent: (no response for 3 sec.) Child: Look at the big triangle. (QU/NOA + CM/NOC)
Child: What's this animal? Parent: (no response for 3 sec.) Child: Mommy? (CM/NOC) Parent: I'm busy honey. (NA + TA)	Child: What time is it? Parent: (ignores for 3 sec.) Child: Hey! (CM/NOC) Parent: Pipe down. (NA + NTA)
Child: What's this called? (points to Mr. Potato Head's mustache) Parent: (no response for 1 sec.) Child: Mom? (CM/NOC) Parent: His mustache. (AN + TA) ----- BUT: Parent: I'm busy, honey. (NA + TA)	

- c. When "Huh?" or its synonyms (i.e., Eh? Hmm?) follow a child Question by more than 2 seconds and has no meaning except to prompt the answer to the child Question, "Huh?" is coded as a child Question with No Opportunity for Answer. Because in this case it has no opportunity, "Huh?" does not interrupt the 5-second response interval for the original question.

Examples	
Child: What kind of bird is that? Parent: (no response for 2 sec.) Child: Huh? (QU/NOA) Parent: It's a swan. (AN + TA) ----- BUT: Child: What kind of dinosaur is that? Parent: Tyrannosaurs Rex. (AN + TA) Child: Huh? (meaning "What did you say?") (QU with opportunity)	
Child: When can I see Daddy? Parent: (no response for 2 sec.) Child: Huh? (QU/NOA) Parent: (no response) (NA for initial question) ----- BUT: Child: What is that called? Parent: A trapezoid. (AN) Child: Huh? (meaning "What did you say?") (QU with opportunity)	

7. If the child asks a question that is clearly outside the parent's competence or ability to answer, code **No Opportunity for Answer** rather than **No Answer** if the parent does not attempt to answer. Code **Answer** if the parent attempts to answer the question.

Examples	
Dyad: (playing with Tinker Toys) Child: How do you make a Ninja Turtle jet? Parent: (with puzzled look tries to fit pieces together) (AN) ----- BUT: Parent: (shrugs) (NOA)	Dyad: (building a castle) Child: What can we use for a Power Rack? Parent: These pieces? (AN + DQ) ----- BUT: Parent: You'll have to tell me. (NOA + DC)
Dyad: (playing with zoo puzzle) Child: Where's the piece that looks like a dinosaucer? Parent: (with puzzled look searches through pieces) (AN) ----- BUT: Parent: (gives puzzled look, and says, "A dinosaucer?") (NOA + DQ)	Dyad: (building rocket with Lincoln Logs) Child: What can we use for a robobooster? Parent: A what? (NOA + IQ)
Child: Where's the thingamajig? Parent: (says nothing) (NOA) ----- BUT: Parent: I think you want the handle on the back. (AN)	Child: Where's the piece to make Tyrorex? Parent: (gives puzzled look, and says, "Tyrorex?") (QU/NOA + DQ) ----- BUT: Parent: (with puzzled look searches through toy box) (QU/AN)

8. If the child asks an **Information Question** that is clearly rhetorical to which **No Answer** is expected, code **No Opportunity for Answer** rather than **No Answer** if the parent does not attempt to answer. Code **Answer** if the parent attempts to answer the rhetorical **Information Question**.

Examples	
Child: (looking in box of crayons and finds Lego) How did that get in there? Parent: Someone must have put it in there. (AN) ----- BUT: Parent: (looks over at child but makes no comment) (NOA)	Child: (playing with broken horse) Child: When are they gonna get better toys in here? (QU) Parent: I don't know. (AN) ----- BUT: Parent: (continues playing with doll) (NOA)
Child: (gets into toy box and closes lid) Where am I? (QU) Parent: (no response) (NOA)	Child: (puts bag over head) How come it got so dark in here? (QU) Parent: (laugh) (NOA)
Child: (puts ball in mouth) Why can't I talk? (IQ) Parent: Because you have a ball in your mouth. (AN)	Child: (playing with magnetic numbers) Child: Why is this so boring? (QU) Parent: I don't know. (AN) ----- BUT: Parent: (ignores comment) (NOA)
Child: (finding plastic block in box of wooden blocks) How did this get here? (QU) Parent: Maybe another child put it there. (AN) ----- BUT: Parent: (looks over at child but makes no comment) (NOA)	

9. If the parent responds to an information question with “What?” or its synonyms, code no answer only when the parent appears to be deliberately avoiding answering the question. When it appears as if the parent did not hear or understand the question, code no opportunity for answer.

Examples	
Child: When can we have some ice cream? Parent: (working on drawing) What? What? What? (<i>NA + IQ + IQ + IQ</i>) BUT: Child: When can we have some ice cream? Parent: (with puzzled look, says, “What?”) (<i>NOA + IQ</i>)	Child: Where's the gyrosaur? Parent: The what? (<i>QU/NOA + IQ</i>)
Dyad: (drawing pictures) Child: What does this look like? Parent: (with puzzled look, says, “What?”) (<i>QU/NOA + IQ</i>) BUT: Child: Why is her tummy so big? Parent: (dumps big bucket of blocks in front of child) I think I'm gonna dump all these blocks on the table so we can have a lot of fun. (<i>QU/NA + TA</i>)	

ANSWER (AN)

Definition

An answer is a verbal or nonverbal response to an Information Question that provides or attempts to provide the information requested in the question.

Parent Answer Examples	
Child: Where is Mr. Potato Head's hat? Parent: Under the chair.	Child: How does this work? Parent: Push the button.
Child: How do you spell potato? Parent: P. O. T. A. T. O. (5 sec. elapse)	Child: Which one fits here? Parent: (tries to fit several pieces for 3 sec.) Child: Oh, I found the one that goes there.
Child: What colors are in a rainbow? Parent: Yellow and red.	Child: Does this one go here? Parent: Yes.

Decision Rules

1. When uncertain as to whether the response to an Information Question is coded Answer or No Answer to a child Question, code Answer.
2. When uncertain as to whether the parent is intentionally not answering a question, do not code No Answer.

Parent AN Guidelines

1. **Verbal responses from the parent that provide the requested information or attempt to provide it within 5-second are coded Answer to question. When the parent provides the requested information, Answer is immediately coded and the 5-second interval stops.**

Examples	
Child: (holding red car) What color is this one? Parent: Red. (AN + TA)	Child: What do you want to do? Parent: I want to draw. (AN + TA)
Child: (points to five flowers) How many are there? Parent: ("One, two," 1 sec. pause, "Three, four" as 5 sec. elapse) (AN + TA)	

2. **If the parent has begun but not completed the answer within the 5-second interval, the parent must be continuing to attempt to provide the answer during the remainder of the 5-second interval for Answer to be coded.**

Examples	
Child: (points to six stars) How many are there? Parent: (looks at stars for 4 sec. and says, "One, two...") (AN + TA)	
BUT: Child: (points to three cars) How many are there? Parent: ("one, two, ...) Hey there's the one we couldn't find before.") (NA + TA + TA)	

3. **If an Information Question has numerous possible answers that would be adequate, the parent must provide at least one of the possible answers for Answer to be coded. Answer is coded only once regardless of the number of sentences in the answer.**

Examples	
Child: What does Mrs. Potato Head have on? Parent: She's got two eyes, a nose, big pink ears, and a hat. (AN + TA)	Child: What does Mrs. Potato Head have on? Parent: She has on her purse and she looks like she's going shopping. (AN + TA + TA)
Child: What does Mrs. Potato head have on? Parent: She has on her purse and she's got two eyes. She has funny feet too. (AN + TA + TA + TA)	

4. Nonverbal responses that intentionally provide or attempt to provide the requested information are coded Answer.

Examples	
Child: Which one do you want? Parent: (points to one) (AN)	Child: What animal says Woof-woof? Parent: (picks up dog and shows to child) (AN)
Child: How does that work? Parent: (says "It's easy" and demonstrates turning handle) (AN + TA) ----- BUT: Parent: It's easy. Try it. (NA + TA + DC)	Child: Am I doing this right? Parent: (nods) (AN)

5. Answer is coded only when the parent actually provides or attempts to provide within the 5-second interval the information requested. Responses that do not attempt to provide the information regardless of their appropriate or pleasant nature are not coded Answer.

Examples	
Parent: (building block house) Child: What can I do? Parent: Just a second. (NA + TA)	Parent: (drawing) Child: What's that? Parent: You need to guess. (NA + DC)
Dyad: (playing farm) Child: Where is the cow gonna go? Parent: It's a surprise! (NA + TA)	Dyad: (playing with magnetic numbers) Child: What number comes next? Parent: Gee (3 sec.) Well... (NA + TA + TA)

6. If the parent is attempting to answer a child Question and the child issues another verbalization within the 5-second interval, the attempt to answer the initial question is coded Answer.

Examples	
Child: How many blocks are there? Parent: (counting out loud) (IQ/AN) Child: (4 sec. after initial question) How many are there? (IQ)	Child: Where does this fit? Parent: (tries to fit piece into puzzle for 2 sec.) Child: Try this one now. (IQ/AN + DC)

NO ANSWER (NA)

Definition

No Answer to child Question occurs when the parent does not attempt to provide the information requested in the question.

Parent No Answer Examples	
Child: What time is it? Parent: (No Answer)	Child: What shape is this? Parent: Go away.
Child: Which car do you want to play with? Parent: Can't I finish the puzzle first?	Child: How many do you have? Parent: One ... two ... (begins playing as 5 sec. elapse)

Decision Rules

1. If uncertain whether a parent's response is coded Answer or No Answer, code Answer to question.
2. If uncertain whether a parent's response to a child Question is No Answer or No Opportunity for Answer, code No Opportunity for Answer.

Parent NA Guidelines

1. If the parent gives no verbal or nonverbal response to a question that could be answered, it is coded as No Answer.

Examples	
Child: What are you building? Parent: (no response) (NA)	Child: (playing with blocks) Which one is red? Parent: (No Answer and continues playing alone) (NA)

2. If the parent's response does not provide or attempt to provide the information requested in the question, code No Answer.

Examples	
Child: What are you drawing? Parent: Leave me alone. (NA + DC)	Child: What do you want to do now? Parent: I don't want to do anything. (NA + TA)
Child: Which piece do you want? Parent: Which do you want? (NA + IQ)	Child: When are we going? Parent: Don't ask me that again. (NA + NTA)

3. If a parent has begun but not completed the answer to an Information Question, code No Answer only if the parent has not provided an adequate answer and ceases to continue to attempt to answer for the remainder of the 5-second interval.

Examples	
Child: (points to large pile of blocks) Child: How many are there? Parent: One, Two ... (stops counting and begins talking about plans for dinner) (NA + TA)	Child: How do you spell my name? Parent: M. A. (2 sec. pause) I'm gonna write my name too. (NA + TA + TA + TA) ----- BUT: Child: (places box with toy garage pieces in it on the table) What's in the box? Parent: There's a garage. (sets up garage for remainder of 5 sec.) (AN + TA)

NO OPPORTUNITY FOR ANSWER (NOA)

Definition

No Opportunity for Answer is coded when the parent does not have an adequate chance to provide the information requested by a child in an Information Question.

Parent No Opportunity for Answer Examples	
Child: What's that shape? (2 sec.) It's a square.	Child: Where does this go? That's a pretty picture, Mommy.
Child: How do you make this work? (keeps talking for 5 sec.)	Child: What? (1 sec.) What did you say?
Child: What's in your pocket? What's in that pocket?	Child: What are we building? (loud noise occurs) What was that?
Child: How do you spell puppy? (2 sec.) Huh?	Child: How do you draw a helicopter? Show me how to draw one?
Child: How does this work? (2 sec.) Daddy?	

Decision Rule

If uncertain whether the parent had sufficient opportunity to respond, code No Opportunity for Answer.

Parent NOA Guidelines

1. **If a child makes any statement after an Information Question within the 5-second interval before the parent has attempted to answer, these child statements, with the exception of brief clarifications of the question, typically eliminate the parent's opportunity to answer the Information Question.**
 - a. If a child answers his/her own Information Question within 5-seconds of asking it and before the parent has attempted to answer it, the parent's response is coded No Opportunity for Answer.

Examples	
Child: Which block has "A" Parent: (turning alphabet blocks face up) Child: (3 sec.) Here's an "A". (IQ/NOA)	Child: Where's the window? Parent: (no response) Child: (2 sec.) Here's the window. (IQ/NOA)

- b. If the child follows an Information Question within the 5-second interval with a statement that does not serve to prompt the answer to the question or that takes the focus off the question before the parent has begun to answer, the Information Question is coded No Opportunity for Answer.

Examples	
Child: Where is the pig? Child: Oh, here's the logs. Let's make a farm. (IQ/NOA + TA + IC)	Child: What's yours gonna be? Parent: (no responses for 3 sec.) Child: Mine's gonna be a rocket. (IQ/NOA + TA)
Child: What stick is longest? Parent: (no response in 4 sec.) Child: You're making a big house. (IQ/NOA + BD)	

- c. If the child asks an Information Question but continues talking for the 5-second interval following the question, the Information Question is coded No Opportunity for Answer.

Examples	
Child: How did you make it green? Child: (no pause) It was yellow and then it was gonna be blue and it turned green! (IQ/NOA + TA + TA +TA)	Child: Why is it time to clean up? Child: (no pause) We hardly played at all. (no pause) You said we could play the train game. (IQ/NOA + TA + TA)

- d. If the child issues a statement following an Information Question that serves to clarify or prompt the answer to the Information Question and does not take the focus off the question, the statement does not interrupt the 5-second interval. However, if the child's statement after the Information Question leaves no time or opportunity for the parent to begin to answer (i.e., the child is still clarifying the question as the 5-second interval elapses), code No Opportunity for Answer.

Examples	
Child: What is the biggest building? (IQ) Child: (no pause) I forgot. Mrs. Brown told us. It was like there are two. (NOA + TA + TA + TA) ----- BUT: Child: What is that? (IQ) Child: (1 sec.) That right there. (TA) Parent: (says, "A mouse" before the 5 sec. elapse) (AN + TA)	Child: What is the big animal called? (IQ) Child: (2 sec.) On that page there. (TA) (question still has opportunity for answer).

2. If a child follows an Information Question with another question within the 5-second interval before the parent has attempted to answer, any question except for "Huh?" and its synonyms eliminates the parent's opportunity to answer the Information Question.

- a. If the child repeats the Information Question within the 5-second interval before the parent has attempted to answer, the first question is coded No Opportunity for Answer as soon as the second question is issued.

Examples	
Child: What's this piece called? Child: (1 sec.) What's it called, huh? (IQ/NOA + IQ)	Dyad: (playing with toy farm) Child: What do horses eat? Child: (3 sec.) Do they eat ice cream? (IQ/NOA + DQ)
Child: What's behind my back? Parent: (doesn't respond for 3 sec.) Child: What animal says "Moo"? (IQ/NOA + IQ)	Child: What are you drawing? Parent: (no response for 2 sec.) Child: An igloo, isn't it? (IQ/NOA + DQ)

- b. If the child issues an Information Question and then, within 5 seconds and before the parent attempts to answer, issues another, unrelated question that changes the subject, the first question is coded No Opportunity for Answer.

Examples	
Child: What do you want to play with? Parent: (looking around the room) Child: What color is this? (IQ/NOA + IQ)	Child: Why is their paper pink? Parent: (no response for 3 sec.) Child: Why is that chair backwards? (IQ/NOA + IQ)

- c. When "Huh?" or a synonym (e.g., Eh?, Hmm?) follows an Information Question by more than 2 seconds and has no meaning except to prompt the answer to the Information

Question, “Huh?” is coded as an Information Question with No Opportunity for Answer and does not interrupt the 5-second response interval for the original question.

Examples	
Child: What shape is that?	
Parent: (no response for 2 sec.)	
Child: Huh? (IQ/NOA)	
Parent: It's an octagon. (AN for initial question)	

BUT: Child: What kind of bird is that?	
Parent: Hummingbird. (IQ/AN + TA)	
Child: Huh? (meaning “What did you say?”) (IQ with opportunity)	

3. If the child issues a command within the 5-second interval following an Information Question before the parent has attempted to answer, commands with opportunity to comply eliminate the parent's opportunity to answer the Information Question.

- a. If the child issues a command for an observable behavior within the 5-second interval following an Information Question before the parent has attempted to answer, the Information Question is coded No Opportunity for Answer and the command and its response are coded.

Examples	
Child: Where is the cow?	Child: Which one's the square?
Parent: (no response)	Parent: (no response)
Child: Give me the cow. (IQ/NOA + DC)	Child: Pick up the square.
	Parent: (2 sec.) (picks up the square)
	(IQ/NOA + DC/CO)

Bid for attention commands and commands for internal unobservable behavior which are automatically coded as No Opportunity for Compliance and that do not redirect the parent from answering the question do not interrupt the 5-second interval of opportunity for the parent to answer an Information Question. When these commands direct the parent's attention away from the Information Question, the Information Question is coded No Opportunity for Answer.

Examples	
Dyad: (coloring)	Child: What's that noise?
Child: What are you making? (IQ)	Parent: (no response for 3 sec.)
Parent: (no response for 3 sec.)	Child: Daddy? (IC/NOC ; IQ still has opportunity for answer)
Child: Mom? (IC/NOC)	-----
(initial question still has opportunity for answer)	BUT: Child: What's that noise?

BUT: Child: What are you making?	Parent: (looks around but says nothing for 3 sec.)
Parent: (no response for 3 sec.)	Child: (says, “Listen to that funny noise that's outside the door that sounds like a vacuum...” as the 5 sec. elapse) (IC/NOC + IQ/NOA)
Child: Look at mine.	
(DC/NOC + IQ/NOA)	

RESPONSES TO COMMANDS

After a member of the dyad issues a command, the other member has five seconds to respond. There are three categories describing responses to commands: Compliance (CO), Noncompliance (NC), and No Opportunity for Compliance (NOC). Compliance is coded when the command is obeyed or beginning to be obeyed within the 5-second interval. Noncompliance is coded when the command is not obeyed or attempted within 5-seconds or when a behavior incompatible with the command is performed. No Opportunity for Compliance is coded when an adequate chance to comply has not been given.

GENERAL PARENT RESPONSE TO COMMANDS GUIDELINES

1. **When a command is followed within 5-seconds by a command that is automatically coded No Opportunity for Compliance (e.g., bid for attention commands, vague commands, commands for internal, unobservable behavior), the second command does not interrupt the 5-second compliance interval of the original command.**

Examples	
Child: Help me tie my shoes. Parent: (touches a shoe) Child: Hurry up! (DC/NOC) Parent: (ties a shoe as 5 sec. elapse) (DC/CO)	Child: You can use the big ones first. Parent: (searches through Lincoln logs) Child: Look here. (points to big ones) (DC/NOC) Parent: (picks up big Lincoln logs) (IC/CO)
Child: Let me have one, okay? Parent: (after 2 sec., no response) Child: Hey? (IC/NOC) Parent: (hands child crayon) (IC/CO)	Child: Take me to the bathroom. Parent: (continues playing with the cars) Child: (waits 3 sec.) Come on! (DC/NOC) Parent: (walks to the door) (DC/CO)
Child: Help me put my shoes on. Parent: (picks up a shoe) Child: Hurry up! (DC/NOC) Parent: (putting on shoe as 5 sec. elapse) (DC/CO)	Child: Put her away. Parent: (continues dressing doll) Child: (waits 2 sec.) Daddy! (IC/NOC) Parent: (places doll in toy box as 5 sec. elapse) (IC/CO)
Child: Hand me the pink car, okay? Parent: (after 2 sec., no response) Child: Please? (IC/NOC) Parent: (hands pink car 4 sec. after first command) (IC/CO)	Child: Let's finish the guardhouse before the fort. Parent: (continues working on fort) Child: Look over here. (points to guardhouse) (DC/NOC) Parent: (continues working on fort as 5 sec. elapse) (IC/NC)
Child: Draw one just like mine. Parent: (continues drawing own picture) Child: (waits 3 sec.) Come on, mommy! (DC/NOC) Parent: (begins drawing as commanded 6 sec. after first command) (DC/NC)	Child: Throw me the ball. Parent: (after 3 sec., no response yet) Child: Hey! (IC/NOC) Parent: (throws ball immediately) (DC/CO) ----- BUT: Child: Throw me the ball. Parent: (throws ball immediately) (DC/CO)
Child: Give me the truck. (DC) Parent: (does not respond for 3 sec.) Child: Mom! (IC/NOC) Parent: (does not respond for another 3 sec.) (NC)	

2. **Within the 5-second interval following a command, if a child issues a second command before the parent has completed the first and the second command is not automatically coded No Opportunity for Compliance, the second command is coded for compliance and the first command is coded No Opportunity for Compliance.**

Examples	
Child: Give it to me. (no pause) Give it to me. (DC/NOC + DC)	Child: Fly the airplane over here. Parent: What? Child: (2 sec.) Fly the airplane over here. (DC/NOC + DC)
Child: Pick me up, Daddy. Parent: (doesn't pick up child) Child: (waits 4 sec.) Please pick me up. (DC/NOC + DC)	Child: Put the next one on. Parent: Where do you want it? Child: (2 sec.) Put it here. (DC/NOC + DC)
Child: Let's make a rocket now. Parent: Can I finish my boat first? Child: (2 sec.) No, make a rocket with me. (IC/NOC + TA + DC)	Child: Draw a monkey, okay? Parent: (starts to draw monkey) Child: Draw a whale instead. (IC/NOC + DC)
Child: Color the froggy green. Parent: (continues drawing a lily pad for 3 sec.) Child: Turn the page so I can see it. (DC/NOC + DC)	Child: Color the sun yellow. Parent: (continues to color the grass green for 2 sec.) Child: Draw a horse, too. (DC/NOC + DC)
Child: Make me an airplane. Parent: What? Child: (1 sec.) Make me an airplane. (DC/NOC + DC)	Child: Take this bow out of my hair. Parent: (doesn't remove bow) Child: (waits 4 sec.) Take this bow out, please. (DC/NOC + DC)
Child: Give it to me. (no pause) Give it to me. (DC/NOC + DC)	Child: Can we get a drink now? Parent: (no response for 1 sec.) Child: Mommy, let's go get a drink. (IC/NOC + IC)
Child: Give me the red one. Parent: (picks up red crayon) Where do you want it? Child: (1 sec.) Put it right here. (DC/NOC + DC)	Child: Let's play with the Lincoln Logs. Parent: Can I finish this story first? Child: (1 sec.) No, put it away now so we can build something. (IC/NOC + TA + DC)
Child: Give me the purple one. Parent: (reaches for the purple crayon) Child: Uh, give me blue instead. (DC/NOC + DC)	Child: Daddy, put the doll in the cradle. Parent: (continues playing 3 sec.) Child: Cover her up with the blanket. (DC/NOC + DC)
Child: Color with me, Mommy. Parent: (continues building for 4 sec.) Child: Color this picture with me. (DC/NOC + DC)	Child: Find some roof pieces. Parent: (begins looking) Child: (2 sec. after first command) Get all the yellow ones. (DC/NOC + DC)
Child: Let's make a fort. Parent: (after 3 sec. no response) Child: Okay? (DQ) Parent: (no response 5 sec. after command) (NC)	Child: Give me one. Parent: (reaches for blue car) Child: (2 sec. after command) I want the green. (TA) Parent: (5 sec. after command) (has kept all cars) (NC)

3. When one sentence contains a series of commands joined by “and” or “but,” each command and its response are coded separately. The timing of the 5-second interval begins after the entire sentence has been completed.

- a. If the commands in the series are not sequential (i.e., commands can physically be completed in any order), the commands may have opportunity for compliance or noncompliance. Any commands that could not be started within the 5-second interval are coded as No Opportunity for Compliance.

Examples	
Child: Move the tunnel over here and push the train through it. (DC + DC) Parent: (moves tunnel, but does not drive train through) (CO + NC) Parent: I don't like to play that game (doesn't obey either command) (NC + NC) Parent: (drives train through tunnel as 5 sec. elapse) (CO), (doesn't move tunnel) (NOC)	Child: Pick the toys up and put them on the table. Parent: (pushes truck along floor as 5 sec. elapse) (NC + NC) Parent: (picks up one toy and plays with it) (NC + NC) Parent: (collects all toys into a pile; 5 sec. elapse before parent begins to put them on the table) (CO + NO)
Child: Mommy, let's put these away and play with the Legos. Parent: (begins putting toys away for 5 sec.) (DC/CO) (second command is NOC) Child: Take these Legos apart and put them in here. Parent: (takes Lego creation apart; 5 sec. elapse before parent begins to put them in the container) (DC/CO + DC/NOC) ----- BUT: Parent: (takes some Legos apart, putting each one in the container) (DC/CO + DC/CO) Parent: (takes Lego creation apart and begins to put them in the container as the 5 sec. elapse) (DC/CO + DC/CO)	Dyad: (beginning to play with Tinker Toys) Child: Take all of 'em out of the box and finish the racecar. Parent: (takes pieces out of the box one at a time, adding each piece to the race car as it's taken out) (CO + CO) ----- BUT: Parent: (takes all of the pieces out of the box and begins to add them as 5 sec. elapse) (CO + CO) ----- BUT: Parent: (takes each piece out of the box; 5 sec. elapse before parent can begin to add them to race car) (CO + NOC)
Child: Put Ernie in the car and drive it to the garage. Parent: (puts Ernie in a toy car and pushes car to the garage) (CO + CO)	

- b. When the series of commands in the sentence “should be” completed in a specific order, the parent’s compliance to any command, regardless of the order it “should be” completed in, is still coded as Compliance. Any command that cannot be begun within the 5-second interval because the parent is still completing another command is coded No Opportunity for Compliance.

Examples	
Child: Can you help me put the crayons in their box and put the box on the shelf?	
Parent: (absent-mindedly puts box on the shelf and goes back to Lincoln logs) (NC + CO)	
Child: Take the train and drive over the mountain.	
Parent: (takes the train and begins checking the cars) (CO + NC)	
BUT: Parent: (drives a car over the mountain as 5 sec. elapse) (NOC + CO)	
Child: Take the yellow crayon and draw a sun.	
Parent: (draws a sun with the red crayon she had been holding as 5 sec. elapse (CO + NOC for command to take yellow crayon)	
BUT: Parent: (draws sun with the red crayon she had been holding and picks up yellow crayon as 5 sec. elapse) (CO + CO)	
Child: Take the yellow crayon and draw a sun.	
Parent: (picks up yellow crayon) (CO), (draws sun) (CO)	
OR: Parent: (draws sun with the red crayon she had been holding) (CO), (picks up yellow crayon) (CO)	
BUT: Parent: (doesn't take the yellow crayon) (NC), (draws a sun with the red crayon she had been holding) (CO)	
Child: Let's finish the roof and then put the chimney on.	
Parent: (assembles roof and puts chimney on it, but 5 sec. elapse before the roof is placed on the house) (CO + CO)	
BUT: Parent: (finishes roof on Lincoln log house) (CO), (NOC for command to put the chimney on) Parent: (puts the chimney on roof piece as 5 sec. elapse) (CO) (NOC for command to finish roof)	

- c. If the commands in the series are sequential (i.e., they physically cannot be completed out of order), the commands that cannot be begun within 5 seconds following the end of the sentence are coded No Opportunity for Compliance.

Examples	
Child: Can you open this container and take out the blocks for me?	
Parent: (does not open container for 5 sec.) (NC + NOC)	
Parent: (drops cow)	
Child: Daddy, pick up that cow and put him in the barn.	
Parent: (doesn't pick up cow) (NC + NOC)	
Child: Find the right piece and put it in this space.	
Parent: (keeps looking for correct puzzle piece until the 5 sec. elapse) (CO + NOC for putting piece in puzzle)	
BUT: Parent: (tries to fit a piece in the space and then searches for another one to fit there) (CO + CO) Parent: (finds correct piece and examines it for several sec. as 5 sec. elapse) (CO + NC)	
Child: Find Mr. Potato Head's nose and put it on him.	Child: Take out the pieces and give me the yellow ones.
Parent: (finds nose) (CO), (is putting nose on as 5 sec. elapse) (CO)	Parent: (takes out pieces) (CO), (does not give child yellow pieces for remainder of 5 sec.) (NC)

4. If a child command is followed by a child verbalization that is not a command, the verbalization is coded but does not interrupt the 5-second response interval of the original command provided that the verbalization does not serve to cancel the original command. **Note:** Child verbalizations occurring less than 5-seconds after a command that serve to cancel the command or interrupt compliance are coded the appropriate verbalization category and the original command is coded No Opportunity for Compliance.

Examples	
Child: I want you to put the ball up here. (DC) Parent: (puts ball on table) (CO) Child: No. Right here. (child points to a different spot on the table) (CR + TA) Parent: (moves ball to location child pointed out) (No code).	Child: Can you draw a clown? Parent: (hesitates for 2 sec.) Child: Like the one we saw on TV. (TA) Parent: (begins to draw) (CO) ----- BUT: Child: Make a race car, alright? Parent: (begins to assemble pieces) (IC/NOC) Child: (after 1 sec.) I want to do it myself. (TA)
Child: Give me some gum. Parent: (after 3 sec. no response) Child: Did you have gum? (DQ) Parent: (at 4 sec. begins looking through purse for gum) (CO)	Child: (dressing doll) Child: Why don't you comb her hair? Parent: Okay. (TA) Child: But first I need to finish putting on these little shoes. (IC/NOC + TA)
Child: Put the green one on top. Oh, let me do it. (DC/NOC + DC/NOC)	Child: Put the red one on top. I mean put the green one on top. (DC/NOC + DC)
Child: Draw a star on top. Do you think that we can make it look like a Christmas tree? (DC/NOC + DQ)	

5. When a command appears to be outside the parent's competence or ability, code No Opportunity for Compliance rather than Noncompliance if the parent does not attempt to perform the behavior. Code Compliance if the parent attempts to perform the commanded behavior, or if the child praises the parent for complying (when compliance cannot be observed).

Examples	
Child: (pointing to picture on Tinker Toy box) Make me a space ship like this. Parent: I'll try. (begins to assemble pieces) (CO) ----- BUT: Parent: There aren't enough pieces. (does not try) (TA + NOC)	Dyad: (taking apart Tinker Toys that are stuck together) Child: Please take this one apart, mommy. Parent: I can't do it. (doesn't try) (DC/NOC + TA) ----- BUT: Parent: (tries to take it apart but can't) (DC/CO)
Child: Find my favorite crayon. Parent: (goes to crayon box and looks inside) (CO) ----- BUT: Parent: (continues coloring) (NOC)	Child: Hand me the red Lego block (DC) Parent: (can't see parent) Child: Thanks for handing it to me. Parent: (CO)

COMPLIANCE

Definition

Parental compliance occurs when the parent performs, begins to perform, or attempts to perform a behavior requested by the child within the 5-second interval following the command.

Parent Compliance Examples	
Child: Give me the red block, okay? Parent: (after 2 sec. gives red block)	Child: Can you sit down next to me? Parent: The chair's too small. (sits in chair)
Child: Put yours away too. Parent: (picks up one toy as 5 sec. elapse)	Child: Make it go fast. Parent: (pushes car)
Child: Lay all the sticks in a row. Parent: (after 2 sec. parent begins to lay sticks in a row and continues until 5 sec. elapse)	
Child: Will you please help me carry these? Parent: No! (roughly grabs some toys from child)	

Decision rules

1. When uncertain as to whether the parent complied, did not comply, or had no opportunity to comply, code No Opportunity for Compliance.
2. When uncertain as to whether the parent has complied or noncomplied, code Compliance.

Parent CO Guidelines

1. When a parent complies to the command by completing the requested behavior, Compliance is immediately coded and the 5-second interval stops.

Examples	
Child: Give me a car, please. Parent: (no pause) (gives car to child) (CO)	Child: Will you fly the space ship? Parent: (1 sec.) (begins flying spaceship) (CO)
Dyad: (playing with toy farm) Child: I want you to feed the cows some hay. Parent: (3 sec.) (feeds toy cows) (CO)	

2. If the parent has begun but not completed the requested behavior within the 5-second interval, code Compliance only if the parent is continuing to attempt to perform the requested behavior and not have begun an incompatible behavior during the remainder of the 5-second interval.

Examples	
Child: Put this fence together, okay? Parent: (has connected half of the fence pieces when 5 sec. elapse) (CO)	Child: Tell me a story. Parent: (4 sec.) Once upon a time ... (CO)
Child: Draw a person. Parent: (drawing a face until 5 sec. elapse) (CO)	Child: Sit on the floor with me, Dad. Parent: (walks over to child in first sec. but then stands until the 5 sec. elapse.) (NC)

3. **Compliance is coded if the parent performs or attempts to perform the requested behavior regardless of accompanying inappropriate behavior.**

Examples	
Child: Give me all the marbles. Parent: (whines, "But that's not fair," while handing child the marbles) (WH-TA + CO)	Child: Color this one red. Parent: Oh ____! (colors it red) (NTA + CO)
Child: Fix this car, will ya? Parent: <u>You</u> messed it up (begins to fix car) (NTA + CO)	

4. **If the parent indicates verbal unwillingness to comply, but performs the requested behavior within 5-seconds, code Compliance.**

Examples	
Child: Let's color this page. Parent: I'd rather play with the farm (colors on page) (TA + CO)	Child: Push the train to me, Mom. Parent: I want to see how the boxcars fit together (but pushes train to child) (TA + CO)
Child: Come over here. Parent: Can't I sit down for a minute? (moves toward child) (DQ + CO).	Child: Give me the doll in the blue dress. Parent: That's the one <u>I</u> wanted (gives doll to child) (TA + CO)

5. **If the parent performs the commanded action, the quality of the response is not considered unless it is unquestionably incompatible with the command.**

Examples	
Child: Draw a picture of a horse. Parent: (draws) (CO)	Child: Set it down nice 'n easy. Parent: (places doll house on table) (CO)
----- BUT: Child: Draw between the lines. Parent: (scribbles) (NC)	----- BUT: Child: Set it down nice 'n easy. Parent: (drops doll house on table) (NC)

NONCOMPLIANCE (NC)

Definition

Noncompliance is coded following a Direct or Indirect Command given by one member of the dyad when the respondent does not perform, attempt to perform, or stops attempting to perform the requested behavior within the 5-second interval following the command.

Parent Noncompliance Examples	
Child: Come over here. Parent: (continues sitting for 5 sec.)	Child: Daddy, pick that truck up. Parent: (colors for 6 sec., then picks up truck)
Child: Erase that stuff off the chalkboard. Parent: (begins erasing but stops after 3 sec. and blows chalk dust away)	Child: Let's play farmhouse. Parent: I don't want to. (does not begin to)
Child: Will you pick up the Legos? Parent: <u>You</u> made the mess. (continues to play with Legos)	

Decision rules

1. When uncertain as to whether the parent has complied, noncomplied, or been given no opportunity, code either Compliance or No Opportunity for Compliance.
2. When uncertain as to whether the parent has complied or noncomplied, code Compliance.

Parent NC Guidelines

1. **Noncompliance is coded after a command when a parent performs a behavior that is incompatible with the child's request. When Noncompliance is coded, the timing of the 5-second interval is stopped.**

Examples	
Dyad: (playing with coloring book) Child: Make the zebra have green stripes. Parent: (colors stripes black) (NC)	Child: Give me that quarter! Parent: (puts quarter in purse) (NC)
Child: Let's build another tower. Parent: (puts blocks in their container) (NC)	

2. **Failure to begin or attempt to perform a requested behavior within 5-seconds is coded Noncompliance. Noncompliance is coded after 5-seconds elapse with no response from the parent.**

Examples	
Child: (standing at door) Let's go home. Parent: (continues playing and ignores child for 5 sec.) (NC)	Child: Will you give me a piggyback ride? Parent: (continues drawing for 5 sec.) (NC)
Child: Drive the bus over here. Parent: (after 6 sec., begins to move the bus toward the child) (NC)	Child: Could you draw a mermaid for me? Parent: (continues to draw a sun for 5 sec.) (NC)
Child: Put the sun suit on my dolly. Parent: (after 6 sec., picks up sun suit) (NC)	

- 3. If the parent has begun but not completed the requested behavior within the 5-second interval, Noncompliance can be coded only if the parent purposefully engages in a behavior incompatible with completion of the command or ceases to attempt to perform the requested behavior during the remainder of the 5-second interval.**

Examples	
Child: Will you put Mr. Potato Head in his car? Parent: (picks up Mr. Potato Head, but fixes his nose and mustache for 8 sec.) (NC)	Child: Build me another tower. Parent: (puts one block down and says, "I'm making a train this time.") (NC)
Child: Draw a star on my paper, okay? Parent: (reaches for child's paper (2 sec.) but begins praising the child's drawing until 5 sec. elapse) (NC)	

- 4. Noncompliance is coded when the parent fails to perform or to attempt to perform a commanded behavior within the 5-second interval, regardless of verbal statements indicating the parent's willingness to comply.**

Examples	
Child: Tell me a story. Parent: Okay, hmm. Parent: (after 5 sec., parent has not started story) (NC)	Child: Move those pieces closer. Parent: Sure. (but continues sorting them for 5 sec.) (NC)
Child: We should put the baby to bed. Parent: Good idea. (continues to pretend baby doll is jumping on ants for 5 sec.) (UP + NC)	

- 5. Noncompliance is coded if the parent does not perform or attempt to perform the commanded behavior regardless of accompanying inappropriate behavior.**

Examples	
Child: (jumping and yelling, "Fly the airplane!") Parent: (yells, "Settle down!" and puts the airplane away) (YE-DC + NC)	Child: How about playing Jack-in-the-box? Parent: (whines, "It's too noisy," and continues coloring) (WH-TA + NC)
Child: Close the story book. Parent: Your mouth is what needs closing. (keeps book open past 5 sec. interval) (NC + NTA)	

NO OPPORTUNITY FOR COMPLIANCE (NOC)

Definition

No opportunity is coded when a member of the dyad is not given an adequate chance to comply with a command.

Parent No Opportunity for Compliance Examples	
Child: Hang my picture on the refrigerator, okay?	Child: Give dolly a drink. (child gives doll drink)
Child: Color that with the secret color of the day, alright?	Child: (after parent yells) Grown-ups are 'sposed to talk quiet.
Child: Hurry up.	Child: Please.
Child: Look.	Child: Mommy.

Decision rule

1. When uncertain as to whether the parent has or has not had an adequate chance to comply, code No Opportunity for Compliance.

Parent NOC Guidelines

1. **Commands that request a behavior to be performed in the not-immediate future (> 5 sec.) are coded No Opportunity for Compliance.**

Examples	
Dyad: (taking farm parts out of box) Child: You can make the fence next. (CM/NOC)	Parent: We're getting a new car tomorrow. Child: Let's go for a ride in it as soon as you get it. (CM/NOC)
Parent: (puts all the Legos on table) Child: You'll have to put them away when we're done. (CM/NOC)	

2. **Positively stated commands in the form of general rules for appropriate behavior that immediately follow the commission of an inappropriate behavior are coded No Opportunity for Compliance.**

Examples	
Parent: (yells) Child: Parents should talk quiet to their kids. (CM/NOC)	Parent: (coughs without covering mouth) Child: People should cover their mouth when they cough. (CM/NOC) ----- BUT: Parent: Those people were fighting all day. Child: People should be nice to each other, huh? (QU)
Parent: Your mom doesn't draw very well, does she? Child: Dads shouldn't say mean things about Moms. (NTA)	

3. When the child completes the action requested in the child's command in such a way as to prevent the parent's compliance, No Opportunity for Compliance is coded. However, if the child simply joins in the requested activity and does not prevent compliance, do not code No Opportunity for Compliance.

Examples	
Child: Let's put the cow in the wagon.	
Parent: (ignores command)	
Child: (after 4 sec. puts the cow in the wagon) (CM/NOC)	

BUT: Child: Let's put all the animals in the barn.	
Child: (after 1 sec. begins putting animals in the barn)	
Parent: (after 3 sec. also begins putting animals in the barn) (IC/CO)	

4. Verb phrases in a command that do not provide sufficient information for the parent to perform the expected behavior are coded as No Opportunity for Compliance. These verb phrases include those that call for internal or unobservable behavior or those that are too vague to judge compliance.

Examples	
Child: Be careful. (CM/NOC)	Child: Hurry up. (CM/NOC)
BUT: Child: Careful (PRO)	BUT: Child: Quickly. (PRO)
Child: Watch out. (CM/NOC)	Child: Be nice. (CM/NOC)
	BUT: Child: Nicely. (PRO)
Child: Get ready. (CM/NOC)	Child: Shhh. (i.e., Be quiet) (CM/NOC)
Child: Listen. (CM/NOC)	Child: Wait for me. (CM/NOC)
Child: Remember this, okay? (CM/NOC)	Child: Look. (CM/NOC)
Child: Let me do it. (CM/NOC)	Child: Be gentle (CM/NOC)
	BUT: Child: Gently. (PRO)
	Child: Play gently with the blocks (CM)

5. When a parent's name, or a synonym for it, is used as a bid for attention and is separated from another verbalization by 2 seconds or longer, it is coded as an Indirect Command with No Opportunity for Compliance (see Indirect Command, guideline 15).

Examples	
Child: Mommy? (CM/NOC)	Child: Hey. (CM/NOC)
BUT: Child: Are you using the black crayon, Mommy? (QU)	BUT: Child: Hey, (< 2 sec.) which one fits over there? (QU)
Child: Daddy, (> 2 sec.) It goes here. (CM/NOC + PRO)	
BUT: Child: Daddy, (< 2 sec.) it goes here. (PRO)	
Child: It goes here (no pause) Daddy. (PRO)	

6. When the word “please” is separated from a preceding command by 2 seconds or longer and functions to repeat the preceding command, “please” is coded as an Indirect Command with No Opportunity for Compliance.

Examples	
Child: Give me some candy. Parent: (ignores child) Child: (after 2 sec. pause) Please. (CM/NOC)	Child: Can we play hide and seek? Parent: Not in here. Child: (2 sec. after original command) Please, Mom. (CM/NOC) ----- BUT: Child: Lift up the fence. Parent: (ignores) Child: (after 2 sec.) Please lift it. (CO with opportunity; previous command is CM/NOC)

CHILD CATEGORIES

Child Play Talk	Child Laugh
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PLAY TALK (PT)

Definition

Play Talk is any verbal or vocal behavior that is not a direct form of verbal communication from one person to the other.

Child Play Talk Examples	
(talking for King doll) I'm the boss.	(talking for rabbit) What's up doc?
(talking to clay snake) You're squishy!	(talking to doll's hat) Stay on her head!
(talking as teacher) Raise your hand before you talk.	(playing with toy car) Beep, beep.
(moving toy dog) Arff, arff.	(singing) "I'm a little teapot..."
(reciting) Jack and Jill went up the, hill...	(reading words in book) "See Jack run."
(yells, "I'm melting!")	(whining as baby doll, "I'm hungry.")
(child's lion bites parent) Yum, yum.	Three blind mice, See how they run

Decision Rules

1. When uncertain whether the verbalization is Play Talk or another DPICS category, do not code Play Talk.
2. When uncertain whether one or more Play Talks has occurred, code one Play Talk.

Child PT Guidelines

1. **Play Talk includes any verbalization stated as "pretend talk", where the child is talking as a toy or character other than him or herself. Talking as a toy or character is recognized by a) a change in voice quality, or b) synchronous movement of the toy with the verbalization. If you are unable to see child moving toy with the verbalization, do not code Play Talk.**

Examples	
Child: (talking in "farmer" voice) Hello there, Mr. Cow. (PT)	Child: (talking in "dog" voice) My name is Ruffer. (PT)
Child: (talking in "monster" voice) I'm going to eat you up! (PT)	Child: (while moving plastic figure back and forth) I'm the wisest in the land. (PT)
Child: (moving doll up and down) I don't want you to go away. (PT)	Parent: I like you, Mr. Rabbit. Child: (wiggling toy rabbit) I like you too. (PT) OR: Child: (talking in "bunny" voice) I like you too. (PT) BUT: Child: (talking in own voice) I like you too. (PRO)

2. **Play Talk includes verbalizations spoken directly to a toy or object in which the child addresses the toy or object by name.**

Examples	
Child: (puts doll in bed)	Child: (trying to take Oscar up the elevator)
Child: Good night, Miss Annie. (PT)	Child: Get in there, Oscar. (PT)

3. **Play Talk includes talk as a character in a make-believe play. Code Play Talk only when you are certain the child's verbalization is "in role".**

Examples	
Dyad: (playing doctor)	
Child: (puts hand on parent's forehead while saying, "Do you have a fever?") (PT)	
Parent: I don't know, Doctor.	
Child: You have a fever. (PT)	
Parent: What should I do?	
Child: (holds out pretend medicine) Take this medicine. (PT)	

4. **Play Talk includes vocalizations used for sound effects in the play.**

Examples	
Dyad: (pushing train)	Dyad: (playing with farm)
Child: Chug, chug, chug. (PT)	Child: (holds up pig) Oink, oink. (PT)
Parent: It's going to blow up.	
Child: (makes explosion sound) (PT)	

5. **Play Talk includes singing and reciting poems or nursery rhymes.**

Examples	
Parent: You're drawing lots of stars.	Parent: Hickory, dickory, dock
Child: (singing) Twinkle, twinkle, little star... (PT)	Child: The mouse ran up the clock. (PT)

6. **Play Talk includes reading text.**

Examples	
Dyad: (looking at primer)	Dyad: (reading from book)
Child: (reading) "See Jane run. See Spot run." (PT + PT)	Parent: "A is for apple."
	Child: "B is for ball." (PT)
	BUT: Dyad: (playing with Magna Doodle)
	Parent: (points to "A" on Magna, Doodle)
	What's this?
	Child: A is for apple. (PRO)

7. Individual sentences of direct communication to the parent that incorporate Play Talk fragments are not coded as Play Talk.

Examples	
Parent: What does this say? Child: It says, "He runs fast." (PRO) BUT: Child: (reads) "He runs fast." (PT)	Dyad: (looking at storybook) Child: These words say, (reading) "A big car." (PRO) ----- BUT: Child: (continuing to read) "The car is big." (PT)
Parent: What does the rooster say? Child: It says, (crowing) "Cock-a-doodle-do." (PRO) ----- BUT: Child: (crowing) "Cock-a-doodle-do." (PT)	Parent: Do you know the alphabet. Child: Mrs. Brown goes (sings) "a, b, c, d, e, f, g" (PRO) ----- BUT: Child: (sings) "A, b, c, d, e, f, g." (PT)

8. When Play Talk occurs simultaneously with a vocalization category (Laugh, Whine, Yell), both Play Talk and the vocalization are coded.

Examples	
Dyad: (playing with dragon) Child: (yells, "I'll get you!") (YE-PT)	Dyad: (playing with baby doll) Child: (whines, "I want my mommy.") (WH-PT)
Parent: (talking for Mr. Potato Head) My mouth is in my nose. Child: (while laughing, says "You're a silly potato." (LA-PT)	

9. Physical behavior categories (Negative Touch; Positive Touch) are not coded as Play Talk, even if the "toy" is engaging in the physical behavior.

Examples	
Child: (pretending his/her puppet is hitting parent) (NTO)	Child: (touches parent's face with puppet) She's kissing you. (PTO + PRO)

10. When Play Talk verbalizations or vocalizations occur in a series, use the one sentence rule and 2 second rule to determine when one Play Talk ends and the next one begins. For standard rhymes and songs, each "line" is considered a sentence. For sound effects, each clearly different sound effect is coded as a separate Play Talk.

Examples	
Parent: (talking as if a telephone) Ring, ring, ring. Child: (answering pretend phone) Hello. How are you? (PT + PT)	
Dyad: (playing with dollhouse) Child: (bounces doll at front door) Ring, ring, ring. (PT) Parent: (holds parent doll behind couch) We're not home. Child: Yes you are! Ring, ring, ring (2 sec. pause) ring, ring, ring. (PT + PT + PT)	
Child: Humpty Dumpty sat on a wall, Humpty Dumpty had a great fall, All the King's horses and all the King's men, Couldn't put Humpty together again. (PT + PT + PT + PT) ----- BUT: Child: "Humpty Dumpty sat on a wall, Humpty Dumpty, whoops, I dropped him!" (PT + PT + PRO)	

LAUGH (LA)

Definition

Laugh is an audible vocalization of laughter or giggling in a pleasant and agreeable manner in the context of a neutral or positive interaction. Coded only as a child category.

Decision Rules

1. When uncertain whether a sound is a Laugh, do not code Laugh.
2. When uncertain as to whether a Laugh is appropriate or is derisive or humiliating, do not code Laugh.

Child LA Guidelines

1. **A Laugh is a vocalization that may or may not occur simultaneously with a verbalization. When a child laughs a verbalization, both the vocalization and the verbalization category are coded.**

Examples	
Parent: I'll put a flower on top of his head. Child: (giggles while saying, "Pretty!") (LA + PRO)	Parent: (pushes car down ramp) Child: (laughs while saying, "That went fast.") (LA + PRO)

2. **Vocalizations (i.e., Laugh, Whine, Yell) without intelligible content are coded the appropriate vocalization category and no verbalization category is coded.**

Examples	
Parent: You are the fairy princess. Child: (laughs) (LA)	Parent: We don't have enough pieces left. Child: (whines, "Ooo.") (WH)
Parent: Are you pretending to be a shark? Child: (yells, "Aaugh!") (YE)	

3. **Laugh is coded when it occurs within the context of a neutral or positive interaction. When the context is hurtful or inappropriate, do not code Laugh. Even though the parent may initiate or join in the laughter, Laugh is not coded when the interaction includes ongoing child or parent inappropriate behavior (e.g., noncompliance, sarcasm).**

Examples	
Parent: Want to play hide and seek? Child: (laughs and climbs into toy box) (LA) ----- BUT: Parent: Help me clean this up. Child: (laughs and climbs into toy box). (laugh not coded + NC)	Parent: (drawing cat) I made her look like our cat. Child: (laughs and then says, "Your cat doesn't shed.") (LA + PRO) ----- BUT: Child: (laughs and then says, "That doesn't look right.") (NTA)
Dyad: (pinching each other and giggling) (laugh not coded; NTO)	

4. **Each laughed verbalization constitutes a separate Laugh. Laughed phrases separated from one another by a pause of 2 seconds or longer are coded as separate laughs.**

Examples	
Dyad: (making Lego car) Child: (laughing while saying, "Cool. It'll go fast.") (LA-PRO + LA-TA)	Parent: (flies toy figure through the air) It's Superman. Child: (laughing while saying, "Where's he going? Fly him to me.") (LA-QU + LA-CM)

5. **Laugh is a positive vocalization category. When laughing is derisive or humiliating, do not code Laugh.**

Examples	
Parent: (adds block to tall tower, causing it to fall over) Parent: (laughs and says, "Timber!") Child: (laughs) (LA)	Parent: What is that? (points to child's drawing) Child: (says "It's a froggie," and laughs) (PRO + LA) ----- BUT: Parent: (reaches for child saying, "Come here now!") Child: (laughs derisively and says, "No.") (NTA)
Parent: (accidentally knocks over her block tower) Child: (laughs tauntingly and says, "Yours fell over.") (PRO)	

- 6. One Laugh is coded at the termination of an episode of laughing or giggling. Each discrete episode of laughing or giggling is discontinued by a verbalization or by a pause in laughing of 2 seconds or longer. Subsequent laughter after a verbalization or a 2 second pause is coded as a new Laugh.**

Examples	
Parent: (making noises like a monkey) Child: (continuous giggling for 6 sec.) (LA)	Dyad: (playing tic-tac-toe) Child: (laughs; says, "I won!"; laughs) (LA-PRO + LA)
Parent: (making silly Potato Head) Child: (laughs as parent puts on ears) (2 sec. later, laughs as parent puts on mouth) (LA + LA)	Parent: I drew a smile on the fish. Child: (laughs while saying, "He's a happy fish"; laughs again) (LA-PRO + LA)

- 7. Laugh cannot be coded simultaneously with another vocalization category (i.e., Whine, Yell). If a parent simultaneously laughs and yells, code Yell. It is not possible for a Whine to simultaneously be a Laugh.**

Example
Child: (playfully climbs into toy box) Parent: I'm gonna get you. Child: (loud screeching laugh) (YE)

- 8. Laugh is coded when it occurs simultaneously with positive physical behavior. Laugh cannot be coded simultaneously with a negative physical behavior (i.e., Negative Touch) because Laugh can only be coded within a positive context.**

Examples
Parent: You did a great job! Child: (laughs and hugs parent) (PTO + LA) ----- BUT: Parent: I'll be right back. Child: (laughingly says, "Don't leave me," while hanging onto parent's legs.) (NTA + NTO)

Appendix C TABLES

Table 1. Reliability of Live Coding of the DPICS Categories in the Child Led Play (CLP) and Parent Led Play (PLP) Situations

	Pearson Correlation		Percent Agreement*		Cohen's Kappa	
	CLP	PLP	CLP	PLP	CLP	PLP
Parent Categories						
Direct Command	.90	.65	82%	67%	.72	.66
Indirect Command	.85	.60	62%	36%	.59	.46
Information Question	.96	.82	85%	87%	.76	.82
Descriptive/Reflective Question	.87	.92	74%	81%	.72	.78
Behavioral Description	.47	.93	40%	78%	.24	.76
Information Description	.83	.89	77%	82%	.67	.71
Reflection	.69	.73	65%	71%	.59	.69
Acknowledgement	.80	.91	67%	77%	.65	.74
Labeled Praise	.72	.25	17%	25%	.13	.29
Unlabeled Praise	.90	.93	71%	77%	.76	.45
Critical Statement	.74	.45	69%	33%	.76	.17
Play Talk	.99	.99	81%	75%	.86	.74
Child Categories						
Compliance	.83	.38	84%	80%	.95	.77
Noncompliance	.93	.90	39%	67%	.67	.74
No Opportunity for Compliance	.79	.45	83%	88%	.85	.88
Answer	.82	.73	82%	94%	.83	.89
No Answer	.63	.44	71%	56%	.54	.59
No Opportunity for Answer	.94	.91	94%	75%	.89	.80

Note. From Bessmer & Eyberg, 1993. All data based on mother-child dyads.

*Percent agreement based on summing agreements across participants divided by agreements plus disagreements across participants.

Table 2. Reliability of Videotaped Coding of DPICS-II Categories During Mother-Child Interactions Combined Across the Three DPICS Situations

Category	Pearson Correlation		Percent agreement*		Cohen's Kappa	
	Parent	Child	Parent	Child	Parent	Child
Information Question	.93	.96	85%	80%	.80	.87
Direct Command	.99	.89	82%	68%	.69	.72
Descriptive/Reflective Question	.90	.89	80%	68%	.74	.72
Unlabeled Praise	.88	.81	77%	50%	.70	.72
Information Description	.86	.93	75%	78%	.63	.71
Answer	.93	.82	74%	73%	.90	.82
Labeled Praise	.89	Did not occur	71%	Did not occur	.68	Did not occur
Laugh	.90	.96	67%	65%	.84	.78
Indirect Command	.92	.74	64%	45%	.63	.61
Critical Statement	.94	.60	63%	45%	.62	.58
Acknowledgement	.86	.79	58%	64%	.59	.74
Play Talk	.85	.95	69%	60%	.76	.70
Compliance	.79	.92	54%	63%	.73	.71
No Opportunity for Compliance	.82	.95	53%	67%	.70	.59
Reflection	.75	.66	48%	45%	.46	.51
Behavioral Description	.69	.63	43%	32%	.55	.43
Smart Talk	.81	.91	47%	55%	.57	.70
No Opportunity for Answer	.78	.78	44%	59%	.65	.71
Negative Touch	.82	.29	39%	18%	.86	.33
Positive Touch	.49	.37	37%	17%	.65	.61
Noncompliance	.99	.85	37%	48%	.63	.55
No Answer	.66	.64	35%	37%	.54	.51
Whine	.54	.85	21%	50%	.66	.57
Yell	Did not occur	.93	Did not occur	52%	Did not occur	.57

Note. Percent agreement is based on summing the agreements across participants and dividing by the agreements plus disagreements across participants (Bessmer, Brestan, & Eyberg, 2005)

Table 3. Reliability of Videotaped Coding of DPICS-II Categories During Father-Child Interactions Across the Three DPICS Situations

Category	Kappa		Intraclass Correlation	
	Father	Child	Father	Child
Compliance	.86	.69	.89	.95
Play Talk	.80	.76	.97	.92
Answer	.79	.84	.82	.93
Information Question	.76	.83	.91	.88
No Opportunity for Compliance	.76	.65	.66	.92
Negative Touch ^a	.74	1.0	.75	.89
Descriptive/Reflective Question	.69	.78	.89	.90
Physical Positive	.68	.65	.48	.40
Unlabeled Praise ^a	.66	.49	.75	.64
Direct Command	.65	.67	.98	.86
Indirect Command	.64	.60	.92	.83
Praise (total) ^b	.64	.66	.89	.84
No Answer	.64	.61	.49	.67
No Opportunity for Answer	.64	.70	.54	.74
Acknowledgement	.62	.81	.90	.91
Reflection	.58	.72	.66	.81
Noncompliance	.58	.61	.63	.92
Critical Statement ^a	.57	.61	.92	.74
Information Description	.57	.71	.90	.92
Smart Talk ^a	.56	1.0	.65	.91
Negative Talk ^b	.52	.66	.92	.89
Labeled Praise ^a	.49	**	.05	.00
Contingent Praise	.49	**	.00	**
Laugh	.48	.66	.83	.85
Behavioral Description	.46	.60	.53	.58
Destructive ^a	**	.09	-.03	.08
Whine ^a	**	.73	.26	.78
Yell ^a	**	.75	**	.76

Note. Adapted from Brestan, Foote, and Eyberg (2005). Analyses based on $N = 104$ 5-minute coding intervals, including the clinic-referred group ($n = 47$ coding intervals) and the comparison group ($n = 57$ coding intervals).

^aCoded only for the clinic-referred group.

^bCoded only for the comparison group (Negative Talk = Critical Statement/Smart Talk; Praise (total) = Unlabeled Praise/Labeled Praise/Contingent Praise).

** Could not be calculated due to insufficient data.

Table 4. Kappa Reliabilities for DPICS-II Categories with Disruptive Child-Parent Dyads at Pre-treatment

Categories	Child	Parent
Vocalizations		
Laugh	0.75 ^b	0.38 ^a
Whine	0.83	1.00 ^b
Yell	0.76	0.90 ^b
Answer Codes		
Answer	0.77	0.74 ^b
No Answer	0.63	0.57 ^b
No Opportunity to Answer	0.73	0.72 ^b
Compliance Codes		
Comply	0.70	0.77 ^b
Non-Comply	0.59	0.67 ^b
No Opportunity for Comply	0.56	0.61 ^b
Physical Behaviors		
Destructive	0.29 ^a	1.00
Negative Touch	0.88	0.69
Positive Touch	0.79	0.76
Verbalizations		
Acknowledgement	0.80 ^c	0.69 ^c
Behavioral Description	0.47 ^c	0.53
Critical Statement	0.65 ^c	0.61 ^c
Direct Command	0.71 ^c	0.70
Descriptive Question	0.77 ^c	0.75
Indirect Command	0.68 ^c	0.67
Information Description	0.72 ^c	0.66 ^c
Information Question	0.85 ^c	0.82
Labeled Praise	0.50 ^c	0.70
Play Talk	0.78 ^b	0.82 ^b
Reflection	0.72 ^c	0.56
Smart Talk	0.71 ^c	0.57 ^c
Unlabeled Praise	0.75 ^c	0.76

Note. Sample included 42 father-child dyads and 89 mother-child dyads. Reliabilities calculated across all three DPICS situations during pre-treatment.

^aCategory deleted from third revision due to poor reliability.

^bCategory moved to DPICS supplemental categories in Appendix B of this manual.

^cCategory has been combined with other categories in third revision of DPICS.

Table 5. One-week Test-Retest Reliability (Pearson Correlations)for Referred Mother-Child Dyads During Pretreatment Assessment (n = 79)

	Parent-Led Play Situation	Clean up Situation
Parent Critical Statement	.39**	.34**
Parent Praise	.47**	.57**
Child Negative Talk	.47**	.42**

Note. Adapted from Brinkmeyer (2005).

** $p < .001$.

Table 6. Studies Using the DPICS

Reference	Population	Psychometric Data Provided	Parent Categories Used	Child Categories Used
Aragona & Eyberg, 1981	Mothers of neglected, behavior problem, and normal children	Discriminative validity	DC, IC, TA, CR, Total Commands*, Total Describe*, Praise*, Total Verbal	None
Bessmer et al., 2005	Mother-child dyads from normal and conduct problem families	Normative; interrater reliability; discriminative validity	Commands*, Direct Command Ratio*, Prosocial Behavior*, Negative Talk*, Inappropriate Behavior*	NC, Ratio of Inappropriate Behavior*, Prosocial Behavior*
Borrego Jr. et al., 2004	Abusive and non-abusive mother-child dyads	Discriminative validity	CR, YE, DS, PN, Praise, PP, LA, AK, Descriptions, Questions, Commands	CO, NC
Brestan et al., 2005	Father-child referred and non-referred dyads	Normative; interrater reliability; discriminative validity	Commands, Inappropriate Behaviors, Prosocial Behaviors	CO, Inappropriate Behavior, Prosocial Behavior
Calzada, Eyberg, Rich, & Querido, 2004	Children with disruptive behavior disorders and their parents involved in PCIT	Descriptive	Demandingness*, Responsiveness*	CO, Alpha Compliance*, Beta Compliance*
Eisenstadt, Eyberg, McNeil, Newcomb, & Funderburk, 1993	Children referred for treatment of disruptive behavior and their parents	Treatment sensitivity	PN, PP	CO, Deviant Behavior*
Eyberg, Boggs, & Algina, 1995	Children referred for treatment of disruptive behavior disorders and their parents	Treatment sensitivity	Percent Praise*, Percent Negative Talk*	Percent CO, Percent Negative Talk*
Eyberg & Matarazzo, 1980	Children with speech and language disorders and their mothers	Treatment sensitivity	DC, IC, DQ, DS, LP, LP, CS	NONE
Eyberg & Robinson, 1982	Children referred for treatment of disruptive behavior and their parents	Treatment sensitivity	Total Praise*, Direct Command Ratio*, No Opportunity Ratio*	Total Deviance*, Compliance Ratio*, Noncompliance Ratio*
Eyberg et al., 2001	Children and mothers followed after successful treatment of disruptive behavior	Treatment sensitivity	Follow*, Lead*, Affection*, Negative Behaviors*	Verbal Positive and Deviant Behavior, Alpha Compliance and PN
Forster et al., 1990	4- to 8-year-old children with and without conduct problems	Inter-coder reliability; Discriminative validity	None	DQ, Praise, CR, Play Talk, Command
Gross et al., 2003	Parents and their 2- to 3-year-old children undergoing treatment for behavior problems	Treatment sensitivity	All Positive Parent Behavior*, IC, DC, CR, Intrusions*, PN	Aversive Child Behaviors (NC, DS, PN, Cry, WH, YE, ST), Positive Child Behaviors*
Hartman, Stage, & Webster-Stratton, 2003	Parents and children undergoing treatment for behavior problems	Treatment sensitivity	Coercive parenting*	Total Child Deviance*
Kniskern et al., 1983	Non-referred mother-child pairs	Generalization	TA, Irrelevant verbalizations, CR, UP LP, DQ, IQ, TA, BD, PP, PN, TA, DC	PN, DS, YE, ST, Cry, WH
McIntosh et al., 2000	Two-year-old child with behavior problems and her teacher	Treatment sensitivity	DQ, IQ, RF, BD, IC, DC, Praise	Commands, NC, CO, Disruptive, Ignore
McNeil, Eyberg, Eisenstadt, & Newcomb, 1991	Children with disruptive behavior disorders and their parents involved in PCIT	Treatment sensitivity	None	CO, Deviant Behavior*
Nelson et al., 2005 unpublished data analysis	Children referred for treatment of disruptive behavior disorders and their parents	Interrater reliability; treatment sensitivity	ALL DPICS-II individual categories	ALL DPICS-II individual categories
Nixon et al., 2003	Children with disruptive behavior disorders and their parents involved in PCIT	Treatment sensitivity	Praise, CR, DC, IC	CO, Deviant Behavior
Querido, Eyberg, & Boggs, 2001	Children with disruptive behavior disorders and their parents	Convergent validity	CR, PN	CR, ST, WH, YE, PN

Robinson & Eyberg, 1981	Normal mother-child dyads	Standardization of the DPICS (1 st ed.)	DC, IC, LP, UP, CR, Commands, Physical Positive, Physical Negative, and response to child deviant behavior	Changes activity, WH, Cry, Physical Negative, ST, YE, DS, CO, NC, and NOC
Schuhmann et al., 1998	Children referred for treatment of disruptive behavior disorders and their parents	Treatment sensitivity Inter-coder reliability	Praise, Percent Praise, CR, BD	CO
Stormshak & Webster-Stratton, 1999	Children undergoing treatment for behavior problems and their parents	Convergent validity	None	Total Child Deviance*
Timmer, Borrego, & Urquiza, 2002	Abusive and non-abusive mother-child dyads	Convergent validity	Questions*, Neutral Comments*, Commands*, Positive Behaviors*	AN, NA, Negative Behaviors*
Webster-Stratton, 1985a	Children observed interacting with their parents at home and in the clinic	Generalization	Total Praise, CR, Total Commands, DC	Deviance*
Webster-Stratton, 1994	Parents and their children undergoing treatment for behavior problems	Treatment sensitivity	Praise, Non-intrusive Descriptive Statements, Deviance*, CR	Deviance*
Webster-Stratton, 1998	Parents and their children undergoing treatment for behavior problems and parent-child dyads not in treatment	Treatment sensitivity	Positive Affect, Praise*, PP, CR, Commands*	Deviance*, NC, Total Positive Affect, Prosocial Behavior*
Webster-Stratton & Hammond, 1998	Children in Head Start and their parents	Convergent validity	Praise*, PP, CR	NC, Total Negative Behaviors (WH, cry, YE, PN, ST, DS)
Webster-Stratton & Hammond, 1999	Parents experiencing marital conflict and their children	Convergent validity	Positive Affect*, Negative Affect*, CR	Deviance*
Webster-Stratton & Lindsay, 1999	Clinic-referred and non-referred children	Convergent validity (relative to social processing)	None	Total Child Deviance*, Total Noncompliance*, Negative Affect*
Webster-Stratton, Reid, & Hammond, 2001	Parents and their 2- to 3-year-old children undergoing treatment for behavior problems	Treatment sensitivity	CR, PR, PP	NC, NOC, Child Deviance*
Wruble, Sheeber, Sorensen, & Boggs, 1991	Non-referred preschool children	Descriptive	IC, DC	CO
Zangwill, 1983	Conduct problem children receiving parent training treatment	Treatment sensitivity	Rate of Reinforcement*, Rate of Punishment*	Rate of Deviant Behavior*, Rate of Compliance*
Zangwill & Kniskern, 1982	Children observed interacting with their parents at home and in the clinic	Generalization	Rate of Reinforcement*, Rate of Punishment*	Rate of Deviant Behavior*, Rate of Compliance*

*Please refer to original article for detailed description of composite categories used.

Table 7. Inter-observer Reliability Estimates for DPICS II Categories and Validity Data by Source

Category	GIFT ^a Kappa	Foote ^b Kappa	Bessmer ^c Kappa	Discrimination Between Groups ^d		Pre to Post Treatment Differences ^d	
				Difference	No Difference	Difference	No Difference
Parent Acknowledgment (AK)	.69	.62	.59	2, 17	1	14 (fathers), 10	14 (mothers)
Parent Answer (AN)	.74	.79	.90			14 (mothers)	14 (fathers)
Parent Behavior Description (BD)	.53	.46	.55	2, 8, 17	1	14, 8 (CDI only), 12, 16	7, 8 (PDI)
Parent Compliance (CO)	.77	.86	.73			14	
Parent Contingent Praise (CP)	---	.49	---			14	
Parent Critical Statement (CR)	.61	.57	.62	2, 4, 8, 17, 21	1	14, 6, 8 (CDI only), 9, 10, 11, 15, 16, 18, 19, 21, 22	7, 8 (PDI)
Parent Descriptive Question (DQ)	.75	.69	.74	2, 8	17	14, 8, 12	7
Parent Direct Command (DC)	.70	.65	.69	2, 3, 8, 17	1, 4	14, 8 (CDI only), 9, 10, 11, 12, 15, 19	7, 8 (PDI)
Parent Indirect Command (IC)	.67	.64	.63	2, 3, 8, 17	1, 4	14, 8 (CDI only), 10, 11, 12, 16, 19	7
Parent Information Description (ID)	.66	.57	.63	2, 8, 17	1	8 (CDI only), 12	7, 8 (PDI)
Parent Information Question (IQ)	.82	.76	.80	2	17	14, 12	7
Parent Labeled Praise (LP)	.70	.49	.68	2, 8, 17	1, 21	14, 6, 8, 9, 10, 12, 15, 16, 19, 22	7
Parent Smart Talk (ST)	.57	.56	.57	3, 4		14, 6	
Parent Negative Touch (NTO)	.69		.86	2, 3, 4, 17		14, 5, 10, 20	7
Parent No Answer (NA)	.57	.64	.54			14	
Parent Noncompliance (NC)	.67	.58	.63			14	
Parent No Opportunity for Answer (NOA)	.72	.64	.65				
Parent No Opportunity for Compliance (NOC)	.61	.76	.70				
Parent Positive Touch (PTO)	.76	.68	.65	2	21	19	5, 7
Parent Reflection (RF)	.56	.58	.46	17		14, 12, 18	7
Parent Unlabeled Praise (UP)	.76	.66	.70	2, 8, 17	1, 21	14, 6, 8, 9, 10, 12, 16, 19, 22	7
Parent Play Talk (PT)	.82	.80	.76				
Parent Laugh (LA)	.38	.48	.84	2			
Parent Whine (WH)	1.00	---	.66	3, 4, 17		14	
Parent Yell (YE)	.90	---	---	2, 3, 4, 17			
Parent Destructive (DS)	1.00	---	---	2, 3, 4, 17			
Child Acknowledgment (AK)	.80	.81	.74		17	14	
Child Answer (AN)	.77	.84	.82		17	14	
Child Behavior Description (BD)	.47	.60	.43		17		
Child Compliance (CO)	.70	.69	.71	2, 3, 4		14, 5, 6, 9, 15, 16	12, 13
Child Descriptive Question (DQ)	.77	.78	.72				
Child Destructive (DS)	.29	---	---	3, 4	17	9, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22	5, 7, 10, 13, 15
Child Direct Command (DC)	.71	.67	.72				
Child Indirect Command (IC)	.68	.60	.61				
Child Information Description (ID)	.72	.71	.71		17	14 (mothers)	14 (fathers)
Child Information	.85	.83	.87			14 (IT mothers only)	14 (WL mothers, all

Question (IQ)							fathers)
Child Labeled Praise (LP)	.50	---	---		17		
Child Critical Statements (CR)	.65	.61	.58	3, 4	17		14, 6, 13, 15
Child Smart Talk (ST)	.71	1.0	.70	3, 4, 23		9, 11, 18, 19, 20, 22, 24	5, 6, 7, 10, 13, 15
Child Negative Touch (NTO)	.88	---	.33	3, 4, 22	17	9, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 24	5, 10, 13, 15
Child No Answer (NA)	.63	.61	.51		17	14 (IT mothers only)	14 (WL mothers, all fathers)
Child Noncompliance (NC)	.59	.61	.55	22		14, 9, 11, 12, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 24	7, 10
Child No Opportunity for Answer (NOA)	.73	.70	.71			14	
Child No Opportunity for Compliance (NOC)	.56	.65	.59			14, 9, 22 (fathers)	22 (mothers)
Child Positive Touch (PTO)	.79	.65	.61		17	19	
Child Reflection (RF)	.72	.72	.51		17		
Child Unlabeled Praise (UP)	.75	.49	.72		17		
Child Play Talk (PT)	.78	.76	.70			14 (fathers)	14 (mothers)
Child Laugh (LA)	.75	.66	.78		17	14 (fathers), 19	14 (mothers), 7,
Child Whine (WH)	.83	.73	.57	3, 4, 22	17	14 (IT mothers only), 9, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 24	14 (WL mothers, all fathers), 5, 7, 10, 13, 15
Child Yell (YE)	.76	.75	.57	3, 4, 22	17	14 (IT mothers only), 9, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 24	14 (WL mothers, all fathers), 5, 7, 10, 13, 15

^aData from Project GIFT (Growing Into the Future Together) R01 MH 60632, Eyberg and Boggs, in progress.

^bBrestan, Foote, and Eyberg (2005) Calculated kappas for parent and child categories using referred and non-referred children, except those in bold, which were for referred father-child dyads only.

^cBessmer, Brestan, and Eyberg (2005).

^dStudy numbers correspond to studies listed by number in Table 7 below.

Table 8. Studies Using DPICS to Distinguish Between Groups or Demonstrate Pre-Post Treatment Effects

	Study	Specific Findings
1	Aragona & Eyberg (1981)	- Neglectful mother displayed more CR during CDI and PDI than non-neglectful mothers - Neglectful mothers exhibited less praise (LP, UP), acknowledgment and more DC during PDI than non-neglectful parents - There were no observed differences between neglectful and non-neglectful mothers in use of descriptive statements (ID, BD) or indirect commands - Mothers of neglected children and mothers of children with behavior problems displayed comparable rates of commands (IC, DC), descriptive statements (ID, BD), acknowledgement, praise (UP, LP) and critical statements - Mothers of children with behavior problems, compared to mothers of children without behavior problems, exhibited: more Critical Statements in CDI and PD; and fewer direct commands, praises, and acknowledgments during PDI
2	Borrego, Timmer, Urquiza, & Follette (2004)	- Physically abusive mothers were more likely to respond with negative behavior (CR, YE, DS, or PN) than non-abusive mothers immediately preceding or following child NC - Abusive mothers demonstrated lower rates of positive behaviors (UP, LP, PP, LA) than non-abusive mothers - Abusive mothers were less likely than non-abusive mothers to exhibit positive behaviors (UP, LP, PP, LA) immediately before child CO - Both abusive and non-abusive mothers were more likely to give a command (IC, DC) than a neutral verbalization (AK, BD, ID, IQ, DQ) after child NC - Both abusive and non-abusive mothers were more likely to exhibit positive behaviors (UP, LP, PP, LA) after child CO than after a neutral child behavior - Abusive and non-abusive mothers did not differ in their likelihood of praising child CO - Rates of CO were lower for abused children than non-abused children
3	Bessmer, Brestan, & Eyberg (2005)	- Non-referred mothers gave fewer commands (as part of total commands composite and direct command ratio) than referred mothers - Non-referred mothers showed less inappropriate behavior (ST, PN, WH, YE, DS) than referred mothers - Non-referred children displayed higher compliance than referred children with mothers (as part of compliance ratio) - Non-referred children displayed less inappropriate behavior (DS, CR, PN, WH, WH, YE) than referred children with mothers
4	Brestan, Foote, & Eyberg (2005) ^b	- Referred and non-referred fathers were comparable in the number of commands given (as part of total commands composite) - Non-referred fathers displayed less inappropriate behavior (CR, ST, PN, WH, YE, DS) than referred fathers - Non-referred children displayed more compliance with fathers than referred children (as part of compliance ratio) - Non-referred children displayed less inappropriate behavior (YE, WH, PN, CR, DS) than referred children with fathers
5	Eisenstadt, Eyberg, McNeil, Newcomb, & Funderburk (1993)	- Parents displayed less PN behavior after treatment - No observed treatment effect for Parent PP - Child compliance higher after treatment [as percentage: CO/(IC+DC)] - No observed treatment effect for Child Deviant Behavior composite (DS, CR, PN, WH, YE)
6	Eyberg, Boggs, & Algina (1995)	- Mothers showed less negative talk (CR, ST) after treatment - Children did not show a treatment effect for negative talk (CR, ST) - Mothers demonstrated a higher percent praise (LP, UP) after treatment - Mothers demonstrated increased praise after treatment - Child compliance increased after treatment (as percentage)
7	Eyberg et al., (2001)	Did not find significant pre-post differences for child deviant behavior (WH, YE, 'Cry,' ST, DS), parent leading (DQ, DC, IQ, IC), parent following (ID, BD, RF), parent affection (UP, LP, PP), child verbal positive (LA, 'self praise'), child alpha compliance ratio, or parent negative behavior (CR, PN) although effect sizes were moderate to large
8	Eyberg & Matarazzo (1980)	- Mothers receiving individual interaction training described (BD, ID) more, criticized less, and gave fewer commands during CDI phase of PCIT; no observed change in PDI phase of PCIT than mothers who did not receive treatment - Mothers receiving individual interaction training gave fewer indirect commands; asked fewer questions; and praised more during CDI and PDI phases of PCIT than mothers who did not receive treatment - Mothers who received individual interaction training made fewer CR in CDI than those receiving didactic group training than mothers who did not receive treatment - Mothers who received individual interaction training asked more questions; gave fewer

		indirect commands; and praised more in CDI and PDI than mothers receiving didactic group training Mothers who received individual interaction training gave fewer commands and described (ID, BD) more in CDI than mothers receiving didactic group training
9	Eyberg & Robinson (1982)	- Parents criticized less, gave fewer commands and gave fewer no opportunity commands after treatment - Parent gave more praise (LP, UP) after treatment - Children were more compliant after treatment (as part of compliance ratio composite) - Children displayed less deviant behavior (DS, CR, PN, YE, WH) after treatment
10	Gross, Fogg et al. (2003)	- No treatment effect for Child YE as part of Child Behavior Problems Ratio composite - Parent positive behavior ratio improved with treatment (AK, LP, UP, 'positive parent behavior,' and 'positive parent affect' divided by CR, 'critical commands,' 'intrusions,' and PN) - Child behavior problems (DS, ST, PN, YE, WH, NC) did not change with treatment
11	Hartman, Stage, & Webster-Stratton (2003)	- Parents demonstrated less coercive parenting (CR, DC, IC) after treatment - Children display fewer deviant behavior (YE, DS, CR, PN, NC, WH) after treatment
12	McIntosh, Rizza, & Bliss (2000)	- Teachers exhibited more descriptive statements (ID, BD), more praise (UP, LP), more reflections (RF), fewer commands (IC, DC), and fewer questions (IQ, DQ) after Teacher-Child Interaction Treatment - No treatment effect observed for child compliance with Teacher-Child treatment (as frequency; note commands decreased with treatment)
13	McNeil, Eyberg, Eisenstadt, Newcomb, & Funderburk (1991)	- No observed changes in child deviant behavior (YE, CR, DS, PN, WH) after treatment - Higher percent child compliance after treatment
14	Nelson, Eyberg, Boggs, & Stevens (2005) ^a unpublished raw data	- Parent acknowledgment decreased with treatment for fathers only - Parent answer decreased with treatment for mothers only - Parent behavior description, contingent praise, reflection, unlabeled praise, whine, labeled praise, increased with treatment for mothers and fathers - Parent criticize, descriptive question, direct commands, information questions decreased with treatment for mothers and fathers - Mothers complied more with child commands after treatment; fathers complied less after treatment - Child compliance increased with mothers as part of Alpha and Beta Compliance, increased with fathers as part of beta compliance only - Child information description decreased with mothers only - Child information question, no answer, whine, yell decreased with immediate treatment mothers only, no change in wait list mothers at post-treatment - Child noncompliance, no opportunity for answer, no opportunity for compliance decreased with mothers and fathers after treatment - Child play talk, laugh decreased with fathers only - No treatment effect noted for child critical statements
15	Nixon, Sweeney, Erickson, & Touyz (2003)	- Mothers criticized less after treatment - Mothers praised more after standard or abbreviated PCIT compared to WL controls - Mothers gave fewer commands (IC, DC) after treatment and praised more (UP, LP) - Child compliance increased (as percentage) with treatment - Total Child Deviance (YE, DS, CR, PN, WH) did not change with treatment
16	Schuhmann et al. (1998)	- The treated group of parents demonstrated fewer Critical Statements, more descriptions (BD), and more praise (LP, UP) than the untreated group - Higher child compliance with mothers and fathers observed in treated group than untreated group (as percentage)
17	Timmer, Borrego, & Urquiza (2002)	- Abusive mothers exhibited fewer neutral behaviors (BD, ID, RF, AK) than non-abusive mothers - Abusive mothers were more likely than non-abusive mothers to demonstrate negative behavior (CR, WH, YE, DS, PN) following child AK - Non-abusive mothers were more likely than abusive mothers to exhibit neutral behaviors (BD, ID, RF, AK) after a child NA - Non-abusive mothers were more likely than abusive mothers to exhibit neutral behaviors (BD, ID, RF, AK) after a child AK - Abusive and non-abusive mothers did not differ in the frequency of questions given (IQ, DQ) - Abused and non-abused children did not differ in the frequency of the following child codes: AK, AN, BD, DS, ID, LP, CR, NTO, PTO, NA, RF, UP, LA, WH, YE - Abused and non-abused children were more likely to exhibit negative behavior (CR, WH, YE, DS, PN) after a parent command than after a parent question or neutral comment (BD, ID, RF, AK) - Abused children were more likely than non-abused children to exhibit negative behavior (CR, WH, YE, DS, PN) after a parent question

		- Abused children were more likely than non-abused children to respond to parent question with an AK - Abused and non-abused children were more likely to exhibit neutral behavior (BD, ID, RF, AK) after a parent question than after a parent command or neutral comment
18	Webster-Stratton (1994)	- Parents criticized less and reflected more after treatment - Children displayed less deviant behavior (DS, YE, CR, PN, NC, WH) after treatment
19	Webster-Stratton (1998)	- After treatment, parents criticized less, gave fewer commands (DC, IC) and showed more positive parenting (UP, LP, PP) - Children displayed less deviance and noncompliance (DS, 'cry,' YE, WH, NC, PN) and more positive affect ("Affectionate Behavior," LA) after treatment
20	Webster-Stratton & Hammond (1990)	- Use of Critical Statements and physical negative behaviors decreased with treatment for mothers and fathers. - Child deviant behavior (WH, 'cry,' PN, ST, YE, DS, NC) in interactions with both parents decreased with treatment
21	Webster-Stratton & Hammond (1998)	- Parents of children with pervasive social competence problems criticized more than parents of children with non-pervasive social competence problems; parents of normal children criticized the least - Parents of children with social competence problems displayed less "positive affect," PP, UP, and LP than parents of normal children (as part of Total positive affect, praise, and physical positive composite) - Parents of children with pervasive conduct problems criticized more than parents of children with non-pervasive conduct problems; parents of normal children criticized the least - Parents' use of 'positive affect,' LP, UP, and PP did not distinguish children with conduct problems from normal (as part of Total positive affect, praise, and physical positive composite)
22	Webster-Stratton, Hollinsworth, & Kolpacoff (1989)	- Children displayed less deviant behavior and noncompliance (YE, CR, DS, PN, NC, WH) with mothers and fathers after treatment - Mothers and fathers praised (LP +UP) more and criticized less after treatment - Fathers gave less no opportunity commands after treatment, no treatment effect noted for mothers (as total NOC commands composite)
23	Webster-Stratton & Lindsay (1999)	Referred children displayed more deviant behavior (PN, WH, CR, ST, YE, 'Cry,' 'Aggression') and more NC than non-referred children
24	Webster-Stratton, Reid, & Hammond (2001)	Less child deviance (YE, CR, PN, NC, WH) observed in treated group than non-treated group

^aCombined the three situations

Table 9. New Individual DPICS Categories Created from Combining Second Edition Categories

New DPICS Parent Categories	Old Parent Categories from DPICS-II
Neutral Talk (TA)	Acknowledgement (AK) + Information Description (ID)
Negative Talk (NTA)	Critical Statement (CR) + Smart Talk (ST)
New DPICS Child Categories	Old Child Categories from DPICS-II
Prosocial Talk (PRO)	Acknowledgement (AK) + Information Description (ID) + Behavioral Description (BD) + Reflection (RF) + Labeled Praise (LP) + Unlabeled Praise (UP)
Question (QU)	Descriptive/Reflective Question (DQ) + Information Question (IQ)
Command (CM)	Direct Command (DC) + Indirect Command (IC)
Negative Talk (NTA)	Critical Statement (CR) + Smart Talk (ST)

Table 10. Mother-Child Interactions: Frequency of Category Occurrences in 25 Random 5-Minute Interactions of Child-Led Play (CLP), Parent-Led Play (PLP), and Clean-up (CU) at Pre and Post Treatment (Number of Occurrences in 125 Minutes of Observation in Each DPICS Standard Situation)

	Pre CDI	Pre PDI	Pre CU	Post CDI	Post PDI	Post CU
Parent Categories						
Acknowledgement	190	152	179	168	171	152
Behavioral Description	4	5	4	129	33	20
Contingent Praise	0	0	0	0	0	0
Critical Statement	62	127	148	17	37	42
Direct Command	89	347	528	26	146	256
Descriptive Question	249	225	180	62	66	37
Destructive	1	1	0	1	4	0
Indirect Command	49	227	311	26	133	98
Information Description	382	666	482	497	622	325
Information Question	188	143	72	16	40	13
Laugh	16	12	6	33	24	6
Labeled Praise	6	3	3	102	121	106
Physical Negative	3	28	27	1	5	4
Physical Positive	13	11	16	10	10	26
Play Talk	92	153	21	216	81	12
Reflection	31	15	7	109	46	23
Smart Talk	19	12	47	2	2	2
Unlabeled Praise	34	30	63	118	175	207
Warning	0	0	0	0	0	3
Whine	1	5	12	0	2	0
Yell	1	2	0	1	1	0
Child Categories						
Acknowledgement	151	106	90	63	96	70
Behavioral Description	0	0	0	3	2	0
Contingent Praise	0	0	0	0	0	0
Critical Statement	29	67	55	25	37	24
Direct Command	67	45	54	91	58	38
Descriptive Question	75	49	85	64	107	80
Destructive	40	15	30	26	12	55
Indirect Command	45	36	32	31	49	25
Information Description	537	393	350	477	391	204
Information Question	78	56	55	48	45	36
Laugh	10	12	8	20	36	8
Labeled Praise	0	0	0	1	0	0
Physical Negative	3	14	2	1	1	3
Physical Positive	0	1	6	5	9	7
Play Talk	181	110	38	341	60	63
Reflection	12	5	1	5	6	1
Smart Talk	9	82	149	15	34	20
Unlabeled Praise	3	0	2	14	11	8
Whine	50	111	207	12	43	54
Yell	78	83	30	29	3	11

Table 11. Father-Child Interactions: Frequency of Category Occurrences in 25 Random 5-Minute Interactions of Child-Led Play (CLP), Parent-Led Play (PLP), and Clean-up (CU) at Pre and Post Treatment (Number of Occurrences in 125 Minutes of Observation in Each DPICS Standard Situation)

	Pre CLP	Pre PLP	Pre CU	Post CLP*	Post PLP*	Post CU*
Parent Categories						
Acknowledgement	251	202	152	172	155	157
Behavioral Description	8	7	7	64	23	18
Contingent Praise	0	0	0	0	0	0
Critical Statement	32	112	125	18	49	41
Direct Command	74	348	448	43	187	234
Descriptive Question	362	269	180	71	122	65
Destructive	18	2	2	0	4	0
Indirect Command	45	193	187	39	115	149
Information Description	408	626	474	480	590	413
Information Question	231	136	55	38	43	24
Laugh	35	22	11	21	15	15
Labeled Praise	5	3	7	69	61	75
Physical Negative	0	13	9	4	2	4
Physical Positive	11	29	10	15	5	22
Play Talk	48	54	16	238	160	11
Reflection	56	28	15	79	37	10
Smart Talk	4	4	13	1	8	7
Unlabeled Praise	37	59	59	114	121	233
Warning	0	0	0	0	0	1
Whine	0	2	3	2	2	0
Yell	0	0	2	0	2	14
Child Categories						
Acknowledgement	199	202	106	86	127	97
Behavioral Description	2	0	3	3	2	1
Contingent Praise	0	0	0	0	0	0
Critical Statement	16	38	37	34	25	17
Direct Command	115	68	33	58	33	32
Descriptive Question	80	59	64	60	70	67
Destructive	70	56	45	30	25	12
Indirect Command	32	25	23	46	33	17
Information Description	570	419	281	385	415	269
Information Question	74	60	50	31	40	47
Laugh	56	49	10	19	15	22
Labeled Praise	0	0	2	2	1	2
Physical Negative	5	7	6	8	4	8
Physical Positive	8	9	2	9	0	9
Play Talk	135	88	49	185	172	22
Reflection	7	10	2	5	9	5
Smart Talk	21	29	71	12	26	30
Unlabeled Praise	2	9	1	10	15	5
Whine	7	63	101	17	28	29
Yell	18	33	30	9	11	38

Note. Data based on 22 observations (110 minutes of observation).

Table 12. Common Child Composite Categories

Category	Equation
% Alpha Compliance (coded only in PLP and CU)	$cCO \div [(pDC + pIC) - cNOC]$
% Alpha Noncompliance (coded only in PLP and CU)	$cNC \div [(pDC + pIC) - cNOC]$
% Beta Compliance (coded only in PLP and CU)	$cCO \div (pDC + pIC)$
% Beta Noncompliance (coded only in PLP and CU)	$cNC \div (pDC + pIC)$
% Opportunity Commands (coded only in PLP and CU)	$(cCO + cNC) \div (cCO + cNC + cNOC)$
% Answer to Questions	$cAN \div (cAN + cNA)$
% No Answer to Questions	$cNA \div (pIQ - cNOA)$
Inappropriate Behavior	$cNTA + cNTO + cYE + cWH$

Note. See *Quick Reference Guide* at the front of this manual for definitions of category abbreviations. The subscript c indicates the child category. The subscript p indicates the parent category.

Table 13. Common Parent Composite Categories

Category	Equation
Total Commands ^a	$pIC + pDC$
Direct Command Ratio	$pDC \div (pIC + pDC)$
Total Praise	$pLP + pUP$
% Praise	$(pLP + pUP) \div \text{Total Parent Verbalizations}^b$
% Negative Talk	$pNTA \div \text{Total Parent Verbalizations}^b$
% Positive Following (coded only in CLP)	$(pBD + pRF + pLP + pUP) \div \text{Total Parent Verbalizations}^b$
% Positive Leading (coded only in PLP and CU)	$(pDC + pBD + pRF + pLP + pUP) \div \text{Total Parent Verbalizations}^b$
% Negative Leading	$(pDQ + pIQ + pIC + pNTA) \div \text{Total Parent Verbalizations}^b$
Inappropriate Behavior	$pIQ + pDQ + pNTA + pNTO$
Prosocial Behavior	$pBD + pRF + pUP + pLP + pPTO$

Note. Please see the Quick Reference Guide at the front of the manual for definition of category abbreviations.

The subscript p indicates the parent category.

^a Also called Demandingness (Calzada, Eyberg, Rich, & Querido, 2004).

^b Total Parent Verbalizations = $pNTA + pDC + pIC + pLP + pUP + pIQ + pDQ + pRF + pBD + pTA$.

Table 14. Examples of Appropriate and Inappropriate Toys for DPICS Observations

Appropriate Toys	Inappropriate Toys
Building blocks	Bats or balls
Legos or Duplos	Scissors
Wooden puzzles	Hammer
Magnetic letters and numbers	Toy Guns or Swords
Constructo-Straws	Superhero Figures
Tinker Toys	Story books
Chalkboard and chalk	Puppets
Magna-Doodle	Toy Telephones
Toy tea set or food	Play Dough
Toy buildings with toy people, animals, vehicles, etc.	Paints or markers
Mr. or Mrs. Potato Head	Bubbles
Lincoln Logs	Board games or card games
Coloring books	Video Games
Crayons (sometimes)	Crayons (sometimes)

Table 15. Priority Order and Decision Rules for the DPICS Categories

The Priority Order

When a behavior contains elements of more than one category *within* a class of behavior, only one category is coded. For example, the sentence “Isn’t that pretty snowflake you drew!” has elements of two categories in the verbalization class: a *Descriptive/Reflective Question* and a *Labeled Praise*. A **Priority Order** has been established (shown in Table 15, Appendix C) that lists the categories for each class in the order of their importance to the quality of the parent-child interaction. Thus, in the example given, the priority order indicates that praise takes precedence over questions. Therefore, this verbalization is coded only as a *Labeled Praise*.

Decision Rules

There will be times when a coder is **not sure** which category in a class should be coded. Using the hypothetical sentence, “Isn’t that a brightlight snowflake you drew,” if you were unsure if “brightlight” is positive or neutral, you might be unsure if the sentence is a praise or a question. When a coder cannot decide between two categories, the manual has **Decision Rules** to guide the choice. The decision rules list the categories in exactly reverse order from the priority order (see Table 15, Appendix C). That is, when in doubt between two categories, the decision rules guide the coder to select the category that is least important to the quality of the parent-child interaction. The decision rules are intended to prevent over-coding of important behaviors when there is doubt. At the same time, they are intended to help prevent the coding of neither category when in doubt, so that the overall rate of behavior during the interaction is not underestimated.

Note that when a behavior contains elements of two categories in *different* classes of behavior, such as a yelled criticism, both elements (e.g., both the *Yell* and the *Critical Statement*) are coded. Similarly, if two behaviors from different classes occur simultaneously, such as child compliance and a child verbalization, both behaviors are coded.

Priority Order	Decision Rules Order
<i>Parent Verbalizations</i>	
Negative Talk (formerly CR and ST)	Neutral Talk (formerly AK and ID)
Direct Command	Behavioral Description
Indirect Command	Reflective Statement
Labeled Praise	Descriptive/Reflective Question
Unlabeled Praise	Information Question
Information Question	Unlabeled Praise
Descriptive/Reflective Question	Labeled Praise
Reflective Statement	Indirect Command
Behavioral Description	Direct Command
Neutral Talk	Negative Talk
<i>Parent Physical Behaviors</i>	
Negative Touch	Positive Touch
Positive Touch	Negative Touch
<i>Child Verbalizations</i>	
Negative Talk (formerly CR and ST)	Prosocial Talk (formerly AK, ID, RF, BD, LP, and UP)
Command	Question
Question	Command
Prosocial Talk	Negative Talk
<i>Child Vocalizations</i>	
Yell	Whine
Whine	Yell
<i>Child Physical Behaviors</i>	
Negative Touch	Positive Touch
Positive Touch	Negative Touch

Note. The categories in the classes of Responses Following Commands and Responses Following Information Questions cannot occur simultaneously.

Table 16. Pretreatment Means for 5-Minute Child Led Play Interaction with Children with Oppositional Defiant Disorder

	Mother		Child with Mother		Father		Child with Father	
	Mean	SD	Mean	SD	Mean	SD	Mean	SD
Verbalization categories								
Neutral Talk	9.12	5.68	7.09	4.55	7.51	4.81	7.32	4.01
Behavioral Description	0.22	0.38	0.04	0.16	0.19	0.47	0.06	0.23
Contingent Praise	0.00	0.00	---- ^a	---- ^a	0.00	0.00	---- ^a	---- ^a
Critical Statement	1.37	1.54	0.97	1.11	1.42	2.23	1.99	2.57
Direct Command	3.50	3.73	3.42	2.94	3.71	3.44	4.21	3.25
Descriptive Question	10.68	6.28	2.76	2.37	9.49	5.46	2.73	2.37
Indirect Command	1.23	1.18	1.49	1.47	1.33	1.34	1.57	1.27
Neutral Talk	14.68	8.44	22.61	9.65	12.35	7.47	21.94	8.09
Information Question	6.43	3.61	3.22	2.98	6.70	2.78	3.96	4.38
Labeled Praise	0.07	0.23	0.00	0.00	0.10	0.23	0.02	0.11
Play Talk	2.27	4.70	7.02	8.64	3.37	7.16	6.70	9.06
Reflection	0.92	1.10	0.44	0.84	0.80	1.43	0.12	0.27
Smart Talk	0.04	0.16	0.26	0.51	0.02	0.15	0.55	0.94
Unlabeled Praise	0.99	1.08	0.17	0.35	0.86	1.13	0.25	0.55
Vocalization Categories								
Laugh	---- ^a	---- ^a	1.51	2.00	---- ^a	---- ^a	1.31	1.95
Whine	0.00	0.00	0.42	0.91	0.00	0.00	0.74	1.84
Yell	0.02	0.13	0.33	0.88	0.00	0.00	0.42	1.09
Physical Categories								
Negative Touch	0.05	0.20	0.07	0.25	0.08	0.33	0.08	0.29
Positive Touch	0.39	0.83	0.11	0.30	0.20	0.56	0.12	0.45
Response Categories								
Answer	1.91	2.05	3.52	2.27	1.88	2.27	3.86	2.07
No Answer	0.49	0.70	1.16	1.39	0.99	1.24	1.05	0.96
No Opportunity for Answer	0.79	1.09	1.67	1.48	1.08	1.55	1.69	1.25
Comply			1.25	1.57	1.50	1.98	1.42	1.17
Noncompliant	0.30	0.47	0.38	0.57	0.48	0.69	0.70	0.77
No Opportunity for Compliance	3.36	2.48	3.11	2.95	3.74	2.49	2.94	2.75
Selected Composite Categories								
Inappropriate Behavior	18.57	8.67	7.29	4.41	17.71	7.39	9.31	6.09
Prosocial Behavior	2.59	2.10	2.02	1.88	2.14	1.83	1.99	1.46
Percent Negative Verbalizations	0.45	0.11	---- ^a	---- ^a	0.48	0.13	---- ^a	---- ^a
Percent Positive Following	0.04	0.04	---- ^a	---- ^a	0.04	0.03	---- ^a	---- ^a
Total Commands	4.73	4.30	---- ^a	---- ^a	5.05	3.91	---- ^a	---- ^a
Total Praise	1.06	1.15	---- ^a	---- ^a	0.95	1.18	---- ^a	---- ^a
Total Verbalizations	51.52	20.63	50.48	16.04	47.85	16.82	53.42	15.30

Table 17. Pretreatment Means for 5-Minute Parent Led Play Interaction with Children with Oppositional Defiant Disorder

	Mother		Child with Mother		Father		Child with Father	
	Mean	SD	Mean	SD	Mean	SD	Mean	SD
Verbalization categories								
Neutral Talk	7.26	4.33	6.52	4.10	7.13	4.46	6.74	4.97
Behavioral Description	0.20	0.36	0.06	0.25	0.26	0.61	0.04	0.13
Contingent Praise	0.00	0.00	---- ^a	---- ^a	0.01	0.08	---- ^a	---- ^a
Critical Statement	6.77	4.82	2.29	3.01	6.82	5.16	1.56	2.00
Direct Command	15.84	10.42	2.42	2.26	19.44	12.10	2.40	2.36
Descriptive Question	10.40	5.48	2.86	2.20	10.05	5.54	2.82	2.16
Indirect Command	7.78	4.88	1.34	1.11	8.11	4.43	1.24	1.43
Neutral Talk	23.36	9.58	19.38	8.54	21.43	8.82	18.95	7.81
Information Question	5.79	4.41	2.47	2.14	5.63	4.54	2.81	2.49
Labeled Praise	0.21	0.46	0.02	0.13	0.11	0.26	0.00	0.00
Play Talk	2.15	4.53	2.90	5.50	0.40	0.75	2.82	4.36
Reflection	0.46	0.66	0.50	0.90	0.46	0.58	0.39	0.61
Smart Talk	0.47	1.36	2.92	4.98	0.20	0.35	3.29	5.93
Unlabeled Praise	1.98	2.58	0.18	0.39	2.05	2.10	0.24	0.64
Vocalization Categories								
Laugh	---- ^a	---- ^a	1.27	2.24	---- ^a	---- ^a	1.08	1.62
Whine	0.00	0.00	3.91	8.43	0.00	0.00	2.67	5.31
Yell	0.03	0.24	1.24	3.03	0.04	0.13	0.93	2.55
Physical Categories								
Negative Touch	1.19	2.76	0.51	1.36	0.68	1.60	0.39	1.86
Positive Touch	0.53	1.18	0.16	0.59	0.26	0.68	0.04	0.13
Response Categories								
Answer	1.36	1.29	2.78	2.24	1.69	1.95	3.08	3.33
No Answer	0.65	1.03	0.85	1.12	0.58	0.79	0.88	1.10
No Opportunity for Answer	0.43	0.59	2.09	2.05	0.48	0.55	1.61	1.23
Comply	0.50	0.68	5.01	4.06	0.49	0.62	6.70	4.75
Noncompliant	0.80	1.03	4.25	4.44	0.77	1.05	4.68	4.44
No Opportunity for Compliance	2.42	2.04	14.13	8.62	2.35	2.33	16.08	8.72
Selected Composite Categories								
Inappropriate Behavior	24.62	10.38	11.05	8.08	23.38	8.80	10.87	7.42
Prosocial Behavior	3.38	3.83	5.93	4.42	3.14	2.52	7.40	4.68
Percent Negative Verbalizations	---- ^a	---- ^a	---- ^a	---- ^a	---- ^a	---- ^a	---- ^a	---- ^a
Percent Positive Following	---- ^a	---- ^a	---- ^a	---- ^a	---- ^a	---- ^a	---- ^a	---- ^a
Total Commands	23.62	12.70	---- ^a	---- ^a	27.55	12.84	---- ^a	---- ^a
Total Praise	2.19	2.93	---- ^a	---- ^a	2.15	2.10	---- ^a	---- ^a
Total Verbalizations	82.66	23.55	46.16	16.14	82.11	20.87	44.86	17.17

Table 18. Pretreatment Means for 5-Minute Clean-up Interaction with Children with Oppositional Defiant Disorder

	Mother		Child with Mother		Father		Child with Father	
	Mean	SD	Mean	SD	Mean	SD	Mean	SD
Verbalization categories								
Neutral Talk	6.53	4.26	4.27	3.16	4.78	4.52	4.25	2.97
Behavioral Description	0.15	0.35	0.00	0.00	0.11	0.31	0.01	0.08
Contingent Praise	0.01	0.11	---- ^a	---- ^a	0.00	0.00	---- ^a	---- ^a
Critical Statement	5.82	4.34	1.91	2.81	4.76	4.49	1.39	1.79
Direct Command	23.01	14.99	2.19	2.28	21.39	14.57	1.70	2.21
Descriptive Question	6.45	4.21	2.67	2.35	6.04	3.98	2.85	2.83
Indirect Command	10.70	6.92	1.15	1.56	8.50	5.47	0.98	1.03
Neutral Talk	17.61	7.48	14.31	5.73	15.54	8.92	14.00	7.39
Information Question	2.69	2.65	3.21	2.51	3.01	3.18	2.83	3.30
Labeled Praise	0.26	0.63	0.00	0.00	0.25	0.60	0.01	0.08
Play Talk	0.34	1.55	1.43	2.52	0.23	0.52	6.70	9.06
Reflection	0.30	0.58	0.09	0.23	0.30	0.46	0.15	0.40
Smart Talk	0.65	1.78	5.89	7.65	0.28	0.53	0.55	0.94
Unlabeled Praise	2.58	3.16	0.05	0.15	2.35	2.95	0.11	0.31
Vocalization Categories								
Laugh	---- ^a	---- ^a	0.43	1.03	---- ^a	---- ^a	0.45	0.66
Whine	0.01	0.07	6.98	8.62	0.00	0.00	5.24	9.78
Yell	0.19	1.45	1.92	3.57	0.06	0.32	1.91	4.21
Physical Categories								
Negative Touch	0.95	2.01	0.13	0.31	0.46	0.98	0.31	1.37
Positive Touch	0.41	0.78	0.09	0.23	0.25	0.49	0.11	0.42
Response Categories								
Answer	2.10	1.66	1.29	1.34	1.83	2.44	1.40	1.57
No Answer	0.71	0.79	0.52	0.90	0.54	0.74	0.66	1.18
No Opportunity for Answer	0.36	0.57	0.85	1.11	0.40	0.51	0.93	1.21
Comply	0.30	0.51	6.64	4.45	0.24	0.65	6.85	4.93
Noncompliant	1.43	2.27	7.86	6.66	1.03	1.35	6.78	7.22
No Opportunity for Compliance	1.55	1.85	18.95	12.64	1.31	1.60	16.16	10.30
Selected Composite Categories								
Inappropriate Behavior	16.58	8.24	13.81	9.62	14.55	7.30	11.46	8.46
Prosocial Behavior	3.70	4.08	6.87	4.47	3.26	3.55	7.25	5.05
Percent Negative Verbalizations	---- ^a	---- ^a	---- ^a	---- ^a	---- ^a	---- ^a	---- ^a	---- ^a
Percent Positive Following	---- ^a	---- ^a	---- ^a	---- ^a	---- ^a	---- ^a	---- ^a	---- ^a
Total Commands	33.70	17.75	---- ^a	---- ^a	29.89	17.08	---- ^a	---- ^a
Total Praise	2.84	3.60	---- ^a	---- ^a	2.60	3.30	---- ^a	---- ^a
Total Verbalizations	77.10	24.79	39.09	13.77	67.53	28.00	35.16	16.50

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